

COMPLETE INTERVIEW RESEARCH PACK

Deloitte UK Consulting & Technology

The role decoded, the firm from the inside, the industry from zero, the rules that bind it, live news, the full recruitment process, a 40-plus question bank, a scenario playbook and a mechanism-based answer to "why Deloitte?"

Prepared for

A UK undergraduate applying for 2027 entry to Deloitte UK's consulting and technology businesses (graduate, vacation scheme or placement)

Stage

Application. No interview booked yet. The pack covers every stage from the form to the final interview.

Prepared 4 October 2026 from public sources only. Every non-obvious claim carries a source marker [Sxx] resolving to Part 15, and a confidence tag: **Confirmed** (primary source or two credible outlets), **Reported** (single credible source), **Inferred** (the author's reasoning). This is independent preparation material. It is not produced, reviewed or endorsed by Deloitte.

CONTENTS

What is in this pack

Part 0: How to use this pack, and the 10-minute version	5
Who this is for, and where you are now	5
How the parts fit together, and what to read first	6
The 10-minute emergency version	7
The master diagram: the firm, the industry and the role on one page	8
How to read this pack: tags, sources and boxes	10
Part 1: The role, decoded line by line, and the team mapped	11
Read this first: timing, and which posting is "the JD"	11
What Deloitte calls things now	12
THE JD: the text that matters	14
The JD decoded, line by line	15
The sister postings: what the other consulting teams do	21
Two worked days in the seat	22
Kinds of work, grades, and how people are judged	25
The compliance and control side of the job	27
The team mapped: where TST sits and who leads it	30
How big the team is: an estimate with the method shown	32
How the work splits: offering, industry and location	33
How a client request moves through the team	35
How this compares with peers	37
What to take from this Part	37
Part 2: The firm as a business, from the inside	39
A. The founding insight: an independent check on other people's numbers	39
B. How the firm makes money: from a client's fee to a partner's share	41
C. The contracts: what partners, staff and clients each give and get	48
D. The risk and control architecture	49
E. Business mix and growth over time	52
F. What "private partnership" means for your research	55
G. Where leadership says the firm is going, and what the spending says	56
H. Recent moves, October 2024 to October 2026	57
I. The skeletons, told straight	58
Part 3: Why Deloitte is built this way	61
The short answer	61
What the structure actually is	61
Why one partnership: the theory and the numbers	62
What the structure costs	65
The natural experiment: EY's Project Everest	66
How the businesses work together	67
What clients actually buy	70
The non-core side: the centre and internal AI	72
Putting it together: how a client team is wired into the firm	73
Part 4: How Deloitte stands out	76
The field at a glance	76
Six design choices, and where each firm sits	77
What only Deloitte can claim	81
Where Deloitte does not lead	82

Part 5: The industry from zero	84
What consulting sells, and who buys it	84
The five kinds of firm, and how they differ	85
How consulting differs from its neighbours	85
How a consulting firm makes money	86
Core vocabulary in one place	88
How big is the market?	88
The forces reshaping the industry now	90
Where it goes in the next three to five years: five competing views	94
Part 6: The role's own industry and its regulation	95
Why a lightly regulated industry still has rules that bite	95
Rule set 1: auditor independence	95
Rule set 2: operational separation of audit	98
Rule set 3: audit reform, from white paper to abandonment	98
Rule set 4: how the government buys consultancy	99
Rule set 5: data and AI	100
Rule set 6: the client-side regulation consultants are hired to implement	101
The competitive map of UK suppliers	105
Part 7: What is happening right now	106
How to use this part	106
The results: Deloitte UK and Deloitte global, FY2026	107
Leadership, people and the pyramid	109
Clients, government and the market	111
Rules and reputation	113
The latest Deloitte CFO Survey	114
Tech Trends 2026 in brief	114
How to stay current between now and the interview	115
Part 8: Forming your own view	116
The method: how to build an opinion in 45 seconds	116
Debate 1: Will AI break the consulting pyramid?	117
Debate 2: Should the Big Four split audit from consulting?	118
Debate 3: Is the government right to cut consultancy spend?	118
Debate 4: Is outcome-based pricing good for clients?	119
Debate 5: Offshore delivery centres or UK regional centres?	120
Debate 6: Should graduates fear AI?	120
Debate 7: Is Deloitte's EMEA merger smart?	121
Debate 8: Partnership or company: which funds AI better?	121
Debate 9: Should Deloitte push harder into managed services?	122
A one-page cheat sheet	122
Part 9: The interview: process, question bank, questions to ask	124
The process in one view	124
Stage by stage: what happens, what it tests, how sure we are	125
What happens after an offer	127
Your timeline from today (4 October 2026)	128
The Final Stage topic discussion	128
The question bank	129
Questions to ask them	136
Part 10: Who you will meet: interviewer and leadership briefing	137
Interviewer types by stage	137
How to pitch to each type	137
Reading the interviewer, and adjusting honestly	138
Leaders to recognise	138

Part 11: The scenario playbook	140
Why scenarios decide this process	140
The four-step answer protocol	141
The priority order when good things collide	142
Ranking items: applying the order to multiple choice	145
Eight ways interviewers break a frame	146
Staying calm physically: what the evidence supports	148
The scenario ladder: every JD duty line, three rungs	149
The composure set: five hard role-specific scenarios	150
The CV grill: holding your ground three levels deep	155
Part 11: Scenario cards by duty line	158
D1 · Senior client engagement and rapport	158
D2 · IT operating model	159
D3 · The digital core and the technology landscape	161
D4 · Business case and value	162
D5 · Net zero and inclusive ways of working	164
D6 · Large-scale transformation, design through implementation	165
D7 · Requirements	167
D8 · Documents and client materials	168
D9 · Firm-approved AI, used responsibly	170
D10 · Teaming across the wider T&T practice	171
Part 12: Why Deloitte, in three lengths, and the counter-case	174
The idea behind every version	174
The 30-second version	174
The 2-minute version	175
The close: one specific thing you would work on	175
What most candidates say, and what you can say	175
The counter-case: why someone might reasonably choose elsewhere	176
Part 13: Cheat sheet	179
Part 14: Glossary	180
Terms A to Z	180
Part 15: Source table	187
All sources, by ID	187
Part 16: Gaps and open questions	204
How to use this part	204
What could not be established	204
Where sources disagree, and what this pack did	207
Self-check against the brief	208

PART 0

How to use this pack, and the 10-minute version

Start here. This part tells you what to do this week, which parts to read in the time you have, the fifteen facts that matter most, and how to read the tags and boxes. It includes one diagram that holds the whole story.

Who this is for, and where you are now

This pack is for a UK undergraduate applying for 2027 entry to Deloitte UK's consulting or technology business: a graduate role, a Summer Vacation Scheme (Deloitte's internship) or an Industrial Placement. It assumes you know little about consulting today (about 2 out of 10), that no interview is booked, and that pictures help you learn. It is built only from public sources, each tagged with an ID such as [S14] that you can look up in Part 15.

You are at the **application stage**, and timing is the most urgent fact in the pack. Deloitte's 2026/27 timeline says Consulting, Advisory, Enabling Functions and Real Estate roles open on 5 October 2026, and Technology roles open partly on 28 September and partly on 5 October [S14] **CONFIRMED**. On 4 October only a first wave of Consulting roles was live, in Belfast and Edinburgh [S1] **CONFIRMED**. Deloitte runs "a strict one application per year policy" across its early-careers programmes [S14] **CONFIRMED**, and it closes roles early when volumes are high [S13][S261] **CONFIRMED**. So you get one shot, and an early one is better than a polished late one.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Two research passes read the same Deloitte timelines page on the same day and saw different versions: one showed the 2026/27 dates above [S14], the other still showed the 2024 cycle [S262]. Both point to 5 October for Consulting. Treat the date as very likely, and check the board yourself on 5 October.

Do this week (5 to 11 October 2026)

Action	Why, and the detail
☐ Monday 5 October: check the board	Look for London Technology & Transformation (T&T) and Consulting roles as they go live [S1][S14]. The Belfast Technology Strategy graduate role used in this pack closes on 23 October 2026 "or earlier" [S2].
☐ Pick your programme	Graduate if you will graduate by September 2027 with at least a 2:1 (achieved or predicted) [S2]. Summer Vacation Scheme if you are in your penultimate year: expected start 28 June 2027, six weeks in T&T [S13][S57]. Industrial Placement: 12 months, can lead to a graduate offer [S13].
☐ Pick one team	"Consulting" on the careers site means T&T teams; "Advisory" means Strategy, Risk & Transactions teams [S12][S15]. Read Part 1 before choosing. You cannot transfer an application between roles [S261].
☐ Check your visa position	The consulting early-careers postings say the salary does not meet the threshold for Skilled Worker visa sponsorship [S2][S4] CONFIRMED . If you would need sponsorship, raise it with Deloitte before applying.
☐ Read the Integrity & AI guidance	No AI in the online assessments or interviews. AI is allowed for final-stage topic research if you check it against reliable sources [S351] CONFIRMED .

Action	Why, and the detail
☐ Fill in the form	About 15 minutes, one sitting, progress not saved. Have your GCSE and A-level grades to hand [S260].
☐ Practise the online assessment	Use the Candidate Zone practice tests first. Deloitte's own advice: "go with your gut instinct" [S260].
☐ Learn two things by heart	The 10-minute version below and the 30-second "why Deloitte" (Part 12).

How the parts fit together, and what to read first

The pack moves from the outside in: the firm, its market and its rules first, then the interview, then what you say. Figure 33, later in this part, draws that chain on one page.

Part	What it gives you
1 The role and the JD	The real job advert decoded line by line into ten duties, D1 to D10, plus a worked day and the team map.
2 The firm as a business	How fees become partner profit, the numbers since 2015, the risk controls and the scandals, told straight.
3 Why Deloitte is built this way	The mechanism behind one partnership with audit, tax and consulting, and what it costs.
4 How Deloitte stands out	Rivals compared on six design choices; what only Deloitte can claim, and where it does not lead.
5 and 6 Industry and regulation	Consulting from zero, market size, the forces now, and the rules that bite (independence, procurement, data, AI).
7 and 8 News and views	The live stories, then nine debates with both sides and a suggested stance, so you can hold an opinion.
9 and 10 The interview and the people	Every stage of recruitment, the question bank, questions to ask, and who you will meet.
11 The scenario playbook	One answer protocol (steady, sort, act, close), one priority order, eight frame-breaks, thirty scenarios (three per duty, easy to hard), five hard composure scenarios and a CV grill.
12 Why Deloitte	The answer in 30 seconds, 2 minutes and a closing line, plus the honest counter-case.
13 Cheat sheet	One page for the waiting room.
14, 15, 16	Glossary, every source by ID, and the gaps and conflicts this pack could not close.

Reading plans

ONE HOUR

1. This part's 10-minute version and Figure 33 (15 min)
2. Part 12, the 30-second answer (5 min)
3. Part 9: the process and your timeline (15 min)
4. Part 13, the cheat sheet (10 min)
5. Then apply (15 min)

ONE EVENING (3 HOURS)

1. Everything in the one-hour plan
2. Part 1: the JD and duties
3. Part 2, sections B and E (money and growth)
4. Part 3, the short answer
5. Part 7, the top stories
6. Part 11, the composure set, out loud

A WEEK

1. Day 1: Parts 1 and 2
2. Day 2: Parts 3 and 4
3. Day 3: Parts 5 and 6
4. Day 4: Parts 7 and 8; write three opinions
5. Day 5: Parts 9 and 10; record answers
6. Day 6: Part 11, ten scenarios aloud
7. Day 7: Parts 12 and 13; a mock interview

Use Part 14 whenever a term is new, and read Part 16 once so you know what nobody outside the firm can confirm.

The 10-minute emergency version

If you read nothing else, read this. Each fact is one you can say out loud, with its source.

£5.81bn

Deloitte UK revenue FY26, +2%, UK and Switzerland consolidated [S407]

£1.75bn

UK Technology & Transformation revenue FY26, +4% [S407]

US\$74.5bn

Deloitte global revenue FY26, +3.8% in local currency [S70]

784

UK equity partners, a record, up 6.5% [S407]

- The year.** Deloitte UK's financial year ends on 31 May. In FY26 revenue rose 2% to £5.81bn and distributable profit (the pool shared by the owning partners) rose 14% to £899m [S407] **CONFIRMED**.
- The precision point.** £5.81bn is "UK and Switzerland consolidated" [S407]. Deloitte's metrics split it: UK £5,014m, Switzerland £795m [S88] **CONFIRMED**. Say "the UK and Swiss firm" when you quote £5.81bn.
- Four businesses.** Since 2024 Deloitte runs four businesses. UK FY26: Technology & Transformation £1.75bn (+4%), Tax & Legal £1.36bn (+2%), Audit & Assurance £998m (+3%), Strategy, Risk & Transactions Advisory £913m (+1%). They sum to about £5.01bn, the UK figure [S407][S88] **CONFIRMED**.
- T&T is your business, and it has had a bumpy ride.** It is the largest UK business, about 35% of UK revenue [S88] **INFERRED**. It fell 10% in FY25, then grew 4% in FY26 on ERP, cyber and human capital work [S89][S407] **CONFIRMED**.
- The global contrast.** Globally Deloitte made US\$74.5bn, but T&T was the slowest-growing business at 2.5% [S70] **CONFIRMED**. In the UK it was the fastest. That contrast is a ready-made question.
- The leaders.** Darren Graves became UK CEO on 1 June 2026; Jane Whitlock chairs the UK Board; Hayley McKelvey joined the UK Executive as the first Chief AI Officer [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Hammad Rafique leads UK T&T [S274] **CONFIRMED**.
- The EMEA firm.** On 1 June 2026 the UK firm joined Deloitte EMEA, led by Richard Houston: 16 firms, about 132,000 people, about €20bn of revenue and over €1.5bn of planned investment over four years [S277][S407] **CONFIRMED**.
- The independence point.** Deloitte also audits. UK rules let an auditor sell only a short "whitelist" of other services to the large listed companies, banks and insurers it audits (public interest entities), with non-audit fees capped at 70% of the audit fee [S39][S364] **CONFIRMED**. So consulting is built mostly on clients Deloitte does not audit: £3,819m of non-audit revenue came from non-audit clients in FY25, against £155m from audit clients [S35] **CONFIRMED**.
- AI inside the firm.** Deloitte's own generative AI tool, PairD, reached 75,000 people in Europe and the Middle East by January 2024 [S328], and UK staff sent it about a million prompts a month in FY25 [S85] **CONFIRMED**. In October 2025 Deloitte rolled out Anthropic's Claude to more than 470,000 people, with 15,000 to be certified [S116] **CONFIRMED**.
- AI in your job.** The JD's sister posting lists "Using firm-approved AI tools responsibly to support client delivery" as a duty [S3] **CONFIRMED**. "Firm-approved" means client data stays inside approved tools.
- The Australia lesson.** In 2025 Deloitte Australia agreed to repay part of a A\$440,000 government contract after its report was found to contain fabricated references and a misquoted court judgment; the revised report disclosed AI use [S388] **CONFIRMED**. The lesson: you own every line you send.
- The recruitment stages.** Application, Immersive Online Assessment, Job Simulation (recorded), Final Stage (a 30 to 40 minute topic discussion and a 50 minute skills and motivation interview), outcome. Each step comes "within four weeks" of the last [S260] **CONFIRMED**.
- The values.** Use the five Shared Values: Lead the way; Serve with integrity; Take care of each other; Foster inclusion; Collaborate for measurable impact [S266] **CONFIRMED**. Prep sites still quote an old list of four; do not use it [S264].

14. **Partner numbers, if asked.** 784 equity partners is the year-end headcount from the results release; the accounts give 799 on a full-time-equivalent average basis [S407][S88] **CONFIRMED** . Quote 784.
15. **The market.** UK consulting was worth about £21.8bn in 2025 after 3% growth, with 6% forecast for 2026 [S150] **REPORTED** .

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW (THE 30-SECOND WHY DELOITTE)

"I want to start where the shape of the firm helps me learn. Deloitte keeps audit, tax, advisory and technology in one partnership, and last year showed why that matters: in FY25 T&T revenue fell 10%, but the firm fell only 1% [S89][S305]. That stability pays for £180 million of technology investment and a new Chief AI Officer [S407]. And in FY26 T&T was the fastest-growing UK business, on ERP, cyber and human capital work [S407]. That is the work I want to learn."

ONE QUESTION TO ASK THEM

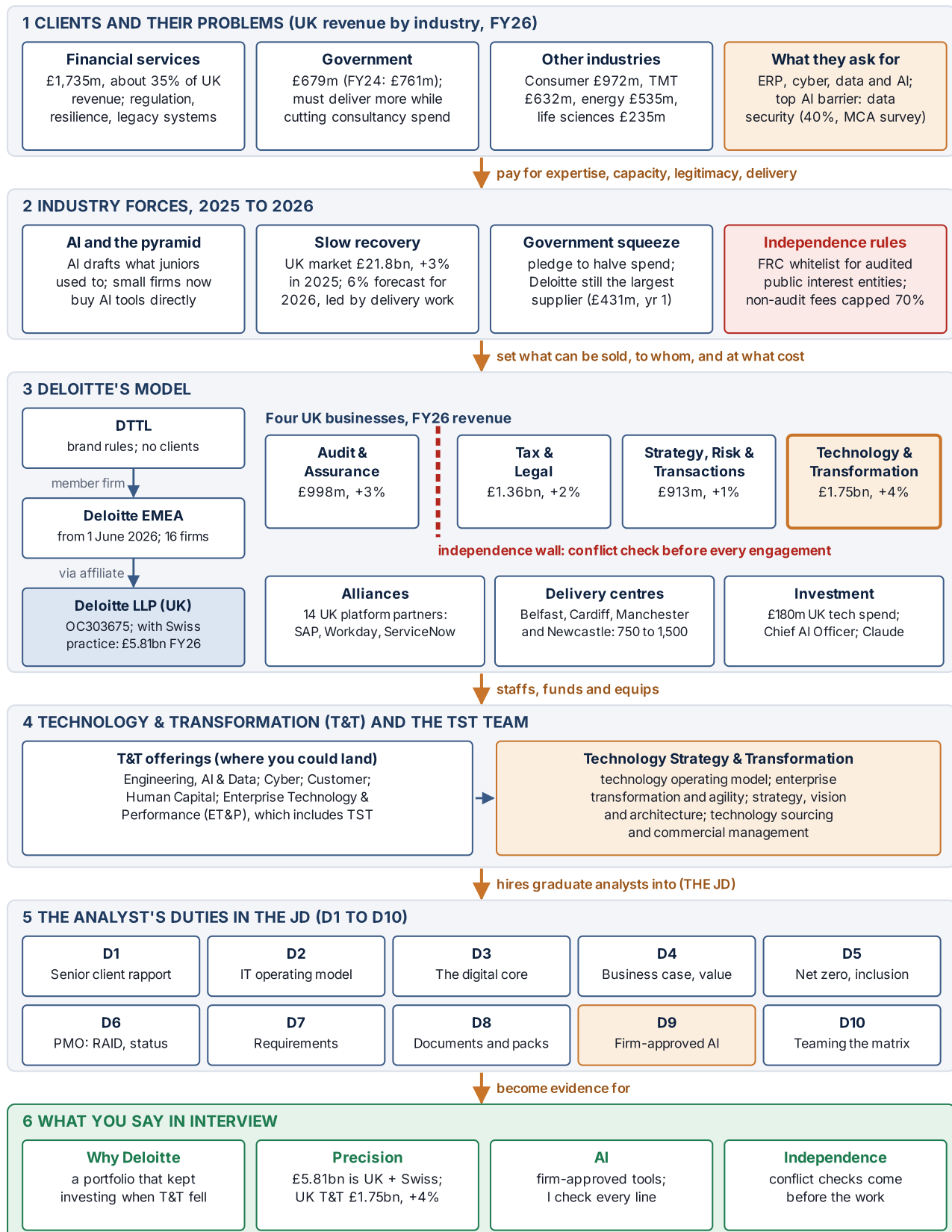
"Globally T&T grew slowest at 2.5%, but in the UK it grew fastest at 4%. What is the UK doing differently?" [S70][S407]

DON'T SAY THIS

"Deloitte UK made £5.81bn." That figure includes Switzerland [S407]. Also avoid "Deloitte is the biggest consulting firm on every measure": Accenture is about the same size overall [S129].

The master diagram: the firm, the industry and the role on one page

Read Figure 33 from top to bottom. Clients have problems and pay fees (layer 1). Industry forces decide what can be sold, to whom and at what cost (layer 2). Deloitte's model turns that into four businesses, a network, alliances and delivery centres, with an independence wall between audit and the advisory businesses for audit clients (layer 3). Technology & Transformation and its Technology Strategy & Transformation (TST) team are where the JD sits (layer 4). Its ten duties (layer 5) are what you will do, and each one gives you evidence for the four things you say in interview (layer 6).

Figure 33 The master diagram: the firm, the industry and the role on one page

Sources: [S88] Deloitte UK FY26 metrics and [S407] FY26 results (Sep 2026); [S240] MCA survey (May 2026); [S239] City AM (Sep 2026); [S150] MCA (Jul 2026); [S149] Source; [S173] NAO (Nov 2025); [S174] Tussell via City AM (Jul 2025); [S364] FRC Ethical Standard 2024; [S277] Deloitte EMEA (Feb 2026); [S319] alliances; [S323] (May 2025); [S2], [S3] JD postings (Oct 2026). Read: each arrow says what flows down to the next layer.

How to read this pack: tags, sources and boxes

Every non-obvious fact carries a source ID in square brackets, such as [S407]. In the PDF it is a link to the source table in Part 15, which gives the outlet, title, date, web address and whether the page was read in full. A confidence tag follows the claim:

Tag	What it means	Example
CONFIRMED	A primary source (Deloitte, a regulator, a statute) or two credible outlets agree.	UK T&T revenue £1.75bn in FY26 [S407] CONFIRMED .
REPORTED	One credible source, or a primary page that may be out of date. Fine to use; say where it came from.	The UK consulting market grew 3% in 2025 [S150] REPORTED .
INFERRED	This pack's own reasoning from sourced facts. Present it as your view.	T&T is about 35% of UK revenue [S88] INFERRED .
ESTIMATE	A calculated figure with stated assumptions. Labelled on charts too.	UK T&T fee-earning headcount of roughly 5,000 to 7,500 [S23][S24] ESTIMATE .
ANECDOTE	A candidate's or employee's own account. Useful colour, never proof.	An experienced-hire candidate reported a director round [S286] ANECDOTE .

Coloured boxes mark what to do with a piece of information. Here is one of each.

KEY TERM

Utilisation: the share of a consultant's available hours that is billed to clients. Firms watch it closely because sold hours are revenue.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

A debate with both sides and a suggested stance. You choose. Example: should graduates fear AI? Part 8 gives the case each way.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

A line you can use as written, with its source, for example the 30-second answer above.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Sources disagree or the fact rests on one weak source. Example: the opening-date page above. Part 16 lists every case.

DON'T SAY THIS

A common mistake, and why it hurts, for example quoting the old four values [S264].

Figures have numbered titles that state the point, and a caption naming the sources and dates. Scenario cards in Part 11 are coloured green, amber or red for easy, medium and hard.

PART 1

The role, decoded line by line, and the team mapped

What the job actually is, in plain English: the posting quoted, every duty translated into what you would do on a Tuesday, who you would work with, the rules that fence the work in, and a map of the team you would join, with each box marked by how sure we are.

Read this first: timing, and which posting is "the JD"

You are researching on 4 October 2026. That date matters, because Deloitte UK opens most of its 2027 consulting roles the next day. Its official timeline says Consulting, Advisory, Enabling Functions and Real Estate open on "5th October". Technology opened partly on 28 September and partly opens on 5 October. Scotland opened first, on 21 September [S14] **CONFIRMED**.

5 Oct 2026

Consulting and Advisory early-careers roles open [S14]

23 Oct 2026

Closing date for THE JD (Belfast TST graduate, 25060); may close earlier [S2]

168

Early-careers programmes live on 4 Oct 2026, mostly Audit, Tax and IT Audit [S1]

1

Applications allowed per year across all Deloitte UK early-careers roles [S14]

SOURCE UNCERTAIN: WHICH POSTING, AND WHEN

The JD used in this pack is a Belfast posting, not a London one. On 4 October 2026 the live board showed a first wave of Consulting roles in Belfast and Edinburgh only. London Consulting graduate postings were not yet live [S1] **CONFIRMED**. This pack therefore treats "Technology Strategy Consulting - Technology Strategy & Transformation", Full Time Graduate, Belfast, posting 25060, as THE JD [S2] **CONFIRMED**. It was chosen because it is a full graduate role, it sits in the core technology consulting model, and its duty list is the most general on the board.

What to do: re-check the board on 5 October. When the London Technology & Transformation postings appear, compare their text line by line with the extract below. Deloitte says roles "may close before the deadline if we experience high demand" [S2], so apply early once you have chosen.

The one-application rule. Deloitte runs "a strict one application per year policy across our Early Careers opportunities" [S14] **CONFIRMED**. Choosing the team is a real decision. Read the sister postings table later in this Part before you pick.

Two oddities in THE JD. Its header says "This role sits within the Finance Transformation Consulting persona", and it says there are "two core areas" but describes only one [S2] **CONFIRMED** (that the text says this). Both look like copy-and-paste leftovers from a template **INFERRED**. Do not build an answer on either line.

The job is a graduate role starting in September 2027. You need a 2:1 (obtained or predicted) in any subject and must have graduated by September 2027 [S2] **CONFIRMED**. The salary is not stated. The posting says it is below the threshold for Skilled Worker visa sponsorship, so Deloitte cannot progress candidates who need that visa [S2] **CONFIRMED**. Self-reported salary snippets of about £34k to £39k exist for consulting graduates, but they are low-confidence and should not be quoted in an interview [S58][S59] **REPORTED**.

What Deloitte calls things now

Deloitte renamed its businesses in recent years, and older blog posts use the old names. Getting the current names right is an easy signal that you have done your reading. Here is the vocabulary, from the top down.

Four businesses

Deloitte UK runs four businesses. Each is a large division with its own leaders, people and revenue line [S24] [S23] **CONFIRMED** :

Business (firm name)	What students see	UK revenue FY26	What it does, in one line
Technology & Transformation (T&T)	"Consulting"	£1,746m (+4%)	Designs and delivers change in how clients run, mostly through technology: strategy through to implementation and managed services [S12][S40].
Strategy, Risk & Transactions Advisory (SR&T)	"Advisory"	£913m (+1%)	Strategy (including Monitor Deloitte), mergers and acquisitions, valuations, infrastructure, sustainability, and risk, regulatory and forensic work [S15][S45].
Tax & Legal	Tax & Legal	£1,357m (+2%)	Tax advice and compliance, and legal services.
Audit & Assurance	Audit & Assurance	£998m (+3%)	Statutory audit (checking companies' accounts) and other assurance.

Revenue: UK only, year to 31 May 2026 [S23] **CONFIRMED** . The headline £5.81bn in press reports is "UK and Switzerland consolidated"; UK alone was £5,014m and Switzerland £795m [S407][S88] **CONFIRMED** .

T&T is the largest UK business. It earned about 35% of UK revenue in FY26 **INFERRED** (arithmetic on [S23]). It fell about 10% in FY25 and grew 4% in FY26, but is still below its FY24 level of £1,857m [S23] **CONFIRMED** (figures). Trade press named ERP implementation (large finance and operations software) and cyber as material contributors to the FY26 growth [S30] **REPORTED** .

KEY TERM

"Consulting" versus "Advisory": on the early-careers website, "Consulting" is the label for teams inside Technology & Transformation, and "Advisory" is the label for teams inside Strategy, Risk & Transactions [S12][S15][S57] **CONFIRMED** . Deloitte's own results footnote says its "advisory businesses include the Technology & Transformation (T&T) business as well as the Strategy, Risk & Transactions Advisory (SRTA) business" [S407] **CONFIRMED** . So the press may call both "advisory". In interviews, use the business names.

Offerings: the teams inside a business

Each business is split into **offerings**. An offering is a team that owns a type of service: its methods, its software partnerships and its people. Inside T&T, Deloitte UK's website lists these offerings [S12][S40] **CONFIRMED** :

- **Customer (Deloitte Digital)**: marketing, commerce, sales and service technology, such as customer relationship management systems.
- **Cyber**: security strategy, defence and resilience, digital trust and privacy, and managed cyber operations.
- **Engineering, AI & Data (EAD)**: software engineering, data platforms and AI, plus Operations, Industry & Domain Solutions.
- **Enterprise Technology & Performance (ET&P)**: the big "back-office" platforms and the strategy around them. It includes Finance Transformation, SAP, Oracle, ServiceNow, Supply Chain & Network Operations, and **Technology Strategy & Transformation (TST)**, the team in THE JD.

- **Human Capital:** HR strategy, workforce and organisation change, HR systems, Major Programmes, and actuarial work.

KEY TERM

Persona: a recruiting family Deloitte uses to group early-careers roles by type of work. The current consulting personas are Business Transformation Consulting, Enterprise Applications Consulting, Technology Strategy Consulting, Finance Transformation Consulting and Risk & Controls Consulting [S2][S4][S7][S8][S9][S10] **CONFIRMED** . A persona tells you the kind of work. The team name after the dash tells you which offering you land in. "Technology Strategy Consulting - Technology Strategy & Transformation" means persona first, team second.

KEY TERM

Industry: the client sector a team serves. Deloitte UK's industries are Consumer; Energy, Resources & Industrials; Financial Services; Government & Public Services; Life Sciences & Healthcare; Technology, Media & Telecommunications; plus Private Equity [S12][S26] **CONFIRMED** . Offerings (what you do) and industries (who you do it for) cross like the rows and columns of a grid. That grid is called a **matrix**, and it decides who you work with.

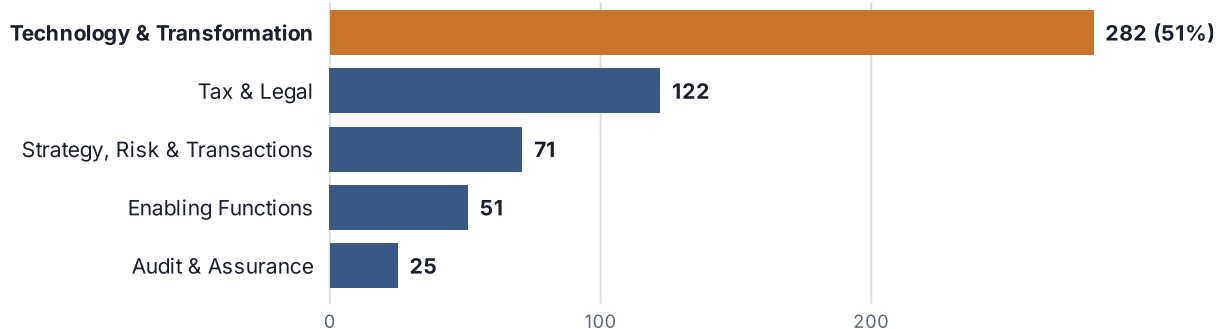
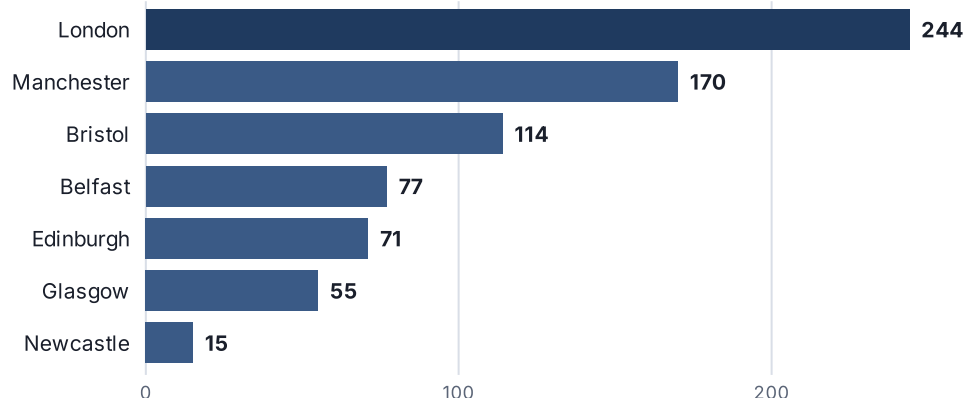
KEY TERM

Engagement: one piece of paid client work with an agreed scope, team, price and end date. Consultants say "project" and "engagement" interchangeably. **Analyst:** Deloitte's name for a graduate joiner in T&T ("As a Graduate (we call you Analysts)") [S4] **CONFIRMED** .

Two older names have faded. "Strategy & Operations" no longer appears as an early-careers team name. "Government & Public Services" now appears as an industry, and "Defence & Security" appears inside many experienced-hire job titles [S40][S49] **CONFIRMED** . If an older blog says "Deloitte Consulting has five service lines", it predates the four-business model.

What the firm is hiring for right now

Job postings are one of the few public windows into a private partnership. On 4 October 2026 Deloitte UK listed 591 experienced-hire postings. We parsed 551 of them and counted them by business and city [S49]. Figure 14 shows the result. Treat it as a sample: 40 postings could not be read, and a posting is a vacancy, not a person.

Figure 14 What Deloitte UK is hiring for: experienced-hire postings by business and city**A. Experienced-hire postings by business (551 of 591 listed postings parsed)****B. Technology & Transformation postings by city (282 postings; a multi-city posting counts once per city)**

Counts taken from the live board on 2026-10-04. Counts are a sample, not headcount.

Source: [S49] Deloitte UK experienced-hire job board, counted 2026-10-04 (591 listed, 551 parsed; counts by business assigned from posting titles and teams). Read: T&T dominates hiring, and Manchester is its second hub after London. Postings are vacancies, not headcount.

Two readings matter. First, T&T is where the hiring is: just over half of all parsed experienced postings [S49] **CONFIRMED** (our count). That shows where the firm is investing, not that T&T is half the firm. Second, London is the main T&T hub, but Manchester is a strong second, and Bristol, Belfast, Edinburgh and Glasgow all hire into T&T [S49] **CONFIRMED** (count) **INFERRED** (reading). If a London interviewer asks whether you would work with colleagues in other cities, the honest answer is that you almost certainly will.

THE JD: the text that matters

Below is a compact extract of THE JD, keeping every duty line word for word. Navigation text, benefits links and the application small print are left out. The full text was read on 4 October 2026 [S2] **CONFIRMED**.

Technology Strategy Consulting - Technology Strategy & Transformation

Programme: Full Time Graduate. Career Path: Consulting. Location: Belfast. Start Date: September-2027. Posting 25060. Closes 23 October 2026.

What does this team do? "In Technology Strategy and Transformation (TST), we focus on enabling our clients to be the best that they can be. We work with their most senior leaders and top-level executives to help them digitise and modernise their organisations from the ground up. We lead the transformation of the organisation itself with innovative and core technologies, helping organisations move away from IT, the department of computers, to technology as a business partner and enabler.

Our teams combine strategic thinking, advisory services, and cutting-edge technology capabilities to create a digital core that has the capability to drive new processes, improved analytics, and improved performance across the business.

We proudly partner with some of the world's largest and most successful organisations, helping COOs, CFOs, CIOs, and their teams achieve their goals, whether that is improving financial performance, accelerating speed to market, delivering continuous innovation, and entering exciting new fields like AI. ... We help them to transform how their businesses run and the technologies they use in ways that drive net zero and incorporate inclusive ways of working.

Our TST market offerings include: Technology Operating Model; Enterprise Transformation & Agility; Technology Strategy, Vision and Architecture; Technology Sourcing & Commercial Management."

What kind of work will I do? "As a Full Time Graduate in TST, you will work on large-scale technology transformations, from the design through to implementation. As part of your role, you will be:

- Learning how to engage with clients to solve their most complex problems
- Working with individuals from our clients' business and IT teams to understand what the problems and needs are, and transforming those into technical requirements
- Creating documents crucial to the delivery and execution of the programme, alongside materials presented back to clients
- Discovering how technologies support everything an organisation does, and which technologies work best for each part of a business
- Using firm-approved AI tools responsibly to support client delivery
- Help assess technology investments, identify opportunities to improve value, agility, efficiency, and user experience.

Throughout your time at Deloitte, you will be working with teams across our wider Technology and Transformation practice, understanding how we bring our range of technical expertise and combine them in the way that best serves our clients."

How will I develop? "... What technologies organisations currently use and how they can transform those to better achieve their strategic objectives; How to interpret business strategic and objectives and transform those into requirements and solutions; What large-scale technology transformations look like; How to build rapport with clients and ensure they have confidence in your capability."

Also in the posting: minimum 2:1 in any discipline; hybrid working, with client-facing staff "expected to attend client sites on certain days"; final assessment and induction in person; one application per year; no Skilled Worker sponsorship [S2].

The JD decoded, line by line

The JD's lines collapse into ten duties, labelled D1 to D10. The same labels are used in the scenario playbook later in the pack, so you can trace any practice scenario back to a line of the posting. Each duty below has five parts: what it means day to day, who you deal with, the tools, what good looks like, and what the line reveals about the firm.

A word on confidence. Deloitte does not publish an analyst's diary. The "day to day" content is built from Deloitte's own job postings, staff profiles and service pages, and is marked **INFERRED** where it is our reasoning. Quotes are from the postings themselves.

Figure 15 first shows where these duties sit in the life of a client problem. Most engagements move through some or all of seven stages. Your contribution changes at each one.

Figure 15 The role's value chain: from a client problem to a delivered outcome

Stage labels and analyst tasks: Inferred from Deloitte job postings

Sources: duty lines from [S2] [S3] [S4] [S6] [S8] [S9]; offerings from [S12]. Stage names and the mapping of tasks to stages are Inferred. Read: follow the copper column to see how an Analyst's work changes as an engagement moves from diagnosis to go-live.

D1. Senior client engagement and rapport

"We work with their most senior leaders and top-level executives"; "How to build rapport with clients and ensure they have confidence in your capability" [S2]

Day to day You will rarely lead a conversation with a client's chief information officer (CIO) in year one. You prepare the pack the partner or director uses, sit in the room, take notes and chase the actions afterwards. Rapport at your level is built in small exchanges with the client's analysts and managers: answering a data question the same day, sending minutes within hours **INFERRED**.

Who you deal with Client: CIO, chief financial officer (CFO), chief operating officer (COO) and their direct reports. Deloitte: a partner who owns the relationship, a director or associate director who leads the engagement, a manager who runs the plan day to day **INFERRED** (grade names **CONFIRMED** [S49][S66]).

Tools PowerPoint meeting packs, Word minutes, Excel action logs, Microsoft Teams **INFERRED**.

What good looks like Reliability. Small promises kept. You know the client's organisation chart and who decides what. You never surprise your manager **INFERRED**.

What it reveals TST sells to the top of the client. Its strategy work can open the door to larger implementation work elsewhere in T&T **INFERRED**. A T&T director describes a week with "a check-in with my client on a project, so we can manage any potential risks" and "preparing a bid to win new work" [S55] **CONFIRMED** (quote).

D2. The IT operating model

"helping organisations move away from IT, the department of computers, to technology as a business partner and enabler" [S2]

KEY TERM

Operating model: how a function is organised, staffed, funded, sourced (in-house or outsourced) and governed. A **technology operating model** answers "who does what in technology, who pays, and who decides". It is the first of TST's four market offerings [S2] **CONFIRMED**.

Day to day	Current-state interviews with IT leaders; a capability map (a one-page grid of everything the IT function does); an IT cost baseline in Excel; summaries of supplier contracts; organisation charts in PowerPoint INFERRED .
Who you deal with	The CIO's leadership team, finance business partners who hold the IT cost data, procurement teams who hold the contracts INFERRED .
Tools	Excel for cost baselines and contract summaries, PowerPoint for maps and charts INFERRED .
What good looks like	A baseline that the client's finance team agrees with. If the starting numbers are disputed, every later recommendation is disputed too INFERRED .
What it reveals	"Technology Sourcing & Commercial Management" is another TST offering [S2] CONFIRMED . Sourcing work (deciding what to outsource, to whom, on what contract) means TST analysts read contracts and compare suppliers INFERRED . The old view of IT as a cost centre is what TST is paid to change.

D3. The digital core and the technology landscape

"create a digital core"; "Discovering how technologies support everything an organisation does, and which technologies work best for each part of a business" [S2]

KEY TERM

ERP (enterprise resource planning): one large software system that runs a company's core processes, such as finance, purchasing, supply chain and often HR. SAP and Oracle are the best-known vendors. The **digital core** is the ERP plus the other core platforms and data that everything else hangs off **INFERRED** (from [S12][S40]).

Day to day	Application inventories (a list of every system the client runs, with owner, cost and age); "keep, retire or replace" assessments; vendor comparisons INFERRED .
Who you deal with	Enterprise architects on both sides; Deloitte's platform teams for SAP, Oracle, Workday or ServiceNow INFERRED .
Tools	Excel inventories, architecture diagrams, vendor documentation INFERRED . Deloitte UK lists alliances with Adobe, Anaplan, Apple, AWS, Google, Informatica, MuleSoft, Oracle, Salesforce, SAP, ServiceNow, UiPath, Workday and Workiva [S12][S40] CONFIRMED .
What good looks like	You can explain in two sentences what each major system does and who depends on it INFERRED .
What it reveals	Deloitte is both adviser and implementer. One posting claims "We are the number one global SAP delivery partner with over 200 implementations delivered to date" [S52] REPORTED (Deloitte's own claim). That raises a fair question: can an adviser with large software alliances recommend platforms objectively? Have a view ready INFERRED .

D4. The business case and value

"improving financial performance, accelerating speed to market, delivering continuous innovation, and entering exciting new fields like AI"; "Help assess technology investments, identify opportunities to improve value, agility, efficiency, and user experience" [S2]

KEY TERM

Business case: the document that justifies spending money on a change. It sets out costs, benefits, risks, timing and options, and usually a payback period (how long until the benefits repay the cost). Boards approve large technology programmes on the strength of it.

Day to day	Benchmarking IT spend against peers, application portfolio rationalisation, cost and benefit models in Excel, sensitivity tables ("what if the benefits arrive a year late?") INFERRED . Deloitte UK's TST service page uses the same words as the JD: "increase the value, agility, efficiency and experience of technology investments" [S41] CONFIRMED .
Who you deal with	The CFO's team and finance business partners, who will challenge every number INFERRED .
Tools	Excel models; benchmark data; PowerPoint summaries INFERRED .
What good looks like	Every number traces to a source. Assumptions are written down and agreed. Each benefit has a named owner on the client side INFERRED .
What it reveals	The business case is the product. Clients spend millions only when someone shows the benefit. An analyst comfortable with Excel and basic finance is useful from week one INFERRED .

D5. Net zero and inclusive ways of working

"transforming their enterprises to make advances in sustainability and diversity and inclusion ... in ways that drive net zero and incorporate inclusive ways of working" **[S2]**

Day to day	Low daily weight for an Analyst. You might add an emissions line to a cloud migration case, or check that a new system works for users with accessibility needs INFERRED .
Who you deal with	The client's sustainability lead; Deloitte's Sustainability team, which sits in SR&T [S15] CONFIRMED (that it sits there).
Tools	The same business case models, with sustainability measures added INFERRED .
What good looks like	You can define net zero (cutting greenhouse gas emissions as far as possible and balancing the rest) and name one technology lever, such as retiring old data centres INFERRED .
What it reveals	Deloitte wants people who connect technology to wider outcomes. It is also fertile ground for an opinion: where do technology and sustainability goals pull against each other, for example the energy demand of AI computing? INFERRED .

D6. Large-scale transformation, design through implementation

"you will work on large-scale technology transformations, from the design through to implementation" **[S2]**

KEY TERM

PMO (programme management office): the small team that keeps a large programme organised: plans, status reports, risks, budgets, governance meetings. **RAID log:** a running list of Risks, Assumptions, Issues and Dependencies, each with an owner and a date. Juniors often own the RAID log. **Steering committee:** the senior client and Deloitte group that meets regularly to take programme decisions.

Day to day	Most first-year time on large programmes goes to PMO work: RAID logs, status reports, plan updates, meeting packs, requirement logs and test tracking INFERRED . Sister postings say it openly: "scheduling meetings and taking minutes, tracking deadlines, and preparing materials" (Cyber) [S9] and "materials for workshops, communications, project plans and progress reporting" (Customer Products) [S4] CONFIRMED .
Who you deal with	The client programme director and workstream leads; your Deloitte manager; build teams on and offshore. An SAP posting asks for communication "with clients and colleagues both on and offshore" [S51] ; a Workday posting mentions "engineering teams (onshore and offshore)" [S50] CONFIRMED .
Tools	Excel, PowerPoint, Word, Jira or Azure DevOps for work tracking, Microsoft Teams INFERRED . Deloitte UK advertises an "Atlassian Center of Excellence" (Atlassian makes Jira) [S49] CONFIRMED .
What good looks like	The RAID log is current, every action has an owner and a date, and the status report tells the truth even when the news is bad INFERRED .

What it reveals Deloitte sells the whole lifecycle, from the first strategy conversation to running the system afterwards. That is its pitch against pure strategy firms on one side and pure IT outsourcers on the other **INFERRED**.

The design-to-implementation span is why the same Analyst can have very different years. Figure 16 contrasts the two channels of work you could be staffed on.

Figure 16 Two channels of work: advisory (strategy, operating model) and delivery (implementation)

	Advisory channel strategy and operating model	Delivery channel implementation of a platform
The client asks	"What should our IT function look like, and is the investment worth it?"	"Make the new system work, on time, for every user who depends on it."
Main output	Operating model, roadmap, business case, steering committee pack.	Configured platform, tested processes, migrated data, trained users.
Team shape	Small: partner, manager and a few consultants and analysts.	Large: many workstreams, client staff, onshore and offshore build teams.
Your day	Interviews, Excel baselines, slide drafts, research, manager reviews.	Stand-ups, requirement logs, test scripts, defect calls, status reports.
Your tools	Excel, PowerPoint, interview logs, benchmark data.	Jira or Azure DevOps, Excel trackers, the platform sandbox.
Good looks like	One message per slide; every number traces to a source.	No surprises: risks raised early, actions closed, tests evidenced.
Rhythm	Weeks to a few months, building towards a decision.	Months to years, building towards a go-live date.

The business case from advisory work often becomes the delivery programme

Inferred from Deloitte job postings; not a Deloitte diagram

Sources: [S2] (TST offerings, design to implementation), [S8] (workshops and labs), [S50] [S51] (onshore and offshore teams), [S49] (Atlassian). Contrast rows are Inferred. Read: the same Analyst title means different days depending on the channel you are staffed on.

D7. Requirements

"Working with individuals from our clients' business and IT teams to understand what the problems and needs are, and transforming those into technical requirements" [S2]

KEY TERM

Requirement: a precise, testable statement of what a system or process must do. "A manager must be able to approve expenses under £500 from a phone" is a requirement. "Make expenses easier" is not. A **user story** is a requirement written from the user's point of view: "As a manager, I want to ... so that ...".

Day to day Run or support workshops; capture "as-is" processes (how work is done today); write requirements or user stories; map them to what the software can do **INFERRED**. Finance Transformation describes "Getting to the bottom of client's problems through interactive workshops and labs" [S8] **CONFIRMED**.

Who you deal with Client process owners (for example the head of accounts payable), client IT, Deloitte functional and technical leads **INFERRED**.

Tools	Process maps, requirements trackers in Excel or Jira, workshop templates INFERRED .
What good looks like	Requirements that are testable, traced to a business objective and signed off by a named client owner INFERRED .
What it reveals	TST is not purely strategy. Its graduates translate between business and technology people, which is the scarce skill on most programmes INFERRED .

D8. Documents and client materials

"Creating documents crucial to the delivery and execution of the programme, alongside materials presented back to clients" **[S2]**

Day to day	PowerPoint is the main output: steering committee packs, design documents, playbooks, training material INFERRED .
Who you deal with	Your manager, who reviews; the client audience, who decides INFERRED .
Tools	PowerPoint and Word in Deloitte templates, with Excel behind every chart INFERRED .
What good looks like	One message per slide, stated in the title. Numbers that tie to a source. No typos. Expect several rounds of review on early drafts INFERRED .
What it reveals	Clear writing is a core skill. The final-stage topic discussion and interview test the same thing: a clear point backed by evidence [S17] CONFIRMED (format).

D9. Firm-approved AI tools, used responsibly

"Using firm-approved AI tools responsibly to support client delivery" **[S3][S2]**

Day to day	Summarising long documents, drafting first versions of minutes or slides, desk research, checking spreadsheets INFERRED . Deloitte's audit business uses an internal tool, PairD, to "analyse, summarise, explain, and translate confidential data, all within its secure digital ecosystem" [S345] CONFIRMED . The names of T&T's internal tools could not be confirmed (gap).
Who you deal with	Your manager, who will want to know what you used AI for; the firm's AI governance, which covers "use-case approval" and "data governance" [S345] CONFIRMED .
Tools	Only tools the firm has approved and secured. Never a public chatbot for client material INFERRED (from [S36][S345]).
What good looks like	You check every fact, number and citation an AI tool produces before it reaches a client. A Deloitte article puts it plainly: "accountability is squarely a human domain" [S347] CONFIRMED .
What it reveals	AI use is now a written junior duty. Deloitte UK named its first Chief AI Officer, Hayley McKelvey, from 1 June 2026 [S407][S274] CONFIRMED . The cautionary tale: Deloitte Australia agreed in 2025 to repay part of a fee after an AI-assisted report contained references that did not exist [S388] CONFIRMED .

D10. Teaming across the wider Technology & Transformation practice

"you will be working with teams across our wider Technology and Transformation practice, understanding how we bring our range of technical expertise and combine them in the way that best serves our clients" **[S2]**

Day to day	Joining a programme led by another offering (say the SAP team), alongside cyber, data and change colleagues; working with Belfast or offshore build teams INFERRED (from [S21][S50][S51]).
Who you deal with	Your People Leader (development and career) and your Resource Manager (who allocates you to engagements) [S4] CONFIRMED (titles; their roles are inferred from the titles).
Tools	Internal staffing and directory systems; names not public INFERRED .
What good looks like	Several teams know you as useful. That gives you more choice of engagements INFERRED .
What it reveals	Deloitte's pitch is breadth: strategy, platforms, cyber, data and people change from one firm. A Major Programmes posting says "we collaborate with other geographies and member firms on high-profile engagements" [S53] CONFIRMED .

The sister postings: what the other consulting teams do

Because you get one application a year, the choice of team matters. These are the consulting and technology postings live or listed on 4 October 2026, plus one Advisory posting for contrast. All start in September 2027 unless stated [\[S1\]](#) **CONFIRMED**.

Posting (persona - team)	Where, ID, closing	What the team does, in one or two sentences
Technology Strategy Consulting - TST (THE JD)	Belfast graduate 25060; placement 25056. Closes 23 Oct	Technology operating model, enterprise agility, technology strategy and architecture, sourcing. Works from design to implementation with CIOs, CFOs and COOs [S2] [S3] .
Business Transformation Consulting - Customer Products (Deloitte Digital)	Edinburgh graduate 24840; Belfast graduate, placement, BrightStart. Closes 12 Oct	"Helps clients deliver and operate enterprise customer experience capabilities across marketing, commerce, sales, and service by providing multi-year process, platform, and data operate services" [S4] . Juniors take actions and minutes in client workshops [S4] .
Enterprise Applications Consulting - Sales & Service (Deloitte Digital)	Belfast graduate 24859; two BrightStart variants	"We help businesses improve their sales and customer service processes", typically by implementing customer platforms [S7] .
Enterprise Applications Consulting - Human Capital (HR Applications)	Belfast graduate 25096	Implements HR cloud systems from Oracle, SAP and Workday. Analysts configure the system, build dashboards, reports, "AI chatbots" and integrations, and can become "a certified implementation practitioner" [S6] . The most hands-on technical posting.
Business Transformation Consulting - Human Capital (Transformation Activation NI)	Belfast BrightStart 25094	Change management: helping people adopt new ways of working. Human Capital runs four teams: HR Strategy & Transformation, Organisation & Workforce Transformation, Major Programmes, and Actuarial, Insurance & Banking [S5] .
Finance Transformation Consulting - Business Analyst	Belfast graduate 24991 and placement	Supports chief financial officers. Work includes "Designing the future state of a finance function" and workshops and labs [S8] .
Risk & Controls Consulting - Cyber Defence & Resilience	Edinburgh graduate 24843. Closes 12 Oct	"We develop robust incident response and recovery plans for clients and test their response strategy with simulated incidents" [S9] . Junior tasks include presentations, minutes, data analysis and "Reading contracts and documents" [S9] .
Risk & Controls Consulting - Cyber Strategy & Transformation	Edinburgh graduate 24841	Five areas: Cyber Strategy, Cyber Transformation, Cyber Governance & Compliance, Privacy Governance & Compliance, and Digital Trust & Online Protection [S10] .
Risk and Controls Consulting - Internal Audit & Change	Edinburgh graduate 24989	Title seen only; text not read [S1] .
Contrast (Advisory): M&A - Business Valuations	Edinburgh graduate 24175. Closed 5 Oct	Valuing businesses for deals, "often questioning management's assumptions" [S11] . Shown to make the line between Consulting and Advisory concrete.

Programme facts that apply across these teams [\[S13\]](#) **CONFIRMED**: the Summer Vacation Scheme is for penultimate-year students, is expected to start on 28 June 2027 and lasts six weeks in T&T and SR&T [\[S13\]](#) [\[S57\]](#). The Industrial Placement lasts 12 months and can lead to a graduate offer. Graduate and BrightStart joiners can take a "£7,000 interest-free loan" [\[S13\]](#).

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Prompt: TST or an implementation team such as HR Applications? **For TST:** broader exposure, senior clients, business-case skills that transfer anywhere. **For an implementation team:** a certifiable technical skill early, clearer daily output, strong demand for platform skills. **Suggested stance:** pick the one whose daily tasks you would enjoy in month three, not the one with the grander title, and say why in one sentence.

Two worked days in the seat

These two days are illustrations, not diaries. They are built from Deloitte's own duty lists [S2][S4][S8][S9][S6], from a T&T director's and a T&T senior manager's described weeks [S55][S56], and from the hybrid working note in THE JD [S2]. No first-hand analyst diaries could be read, because review sites blocked access. Every time and task below is **INFERRED**.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Working hours, travel frequency and how often analysts work late are not published by Deloitte. Treat the times as a sketch of the rhythm, not a promise or a warning.

Day A: a technology operating model review (advisory)

The client is a retailer whose board thinks its IT function is too expensive and too slow. Deloitte has been hired for eight weeks to describe today's IT function and propose a better one. You are the Analyst on a team of four.

Time	What you do	Why it matters
08:30	Travel to the client's head office. Client-facing staff "might be expected to attend client sites on certain days" [S2].	Being on site builds trust and gets you answers faster.
09:00	Team stand-up with your manager and two consultants. Your actions: finish interview notes, update the IT cost baseline.	You leave knowing exactly what "done" means today.
09:30	Sit in on an interview with the Head of Infrastructure. A senior consultant leads; you take notes.	Your notes become the evidence base for the recommendations.
10:30	Write up notes into the interview log and tag themes (sourcing, skills, cloud costs).	Tagging lets the team see patterns across 20 interviews.
11:30	Excel: reconcile IT spend from the client's finance team against supplier contracts. Flag gaps to the manager.	D2 and D4: the baseline must survive the CFO's challenge.
13:00	Lunch with the team.	
13:45	Build two slides for Thursday's steering committee: "current state on one page" and "cost by capability".	D8: the slides carry the team's message to the decision makers.
15:00	Manager reviews the slides. You rework them.	Expect red pen. It is how quality is built, not a judgement on you.
16:00	Desk research on peer benchmarks, using firm-approved tools [S2]. Save every source.	D9: the AI output is a draft; you own the facts.
17:00	Update the RAID log; send minutes from the morning interview.	Same-day minutes are a quiet signal of reliability.
17:45	Record today's hours against the engagement code. Accurate time recording is a Global Code commitment [S36].	Fees and integrity both depend on it.
18:00	Finish slides if comments arrived late. Days run longer near deadlines.	

Day B: an HR or finance system rollout (delivery)

The client is a large organisation replacing its HR system with Workday, or its finance system with SAP. The programme has run for a year and has 18 months to go. You are one of several Analysts in a workstream.

Time	What you do	Why it matters
08:45	Daily stand-up for your workstream: client process owner, Deloitte functional lead, offshore build team on the call.	D10: the matrix in one meeting.

Time	What you do	Why it matters
09:15	Update the requirements tracker in Jira or Excel after yesterday's design workshop.	D7: a requirement not logged is a requirement lost.
10:00	Support a design workshop. You run the screen and capture decisions and open questions. Finance Transformation calls these "interactive workshops and labs" [S8].	Decisions recorded today stop arguments in six months.
11:30	Configure or test a simple element in the test system, with guidance. HR Applications Analysts "configure the chosen HR application" [S6].	Hands-on skill, and the first step to certification.
13:00	Lunch.	
13:45	Write test scripts for user acceptance testing (UAT).	Business users, not the build team, sign off UAT.
15:00	Defect triage call: log defects, assign owners, chase fixes with the build team.	D6: problems get owners and dates.
16:00	Prepare the weekly status report for the PMO.	Status that tells the truth protects the client and the firm.
17:00	Data migration reconciliation in Excel: do record counts in the old and new systems match?	Bad data at go-live is the most common visible failure.
17:45	Timesheet; plan tomorrow. Go-live weeks are longer and can include weekend cutover support.	

KEY TERM

UAT (user acceptance testing): the stage where real business users test a new system against agreed requirements and decide whether to accept it. **Cutover:** the planned switch from the old system to the new one, often over a weekend. **Defect:** anything that does not work as the requirement says.

Figure 17 puts the two days side by side. The colour shows the type of work. Notice how much of each day is documents and coordination, and how little is the dramatic "presenting to the board" picture of consulting.

Figure 17 A worked day in the seat

INFERRED: a typical day built from Deloitte job postings and staff profiles, not a diary

■ Client contact
 ■ Analysis and build
 ■ Documents and slides
 ■ Team and PMO
 ■ Travel, admin, breaks



Times are illustrative. Hours vary by engagement and deadline.

Sources for the tasks: [S2] [S4] [S6] [S8] [S9] job postings; [S55] [S56] staff profiles; [S36] time recording. Times, sequence and durations are Inferred and illustrative. Read: colour shows the type of work; most of each day is documents, analysis and coordination.

Kinds of work, grades, and how people are judged

A taxonomy of consulting activity

Almost all T&T work fits into eleven activity types. The order roughly follows the life of a client relationship. The labels are ours **INFERRED**; the evidence that each exists at Deloitte UK is cited.

Activity type	What it is and the usual formats	Evidence it exists at Deloitte UK
1. Business development and bids	Proposals, pricing, "orals" (pitch meetings), credentials packs.	A director's week includes "preparing a bid to win new work" [S55]; HR Applications Analysts may work on "bids for new client opportunities" [S6]; the board lists a "Bid Advisor" and a "Pricing Manager, Technology and Transformation" [S49].
2. Discovery and current state	Interviews, data requests, process maps, system inventories.	Requirements and problem-finding duties in THE JD [S2] and Finance Transformation [S8].
3. Strategy and options	Target operating model, sourcing strategy, roadmap, architecture.	TST's four market offerings [S2].
4. Business case	Costs, benefits, risks, payback; later, value tracking.	"Help assess technology investments" [S2]; TST service page [S41].
5. Design	Future-state processes and systems; requirements; workshops and "labs".	"Designing the future state of a finance function" [S8].
6. Build, configure, integrate	Setting up SAP, Oracle, Workday, Salesforce, ServiceNow; cloud and data engineering.	Offerings and postings [S6][S12][S49].
7. Testing	Test scripts, UAT, quality engineering.	Quality engineering roles on the board [S49].
8. Deployment and cutover	Go-live planning, data migration, cutover weekends.	Implementation duties in platform postings [S50] [S51] INFERRED (detail).
9. Programme management (PMO)	Plans, RAID logs, status reports, steering committees.	"Major Programmes" is a named Human Capital team [S5][S40]; junior PMO tasks in [S9].
10. Change, training and adoption	Communications, training, stakeholder support.	The Transformation Activation change team [S5].
11. Managed services ("Operate")	Running a system or process for the client over years.	ET&P, EAD, Human Capital and Cyber each list an "as a Service" or "Operate" line [S12]; Customer Products sells "multi-year ... operate services" [S4].

The common **formats** you will meet: the stakeholder interview (one client leader, 45 to 60 minutes, notes afterwards); the workshop (a group of client staff working through a process or decision, with Deloitte facilitating); the steering committee (senior decision meeting, usually monthly); the daily stand-up (15 minutes, what each person did and is doing next); the status report (weekly, one or two pages); and the orals (the pitch meeting before a client chooses a firm) **INFERRED**. A T&T senior manager describes a client workshop "where we try and work out what they need for a new project. We show them examples of our previous work and talk to them about the needs of their customers" [S56] **CONFIRMED** (quote).

Grades, and what each is judged on

Deloitte UK's grade names are confirmed from its job titles, staff profiles and pay report [S4][S49][S66][S25]. What each grade is judged on is not published. The right-hand column is the usual pattern in large professional services firms and is **INFERRED**.

Grade	Typical role on an engagement	Judged mainly on (Inferred)
Analyst (graduate entry)	Notes, analysis, slides, trackers, testing support.	Accuracy, speed, reliability, learning, attitude.
Consultant	Owens a piece of a workstream; client-facing at working level.	Ownership, client trust, quality without heavy review.

Grade	Typical role on an engagement	Judged mainly on (Inferred)
Senior Consultant	Runs a small workstream; coaches analysts.	Delivery of the workstream, coaching, judgement.
Manager	Runs the engagement day to day: plan, budget, team, quality.	Delivery on time and budget, client relationship at working level, team health.
Senior Manager / Associate Director	Several workstreams or engagements; shapes extensions.	Selling follow-on work, managing risk, building the practice.
Director	Leads engagements and client relationships; bids.	Sales, client relationships, quality and risk.
Partner (salaried or equity)	Owens client relationships and the engagement's risk.	For equity partners Deloitte says profit share follows "quality, risk, performance, and leadership" [S93] CONFIRMED .

KEY TERM

Utilisation: the share of your available working hours that is charged to clients. **Chargeable** hours are recorded against a client engagement code; non-chargeable hours go to training, internal work or bids. Juniors usually carry the highest utilisation expectations **INFERRED**. Deloitte UK does not publish its targets (gap). Its accounts say even fixed-fee revenue is measured "based on the actual inputs of time at charge-out rates, via timesheet reporting" [S93] **CONFIRMED**, which is why the timesheet matters so much.

What the team is judged on

Deloitte does not publish targets for individual offerings. What is visible is the business line. UK T&T revenue was £1,857m in FY24, £1,675m in FY25 and £1,746m in FY26 [S23] **CONFIRMED**. Global T&T grew 2.5% in local currency in FY26, the slowest of Deloitte's four global businesses [S34] **CONFIRMED**, so the UK practice grew faster than the network average that year **INFERRED**. The FY26 recovery was credited to work including ERP implementation and cyber [S30] **REPORTED**.

From the firm's own reporting, a T&T team is likely judged on: revenue growth and sales pipeline; profitability, which depends on utilisation, pricing and keeping fixed-fee work on budget; quality and risk (no failed programmes, no independence breaches); and people measures such as retention and promotions **INFERRED** (from [S93][S94]). The firm rates its reputation and "Client Portfolio" risks highly, citing "Increasing breadth and depth of non-audit offerings (including Operate)" as a threat [S94] **CONFIRMED**.

Career path: what is sourced, and what is not

- **Start.** Graduates join an in-person "Analyst Induction Programme (AIP)", then business-area training "for a few more weeks", supported by a "Consulting Early Experience team" and early-talent sponsors [S4] **CONFIRMED**.
- **Two named people.** Each joiner meets a "People Leader and Resource Manager" [S4] **CONFIRMED**. From the titles, the People Leader looks after development and the Resource Manager allocates you to engagements **INFERRED**.
- **Qualifications.** "The professional qualification pathway is determined by the business area that your role is in." Options listed for Consulting graduates include an MSc in Digital and Business Risk Management, the CIMA Certificate in Business Accounting (with the option to complete full CIMA), and an actuarial qualification [S18] **CONFIRMED**. Platform certifications appear in postings, such as becoming "a certified implementation practitioner" [S6] **CONFIRMED**.
- **Promotion.** Promotions are "given on merit" and pay and promotions are reviewed annually [S19] **CONFIRMED**. In 2026 over 6,000 people were promoted, from a firm of about 25,000 [S25][S407] **CONFIRMED**. Average in-grade salary rose 4.2% for FY27 and the bonus pool rose 14% [S25] **CONFIRMED**.
- **Partnership.** 48 people became partners in 2026, of whom 15 were in T&T, the largest share [S25] **CONFIRMED**.

- **Not found (gaps).** Typical years per grade; graduate salary; the name of the current performance management system; utilisation targets. A common market pattern is one to three years per grade below Manager, but this is **INFERRED** and unverified. Do not quote numbers for these in an interview.

The compliance and control side of the job

Consulting at Deloitte comes with rules that do not exist at a pure consultancy. The reason is structural. Deloitte is also one of the UK's largest auditors, and an auditor must be independent of the companies it audits. That one fact shapes which clients T&T can serve, what you may own personally, and how a new engagement starts. Four other controls apply to everyone: conflicts, confidentiality, approved AI and honest timesheets.

Independence: why an audit firm's consultants have extra rules

KEY TERM

Independence: the requirement that an auditor be free of interests that could bias its audit opinion, and be seen to be free of them. **Public interest entity (PIE):** broadly, a listed company, bank or insurer, where the public relies heavily on the audited accounts. The rules for PIE audit clients are the strictest.

- **The standard.** The UK auditing regulator, the Financial Reporting Council (FRC), sets the Revised Ethical Standard 2024, effective 15 December 2024 **[S38] CONFIRMED**.
- **The whitelist for PIEs.** For PIE audit clients, an audit firm "and, where the audit firm belongs to a network, any member of such network, shall not provide (either directly or indirectly) to the audited entity ... services other than those set out" in a permitted list, subject to audit committee approval **[S39] (para 5.40) CONFIRMED**. Prohibited services include "designing and implementing financial information technology systems" and playing "any part in the management or decision-making of the audited entity" **[S364] CONFIRMED**. In plain English: Deloitte consulting cannot sell most technology implementation to a listed company that Deloitte audits.
- **The fee cap.** Non-audit fees for a PIE are capped at 70% of the average audit fee of the last three years **[S39][S364] CONFIRMED**.
- **The management threat.** Any service where a reasonable third party would conclude the firm is taking "a management role" for an audit-relevant entity is prohibited **[S364] CONFIRMED**. If a client that Deloitte audits says "just approve it for us", that is an escalation, not a favour **INFERRED**.
- **Personal independence.** Partners and those closely associated must not hold a financial interest (other than an immaterial indirect one) in an entity relevant to an engagement of the firm **[S39] (para 2.3)**; people on or able to influence an engagement have the same restriction **[S39] (para 2.4) CONFIRMED**. New joiners must "clear Personal Independence checks before you join us" **[S261] CONFIRMED**. Practically, expect to declare investments and to check a restricted list before buying individual shares **INFERRED**.

£3,819m

FY25 non-audit revenue from entities Deloitte UK does not audit **[S35]**

£155m

FY25 non-audit revenue from entities it does audit **[S35]**

~96%

Share of non-audit revenue from non-audit clients (Inferred arithmetic)

32

Engagements referred to the Public Interest Review Group in FY25 **[S35]**

The two revenue numbers are the clearest picture of how independence shapes the business. In FY25 Deloitte UK earned £155m from non-audit services to entities it audits, against £3,819m from non-audit services to entities it does not audit **[S35] CONFIRMED**. About 96% of consulting, tax and advisory revenue therefore comes from clients the firm does not audit **INFERRED**. The consulting business is built on a client list largely separate from the audit client list.

Conflict checks before any engagement

"All proposed engagements and business and financial relationships go through a conflict check before they are accepted." Where conflicts cannot be reduced to an acceptable level, "we decline the engagement" [S35] **CONFIRMED**. Engagements with high public-interest or reputational risk go to the Public Interest Review Group (PIRG): 32 matters in FY25, of which 9% were declined [S35][S345] **CONFIRMED**. For T&T and SR&T the firm set up a "Consultative Forum" and a "globally aligned client portfolio management process" [S94] **CONFIRMED**. A global acceptance and continuance platform is planned for UK implementation in FY2027 [S35] **CONFIRMED**. As an Analyst you will not run these checks, but you may be asked to declare your own conflicts, and you should never start work before the engagement is formally accepted **INFERRED**.

Confidentiality between clients

Deloitte's Global Principles of Business Conduct say: "We prohibit disclosure of confidential and personal information entrusted to us unless granted permission or there is a legal or professional right or duty to disclose", and "We prohibit the use of confidential information about our clients for personal advantage or for the benefit of third parties" [S36] **CONFIRMED**. A consultant may work for two competitors in the same year. What you learn at one must never reach the other. The PwC Australia tax leaks scandal of 2023, in which confidential government information was used to win clients, shows the cost when this fails [S392] **CONFIRMED**.

Government work adds another layer. Many T&T roles prefer or require UK security clearance: "preference will be for those who have SC clearance or eligibility to obtain SC Clearance" [S54] **CONFIRMED**. Graduates placed on public sector work may be asked to apply **INFERRED**.

Inside information on deal work

Some T&T work touches listed companies or deals, for example integration planning before an acquisition is announced. UK market abuse law defines inside information as precise, non-public information that would be likely to have a significant effect on prices if made public [S358] **CONFIRMED**. Disclosure is lawful only "in the normal exercise of an employment, a profession or duties" [S359] **CONFIRMED**, and insider dealing, tipping and unlawful disclosure are prohibited [S360] **CONFIRMED**. In practice: do not trade, do not tip, and do not discuss the work in public places **INFERRED**.

Firm-approved AI only

THE JD makes responsible AI use a duty (D9). The Global Code commits Deloitte to "responsible development and deployment of new technologies, including artificial intelligence" [S36] **CONFIRMED**. Deloitte UK's 2025 Transparency Report rates generative AI a "Very High" priority risk, with controls including "use-case approval" and "data governance" [S345] **CONFIRMED**. The firm's governance base is its "Trustworthy AI Framework" [S35] **CONFIRMED**. And in recruitment, candidates must read Deloitte's "Integrity & AI guidance" before the assessments [S17] **CONFIRMED**.

Timesheet integrity

"We record hours worked timely and accurately, and submit legitimate business-related expenses" [S36] **CONFIRMED**. This is not admin. Time and expense reporting made up 14% of ethics allegations at Deloitte UK in FY26 [S23] **CONFIRMED**. If a manager ever asks you to move hours to a different code or under-record them, that is a Code issue to raise, not a favour to do **INFERRED**.

Figure 22 pulls the walls together: for each one, what may cross with the right process and what may not.

Figure 22 The walls around the role: what may cross and what may not**The wall and who is behind it** **May cross (with the right process)**

Independence wall
Behind it: Deloitte audit clients
Rule: FRC Ethical Standard 2024

Consulting for companies Deloitte does not audit (~96% of non-audit revenue)
Permitted services to an audit client, after checks and audit committee approval

Confidentiality wall
Behind it: every other client
Rule: Deloitte Global Code

Your general skills and public facts
Firm methods and templates, cleaned of client data (Inferred)

Approved-tools wall
Behind it: public AI tools
Rule: Global Code; JD line D9

Firm-approved AI tools inside secure firm systems
Your own checked judgement on every AI-assisted output

Inside information
Behind it: markets, friends, family
Rule: UK Market Abuse Regulation

Need-to-know sharing inside the engagement team, as part of your duties

May not cross

Any management role or decision at an audit client; banned services to listed audit clients (e.g. designing financial IT systems); shares in restricted firms

Client A's data, plans or documents in Client B's work or in a pitch
Client information used for personal advantage or a third party's benefit

Client data pasted into a public chatbot
Unchecked AI output sent to a client (Deloitte Australia part-refunded a fee in 2025 over AI errors in a report)

Trading, or tipping someone, on deal or results news you learned at work
Discussing a live deal on a train, in a pub or on social media

Not a wall, same rule: hours go on the timesheet on time and accurately, to the right engagement code.

Sources: [S38] [S39] [S364] FRC Revised Ethical Standard 2024; [S35] FY2025 non-audit revenue split (£155m from audited entities vs £3,819m from others); [S36] Global Principles of Business Conduct; [S345] [S388] AI governance and the Deloitte Australia refund; [S358] [S359] [S360] UK Market Abuse Regulation. Read: left is what may cross with the right process; right is what may not.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW (UNPROMPTED, IF THE MOMENT FITS)

"Because Deloitte audits some of the biggest UK companies, the consulting side often cannot work for them. About 96% of its non-audit revenue comes from companies it does not audit, and every engagement goes through a conflict check first. I would expect to make my own independence declarations from day one."

"The JD says firm-approved AI tools. To me that means client data stays inside approved systems, and I check every AI-assisted output before it reaches a client, because I am accountable for it."

"I see the timesheet as part of integrity. The firm bills on recorded time, so accurate hours protect the client and the firm."

DON'T SAY THIS

"Deloitte can sell anything to anyone because it is so big." It cannot: independence rules close off most consulting to listed audit clients [S39]. Also avoid naming Deloitte's internal AI tools for T&T, or its performance system, as if you know them. These are not public.

The team mapped: where TST sits and who leads it

Deloitte does not publish an organisation chart for T&T. What follows is reconstructed from service pages, press releases, leadership pages, the annual accounts and job postings. Each box in Figure 18 is coloured by how sure we are: green where a current primary page confirms it, amber where it rests on one source or a page that may be out of date, violet where it is our inference or unknown.

The legal frame, in three lines

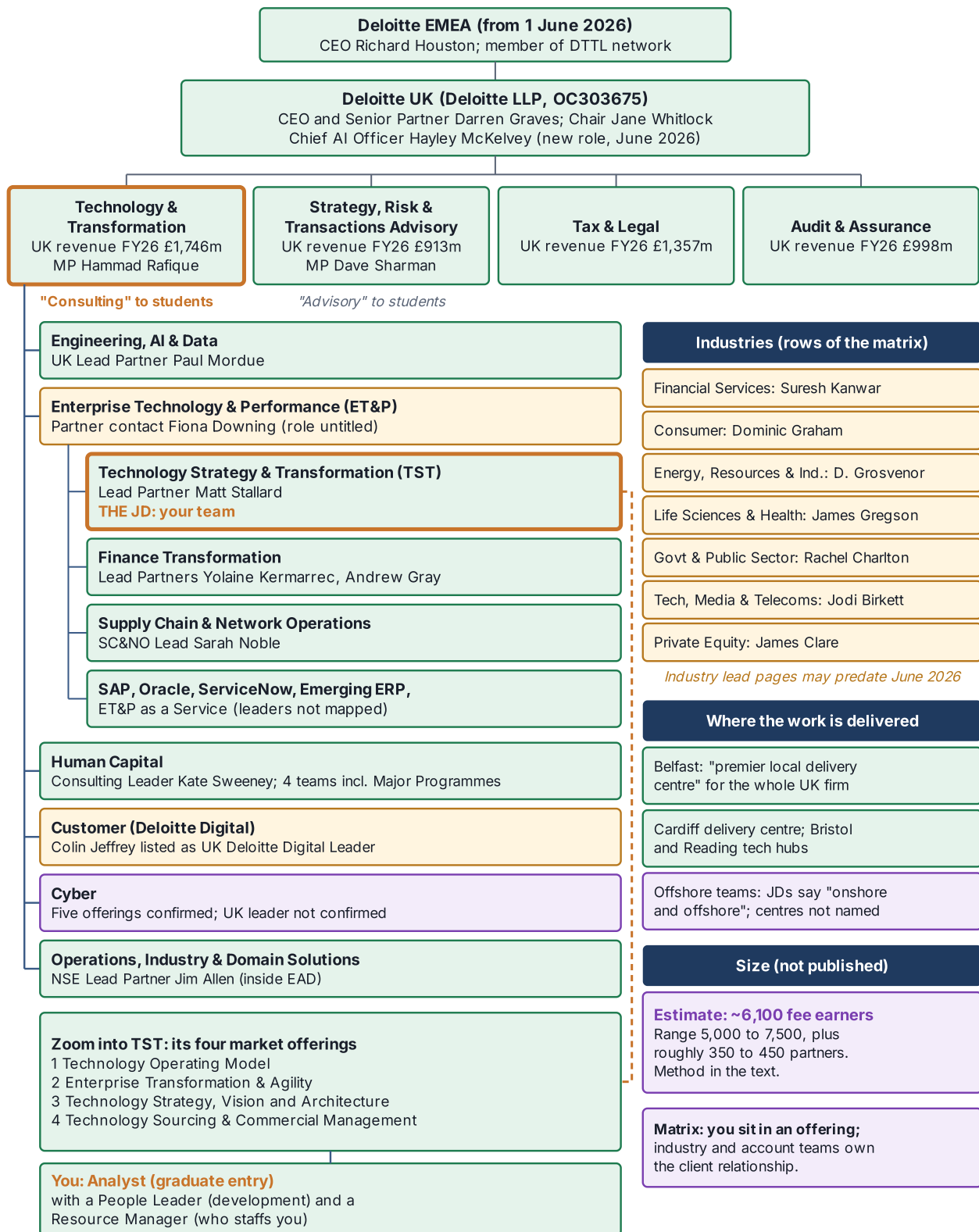
Deloitte LLP is a limited liability partnership registered in England and Wales, number OC303675, at 1 New Street Square, London [S24][S407] **CONFIRMED**. From 1 June 2026 it combined with 14 other Deloitte member firms in Europe, the Middle East and Africa to form Deloitte EMEA; the old parent, Deloitte NSE LLP, ceased to be the parent [S24] **CONFIRMED**. A press summary says 16 participating firms [S33] **REPORTED**, so the count differs between sources. Deloitte EMEA is a member firm of Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited (DTTL), which "do[es] not provide services to clients" [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Some job postings still carry old footer text naming Deloitte NSE LLP [S2]; the accounts show that changed on 1 June 2026 [S24].

Where TST sits

Follow the chain from the top. Deloitte UK has four businesses. TST sits inside Technology & Transformation, inside the Enterprise Technology & Performance offering, next to Finance Transformation, Supply Chain & Network Operations and the SAP, Oracle and ServiceNow practices [S12][S40][S41] **CONFIRMED**. Its UK Lead Partner is Matt Stallard, named on the TST service page [S41] **CONFIRMED**. TST's four market offerings, from THE JD, are Technology Operating Model; Enterprise Transformation & Agility; Technology Strategy, Vision and Architecture; and Technology Sourcing & Commercial Management [S2] **CONFIRMED**.

Figure 18 The reconstructed team: Technology & Transformation, colour-coded by confidence

Confidence key: Confirmed on a primary page Reported, one source or maybe stale Inferred or unknown



Sources: [S407] [S274] [S276] leaders; [S23] UK revenue, FY to 31 May 2026; [S12] [S40] structure; [S41] [S42] [S43] [S44] [S46] [S47] [S48] service pages; [S2] [S4] TST and joiner roles; [S26] [S60] industry leads; [S20] [S21] [S50] [S51] delivery; Estimate from [S23] [S24] [S25]. Read: green confirmed, amber reported or possibly stale, violet inferred or unknown.

The leaders, with confidence

Role	Name	Confidence	Notes and sources
CEO, Deloitte EMEA	Richard Houston	CONFIRMED	From 1 June 2026 [S407]. Previously led Deloitte UK and NSE [S297] REPORTED .
Senior Partner and CEO, Deloitte UK	Darren Graves	CONFIRMED	From 1 June 2026 [S407][S273]. Joined as a Business Tax graduate in 2001 [S273].
Chair, UK Board	Jane Whitlock	CONFIRMED	[S407][S276].
Chief AI Officer (new role)	Hayley McKelvey	CONFIRMED	"responsible for driving the firm's AI strategy across client services and internal operations" [S407][S274].
Managing Partner, T&T	Hammad Rafique	CONFIRMED	From 1 June 2026, on the UK Executive [S274][S276]. Ex-Accenture (17 years); previously led insurance consulting and T&T for Financial Services at Deloitte [S27][S275] REPORTED (career detail). Predecessor Robert Cullen [S27].
Managing Partner, SR&T	Dave Sharman	CONFIRMED	From June 2026; previously Chief Operating Officer [S274][S276].
Engineering, AI & Data, UK Lead Partner	Paul Mordue	CONFIRMED	Service page [S42].
ET&P (contact)	Fiona Downing	REPORTED	Named as Partner contact; leadership title not stated [S43].
TST Lead Partner	Matt Stallard	CONFIRMED	Service page [S41].
Finance Transformation leads	Yolaine Kermarrec; Andrew Gray	CONFIRMED	Business Finance & Controllership Lead Partner; Finance Strategy Lead Partner [S46].
Supply Chain & Network Operations Lead	Sarah Noble	CONFIRMED	[S47].
Human Capital Consulting Leader	Kate Sweeney	CONFIRMED	[S44].
UK Deloitte Digital Leader	Colin Jeffrey	REPORTED	Extended Leadership Team page, which may predate June 2026 [S26].
Cyber, UK leader	Not confirmed	INFERRED (unknown)	Offerings confirmed on the UK site [S12]; no current leader page read.
Industry leads	see Figure 18	REPORTED	Extended Leadership Team page [S26]; Financial Services lead Suresh Kanwar appointed March 2025 [S60].

Use amber names only after re-checking them on the day. Public professional information only.

How big the team is: an estimate with the method shown

Deloitte UK does not publish headcount by business. The estimate below uses published inputs and two transparent assumptions. It is an **ESTIMATE**, and you should present it as one if you use it at all.

Step	Calculation	Result	Source
1	Fee-earning staff (average FTE, UK and Switzerland, FY26)	20,346	[S24] CONFIRMED
2	UK share of group revenue: £5,014m / £5,809m	86.3%	[S23] CONFIRMED (inputs)
3	UK fee-earning FTE: 20,346 × 86.3%	about 17,560	INFERRED

Step	Calculation	Result	Source
4	T&T share of UK revenue: £1,746m / £5,014m	34.8%	[S23] CONFIRMED (inputs)
5	T&T fee earners if revenue per head matched the firm: 17,560 x 34.8%	about 6,100	ESTIMATE
6	Adjust for T&T's different revenue per UK head (subcontractors and offshore delivery raise revenue per UK person)	range 5,000 to 7,500	ESTIMATE
7	Partners: 1,308 partners overall from 1 June 2026, with T&T taking 15 of 48 new partners (31%)	roughly 350 to 450	[S25] inputs; ESTIMATE

Two cross-checks. Of 551 parsed experienced-hire postings, 282 (51%) were in T&T [S49] **CONFIRMED** (our count). That shows T&T hires the most, not that it is half the firm. And 1,353 graduates, apprentices and placement students started in 2026 across 21 offices, 44% outside London [S29][S271] **REPORTED**; Deloitte does not say how many went to T&T (gap). TST's own size within T&T cannot be estimated from public data (gap).

How the work splits: offering, industry and location

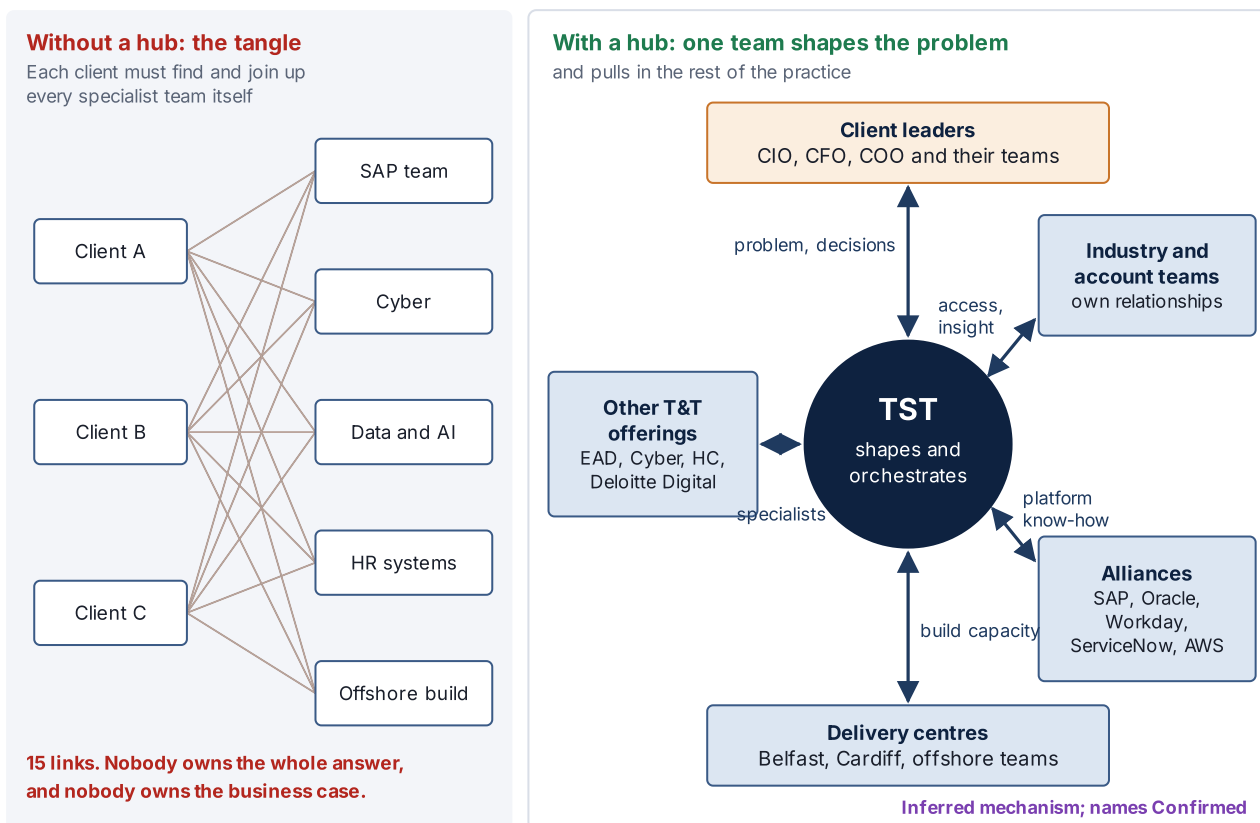
Every engagement sits at a crossing point of three things: an **offering** (what kind of work), an **industry** (whose sector) and a **location** (where the people sit). Experienced-hire titles show the grid directly, for example "Associate Director - Technology, Vision, Strategy & Architecture (Financial Services - Banking & Capital Markets)" [S49] **CONFIRMED**. The change team in Belfast lists the industries it serves: Consumer Business; TMT; ER&I; LSHC; Public Sector; Financial Services [S5] **CONFIRMED**.

The mechanism **INFERRED**: offerings own skills, methods, software alliances and people (your People Leader sits in your offering). Industry and account teams own client relationships and sales. A large engagement draws people from several offerings. Your Resource Manager is how the grid assigns you to work.

Industry mix tells you where your first projects are most likely to be. UK revenue by industry in FY26 was: Financial Services £1,735m; Consumer £972m; Government and Public Services £679m (down from £761m in FY24); Technology, Media & Telecoms £632m; Energy, Resources & Industrials £535m; Life Sciences & Healthcare £235m; other £226m [S23] **CONFIRMED**. Financial services is about 35% of UK revenue **INFERRED** (arithmetic), and the new T&T leader comes from insurance consulting [S27] **REPORTED**.

Why a central offering like TST exists

Without someone to frame the problem, a client buying technology change faces a tangle: separate conversations with platform specialists, cyber, data, HR systems and build teams, with nobody owning the overall answer or the business case. A strategy-led team sits in the middle, shapes the question with the client's leaders, and pulls in the right specialists **INFERRED**. THE JD says TST teams "combine strategic thinking, advisory services, and cutting-edge technology capabilities" and work "with teams across our wider Technology and Transformation practice" [S2] **CONFIRMED**. Figure 19 shows the mechanism.

Figure 19 Why a central offering exists: the tangle without it, the wheel with it

Sources: [S2] (TST "combine strategic thinking, advisory services, and cutting-edge technology"; teaming across T&T), [S12] [S40] (offerings and alliances), [S20] [S21] (delivery centres). The hub mechanism is Inferred. Read: arrows show what flows between TST and each group.

Delivery centres and offices

Not all T&T work happens in London or on client sites.

- **Belfast** is "the premier local delivery centre for the whole of our UK firm, providing services across all our business areas" and "one of Deloitte's tech hubs" [S21] **CONFIRMED**. Most of the current early-careers consulting postings are in Belfast [S1].
- **Cardiff** is "our ever-growing Delivery Centre", supporting client-facing colleagues "with everything from IT support to admin and more" [S20] **CONFIRMED**.
- **Bristol** is "a tech hub" with "a rapidly growing group of creative engineers" [S20] **CONFIRMED**; **Reading** focuses on technology and telecoms as a "centre of excellence" [S20] **CONFIRMED**. **Newcastle** is a centre of excellence for audit, not consulting [S20].
- **Scotland**: Edinburgh and Glasgow opened their roles first this cycle [S14]; Edinburgh hosts the current Risk & Controls Consulting graduate roles [S1].
- **New delivery centres**. Deloitte says its new UK technology delivery centres were "fully operational in FY26" [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Their locations are not named in the release.
- **Offshore**. Early-careers pages refer to "UK and offshore offices" [S13], and the UK group owns Deloitte India Services Limited [S24] **CONFIRMED**. Which offshore centres UK T&T uses is not confirmed on a primary UK page (gap). Postings say only "onshore and offshore" [S50][S51].

The open roles: the org chart in disguise

Postings show where a firm is growing. Figure 14 gave the city split. The titles of the 282 T&T postings add two more views [S49] **INFERRED** (our classification of confirmed titles; keyword groups overlap):

T&T postings by theme (keywords)	Count	T&T postings by grade in title	Count
Engineering, AI & Data, or data and AI terms	76	Manager	80
ET&P platforms (SAP, Oracle, ServiceNow, finance, supply chain, ERP)	57	Senior Manager	53
Defence, security or public sector terms	54	Senior Consultant	51
Human Capital or HR platforms	31	Associate Director	43
Customer / Deloitte Digital	21	Consultant	15
Cyber	9	Director	7
		Analyst	6

Reading the tables **INFERRED** : experienced hiring is concentrated in the middle grades, because entry-level hiring runs through early careers. Data and AI is the biggest single theme. Public sector and defence remain a large hiring area even though government revenue has fallen since FY24 [\[S23\]](#). Sentences inside the postings show who works with whom: "Good communication skills (written and oral) with clients and colleagues both on and offshore" [\[S51\]](#); "Provide technical leadership, mentorship, and architectural guidance to diverse engineering teams (onshore and offshore)" [\[S50\]](#) **CONFIRMED** .

How a client request moves through the team

Figure 20 follows one piece of work from the first client conversation to the close. Two steps are easy to forget and matter most for the firm: the conflict and independence check before anything is agreed, and staffing, which is where you enter the story.

Figure 20 The life of a client request through the team

Steps are Inferred from Deloitte documents; the conflict check, PIRG and the Resource Manager are Confirmed

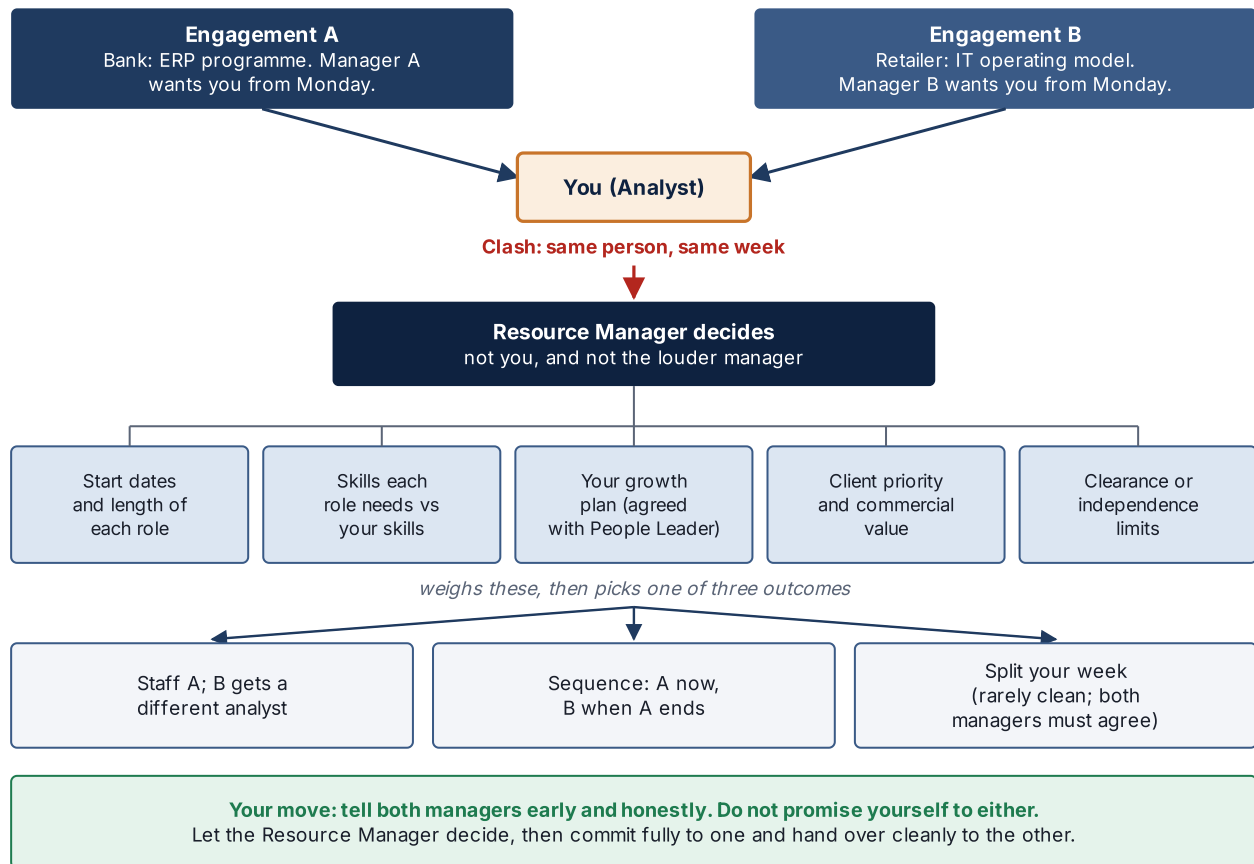
Sources: [S35] (conflict check, decline, PIRG: 32 matters in FY2025), [S49] (bid advisor and pricing manager roles), [S4] (Resource Manager), [S55] (bids, invoicing). Step sequence and analyst tasks are Inferred. Read: top to bottom; the red step can stop the work before it starts.

The scarce resource: your time

In a matrix firm, the thing two managers most often compete for is a good Analyst's week. Deloitte does not publish its staffing rules, so Figure 21 shows the usual pattern **INFERRED**. The point for an interview is behavioural: when two managers both want you, you do not choose by yourself, and you do not hide the clash. You tell both of them, let the Resource Manager decide, and then commit.

Figure 21 The scarce resource: how analyst time is allocated when two engagements want you

INFERRED: how a staffing clash usually resolves in a matrix firm; Deloitte does not publish its rules



Sources: [S4] (People Leader and Resource Manager exist); [S54] (security clearance preferences). The decision factors and outcomes are Inferred; Deloitte does not publish its staffing rules. Read: the clash goes up to the Resource Manager, not sideways between managers.

How this compares with peers

A sourced, like-for-like comparison of Deloitte UK's T&T team with the consulting arms of PwC, EY, KPMG or Accenture in the UK is **not available** from the research for this Part. Their UK consulting revenue and structures were not read (gap). What can be said:

- Deloitte calls its consulting arm "Technology & Transformation" globally, in line with its four-business model [S24][S34] **CONFIRMED**.
- A trade analyst said Deloitte UK T&T growth in FY26 was "aligned with PwC UK's FY26 consulting sales rise" [S30] **REPORTED**.
- Gartner ranked Deloitte the largest consulting services provider by revenue in 2025 [S33] **REPORTED**.
- Big Four graduate training is being reshaped "as AI handles first-year data work" [S32] **REPORTED** (minor outlet).

Part 4 of this pack covers competitors in more depth. Do not make numeric peer comparisons from this Part.

What to take from this Part

- Use the current names: four businesses; "Consulting" means T&T; TST sits in ET&P.

- Most of an Analyst's first year is documents, analysis and coordination (D6, D8), with requirements work (D7) on delivery projects. Say so: it shows realism.
- The business case (D4) links strategy to delivery. It is the thread through Figures 15 and 16.
- Independence, conflicts, confidentiality, approved AI and honest timesheets are part of the job, not paperwork. You can say this unprompted.
- Re-check the London postings from 5 October and choose one team, because you get one application a year.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"TST sits in Enterprise Technology & Performance inside T&T, which is Deloitte UK's largest business at about £1.75bn. What draws me is the span from the business case to implementation: the team can shape a decision with a CIO, then work with the SAP, Oracle or Workday teams to deliver it. As an Analyst I would expect most of my time to go on requirements, documents and programme tracking, and I would like to be the person whose RAID log and minutes people trust."

PART 2

The firm as a business, from the inside

How Deloitte UK earns a pound, who keeps it, who is protected from whom, and what has gone wrong. Read this once and you can talk about the firm the way a partner thinks about it, with the numbers and the dates.

Most candidates describe Deloitte from the careers website: big, global, "purpose-led". Interviewers hear that all day. This Part explains the firm as a business. It traces a client's fee from the invoice to a partner's profit share, shows the legal wiring that holds nearly 500,000 people under one brand, and lists the failures you should know before anyone asks. Every number has a source and a date. Where a number is our own arithmetic, it says so.

Two housekeeping points first, because they trip up almost everyone:

- **Deloitte's year ends on 31 May.** "FY2026" means 1 June 2025 to 31 May 2026 [S93] **CONFIRMED**. Results come out in late September.
- **"Deloitte UK" headline numbers include Switzerland.** Deloitte's own footnote says: "All revenue numbers presented herein, unless otherwise noted, represent UK and Switzerland consolidated" [S407] **CONFIRMED**. So the £5.81bn headline is UK plus Switzerland. The UK on its own was £5,014m, and Switzerland £795m [S88] **CONFIRMED**.

£5.81bn

Revenue FY2026, UK and Switzerland consolidated, +2% [S88][S407]

£5.01bn

UK-only revenue FY2026 (the four UK businesses) [S88]

£899m

Distributable profit FY2026, +14% (UK and Switzerland) [S84][S407]

£1.125m

Average profit per equity partner FY2026, up from £1.051m [S407]

A. The founding insight: an independent check on other people's numbers

William Welch Deloitte set up as an accountant in Basinghall Street, London, in 1845. He is described as the first person appointed as independent auditor of a public company, the Great Western Railway [S103] **REPORTED**. That is the founding idea, and it still runs the business: investors and lenders will put money into a company only if someone independent has checked the accounts. The auditor sells trust.

KEY TERM

Audit: an independent check that a company's published accounts are fair. The auditor signs an "opinion". Investors rely on it, so the auditor must be independent of the company it checks. That need for independence is the source of many of Deloitte's rules today (Section D).

How the name was built: a chain of mergers

Date	What happened	Source
1845	William Welch Deloitte opens his London practice.	[S103] REPORTED
1952	Merges with Haskins & Sells (US): Deloitte Haskins & Sells.	[S103] REPORTED
1989	Combines with Touche Ross in the US: Deloitte & Touche.	[S103] REPORTED
1993	International firm renamed Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu. Tohmatsu was the Japanese partner firm.	[S103] REPORTED

Date	What happened	Source
2002	Arthur Andersen's UK practice joins Deloitte UK, after Andersen collapsed over the Enron scandal.	[S103] REPORTED
10 Jan 2003	Deloitte LLP, today's UK firm, is incorporated as a limited liability partnership.	[S93] CONFIRMED
31 Mar 2003	Deloitte abandons its plan to spin off consulting as "Braxton". It becomes the only Big Four firm to keep its consultancy.	[S104] REPORTED
1 Jun 2026	Deloitte LLP and its Swiss practice combine with 14 other member firms to form Deloitte EMEA.	[S93] CONFIRMED

The decision that made today's firm: keeping consulting

In 2001 the US energy company Enron collapsed. Its auditor, Arthur Andersen, also earned large consulting fees, and regulators asked whether an auditor that sells consulting can stay tough on its client. The US passed the Sarbanes-Oxley Act in 2002, which tightened auditor independence. The other big accounting firms got rid of their consulting arms. Ernst & Young sold to Cap Gemini (2000). KPMG Consulting floated and became BearingPoint (2001). PwC Consulting was sold to IBM (2002) [S104] REPORTED.

Deloitte planned to do the same. In February 2002 it announced that Deloitte Consulting would be separated as a partner-owned firm called "Braxton". On 31 March 2003 it dropped the plan, citing a "tight credit market and the uncertain state of the economy" [S104] REPORTED. It committed to keep consulting "focused on nonaudit clients", in line with the new rules [S104]. Some clients were reported to have walked away during the uncertainty [S104] REPORTED.

So the choice was partly forced by market conditions, not a grand strategic vision. But its effect has been huge. In FY2025, consulting services were US\$43.7bn of Deloitte's US\$70.5bn global revenue, about 62% [S81] CONFIRMED. Gartner ranks Deloitte the number one consulting provider worldwide by revenue, for the eighth year running [S301] CONFIRMED. Deloitte has had more than 20 years to build a multidisciplinary firm while rivals rebuilt their consultancies from scratch. Part 3 explains why that structure works and what it costs; this Part sticks to how it makes money.

KEY TERM

Multidisciplinary firm: one firm that sells audit, tax, consulting and deal advice under one brand. The upside is breadth and steadier income across the economic cycle. The downside is constant policing of conflicts between audit clients and advisory work. See Part 3 for the full mechanism.

Purpose statement

Deloitte's stated purpose is "to make an impact that matters, for our clients, our people, and society" [S82] CONFIRMED (read on the Global Facts and Figures page, 4 October 2026). The UK audit business has its own: "Protecting the public interest and building trust and confidence in business" [S94] CONFIRMED (Audit Transparency Report 2025).

DON'T SAY THIS

"Deloitte has always been a consulting firm." It started as an audit firm, nearly gave consulting away in 2002-03, and kept it partly by accident of timing [S104]. Knowing that history shows you understand why audit independence rules still shape what consultants can sell.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"Deloitte is the only Big Four firm that kept its consultancy after Sarbanes-Oxley. It nearly spun it out as Braxton and pulled back in 2003. Today consulting is about 62% of global revenue, and Technology & Transformation alone was US\$33.4bn in FY2025." [S104][S81]

B. How the firm makes money: from a client's fee to a partner's share

Deloitte UK is a partnership. That one fact explains most of its economics, so start there.

KEY TERM

Limited liability partnership (LLP): a business owned by its partners (legally called "members") rather than by shareholders. Partners share the profit. Unlike an old-style partnership, members are generally not personally liable for the firm's debts. Deloitte LLP is registered in England and Wales as OC303675 [S93][S407] **CONFIRMED**.

KEY TERM

Equity partner vs salaried partner: an equity partner owns a share of the firm, puts in capital and takes a share of profit. A salaried partner carries the partner title but is an employee on a salary and bonus. In FY2026 Deloitte UK averaged 799 equity partners and 654 salaried partners (full-time-equivalent averages, 1,453 in all) [S88] **CONFIRMED**.

The business model in one paragraph

Clients pay fees for work done by teams of people. The firm pays those people salaries, pays sub-contractors, and pays for offices, IT and its share of the global network. Whatever is left is profit, and it all belongs to the equity partners. There are no outside shareholders and no retained-earnings growth story. So the core question for the partnership every year is: how much fee income can a given number of partners generate, through how many staff, at what cost?

Where revenue comes from: global and UK

US\$74.5bn

Global revenue FY2026,
+3.8% in local currency
[S70]

~500,000

Global people FY2026
("nearly 500,000") [S70]

US\$33.4bn

Global Technology &
Transformation revenue
FY2025 [S81]

£1.75bn

UK Technology &
Transformation revenue
FY2026, +4% [S88][S407]

Global. "Deloitte global revenue" is the total of all member firms' revenue. It is not one company's income. In FY2025 it was US\$70.5bn, split by business as follows [S81] **CONFIRMED**:

Business (global, FY2025)	US\$bn	Share	FY2026 growth, local currency [S70]
Technology & Transformation (T&T)	33.4	47%	+2.5% (slowest)
Audit & Assurance (A&A)	14.7	21%	+5.0%
Tax & Legal (T&L)	12.2	17%	+5.8% (fastest)
Strategy, Risk & Transactions (SR&T)	10.3	15%	+4.4%
Total	70.5	100%	+3.8% to US\$74.5bn

Shares are our arithmetic on [S81]. Deloitte has not yet published FY2026 US\$ revenue by business in a form we could read, so the table pairs FY2025 levels with FY2026 growth rates [S70].

Read the table this way: T&T alone is bigger than audit and tax combined (US\$33.4bn against US\$26.9bn) [S81] **INFERRED** (our arithmetic). By revenue, Deloitte is a technology consultancy attached to an audit firm. And T&T, the business you are applying to, was the slowest-growing line in FY2026 [S70] **CONFIRMED**.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

City AM reported FY2026 under the headline "Deloitte's tech consulting division weighs on growth" and described T&T as having "declined" [S100] **REPORTED**. Deloitte's own release says T&T grew 2.5% in local currency [S70] **CONFIRMED**. Use Deloitte's figure. The safe phrasing: "T&T grew, but more slowly than the rest of the firm."

UK. The UK firm reports four businesses. The figures below are UK only and add up to £5,014m; Switzerland is a separate £795m [S88][S407] **CONFIRMED**.

UK business, FY2026	Revenue	Growth	What it sells, in plain English
Technology & Transformation (T&T)	£1,746m	+4%	Designing and implementing technology and change: ERP systems, cloud, cyber, data and AI, HR transformation [S407]
Tax & Legal	£1,357m	+2%	Tax advice and compliance, legal services
Audit & Assurance (A&A)	£998m	+3%	Statutory audits and other assurance opinions
Strategy, Risk & Transactions Advisory (SR&T Advisory)	£913m	+1%	Strategy, risk advisory, mergers and acquisitions, restructuring
UK total	£5,014m		Plus Switzerland £795m = £5,809m group [S88]

Deloitte's footnote groups T&T and SR&T Advisory together as its "advisory businesses" [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Together they were £2,659m, about 53% of UK-only revenue **INFERRED** (our arithmetic). So in the UK, unlike globally, consulting is roughly half the firm, not two-thirds.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"The £5.81bn headline is UK and Switzerland consolidated. UK-only revenue was about £5.0bn, and T&T was the largest single business at £1.75bn, up 4% after a 10% fall the year before." [S88][S407][S89]
Getting the Switzerland point right signals you read the release, not a headline.

Where each pound goes: the cost structure

Deloitte LLP files audited group accounts (audited by BDO LLP) at Companies House [S93] **CONFIRMED**. They show where the money goes. The percentages are our arithmetic on the reported figures.

Line, Deloitte LLP group (UK and Switzerland)	FY2026 £m	FY2025 £m	Share of FY2026 revenue
Revenue	5,809	5,676	100%
Employee costs	(2,920)	(2,853)	50.3%
of which salaries, incl. bonuses and termination benefits	2,272	2,292	39.1%
Expenses and sub-contractor costs on client assignments	(1,369)	(1,311)	23.6%
Other operating costs (DTTL subscription fees, IT, property, professional fees)	(546)	(616)	9.4%
Depreciation and amortisation	(128)	(126)	2.2%
Operating profit	854	776	14.7%
Profit for the year (statutory)	769	757	13.2%
Distributable profit (management accounts basis)	899	789	15.5%

Source: [S93] Deloitte LLP Consolidated and LLP Financial Statements 2026, signed 25 September 2026 **CONFIRMED**; percentages **INFERRED**. The cost lines and operating profit sum to £5,817m, about £8m more than revenue; the difference sits in small items the summary does not show.

Four things to take from this table:

1. **Half of every pound goes on people.** Employee costs were 50.3% of revenue. Note that this line includes salaried partners, who are employees [S88][S93].
2. **About a quarter is pass-through.** Sub-contractors and recoverable expenses were 23.6%. The accounts say revenue includes "recoverable expenses incurred on assignments", including sub-contractor costs [S93] **CONFIRMED**. When Deloitte brings in a specialist software firm or a contractor and bills the client for them, both the fee and the cost go through the books.
3. **The network costs money.** Each member firm pays subscription fees to Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited (DTTL), the global coordinating company. They sit in "other operating costs" [S93] **CONFIRMED**. The amount is not split out.
4. **Equity partners are not a cost line.** Their pay is the profit. Distributable profit of £899m across 799 full-time-equivalent equity partners gives the £1.125m average [S84][S88] **INFERRED** (our arithmetic, which matches Deloitte's figure).

KEY TERM

Distributable profit: the profit available to share among equity partners, measured on Deloitte's internal "management accounts" basis. It uses different accounting policies from the statutory accounts, which is why it was £899m while statutory profit for the year was £769m [S93] **CONFIRMED**. Press releases quote distributable profit.

The engine underneath: rate card, utilisation, realisation, leverage

The accounts show totals. The mechanism that produces them is the same across all large professional-services firms. Deloitte does not publish its internal targets, so what follows is the standard model **INFERRED**, tied to what the accounts do confirm.

KEY TERM

Charge-out rate (the rate card): the standard price per hour or day for each grade, from analyst to partner. **Utilisation:** the share of a person's available hours that are chargeable to a client. **Realisation:** the share of the standard value of those hours that the client actually pays, after discounts and write-offs. **Leverage:** how many staff work under each partner. Profit rises with all four.

The FY2026 accounts confirm the mechanism in Deloitte's own words. Fixed-fee contracts are recognised "based upon the value of the actual services provided ... determined based on the actual inputs of time at charge-out rates, via timesheet reporting" [S93] **CONFIRMED**. In plain English: even when the client pays a fixed price, Deloitte measures progress by hours times rates. Your timesheet is how the firm knows how much revenue it has earned.

Figure 1, on the next page, traces the whole flow from fee to partner on one page.

Figure 1 Where a pound of fee goes: the money flow through Deloitte UK**1. Fees, by business**

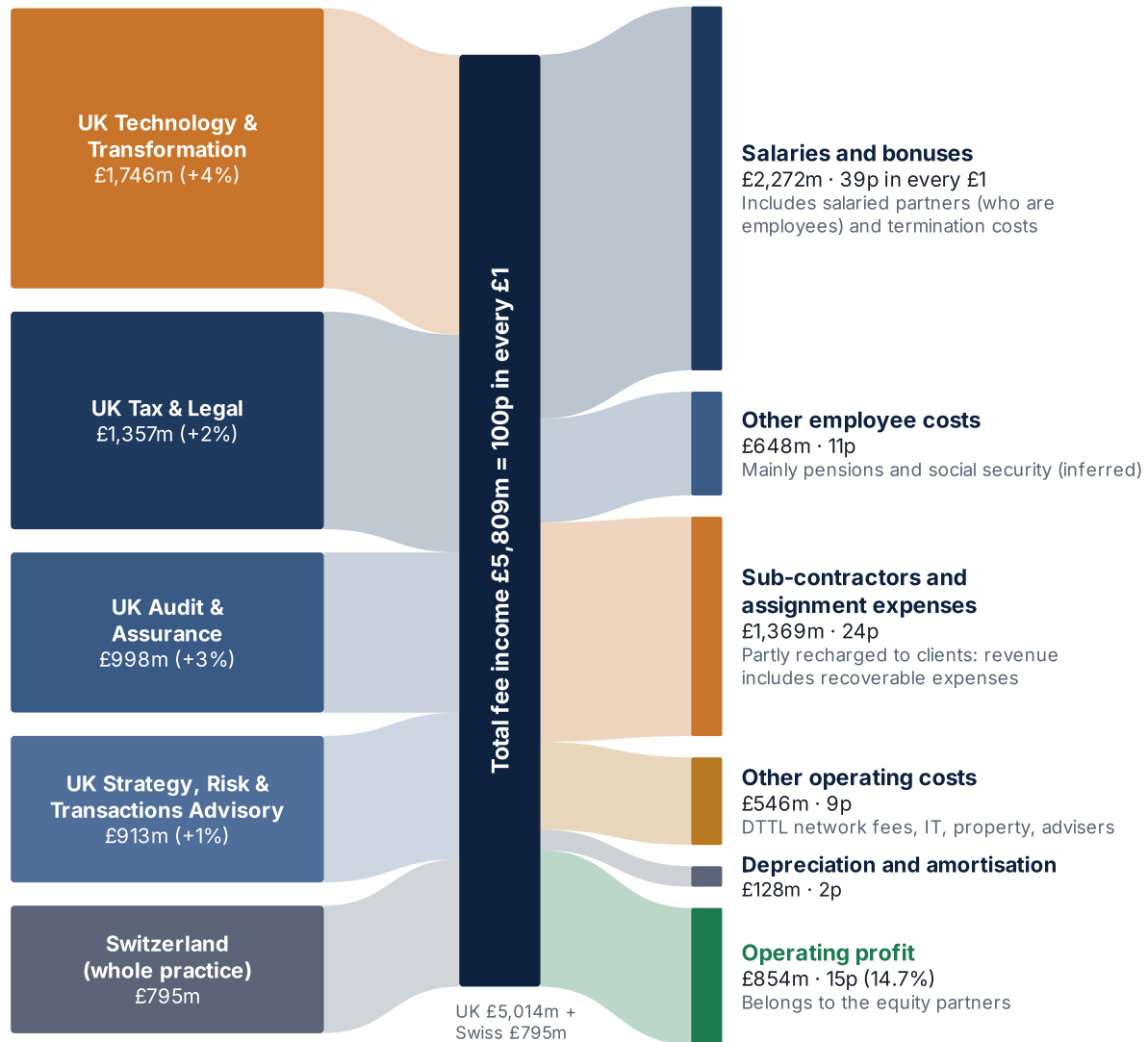
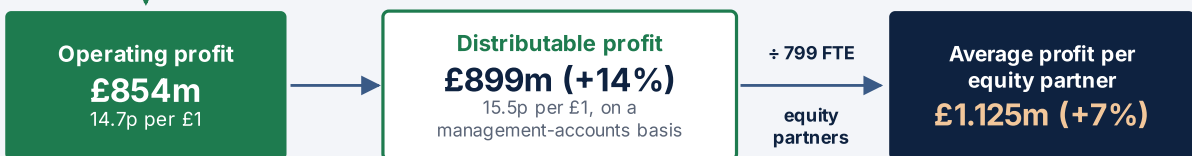
£m, FY2026 (year to 31 May 2026)

2. One pool

Group revenue

3. Where each £1 of fee goes

Cost lines from the audited FY2026 accounts

**4. From operating profit to each equity partner (FY2026)**

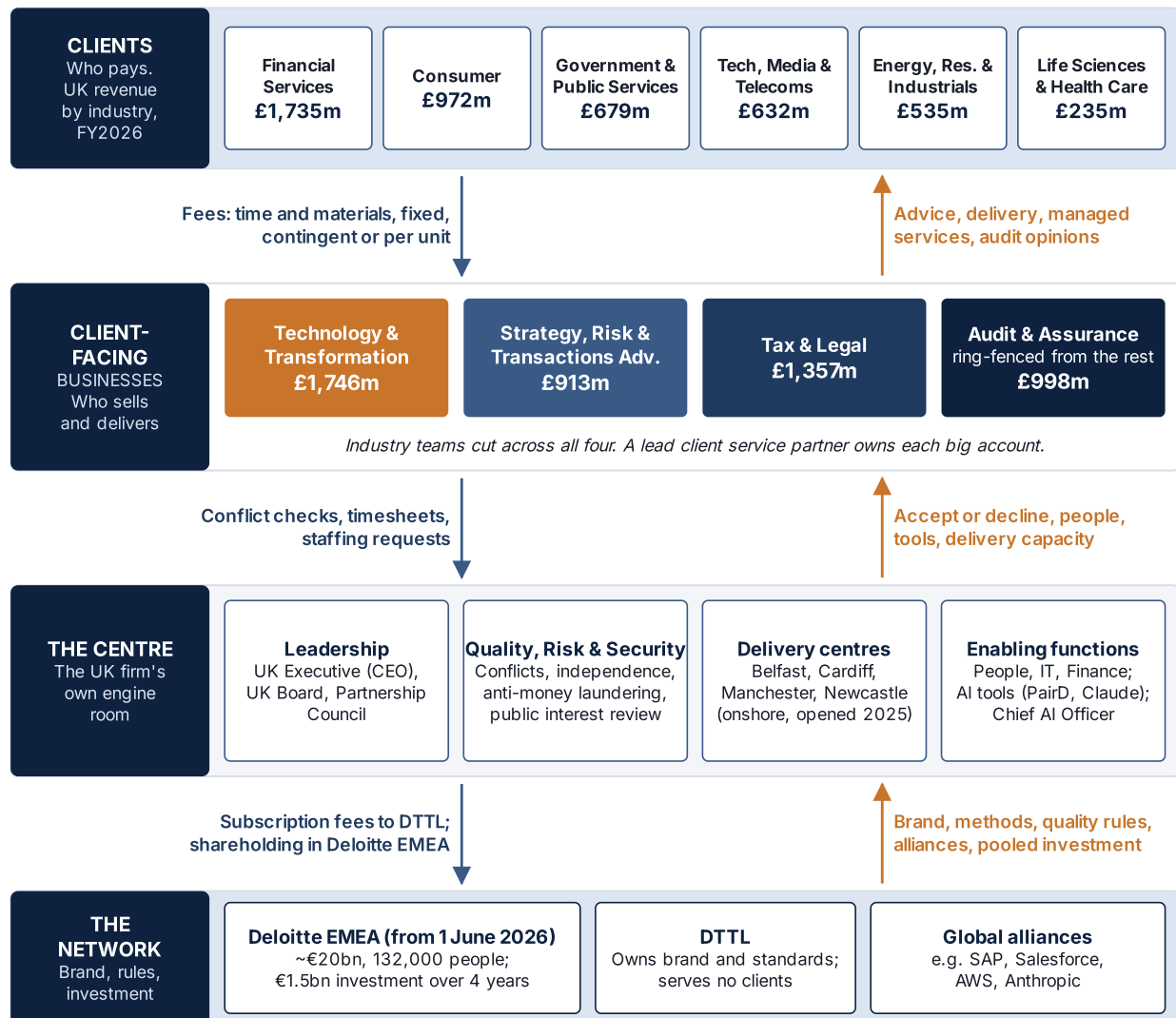
Statutory profit for the year was £769m. Distributable profit uses different accounting policies, so the two differ. Also paid from the pool, not shown: annuities to retired partners (scheme closed to new partners in 2021; payments mainly capped at 8% of operating profit before annuity charges). Partners also keep £296m of capital in the firm. Figures in steps 1-3 are UK and Switzerland consolidated. Pence are rounded arithmetic on the reported £m.

Source: [S88] Deloitte UK FY26 performance metrics (Sep 2026): revenue by business, UK/Switzerland split. [S93] Deloitte LLP Financial Statements 2026 (signed 25 Sep 2026): cost lines, profits, annuities, capital. [S407] FY2026 results release (30 Sep 2026): growth rates, profit per partner. All FY2026 (year to 31 May 2026). Pence per pound are our arithmetic **INFERRED**. Bands to scale. Margins by business are not disclosed, so flows merge into one pool before costs. Read: left to right, then down to the partners.

The operating model in layers

Money is one flow. Figure 2 shows the others: what moves between clients, the four client-facing businesses, the firm's own centre, and the global network. The key point for a beginner: the client-facing businesses do not work alone. Before any work starts, the centre checks conflicts. During the work, the centre supplies people, tools and delivery capacity. Above the firm, the network supplies the brand and the rules, and charges a fee for them.

Figure 2 The operating model in layers: clients, client-facing businesses, the network and the centre



Source: UK revenue by industry and business, FY2026: [S88] (Sep 2026). Fee types: [S93]. Conflict checks and public interest review: [S94] (Audit Transparency Report 2025). Delivery centres: [S85][S323] (2025). AI tools and Chief AI Officer: [S85][S116][S407]. Deloitte EMEA: [S93][S98] (2026). DCTL role and subscription fees: [S83][S93]. Alliances: [S319][S116]. Industry figures are UK only and exclude "Other" (£226m). Read: dark arrows flow down (money and requests), copper arrows flow up (work, approvals, capability).

Fixed fee or time and materials?

Pricing type	How it works	Who carries the risk
Time and materials	The client pays for hours worked at agreed rates, plus expenses. Revenue is "time charged to date" [S93] CONFIRMED	Mostly the client. If the work takes longer, the bill goes up.

Pricing type	How it works	Who carries the risk
Fixed fee	An agreed price for a defined scope. Revenue recognised by inputs of time at charge-out rates [S93] CONFIRMED .	Mostly the firm. Overruns cut realisation, so the partner earns less per hour.
Contingent fee	Paid only if something happens (for example, a deal completes). Not recognised until the contingency resolves [S93] CONFIRMED .	The firm, fully, until the event.
Per unit / transaction	A price per item processed, for example in data processing [S93] CONFIRMED .	Shared. Volume risk sits with the firm.
Risk and reward	Part of the fee depends on outcomes. Allowed under the UK government's Management Consultancy Framework Four alongside time and materials and fixed price [S117] CONFIRMED .	Shared, by design.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

No verified Deloitte day rate exists in our sources. Supplier rate cards for the government framework sit in a tool we could not open [S117]. Historic Test and Trace rates disclosed in 2021 were about £1,000 a day per person [S332]. Do not quote a current day rate in interview. Deloitte also publishes no utilisation or realisation targets.

Leverage: how many people per partner?

Leverage is the shape of the pyramid. The more juniors each partner leads, the more chargeable hours feed each partner's share. Using Deloitte's own numbers [S88][S93] and our arithmetic **INFERRED**:

- UK group FY2026: 23,970 FTE employees across 1,453 partners is about **16.5 staff per partner**. Per equity partner it is about **30**.
- Counting only fee-earners (20,346 FTE), it is about **14 per partner**.
- Deloitte global FY2025: 473,050 people across 21,183 partners, principals and managing directors is about **22 per partner** [S81].
- Revenue per head, UK group FY2026: about £235k per person (employees plus equity partners) **INFERRED**. Average employee cost: about £122k per FTE including employer pension and social security, bonuses and salaried partners. That is not a typical salary; senior grades and Swiss pay pull it up [S93] **INFERRED**.

The most important number in the FY2026 accounts is easy to miss. Average fee-earning employees fell from 21,471 to 20,346 FTE, down about 5%, while revenue rose 2% [S93] **CONFIRMED**. More revenue from fewer people pushed distributable profit up 14%. That is leverage and productivity working in the partners' favour, likely helped by delivery centres, AI tools and lower hiring **INFERRED**. Section E and Figure 41 come back to this.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

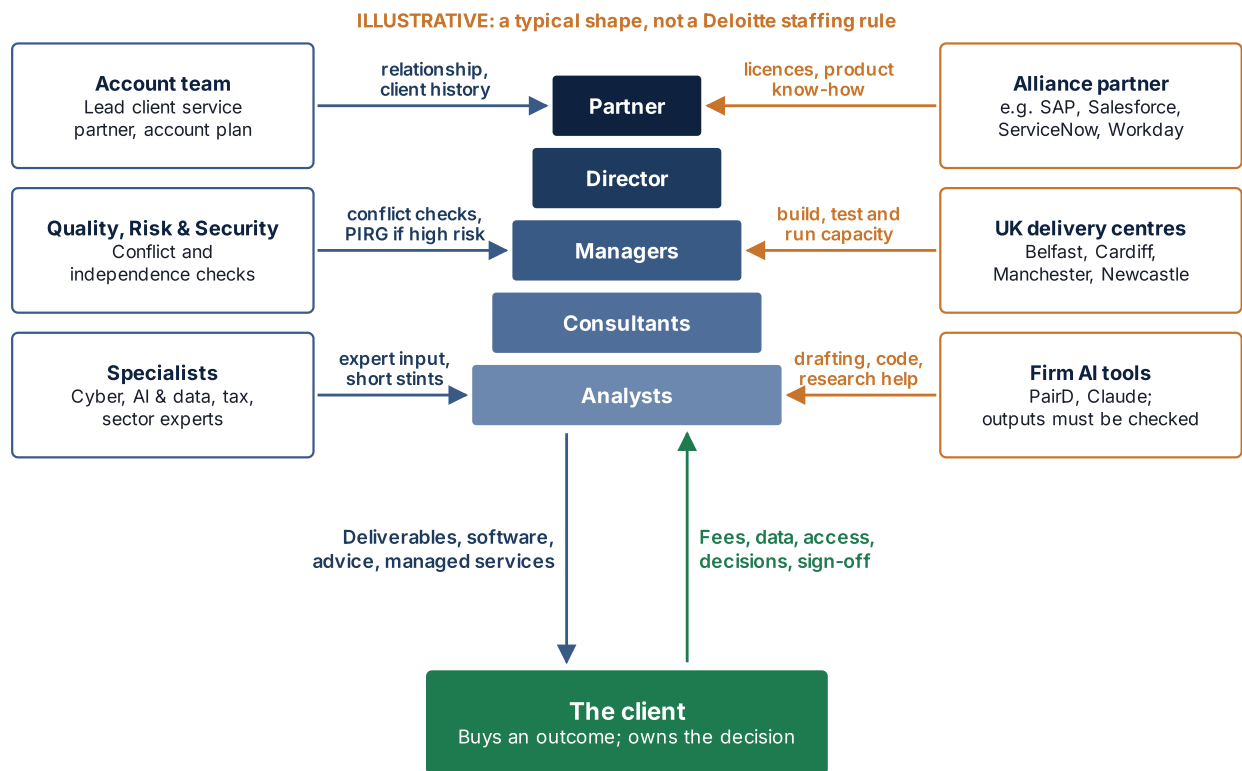
Prompt: "Profit up 14% on revenue up 2% with fewer staff. Is that good news for someone joining?"

For: a profitable firm can invest (technology spend rose to £180m [S407]) and the bonus pool rose 14% [S407]. **Against:** the same arithmetic means fewer junior seats per pound of revenue; entry-level hiring has fallen since FY2023 [S89]. **Suggested stance:** "It is good for the firm's resilience and it raises the bar for juniors. The analysts who thrive will be the ones who use AI tools to do higher-value work, not the ones competing with them on volume."

Anatomy of one engagement

Figure 4 zooms into one engagement team. The grade ladder in Deloitte consulting runs roughly analyst or consultant, senior consultant, manager, senior manager, director, partner (charge-out rates by grade: [\[S93\]](#); the ladder itself is standard practice [INFERRED](#)). A team rarely works only with its own members. It draws on the account team that owns the client relationship, the Quality, Risk & Security function that runs conflict and independence checks [\[S330\]](#), specialists from other offerings, alliance partners such as SAP or Salesforce [\[S319\]](#), the UK delivery centres [\[S323\]](#), and firm-wide AI tools [\[S85\]](#)[\[S116\]](#).

Figure 4 Anatomy of one engagement team, and what it draws from the firm



Behind every engagement: the money mechanics

Each person's hours go on a timesheet at a charge-out rate for their grade. Even fixed-fee work is recognised as revenue this way. Profit depends on how many hours are chargeable (utilisation), how much of the rate is actually billed and paid (realisation), and how many juniors each partner leads (leverage). Deloitte publishes none of the three.

Source: conflict checks and the Public Interest Review Group (PIRG): [\[S94\]](#) (2025). Quality, Risk & Security function: [\[S330\]](#). Lead client service partner role: [\[S322\]](#) (US member firm profiles, Reported). UK alliance list: [\[S319\]](#). UK delivery centres opened from June 2025: [\[S323\]](#)[\[S85\]](#). PairD: [\[S85\]](#)[\[S328\]](#); Claude roll-out to 470,000+ people: [\[S116\]](#) (Oct 2025). Revenue recognition by timesheet: [\[S93\]](#) (FY2026 accounts). Team shape is illustrative [INFERRED](#); Deloitte publishes no standard team size. Read: navy arrows on the left bring relationship and control; copper arrows on the right bring capacity and tools.

Role	What they do on the engagement	How they affect the economics INFERRED
Partner	Wins the work, signs the contract, owns quality and risk, manages the client's senior people.	Mostly not chargeable; their value is the sale and the relationship.
Director	Runs delivery day to day across workstreams; often leads the proposal.	Protects realisation by keeping scope under control.
Manager / senior manager	Plans the work, manages the team, reviews outputs, handles client meetings.	Decides staffing mix, so drives leverage.

Role	What they do on the engagement	How they affect the economics INFERRED
Consultant / senior consultant	Builds the analysis, configures the system, writes the deliverables.	Expected to be highly chargeable.
Analyst (your likely entry role)	Research, data work, slides, testing, meeting notes, first drafts.	Most chargeable time per pound of salary. The base of the pyramid.

C. The contracts: what partners, staff and clients each give and get

A professional partnership runs on three unwritten bargains. Only some of the terms are published. We label which parts are documented and which are norms.

Party	Gives	Gets	Evidence
Equity partners	Capital (£296m in total at 31 May 2026); unlimited effort; personal reputation; their vote on leaders	A share of distributable profit (average £1.125m, FY2026); a say in who leads; capital repaid after retirement	[S93][S407] CONFIRMED
Salaried partners	Partner-level work and selling	Partner title, salary and bonus; a chance of conversion to equity	[S88][S95] CONFIRMED
Staff	Chargeable hours, mobility, willingness to learn fast	Salary, bonus, training (£64.2m L&D spend in FY2025, about 35 hours per FTE), promotion, a brand on the CV	[S89] CONFIRMED ; "up or out" is a norm INFERRED
Clients	Fees; access to their people, systems and data; decisions	Expertise, extra capacity, a brand that reassures boards and regulators, someone accountable for delivery	Fee types [S93] CONFIRMED ; the rest INFERRED

The partner deal, from the accounts

- **Capital.** Each member's capital is set by their profit "units" and is repayable after retirement. Total members' capital was £296m at 31 May 2026 (2025: £293m) [S93] **CONFIRMED**. Across 809 members that averages about £366k, though individual amounts vary **INFERRED** (our arithmetic).
- **Profit share.** In Deloitte's words: "Members' share of profits is based upon a comprehensive evaluation of their individual and team contribution to, among others, quality, risk, performance, and leadership" [S93] **CONFIRMED**. The UK Executive allocates units with oversight from the Partnership Council. For audit partners, the Audit Non-Executives observe the process to test the link to audit quality [S93].
- **Cash.** Partners draw monthly advances against expected profit. The firm holds back tax and pays it to HMRC for them. The average effective tax rate on equity partners was 49% in FY2026 [S88] **CONFIRMED**.
- **Annuities.** A partner annuity scheme pays retired partners. It was closed to new entrants on 1 June 2021. Liabilities are £1,545m. In Deloitte's words: "The annual payments are mainly capped at 8% of applicable Group operating profit before annuity charges in any financial year" [S93] **CONFIRMED**. In effect, today's partners fund past partners' retirement out of today's profit **INFERRED**.
- **Voting.** The Senior Partner and Chief Executive is elected by partner vote, after soundings by the Partnership Council [S93][S96] **CONFIRMED**.
- **Conversion.** Salaried partners become equity partners in a separate step: 29 in 2024, 77 in 2025, 68 on 1 June 2026 [S84][S85][S95] **CONFIRMED**.

KEY TERM

Partner annuity: a retirement income paid by the firm to former partners, funded from current profits rather than a separate pension pot. Deloitte UK closed its scheme to new partners in 2021 and caps the annual cost at mainly 8% of operating profit before annuity charges [S93]. Why you care: it is a cost the current partners carry, so it shapes how hard they push for profit.

The staff deal: promotion, pay and the narrowing pyramid

- On 1 June 2026, over 6,000 people were promoted out of about 25,000, average in-grade salary rose 4.2%, and the bonus pool rose 14% [S95][S407] **CONFIRMED**.
- A year earlier the mood was different. In May 2025 UK staff were reportedly told the firm would "promote fewer people and reduce average salary rises" because profits were "below our original plan" [S101] **REPORTED**.
- New partners: 48 promoted on 1 June 2026, after 60 in 2025 and 80-81 in 2024 [S95][S85] **CONFIRMED**.
- Promotions to partner and director fell from 501 (FY2023) to 485 (FY2024) to 341 (FY2025) [S89] **CONFIRMED**. The top of the pyramid is narrowing.
- Voluntary attrition (people choosing to leave) was 10.0% in FY2025, after 9.4% in FY2024 and 11.1% in FY2023 [S89] **CONFIRMED**.
- Low attrition has a cost. In FY2026 Deloitte offered voluntary redundancy on enhanced terms to "less than 3% of our A&A business" because too few people were leaving [S407] **CONFIRMED**.

KEY TERM

Up or out: the norm in big professional firms that people are expected to move up through the grades on a rough timetable, or leave. Deloitte does not publish an up-or-out policy. Treat it as an industry norm **INFERRED**, visible in the promotion numbers above. Low voluntary attrition breaks the model, because the pyramid only works if people leave the lower grades at a steady rate.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Partner counts differ by definition. The promotions release says "1,308 partners overall" on 1 June 2026 [S95]. The FY2026 metrics say 1,453 partners as a full-year FTE average including Switzerland [S88]. The results release says equity partners rose 6.5% to a record 784 (a year-end headcount), while the accounts use 799 (an FTE average) [S407][S88]. Quote 784 as "record equity partners" and 799 only when you explain the £1.125m average.

DON'T SAY THIS

"Partners earn £1.1m each." That is an average across 799 FTE equity partners, before the 49% average tax rate, and it hides a wide spread [S88][S407]. Salaried partners are not in it at all.

D. The risk and control architecture

Deloitte's biggest asset is trust in one brand. Its biggest liability is that thousands of partners in separately owned firms around the world can damage that brand. The firm manages this with three layers of control: legal separation between firms, governance inside the UK firm, and gates on every engagement.

Layer 1: the network is a brand, not one company

The UK firm's legal position, verbatim from Deloitte's FY2026 release:

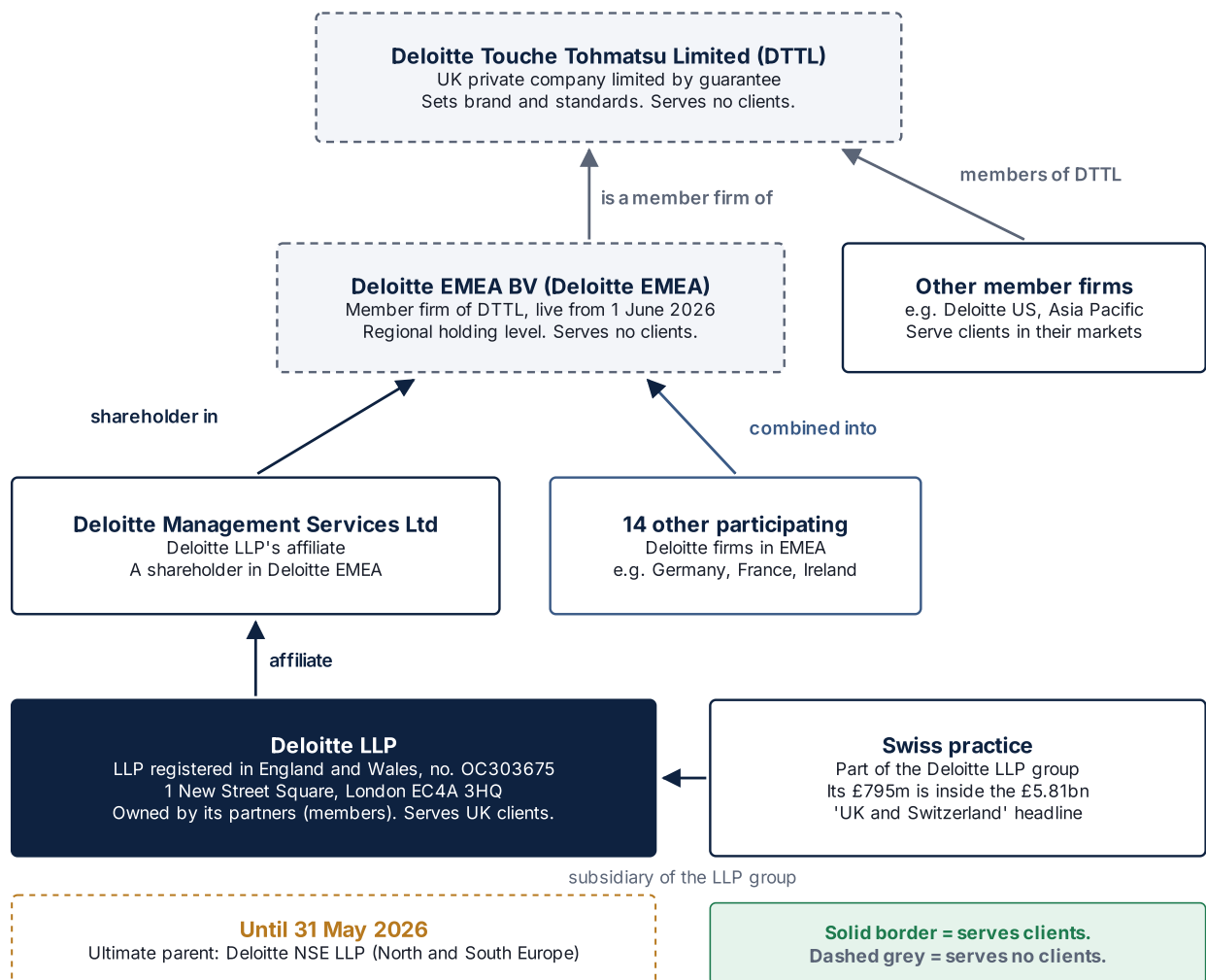
"Deloitte LLP is a limited liability partnership registered in England and Wales with registered number OC303675 and its registered office at 1 New Street Square, London EC4A 3HQ ... Deloitte LLP's affiliate (Deloitte Management Services Limited) is a shareholder in Deloitte EMEA BV (Deloitte EMEA). Deloitte EMEA is a member firm of Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited (DTTL). DTTL and Deloitte EMEA do not provide services to clients." [S407] **CONFIRMED**

DTTL is "a private company limited by guarantee incorporated in England and Wales" [S83] **CONFIRMED**. The network's own legal language explains the logic. DTTL and each member firm "are legally separate and independent entities, which cannot obligate or bind each other in respect of third parties", and are "liable only for their own acts and omissions, and not those of each other" [S83] **CONFIRMED**.

KEY TERM

Member firm: a separate legal business, owned by its own local partners, that has signed up to use the Deloitte brand and follow DTTL's standards. **Company limited by guarantee:** a company with no share capital, owned by members who guarantee a nominal sum; common for coordinating bodies that do not trade.

Figure 40 Deloitte's legal structure: from DTTL to the UK LLP



Source: [S407] Deloitte UK FY2026 results release, notes to editors (30 Sep 2026), verbatim structure; [S83] Deloitte Global "About the network" (live page, read 4 Oct 2026); [S93] Deloitte LLP Financial Statements 2026 for the 14 other participating firms, the Swiss practice and the former parent Deloitte NSE LLP; [S88] for Switzerland's £795m; [S99] (City AM, 2026) for example EMEA countries **REPORTED**. Read: arrows point from each entity to the one it belongs to or holds shares in; only the solid-bordered boxes do client work.

Why this matters to you **INFERRED** : a failure in Deloitte China or Deloitte Australia does not legally bind Deloitte UK. But it lands on the same brand and the same search results. Section I shows that this is not theoretical.

Layer 2: UK governance after 1 June 2026

From 1 June 2026, Deloitte LLP and its Swiss practice combined with 14 other participating member firms to form Deloitte EMEA. Deloitte NSE LLP (North and South Europe), the previous parent, ceased to be the parent **[S93]** **CONFIRMED** . Inside the UK firm, governance changed the same day **[S93][S407]** **CONFIRMED** :

Body	Role from 1 June 2026	Who / note
Senior Partner and Chief Executive	Leads the firm; elected by partners	Darren Graves, from 1 June 2026 [S96][S407]
UK Executive	Runs the firm day to day; allocates partner profit units	Includes Hayley McKelvey, Chief AI Officer [S407]
UK Board (replaced the UK Oversight Board)	Sets long-term strategy with the Executive; oversees risk, reputation, public interest, quality and ethics	Chair: Jane Whitlock [S407]
Board committees	Audit and Risk; Remuneration; Nomination; Partnership Council	[S93]
Partnership Council	Fairness between partners; soundings for leadership elections	[S93][S94]
Audit Governance Board	Oversees the ring-fenced audit practice; majority independent	Continues unchanged [S93] [S94]
Designated members	Legal signatories of the LLP	Darren Graves, Heather Bygrave; Martin Reilly from 1 Sep 2026 [S93]

Layer 3: gates on every engagement

This is where consultants meet the control system. The Audit Transparency Report describes the gates **[S94]** **CONFIRMED** :

- 1. Conflict check before acceptance.** "All proposed engagements and business and financial relationships go through a conflict check before they are accepted." The audit partner is always consulted if a potential conflict touches an audit client. "Where potential conflicts cannot be eliminated or reduced to an acceptable level, we decline the engagement."
- 2. Public Interest Review Group (PIRG).** Reviews engagements with high public-interest or reputational risk. It has looked at more than 800 matters over its history. In FY2025 it formally considered 32 matters and declined 9%; in FY2024, 38 matters with 19% declined.
- 3. Tax Review Panel.** Considers reputational risk in complex tax work.
- 4. Consulting forum.** For SR&T and T&T, a "Consultative Forum" and a "globally aligned client portfolio management process".

32

Matters formally reviewed by the PIRG, FY2025 (38 in FY2024) **[S94]**

9%

Of those declined, FY2025 (19% in FY2024) **[S94]**

800+

Matters reviewed by the PIRG in its history **[S94]**

95%

FRC-sampled audits rated good or limited improvements, 2025 report **[S94]**

KEY TERM

Conflict of interest: a situation where the firm's duty to one client clashes with its interest or its duty to another, for example advising a bidder while auditing the target. **Independence:** the rules that stop an auditor having financial or business ties with its audit client. For a consultant, independence decides which clients you are allowed to work for at all. Part 3 covers the UK rules that limit consulting for audit clients.

How Deloitte rates its own risks

The firm publishes a principal risks register. Two entries matter for consulting [S94] **CONFIRMED** :

- **"Our reputation, role and future public interest impact": Very High residual risk.** Threats listed include "Increased government focus on the reputation and role and public sector use of professional services organisations" and "Increasing breadth and depth of non-audit offerings (including Operate)".
- **"Client Portfolio": High.** It cites "Reputational risks associated with client selection" and notes that "Reputation is at risk from the 'company we choose to keep' and the projects we choose to deliver".

"Operate" means running services for clients on an ongoing basis, such as a benefits system or a finance function, rather than advising and leaving. The firm itself flags it as a source of risk. Rhode Island, in Section I, shows why.

Quality management

Audit firms must run a system of quality management under the standard ISQM (UK) 1. Deloitte UK's evaluation at 31 May 2025 found "two deficiencies identified (neither severe nor pervasive)" and concluded the system gives reasonable assurance; one was fixed by the report date [S94] **CONFIRMED** . The FRC rated 95% of sampled Deloitte audits "good or limited improvements required" (94% the year before) [S94]. The audit practice is "operationally separated" from the rest of the firm, an FRC requirement for the Big Four, and the transition period ended during FY2025 [S94] **CONFIRMED** . Deloitte UK also uses an offshore audit delivery centre, Global Audit India [S94].

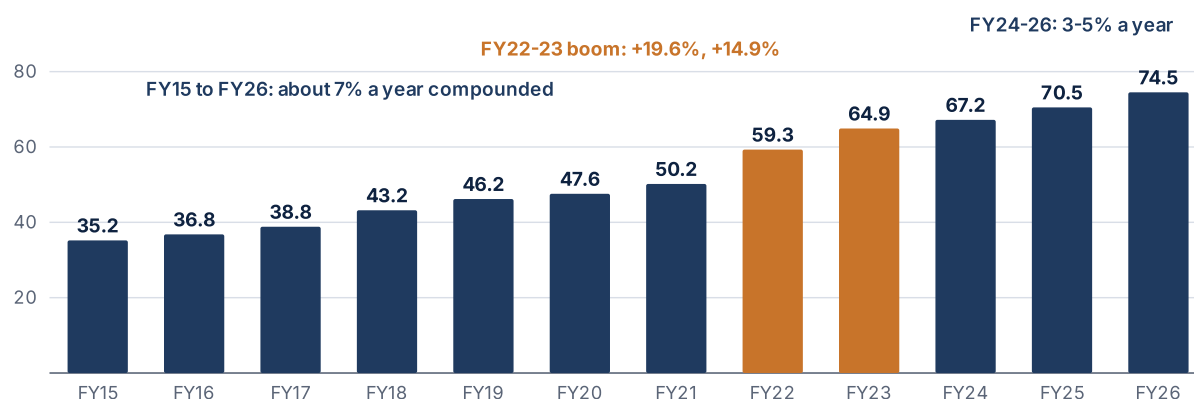
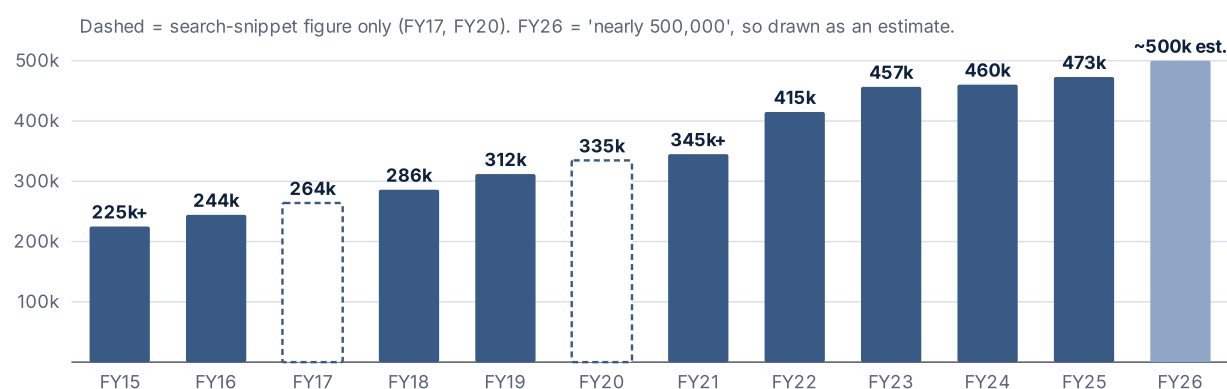
SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"I noticed the Public Interest Review Group declined 9% of the 32 matters it formally reviewed last year, and the firm rates its own reputation risk as Very High, partly because of Operate work. How does that gate show up for a consultant day to day?" [S94] It shows you read the Transparency Report, and it is a real question.

E. Business mix and growth over time

Global: doubled in eleven years

Deloitte's global revenue grew from US\$35.2bn in FY2015 to US\$74.5bn in FY2026, about 7% a year compounded [S80][S70] **INFERRED** (our arithmetic). The fastest years were FY2022 (+19.6% in local currency) and FY2023 (+14.9%), the post-COVID boom in digital and consulting work [S74][S73] **CONFIRMED** . Growth then slowed to 3-5% a year [S70][S71][S72]. Headcount roughly doubled too, from over 225,000 to nearly 500,000 [S80][S70].

Figure 5 Growth over time: global revenue and headcount, FY2015 to FY2026**A. Global revenue, US\$bn (aggregate of all member firms)****B. Global people (headcount at year end, thousands)**

Source: Deloitte global revenue releases: FY2015 [S80] (Sep 2015), FY2016 [S79], FY2017 implied by the FY2018 release [S78], FY2018 [S78] (Sep 2018), FY2019 [S77], FY2020 [S76] (Sep 2020), FY2021 [S75], FY2022 [S74], FY2023 [S73], FY2024 [S72] (Sep 2024), FY2025 [S71][S81] (Sep 2025), FY2026 [S70] (24 Sep 2026). Headcount FY2017 [S119] and FY2020 [S118] are search snippets only (dashed bars). FY2026 headcount "nearly 500,000" is drawn at 500k as an estimate. Fiscal years end 31 May. Read: revenue and people grew together until FY2023; since then revenue has kept rising while headcount growth flattened.

The business mix changed too. On 1 October 2024 Deloitte globally cut its five businesses to four, folding Consulting, Risk Advisory and Financial Advisory into T&T and SR&T [S94][S72] **CONFIRMED**. Global CEO Joe Ucuzoglu announced it in the FY2024 release: "over the course of FY2025, we are aligning our capabilities into the following business units: Audit & Assurance, Tax & Legal, and two units housing our Consulting services: Strategy, Risk & Transactions and Technology & Transformation" [S72] **CONFIRMED**. This breaks the UK time series in FY2024, so compare old and new numbers with care.

UK only, £m	FY19	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23
Consulting	966	1,081	1,189	1,370	1,596
Tax (& Legal)	877	939	969	1,107	1,210
Audit & Assurance	585	636	665	723	869
Financial Advisory	500	525	578	598	669
Risk Advisory	509	539	484	501	493

UK only, £m (restated, new structure)	FY24	FY25	FY26
Technology & Transformation	1,857	1,675 (-10%)	1,746 (+4%)
Tax & Legal	1,249	1,335 (+7%)	1,357 (+2%)

UK only, £m (restated, new structure)	FY24	FY25	FY26
Audit & Assurance	941	969 (+3%)	998 (+3%)
SR&T Advisory	874	901 (+3%)	913 (+1%)

Sources: old structure [S90][S91][S92]; new structure [S88][S89] **CONFIRMED**. Old Consulting is not the same perimeter as new T&T, so do not compute a growth rate across the break.

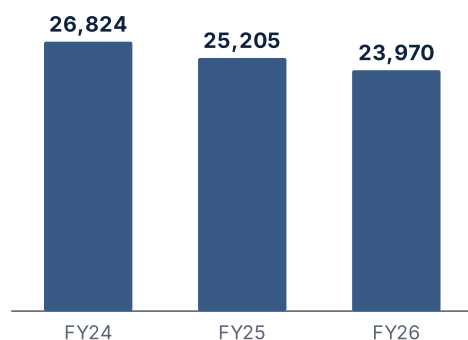
Fewer staff, more equity partners

UK group FTE employees rose from 18,405 in FY2019 to a peak of 26,824 in FY2024, then fell to 23,970 in FY2026, down about 11% in two years [S92][S89][S88] **CONFIRMED** (percentage **INFERRED**). Over the same two years, FTE equity partners rose from 749 to 799 [S88] **CONFIRMED**. Fewer staff, more owners, higher profit per owner: that is the shape of the last two years.

Figure 41 Fewer staff, more equity partners: UK FY2024 to FY2026

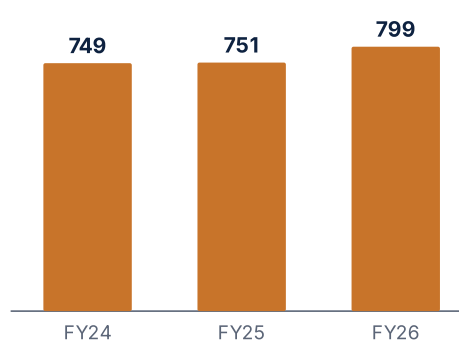
Employees (FTE average)

Down 11% in two years



Equity partners (FTE average)

Up 7% in two years



Staff per equity partner
FY24: 35.8
FY25: 33.6
FY26: 30.0

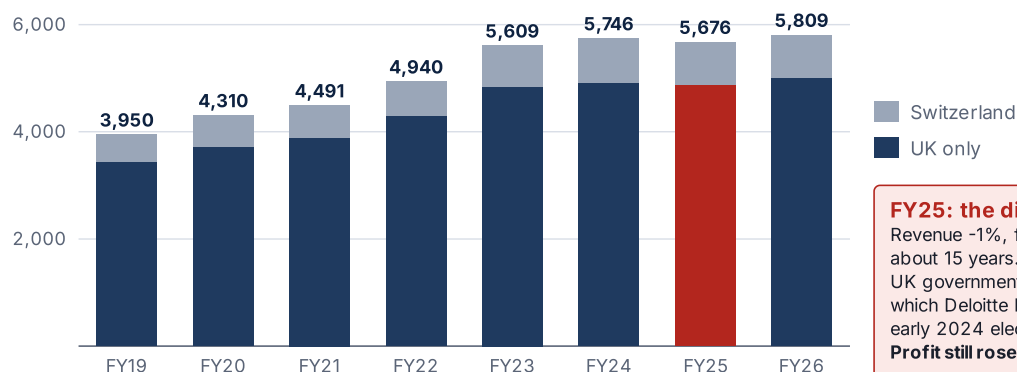
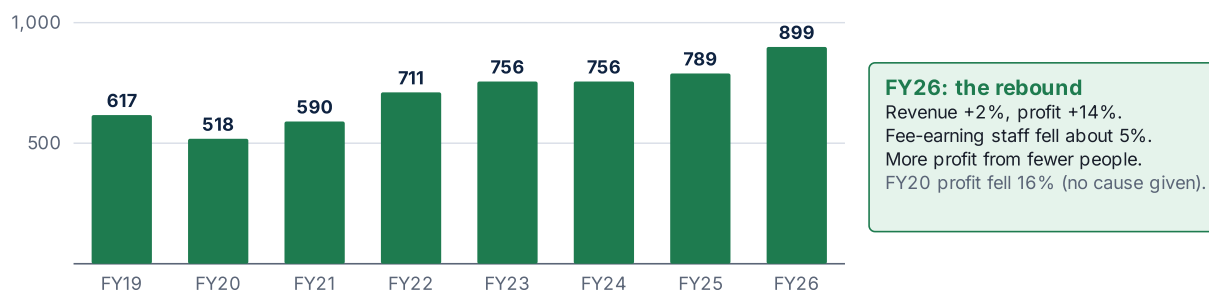
Group figures, UK and Switzerland. Ratio = employees ÷ equity partners, our arithmetic.

Source: [S88] Deloitte UK FY26 Business and ESG performance metrics (Sep 2026), FTE averages for the Deloitte LLP group including Switzerland; [S89] for FY25. Ratio is our arithmetic **INFERRED**. Read: each equity partner now leads about 30 staff, down from about 36 two years earlier.

There are two ways to read this, and you should be able to hold both **INFERRED**. The optimistic reading: the firm over-hired in the FY2023 boom (6,800 hires and 4,109 experienced hires that year [S87][S89]), then corrected, and new technology lets fewer people deliver more. The cautious reading: if AI and delivery centres keep raising output per head, the firm needs fewer juniors per partner for good. Entry-level hiring fell from 2,767 in FY2023 to 1,908 in FY2025 [S89] **CONFIRMED**, with "more than 1,950" in FY2026 [S407]. Part 4 turns this into how you stand out.

UK: steady revenue, rising profit, one dip

Deloitte UK (with Switzerland) grew from £3,950m in FY2019 to £5,809m in FY2026, about 5.7% a year [S92] [S88] **INFERRED** (our arithmetic). FY2025 was the exception: revenue fell 1% to £5,676m, the first fall in about 15 years [S101] **REPORTED**. T&T fell 10%. UK government and public services revenue fell 14%, from £761m to £652m. Deloitte's footnote gives the reason: "The reduction in FY25 revenue was primarily due to the early announcement of the general election which resulted in delays to procurement decision making, contract award decisions and start dates of projects" [S89] **CONFIRMED**. Even in that year, distributable profit rose 4% to £789m [S85] **CONFIRMED**. That is the multidisciplinary model doing its job: tax and legal grew 7% while T&T shrank.

Figure 11 UK revenue and profit stability, FY2019 to FY2026**A. Revenue, £m (UK + Switzerland consolidated)****B. Distributable profit, £m****C. Average profit per equity partner, £k**

Source: Deloitte UK Business and ESG performance metrics: FY19-FY21 [S92] (Sep 2021), FY22 [S91], FY23 [S90], FY24-FY25 [S89] (Sep 2025), FY24-FY26 [S88] (Sep 2026). FY25 reason: Deloitte footnote [S89]; "first fall in about 15 years" [S101] (Irish Times, 30 Sep 2025, Reported). FY26 fee-earner fall: [S93]. All years to 31 May; all values are Deloitte LLP group (UK and Switzerland) except the UK-only bar segments. Read: grey caps are Switzerland; the red FY25 bar is the one revenue fall; profit and profit per partner kept climbing through it.

F. What "private partnership" means for your research

Deloitte UK has no shares on a stock market. That changes where the numbers come from.

WHAT YOU CANNOT GET

- No share price, no analyst forecasts, no quarterly results **INFERRED**.
- No margin by business. You cannot tell whether T&T is more profitable than audit **[S93]**.
- No day rates, utilisation or realisation targets.
- No client names in the accounts and no individual partner pay.

WHAT IS PUBLIC, AND WHERE

- **LLP accounts** at Companies House (OC303675), audited by BDO: income statement, costs, partners, capital, annuities, governance **[S93]**.
- **Business and ESG performance metrics** PDF each September: revenue by business and industry, profit per partner, FTEs, attrition, promotions **[S88][S89][S90][S91][S92]**.
- **Audit Transparency Report**: governance, quality, PIRG, risk register **[S94]**.
- **Global revenue release and Global Impact Report** each September **[S70][S71][S81]**.

Three traps sit in these sources **[S93][S88][S407]** **CONFIRMED** :

1. The UK headline includes Switzerland. Business-line figures do not.
2. The fiscal year ends 31 May, so FY2026 is mostly calendar 2025.
3. Partner and people numbers come in headcount and FTE-average versions. Always say which.

KEY TERM

FTE (full-time equivalent): a way of counting staff where two half-time people count as one. An "FTE average" is the average over the year, so it differs from the headcount on a single day. Deloitte UK's "25,000 people" is a rounded headcount; 23,970 is the FTE average **[S88][S407]**.

G. Where leadership says the firm is going, and what the spending says

What leaders say

- **Joe Ucuzoglu, Deloitte Global CEO, FY2026**: "In a time of rapid change and technology-fueled disruption, organizations around the world continue to place their trust in Deloitte to successfully navigate this historic reshaping of markets and industries" **[S70]** **CONFIRMED**. As quoted by City AM: "Deloitte is unlocking AI's potential through a people-led, AI-powered approach grounded in trust, integrity, and professional excellence" **[S100]** **REPORTED**.
- **Darren Graves, UK Senior Partner and CEO from 1 June 2026**. He joined Deloitte as a Business Tax graduate in 2001, made partner in 2012, led UK Transactions Tax, and from 2022 was Managing Partner for NSE Tax & Legal **[S96]** **CONFIRMED**. He was confirmed by partner vote around 31 March 2026, reportedly unopposed **[S96][S97]** ("unopposed" is **REPORTED**). He has said he wants to "reinvent our firm for the next generation" **[S97]** **REPORTED**. On results day: "As AI makes intelligence increasingly abundant, the role our people play will matter more, not less. AI can't replace lived experience or replicate the judgement and unwritten know-how built..." **[S407]** **CONFIRMED**.
- **Richard Houston, UK CEO since 2019, became CEO of Deloitte EMEA from 1 June 2026** **[S94][S407]** **CONFIRMED**.

What the money and hiring say **INFERRED** from confirmed inputs

Signal	Evidence	Our reading
AI is a board-level job	Hayley McKelvey joined the UK Executive as Chief AI Officer, "responsible for driving the firm's AI strategy across client services and internal operations" [S407]. City AM calls her the first UK chief AI officer [S100].	AI is treated as both a product to sell and a way to change how work is done inside.
Technology spend rising	UK technology investment £180m in FY2026, up from £158m [S407]. Globally, more than US\$3bn of GenAI investment through FY2030 [S72].	Spending is moving from people to platforms.
Scale through regional merger	Deloitte EMEA: about €20bn revenue, 6,000 partners, 132,000 people, more than €1.5bn of extra investment over four years in GenAI, sovereign cloud and sector solutions [S98] [S93].	Investment decisions now sit at European level; expect more cross-border teams.
Cheaper onshore delivery	UK technology delivery centres in Belfast, Cardiff, Manchester and Newcastle opened in FY2025 [S85], "fully operational in FY26" [S407]; plan of 750 technologists rising to 1,500 [S323] REPORTED .	Build and run work moves out of London to lower-cost UK sites.
Alliances with AI model makers	Anthropic alliance, 6 October 2025: Claude for more than 470,000 Deloitte people, a Center of Excellence, 15,000 professionals to certify [S116] CONFIRMED .	Certified headcount on new platforms is what clients buy.
Junior hiring lower	Entry-level hires 2,767 (FY23), 2,150 (FY24), 1,908 (FY25), "1,950+" (FY26); experienced hires 4,109 to about 1,250 [S89][S407].	Fewer, better-prepared juniors. The bar to get in is higher.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Prompt: "Will AI shrink the consulting pyramid?"

Yes: fee-earners fell 5% while revenue rose 2% [S93]; junior hiring is down a third from FY2023 [S89]; the firm has a Chief AI Officer and a firm-wide Claude roll-out [S407][S116]. **No:** the FY2023 peak was exceptional by Deloitte's own footnote [S89]; T&T returned to growth in FY2026 [S407]; the CEO says people "will matter more, not less" [S407]. **Suggested stance:** "The pyramid gets narrower at the bottom but not flatter. Analysts will spend less time producing first drafts and more time checking and explaining them. I want to join a firm that is building the checks, not just buying the tools."

H. Recent moves, October 2024 to October 2026

Date	What happened	Source
1 Oct 2024	Global "four businesses" structure takes effect (context: just before the 24-month window).	[S94][S72] CONFIRMED
18 Mar 2025	Zora AI launched: Deloitte's agentic AI product, built with NVIDIA technology.	[S327] REPORTED
Apr 2025	Deloitte US starts layoffs in government consulting after DOGE contract cuts.	[S114] REPORTED
May 2025	UK staff told of fewer promotions and smaller pay rises. UK delivery centres announced (22 May).	[S101][S323] REPORTED
1 Jun 2025	60 new UK partners (down from 80-81) and 77 equity conversions.	[S85] CONFIRMED
30 Sep 2025	UK FY2025 results: revenue -1%, T&T -10%, profit +4%.	[S85][S89] CONFIRMED

Date	What happened	Source
Late Sep-Oct 2025	Reported UK job cuts, mainly business development and marketing roles.	[S102] REPORTED
6 Oct 2025	Anthropic alliance announced. Same week: Deloitte Australia AI refund makes news.	[S116][S113]
Feb-Mar 2026	Deloitte EMEA announced (about 2 March).	[S98] CONFIRMED
~31 Mar 2026	Darren Graves confirmed as next UK Senior Partner and CEO.	[S96][S97] CONFIRMED
May 2026	Rhode Island settlement brings the state's total recovery to US\$12m.	[S115] REPORTED
29 May 2026	Promotions: over 6,000 people, 48 new partners, 68 equity conversions, record equity partners.	[S95] CONFIRMED
1 Jun 2026	Deloitte EMEA live. Graves becomes CEO; UK Board replaces UK Oversight Board; McKelvey joins as Chief AI Officer.	[S93][S407] CONFIRMED
Jun 2026	Nearly 200 job cuts reported in UK audit.	[S100] REPORTED
24 Sep 2026	Global FY2026 revenue US\$74.5bn, +3.8%.	[S70] CONFIRMED
30 Sep 2026	UK FY2026 results: revenue +2% to £5.81bn (UK and Switzerland), profit +14%.	[S407][S84] CONFIRMED

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

UK job-cut numbers come from secondary press [S100][S102]. Earlier rounds reported elsewhere (about 800 in September 2023, about 100 in February 2024) rest on search snippets only and are not cited here as fact. If asked, say "there have been several reported rounds of cuts" rather than giving a number.

I. The skeletons, told straight

Every big firm has a list. Interviewers do not expect you to defend Deloitte. They do notice whether you know the facts, keep them in proportion, and can say what the firm learned. Only verified matters are listed. Each line ends with why it matters to a consulting candidate **INFERRED**.

Matter	What happened	Why it matters to you
Autonomy (UK audit), 17 Sep 2020	Record £15m FRC fine and severe reprimand for audits of Autonomy covering 2009-2011; two former partners fined; about £5.6m of FRC costs. The tribunal cited "wholesale nature of the failure of professional scepticism" [S105] CONFIRMED .	Shows why independence and scepticism are taken seriously firm-wide, including in consulting.
Serco , 16 Jul 2019	£4.2m FRC fine (after discount) over audits of Serco's electronic tagging division, 2011-12 [S106] REPORTED .	A government contract scandal touched the auditor too. Public-sector work carries reputational risk on every side.
Mitie , 21 Apr 2022	£2m fine, reduced to £1.45m, over 2016 goodwill testing; the FRC said there was "no suggestion that breaches were intentional, dishonest or reckless" [S107] REPORTED .	Most failures are about judgement and evidence, not fraud. That is true in consulting too.
SIG , 22 Dec 2022	£1.25m fine, discounted to £906,250, for 2015-16 audits [S108] REPORTED .	Pattern: repeat sanctions keep audit quality on the board agenda.
Glencore (open)	FRC investigation into Deloitte's Glencore audits for 2013-2020, announced July 2025. Outcome not known at 4 Oct 2026 [S109] REPORTED .	Live issue. Mention as "under investigation", never as a finding.
Deloitte China , 2022-23	SEC US\$20m penalty (29 Sep 2022): staff let audit clients pick their own samples [S111] CONFIRMED . China's Ministry of Finance fined 211.9m yuan (about US\$31m) and suspended the Beijing office for three months (17 Mar 2023) [S112] REPORTED .	A separate legal firm, but the same brand. This is the "liable only for their own acts" structure at work.

Matter	What happened	Why it matters to you
Australia AI report , Oct 2025	Deloitte Australia refunded the final instalment of an AU\$440,000 government review after an academic found fabricated references and a misquoted court judgment. The corrected report disclosed use of "a generative AI large language model (Azure OpenAI GPT-4o)" [S113] REPORTED .	The live cautionary tale for AI-assisted consulting. It broke the same week as the Anthropic deal.
US federal cuts (DOGE) , 2025	At least 129 Deloitte contracts terminated or cut, more than any other consultancy; Deloitte US made "modest personnel actions" in April 2025 [S114] REPORTED (the DOGE data itself was questioned).	Public-sector consulting carries political risk. The UK saw a milder version in FY2025 [S89] .
Rhode Island , 2024-26	Deloitte ran the state's RIBridges benefits system. A ransomware attack discovered in December 2024 affected more than 650,000 people. A May 2026 settlement brought the state's total recovery to US\$12m, plus about US\$6m of system support. Deloitte denied wrongdoing [S115] REPORTED .	In "Operate" work the firm owns operational and cyber risk, not just advice. This is why the risk register rates Operate as a threat [S94] .

For proportion: over the five years to June 2025, pre-discount FRC fines totalled KPMG £81.8m, PwC £34m, Deloitte £19m and EY £18m [\[S110\]](#) **REPORTED**. Deloitte is not the outlier among the Big Four.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

The detail that the Rhode Island attackers used a Deloitte employee's stolen credentials rests on a search snippet, not a page we read (the settlement itself is from [\[S115\]](#)). Kier, Ted Baker and Patisserie Valerie are sometimes mentioned in Big Four lists; we could not verify they were Deloitte audits, so they are excluded.

DON'T SAY THIS

"I don't think that was really Deloitte's fault." Or the opposite: "Big Four firms can't be trusted." Both close the conversation. Don't attribute other firms' scandals to Deloitte, and don't describe Glencore as a finding while it is still an investigation.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW, IF ASKED ABOUT THE FIRM'S PROBLEMS

"The ones I would take most seriously for consulting are the Australian AI report and Rhode Island. The first shows what happens when AI output is not checked properly. The second shows that when you run a service rather than advise on it, you own the operational risk. Deloitte's own risk register rates reputation risk as Very High and names Operate work as a driver [\[S94\]](#), so the firm clearly sees it. As a junior, the practical lesson for me is simple: check every source and every output before it reaches a client, however good the tool is." [\[S113\]](#)[\[S115\]](#)

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Prompt: "Should Deloitte keep doing public-sector Operate work, given Rhode Island and DOGE?"

Keep: government is a large, sticky market; UK government and public services revenue was £679m in FY2026 [\[S88\]](#). **Retreat:** political and cyber risk is concentrated there, and the risk register flags government scrutiny [\[S94\]](#)[\[S114\]](#)[\[S115\]](#). **Suggested stance:** "Keep it, but price and staff it as a risk business: tighter cyber controls, clearer exit terms, and explicit acceptance through the public interest review."

ONE-PARAGRAPH SUMMARY OF THIS PART

Deloitte is a brand shared by legally separate firms. The UK firm is an LLP owned by about 800 equity partners. It turned £5.81bn of FY2026 fees (UK and Switzerland) into £899m of distributable profit: half of each pound pays staff, about a quarter passes through to sub-contractors and expenses, and about 15p is left for the owners. Revenue grew 2% while fee-earning staff fell 5%. Since 1 June 2026 it sits inside Deloitte EMEA under a new CEO and a new Chief AI Officer. Its biggest risk, by its own rating, is reputation, and the cases that matter most for a consultant are about AI quality and Operate work [S93][S88][S407][S94].

PART 3

Why Deloitte is built this way

The mechanism behind the firm: why audit, tax, advisory and technology sit in one partnership, how the pieces work together and where the rules force them apart, what clients really pay for, and the support machine behind the client teams. This is the raw material for a "why Deloitte" answer that nobody else in the room will give.

The short answer

Deloitte is a set of partner-owned firms that share one brand. Inside each country firm, four businesses with different economic rhythms share one profit pool. Audit is steady and regulated. Tax is steady. Technology consulting swings with clients' appetite for large programmes. Put together, they behave like an investment portfolio: when one falls, the others hold the firm up, and the shared profit pays for the next round of investment (today, mostly AI and delivery centres) **INFERRED**.

The price of that design is friction. Independence rules stop the consulting side selling most services to the companies the audit side audits. The UK regulator has ring-fenced audit inside the firm. A scandal in one country lands on every firm that carries the name. Deloitte's leaders have looked at this trade and decided, repeatedly and publicly, that it is worth it.

£5.81bn

Revenue FY26, UK and Switzerland consolidated; UK alone £5,014m **[S407]** **[S88]**

£1,746m

UK Technology & Transformation revenue FY26, +4%; about 35% of UK revenue **[S88]**

-10% vs -1%

FY25: UK T&T fell 10%; UK and Swiss firm revenue fell 1% **[S88]** **[S85]**

£899m

Distributable profit FY26, +14%, shared by 784 equity partners **[S407]**

KEY TERM

Multidisciplinary partnership (MDP): a firm that combines several professions (here audit, tax, legal, strategy, risk, deals and technology consulting) under one ownership and one brand. Academics who studied the big accounting firms found this form "was vigorously contested" from the start, because regulators worried that auditors who also sell consulting may be conflicted **[S315]** **REPORTED**.

What the structure actually is

"Deloitte" is a brand, not a single company. Deloitte describes itself as the brand under which "nearly 500,000" people "in independent firms throughout the world come together" **[S302]** **CONFIRMED**. Three layers matter.

Layer 1: the global umbrella (DTTL)

At the top is Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited (DTTL), a private company limited by guarantee incorporated in England and Wales. It sets brand and quality rules. In Deloitte's words, "DTTL does not provide services to clients" **[S302]** **CONFIRMED**. Member firms pay DTTL subscription fees, which show up in the UK accounts as an operating cost **[S93]** **CONFIRMED**. The key legal line is that DTTL and each member firm "are liable only for their own acts and omissions, and not those of each other" **[S302]** **CONFIRMED**.

Layer 2: the region (new in 2026: Deloitte EMEA)

Until 31 May 2026 the UK firm sat under Deloitte NSE LLP (North and South Europe), a holding entity that served no clients [S93] **CONFIRMED**. From 1 June 2026, Deloitte LLP and its Swiss practice combined with other member firms to form Deloitte EMEA: 16 firms, more than 80 countries, about €20bn of revenue, 6,000 partners and 132,000 people, with more than €1.5bn of planned extra investment over four years in generative AI, sovereign cloud and sector solutions [S124] **CONFIRMED**. Richard Houston, previously UK CEO, runs it [S124] **CONFIRMED**. The UK accounts give the reason: "strategic alignment across participating firms, thereby enhancing the ability to invest in innovation, technology platforms, and talent development at a regional level" [S93] **CONFIRMED**. The legal chain, verbatim from the UK results: Deloitte LLP's affiliate "is a shareholder in Deloitte EMEA BV (Deloitte EMEA). Deloitte EMEA is a member firm of Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited (DTTL). DTTL and Deloitte EMEA do not provide services to clients" [S407] **CONFIRMED**.

Layer 3: the UK firm and its four businesses

Deloitte LLP is a limited liability partnership registered in England and Wales, number OC303675, at 1 New Street Square, London EC4A 3HQ [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Since a global simplification that took effect on 1 October 2024, it runs four businesses: Audit & Assurance (A&A); Tax & Legal (T&L); Strategy, Risk & Transactions Advisory (SR&T-A); and Technology & Transformation (T&T) [S94] [S72] **CONFIRMED**. The old Consulting, Risk Advisory and Financial Advisory units were folded into the last two [S89] **CONFIRMED**. Deloitte calls T&T and SR&T together its "advisory businesses" [S407] **CONFIRMED**.

KEY TERM

Limited liability partnership (LLP) and equity partner: an LLP is a partnership whose owners ("members") are not personally liable for the firm's debts. Equity partners own the firm. They are not paid a salary; they share what is left after staff and costs are paid. That residual is **distributable profit**: £899m in FY26, or £1.125m per equity partner on average [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Salaried partners carry the title but are employees [S88] **CONFIRMED**.

DON'T SAY THIS

"Deloitte UK made £5.81bn and T&T is 30% of it." The £5.81bn includes Switzerland. Deloitte's own footnote: "All revenue numbers presented herein, unless otherwise noted, represent UK and Switzerland consolidated" [S407]. UK-only revenue was £5,014m and the Swiss practice £795m [S88] **CONFIRMED**. The four business lines are UK-only, so T&T is about 35% of the UK firm **INFERRED** (arithmetic).

Why one partnership: the theory and the numbers

There are six mechanisms that explain why the firm is built like this. Each is stated as a theory, then tested against evidence.

1. A portfolio of businesses that peak at different times

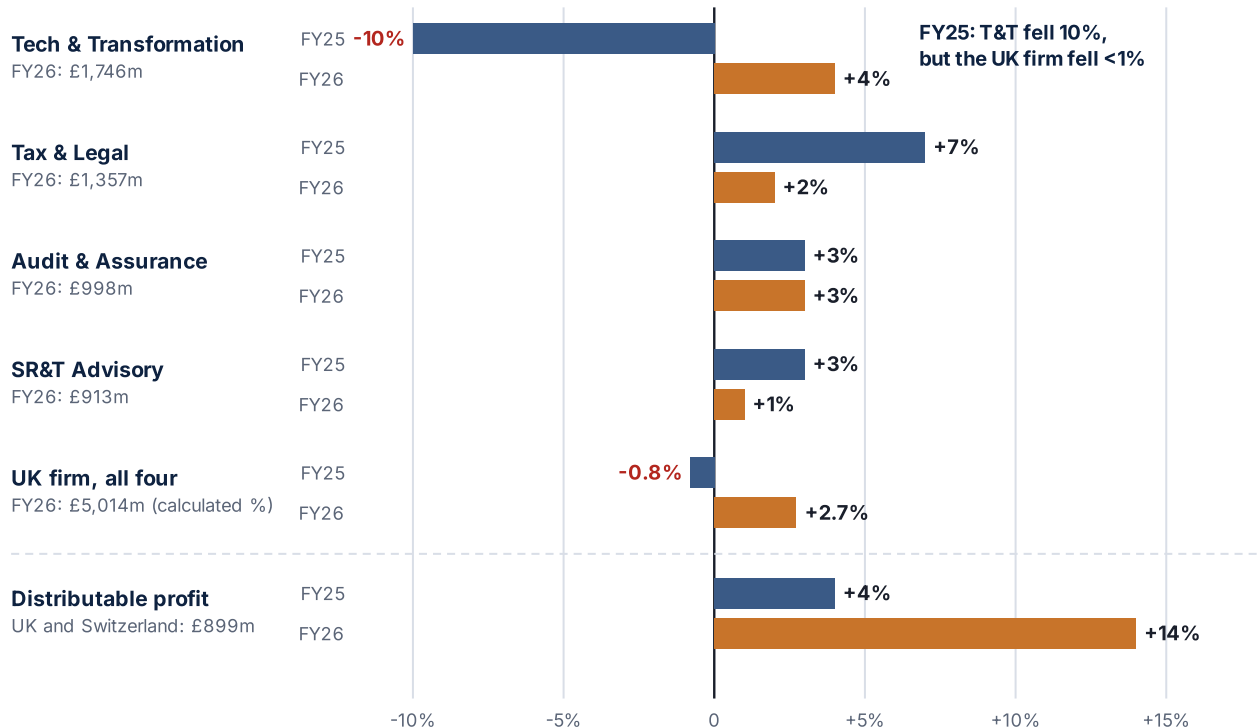
Audit is recurring and required by law: a listed company must have one every year. Tax work follows the tax calendar and changes in tax rules. Consulting depends on whether clients feel confident enough to start large programmes. These cycles do not line up, so combining them smooths partner income **INFERRED**.

The UK numbers for the last two years are the clearest live test. In FY25 (the year to 31 May 2025), UK T&T revenue fell 10% to £1,675m. Tax & Legal rose 7%, Audit & Assurance 3% and SR&T Advisory 3% [S88] [S85] **CONFIRMED**. The firm's total fell only 1%, its first fall in about 15 years [S101] **REPORTED**. The reason given was that "Clients delayed large-scale investment programmes amid economic uncertainty" [S305] **REPORTED**.

Distributable profit still rose 4% [S85] **CONFIRMED**. In FY26, T&T recovered by 4% and profit jumped 14% on revenue growth of 2% [S407] **CONFIRMED**.

Figure 6 Why the portfolio works: businesses that move at different times

Annual revenue growth by business, Deloitte UK, years to 31 May (%). UK only unless marked.



Scope: the four business lines are UK-only. Profit is UK and Switzerland consolidated (Swiss revenue £795m in FY26). Business names are the restated four-business structure. Blue = FY25, copper = FY26.

Source: [S88] Deloitte UK Business and ESG performance metrics FY26 (Sep 2026), restated £m by business for FY24 to FY26; [S85] Deloitte UK FY25 results (Sep 2025); [S407] Deloitte UK FY26 results (30 Sep 2026). Business growth rates are Deloitte's rounded figures; the UK-firm total growth is a calculation from £m values **INFERRED**. Read: in FY25 the biggest business shrank by a tenth while the other three grew, so the firm barely moved and profit still rose.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"I looked at the last two years of UK results. In FY25, Technology & Transformation fell 10%, but tax grew 7% and audit 3%, so the firm only dipped about 1% and profit still went up. In FY26 T&T came back with 4% growth. To me that is the case for the multidisciplinary model in two numbers: it lets the firm keep investing through a weak consulting year."

2. Brand trust from audit, sold across the firm

Audit puts Deloitte inside the finance function of large companies and makes the name a signal of reliability. Deloitte's own framing: "Our multidisciplinary model, deep domain and industry knowledge, and commitment to upholding quality and trust in the corporate reporting ecosystem allow us to provide integrated solutions" [S300] **CONFIRMED**. The firm's origin story is the same idea: William Welch Deloitte, who set up in London in 1845, is described as the first person appointed independent auditor of a public company, the Great Western Railway [S103] **REPORTED**. **INFERRED** The trust earned in audit helps every other business win work, even where the rules stop the audit team itself from passing on leads.

3. Partner capital and a long horizon

Partners own the firm and are paid out of distributable profit [S407]. Each equity partner puts in capital; total members' capital was £296m at 31 May 2026 [S93] **CONFIRMED**. There are no outside shareholders and no

quarterly results **INFERRED**. That let the firm ride out FY25 without a share-price shock, and it means investment comes out of partners' pockets. Deloitte globally has committed US\$3bn to AI through 2030 **[S300] CONFIRMED**; the UK spent £180m on technology in FY26, up from £158m **[S407] CONFIRMED**.

4. Liability containment

Because each member firm is "liable only for their own acts" **[S302]**, a failure in one country should not bankrupt the others **INFERRED**. This is the lesson of Arthur Andersen, which collapsed after Enron in 2001-02. Andersen's UK practice joined Deloitte UK in 2002 **[S103] REPORTED**.

5. Scale for alliances and investment

Big technology vendors want partners who can put thousands of certified people on their platforms. A pooled network can do that; a single country firm cannot **INFERRED**. Global CEO Joe Ucuzoglu, on the EMEA combination: "Our clients expect leading expertise wherever it is based, alongside seamless cross-border and technology-enabled delivery at speed" **[S306] REPORTED**.

6. Breadth for careers

Ucuzoglu's own list of reasons for keeping the model (March 2023, in a video after EY's split collapsed) was that clients value the breadth, people value "the diversity of career paths", markets value the quality and communities value the impact. He called the decision "not even a close call" and said previous separations had "never once played out as intended" **[S308] REPORTED**. In June 2022 Deloitte had already called media reports of a split "categorically untrue", adding "we remain committed to our current business model" **[S309] REPORTED**.

KEY TERM

Local currency growth: growth with exchange-rate effects stripped out. Deloitte's global revenue rose 5.7% in US dollars but 3.8% in local currency in FY26 **[S300]**. The local-currency figure is the "real" growth.

The decision that made Deloitte different: 2002-03

After Enron, regulators worried that auditors selling consulting were conflicted. The other big firms sold or spun off their consulting arms: Ernst & Young sold to Cap Gemini (2000), KPMG Consulting floated and became BearingPoint, and PwC Consulting was sold to IBM (2002) **[S104] REPORTED**. Deloitte announced in February 2002 that it would separate Deloitte Consulting as "Braxton". On 31 March 2003 it abandoned the plan, citing a "tight credit market and the uncertain state of the economy", and kept consulting "focused on nonaudit clients" **[S104] REPORTED**. That left Deloitte the only one of the big firms that still owned a large consulting practice **[S104] REPORTED**. By FY25, consulting (SR&T plus T&T) was US\$43.7bn of Deloitte's US\$70.5bn global revenue, about 62% **[S81] CONFIRMED**. **INFERRED** Deloitte today is, by revenue, a technology and strategy consultancy attached to an audit firm.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

The "only Big Four that kept consulting" history rests on one contemporary press report (InfoWorld, April 2003) **[S104]** and background knowledge; peer details are Reported, not checked against each firm's own records. PwC, EY and KPMG have all rebuilt large consulting businesses since. Say "Deloitte did not complete its planned spin-off, while the others sold theirs", not "Deloitte is the only firm with consulting".

What the structure costs

Cost 1: independence blocks selling

An auditor must be independent of the company it audits, or its opinion is worthless. UK rules turn that principle into hard limits. Under the FRC Revised Ethical Standard 2019 (effective 15 March 2020), auditors of UK public interest entities (PIEs: broadly listed companies, banks and insurers) may only provide a short "whitelist" of non-audit services, mostly work required by law or closely linked to the audit [S180] **CONFIRMED**. Non-audit fees from such clients are capped at 70% of the average audit fee of the previous three years [S182] [S180] **CONFIRMED**. Internal audit, secondments and contingent fees are banned for all audit clients [S180] [S181] **CONFIRMED**. The rules reach the whole network: services to a UK PIE's parent and worldwide subsidiaries are caught [S180] **CONFIRMED**. The current version is the Revised Ethical Standard 2024, effective 15 December 2024 [S178] **CONFIRMED**.

INFERRED In practice, if Deloitte audits a FTSE company, Deloitte's T&T team generally cannot sell it an ERP implementation. Every large Deloitte audit client is a client the consulting side must largely leave to Accenture, PwC, EY or KPMG, and the reverse is true for them.

Cost 2: the regulator has ring-fenced audit inside the firm

On 6 July 2020 the FRC published principles requiring the Big Four to operationally separate their UK audit practices, with full implementation by 30 June 2024 [S183] **CONFIRMED**. The required outcomes include audit governance that protects auditors from the rest of the firm, and audit partners' profit share not persistently exceeding what the audit practice itself contributes, so there is no cross-subsidy [S183] **CONFIRMED**. Press reports of the approved plans add that dealings between audit and the rest of the firm must be at arm's length, and the audit practice may not receive fees for introducing work to other parts of the firm [S312] **REPORTED**. On 10 October 2024 the FRC said all four firms had completed the transition, with independent audit boards and more transparency on transactions between audit and non-audit businesses [S184] **CONFIRMED**. Deloitte UK's Audit Governance Board said ring-fencing "has undoubtedly played an important part" in better audit quality [S94] **CONFIRMED**.

KEY TERM

Operational separation: the audit practice stays inside the same LLP (one legal firm, one brand) but has its own board, its own financial accounting and limits on what money and work can flow to and from the rest of the firm [S183] [S184]. It is separation inside the firm, not a legal split **INFERRED**.

Cost 3: slow decisions across many partner-owned firms

Any structural change needs agreement across many partnerships. EY's attempt to split (below) failed partly for this reason [S310] **REPORTED**. **INFERRED** A partnership can be patient, but it is rarely fast.

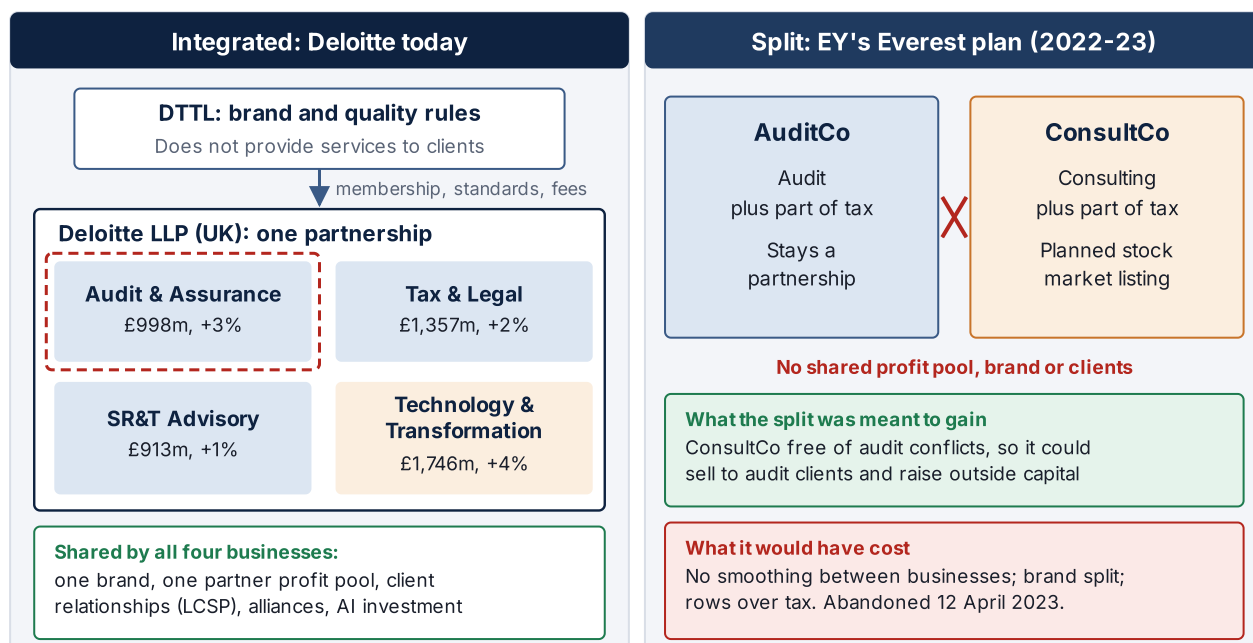
Cost 4: one brand, so one firm's mistake travels

In 2025 Deloitte Australia agreed to repay the final instalment of an AU\$440,000 contract with Australia's Department of Employment and Workplace Relations, after a report on its welfare compliance framework was found to contain fabricated citations and an invented quote from a Federal Court judgment [S316] **CONFIRMED**. The revised report disclosed use of "a generative AI large language model (Azure OpenAI GPT-4o)" [S316]. It happened in a legally separate firm, yet the story ran worldwide under the Deloitte name, in the same week Deloitte announced its Claude deployment to 470,000+ people [S325] [S326]. Other cases make the same point: the US SEC fined Deloitte China US\$20m in 2022 over audit failings [S111] **CONFIRMED**, and Deloitte UK has its own FRC record, including the record £15m Autonomy fine in 2020 [S105] **CONFIRMED**.

Deloitte UK's own risk register rates "Our reputation, role and future public interest impact" as a **Very High** residual risk, and lists "Increasing breadth and depth of non-audit offerings (including Operate)" as one of

the threats [S94] **CONFIRMED**. In other words, the firm itself names the multidisciplinary model as a source of its top risk.

Figure 3 The integrated multidisciplinary model versus the split model



TEST	Integrated (Deloitte)	Split (Everest-style)
Consulting slump	Absorbed: UK FY25 T&T -10%, firm revenue only -1%	ConsultCo takes the full hit (Inferred)
Audit clients	Mostly off-limits to consulting: whitelist and 70% fee cap	Open to ConsultCo once it no longer shares the auditor (Inferred)
Funding	Partners' profits, e.g. US\$3bn global AI commitment to 2030	Shareholders after a listing (the Everest plan)

Source: [S88] UK revenue by business FY26 (Sep 2026); [S302] DTTL network page; [S310] [S141] Accountancy Age EY split timeline (Apr 2023); [S180] [S182] independence rules; [S300] Deloitte FY26 global release (Sep 2026); [S85] UK FY25 results. The dashed red line marks the audit practice's ring-fence (Figure 7). Right-hand outcomes are what the plan intended or implied, not observed results **INFERRED**. Read: left, four businesses share one pool and one name; right, two companies share nothing.

The natural experiment: EY's Project Everest

EY is the only one of the four to have seriously tried the alternative. Its plan, known as Project Everest, was to split audit from consulting and list the consulting side on the stock market. Its stated rationale was to address "conflicts of interest often associated with audit and advisory firms" and capture consulting growth [S310] **REPORTED**. It was abandoned on 12 April 2023 after the US executive committee withdrew, following a dispute over how much of the tax business should stay with audit, and opposition from member firms in China and Israel [S141] [S310] **REPORTED**. The reported cost was about US\$600m [S141] **REPORTED**.

What the experiment shows **INFERRED**: the split had real attractions (freedom to sell to audit clients, outside capital), but unpicking a multidisciplinary partnership is very hard. Tax sits naturally on both sides. Partners in each country have a vote. Deloitte's response has been to go the other way: a larger combined regional firm, Deloitte EMEA, funded by partners rather than by outside investors [S124] **CONFIRMED**.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Prompt: "Should the Big Four split audit from consulting?"

For a split: independence rules wall off the biggest clients from consulting; the UK regulator has already ring-fenced audit [S183]; Deloitte's own risk register rates its reputation as a Very High risk and names the breadth of non-audit work as a threat [S94]; a listed consultancy could raise capital without partners' pockets.

Against: FY25 showed the portfolio absorbing a 10% consulting fall [S88]; EY spent about US\$600m and still could not agree the split [S141]; tax and risk work sit naturally with both sides; private capital in mid-tier firms (Grant Thornton) is a recent, unproven experiment [S144] [S145].

Suggested stance: "For Deloitte, the portfolio benefit and the investment capacity outweigh the lost access to audit clients today. The test I would watch is whether AI shrinks the hours on big implementation projects enough that consulting stops being the growth engine. Then the logic of keeping it tied to audit would weaken."

How the businesses work together

The matrix: offering by industry

Every Deloitte professional sits in an **offering** (what they do) and usually aligns to an **industry** (who they do it for). The six global industries are Consumer; Energy, Resources & Industrials; Financial Services; Government & Public Services; Life Sciences & Health Care; and Technology, Media & Telecommunications [S301] **CONFIRMED**. In the UK, Financial Services is the biggest industry at £1,735m of FY26 revenue, with Government & Public Services at £679m [S88] **CONFIRMED**.

UK T&T offerings named on Deloitte's careers page are Enterprise, Technology & Performance; Engineering, AI & Data; Cyber; Customer; Human Capital; and Defence & Security [S320] **CONFIRMED**. FY26 demand was for "enterprise technology support, including ERP implementation, Cyber and Human Capital services" [S303] **CONFIRMED**. Deloitte's own summary of the idea: "Our multidisciplinary model allows us to bring together technology, tools, insights, and deep industry experience across all businesses to provide integrated solutions" [S301] **CONFIRMED**.

KEY TERM

Offering: a practice built around a skill, such as Cyber or Human Capital (people and organisation). **ERP** (enterprise resource planning): the core software that runs a company's finance, supply chain and HR, for example SAP, Oracle or Workday. ERP implementations are long, large programmes, which is why they drive T&T revenue.

Account teams: where collaboration lives

For large clients Deloitte appoints a Lead Client Service Partner (LCSP). Deloitte US profiles and postings describe the role as leveraging Deloitte's networks to support major relationships, making sure account plans are "developed, monitored", and that pursuit processes are run "consistently ... across the account" [S322] **REPORTED**. These sources are from the US member firm; the UK term and practice are assumed similar but not verified. **INFERRED** Cross-selling is organised around the client, not the offering: the LCSP sees the whole wallet and offering partners bring specialists.

Alliances: the vendor sells the licence, Deloitte sells the implementation

Deloitte UK lists 14 alliance partners: Adobe, Anaplan, Apple, AWS, Google, Informatica, MuleSoft, Oracle, Salesforce, SAP, ServiceNow, UiPath, Workday and Workiva [S319] **CONFIRMED**. Its own description: "We

combine our award-winning consulting services, market sensing data and trusted relationships with some of the largest technology firms to help solve your most complex challenges" [S319] **CONFIRMED** . Globally, Deloitte was named NVIDIA Global Consulting Partner of the Year 2026 for the fifth year running and won six Google Cloud Partner of the Year awards [S300] **CONFIRMED** . On 6 October 2025 Deloitte and Anthropic announced Claude for more than 470,000 Deloitte people, a Claude Center of Excellence and certification for 15,000 professionals [S325] **CONFIRMED** .

Delivery centres: where the building happens

Deloitte UK opened onshore technology centres in Belfast, Cardiff, Manchester and Newcastle from 2025, starting with 750 technologists and aiming for 1,500 within three years [S323] **REPORTED** . T&T managing partner Rob Cullen said the investment "accelerates our ambition to become the largest onshore technology capability in UK" [S323]. The FY26 results say the centres were "fully operational in FY26" [S407] **CONFIRMED** . Deloitte's US-India delivery organisation (USI) is reported at more than 100,000 people [S324] **REPORTED** , but it belongs to the US firm and its role on UK engagements is not established. Deloitte UK audit uses an offshore audit delivery centre, Global Audit India [S94] **CONFIRMED** .

KEY TERM

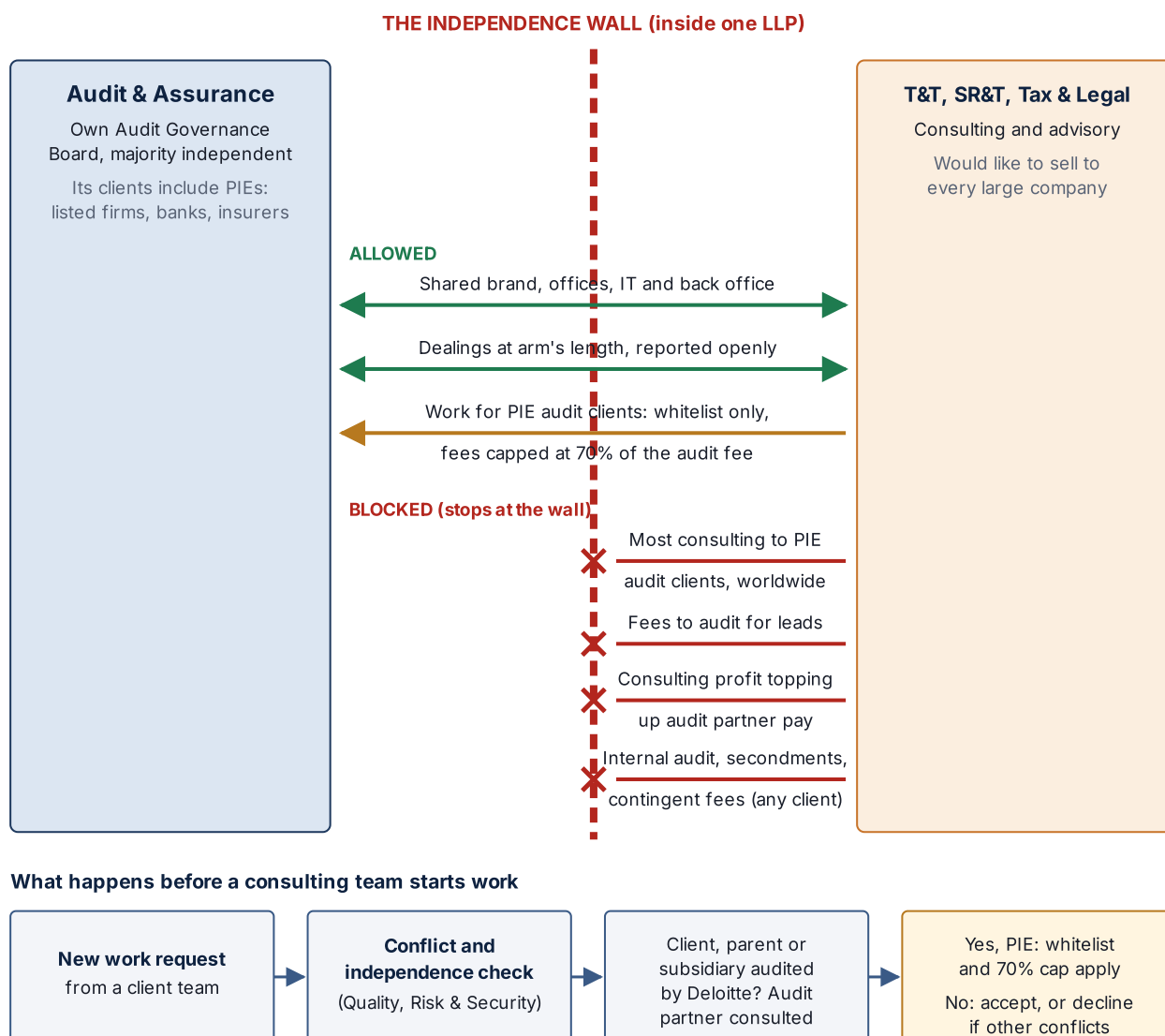
Delivery centre: a lower-cost location where teams build, test and run technology for engagements led elsewhere. **Onshore** means inside the client's country (useful for security-cleared public sector work); **offshore** means abroad, often India.

Where independence blocks collaboration

Deloitte's own rule, from its Audit Transparency Report: "All proposed engagements and business and financial relationships go through a conflict check before they are accepted." If conflicts cannot be reduced to an acceptable level, "we decline the engagement" [S94] **CONFIRMED** . The audit partner is always consulted where a potential conflict touches an audit client [S94] **CONFIRMED** . A Public Interest Review Group reviews engagements with high reputational risk: 32 matters in FY25, of which 9% were declined [S94] **CONFIRMED** .

INFERRED (from [S180] [S183] [S94]) So truly integrated, multi-business work happens mostly at clients that Deloitte does not audit (often audited by another Big Four firm), in the public sector, and in private companies below the PIE threshold.

Figure 7 The independence wall: what crosses between audit and consulting and what never does



Source: [S180] Deloitte briefing on the FRC Revised Ethical Standard 2019 (Feb 2020); [S182] EU Audit Regulation 537/2014 (70% cap); [S183] FRC operational separation principles (Jul 2020); [S184] FRC transition complete (Oct 2024); [S312] City AM on approved plans (Feb 2021); [S94] Deloitte UK Audit Transparency Report 2025 (conflict checks). The whitelist reaches the network's services to a UK PIE's parent and worldwide subsidiaries. The 70% cap does not apply to the wider "other entities of public interest" category [S180] [S181]. Read: green crosses freely, amber crosses under limits, red stops at the wall.

DON'T SAY THIS

"Deloitte can offer its audit clients the full package, from audit to tech implementation." For UK listed and other PIE audit clients, that is exactly what the rules forbid [S180]. Say instead: "The integrated model works best at clients Deloitte doesn't audit, which is why the conflict check comes before everything else."

What clients actually buy

Who the clients are

Deloitte serves "nearly 90% of the Fortune Global 500" [S300] **CONFIRMED**. Gartner ranks Deloitte the No. 1 consulting services provider worldwide by revenue; Deloitte's 2026 release says this is the ninth consecutive year [S125] **REPORTED** (Deloitte's release, Gartner report paywalled). In UK public procurement, Tussell data reported by Consultancy.uk shows UK public sector consulting spend at a record £3.7bn in 2024/25, up 6%, and Deloitte as the top supplier of key consulting contracts for five years running, with £400m+ in fees, about four times the next firm [S335] **REPORTED**. In late June 2026 Deloitte won a four-year Home Office data and analytics deal worth up to £200m [S233] **REPORTED**. "Up to" is a ceiling, not guaranteed spend **INFERRED**.

What they are buying

1. **Scale at short notice.** On NHS Test and Trace in 2020-21, Deloitte had around 900 to 1,035 consultants working at peak [S332] [S333] **CONFIRMED**. Few organisations can find a thousand people in weeks.
2. **Certified platform skills.** 14 UK alliances [S319] and, globally, 15,000 people to be certified on Claude [S325]. Deloitte US cites more than 36,000 SAP-focused professionals [S146] **CONFIRMED**.
3. **Sector depth** from the industry side of the matrix [S301].
4. **A defensible choice.** A board or minister can justify hiring the firm Gartner ranks No. 1 [S125] **INFERRED**.
5. **Risk transfer.** A contract with a large balance sheet behind it. The Australian refund shows the mechanism working in reverse: the client got money back [S316] **INFERRED**.

Why they accept the price

Rates disclosed to Parliament: Deloitte staff on Test and Trace cost about £1,000 a day each, close to £1m a day in total, with some senior consultants up to £6,624 a day [S332] [S333] **CONFIRMED**. Deloitte's contracts were worth £298m, with £174m spent by end-March 2021 [S332] [S333]. The government's explanation was "skills shortages in certain areas of the civil service" and "comparatively low salaries in the civil service" [S333] **REPORTED**. The National Audit Office (NAO, Parliament's spending watchdog) found in November 2025 that 86% of survey respondents said consultants made valuable contributions [S334] **CONFIRMED**.

KEY TERM

Day rate: the price a client pays per consultant per day. It covers salary, the firm's overheads, time between projects and partner profit, which is why it is far higher than the consultant's own daily pay. Deloitte recognises revenue on time-and-materials or on fixed fees managed internally through "actual inputs of time at charge-out rates" [S93] **CONFIRMED**.

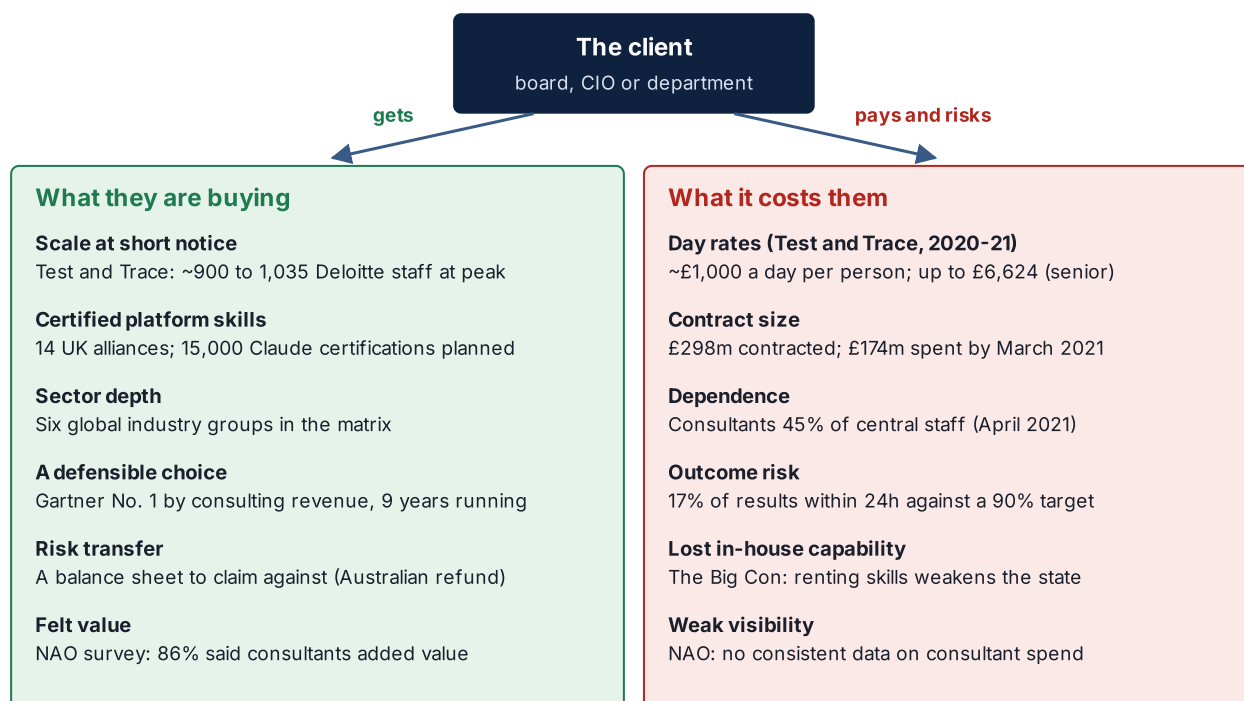
The counter-case, with numbers

- **Performance.** During heavy consultant use on Test and Trace, only 17% of people got test results within 24 hours against a 90% target [S332] **REPORTED**.
- **Dependence.** In April 2021 Test and Trace had 2,239 external workers; consultants were still 45% of central staff [S333] **REPORTED**.
- **Visibility.** The NAO said "Government does not have consistent data on how much individual departments are spending on external consultants" [S334] **CONFIRMED**. HM Treasury estimated central government spend at about £1.36bn in 2022-23; the government targeted £550m of savings in 2024-25 and £700m by 2028-29 [S334] **CONFIRMED**. Yet Tussell measured wider public sector consulting at a record £3.7bn in 2024/25 [S335] **REPORTED**. The two figures use different scopes, so do not compare them directly.
- **Ideas.** Mariana Mazzucato and Rosie Collington's book *The Big Con* (2023) argues that over-reliance on consultancies weakens state capability, charges well above equivalent public staff and creates conflicts

of interest, naming the Big Four including Deloitte [S337] **REPORTED** (summary only, book not read). Critics said its idea of public value is loosely defined [S337].

- **Quality failure.** The Australian AI report [S316].

Figure 10 The client's view: what they are buying and what it costs them



Scale of UK public spend (different scopes: do not add these up)

£3.7bn UK public sector consulting, 2024/25 (Tussell)	~£1.36bn Central government, 2022-23 (HM Treasury estimate, NAO)	£400m+ Deloitte fees, key consulting contracts, 5 years (Tussell)
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Source: [S332] Consultancy.uk, Test and Trace spending (Jul 2021); [S333] PublicTechnology on the NAO's findings (Jun 2021); [S334] NAO press release (21 Nov 2025); [S335] Consultancy.uk reporting Tussell data (26 May 2026); [S319] Deloitte UK alliances; [S325] Anthropic (Oct 2025); [S125] Deloitte Gartner release (Jun 2026); [S316] The Register (Oct 2025); [S337] summary of The Big Con. Day rates are from one 2020-21 emergency programme disclosed to Parliament, not a current Deloitte price list. Read: left is the case clients make for buying; right is the bill and the risk.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Prompt: "Is the government right to keep buying from firms like Deloitte?"

Yes: the civil service cannot hire a thousand people in weeks; the NAO found most users valued the work [S334]; data and digital skills are scarce, which is why the Home Office still bought up to £200m of data work after pledging cuts [S233].

No: £1,000+ a day per person on Test and Trace, 45% of central staff from outside, and weak results against targets [S332] [S333]; the state cannot even count what it spends [S334]; The Big Con argues it hollows out capability [S337].

Suggested stance: "Short, sharp capacity in a crisis is good value. Long-term dependence is not. The best engagements leave the client able to do it themselves, and I'd want to work on ones that are designed to hand over."

The non-core side: the centre and internal AI

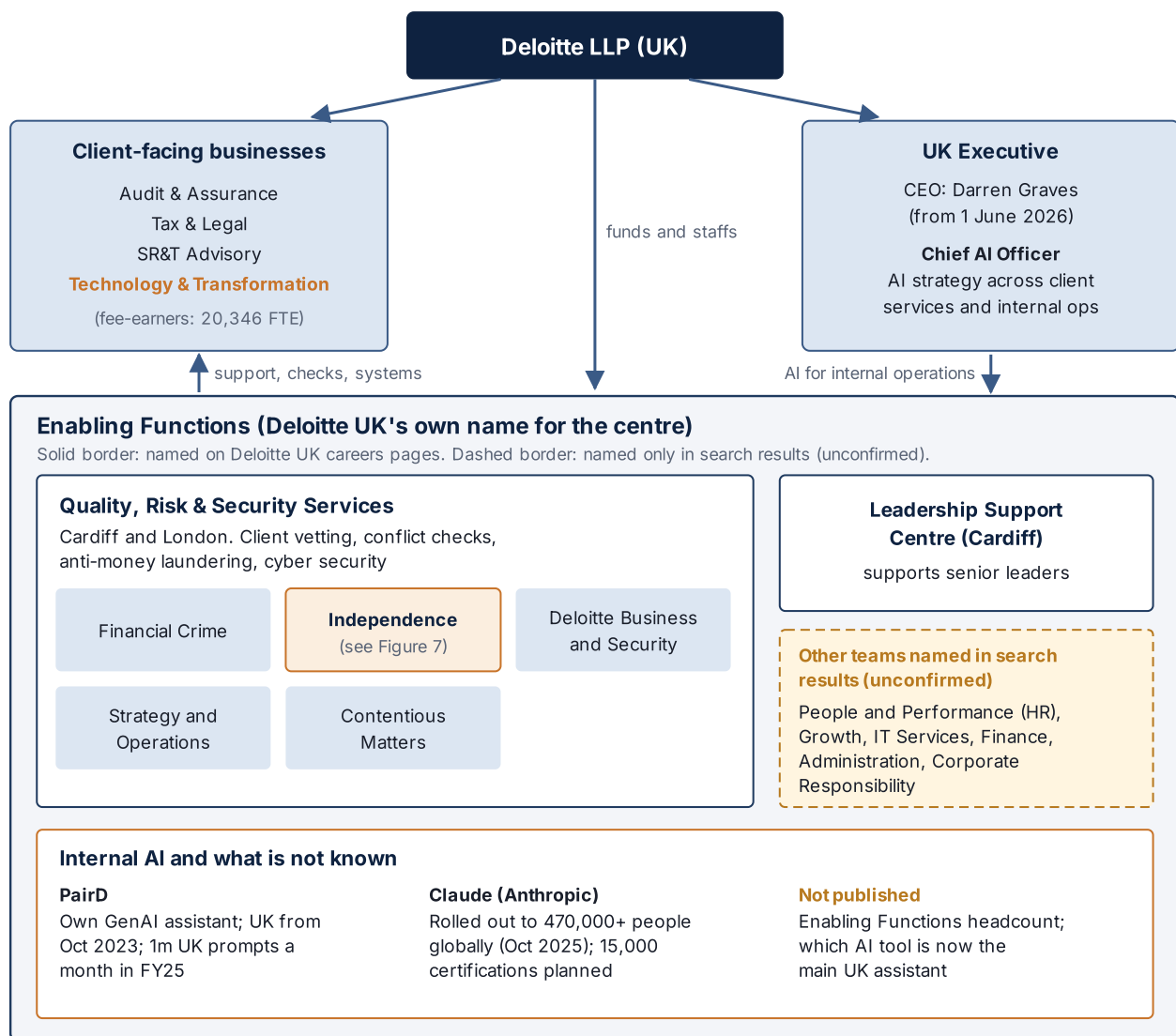
Enabling Functions

Deloitte UK calls its internal support business "Enabling Functions". Its own line: "In Enabling Functions we support our colleagues to do that well, so the firm can continue to make a positive impact" [S330] **CONFIRMED**. Two early-careers routes are named on Deloitte's pages. The Leadership Support Centre in Cardiff supports senior leaders. Quality, Risk & Security Services (Cardiff and London) covers client vetting, conflict checks, anti-money laundering and cyber security, with sub-teams for Financial Crime, Independence, Deloitte Business and Security, Strategy and Operations, and Contentious Matters [S330] **CONFIRMED**. Search results also name People and Performance (HR), Growth, IT Services, Finance, Administration and Corporate Responsibility, with Cardiff described as the centre for centralised business operations [S331] **REPORTED** (snippet only). No headcount for Enabling Functions was found.

INFERRED The Independence team is where the rules in Figure 7 are enforced day to day. Before T&T can start work, Quality, Risk & Security checks whether the client is an audit client and whether there is a conflict. The friction point of the multidisciplinary model has been turned into a job.

Internal AI

- **PairD.** Deloitte's own generative AI assistant, built by its AI Institute, rolled out in the UK from October 2023 and to 75,000 people across Europe and the Middle East by January 2024 [S328] **CONFIRMED**. Staff had to complete training and were warned output may be inaccurate [S328]. UK staff were sending it 1 million prompts a month in FY25 [S85] **CONFIRMED**, and new graduates were introduced to it at induction in 2025 [S232] **CONFIRMED**.
- **Claude.** Made available to more than 470,000 Deloitte people globally from October 2025, with 15,000 certifications planned [S325] [S326] **CONFIRMED**.
- **Zora AI.** A set of AI agents sold to clients on subscription, launched March 2025. Deloitte said it would use Zora AI for Finance internally for expenses, targeting 25% lower costs and 40% higher productivity [S327] **REPORTED** (targets, not outcomes).
- **Governance.** From 1 June 2026, Hayley McKelvey joined the UK Executive as Chief AI Officer, "responsible for driving the firm's AI strategy across client services and internal operations" [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Deloitte US's equivalent assistant, Sidekick, reports "about two hours saved per user each week" [S329], but that is a US tool, not established in the UK.

Figure 12 The centre as Deloitte UK describes it: Enabling Functions

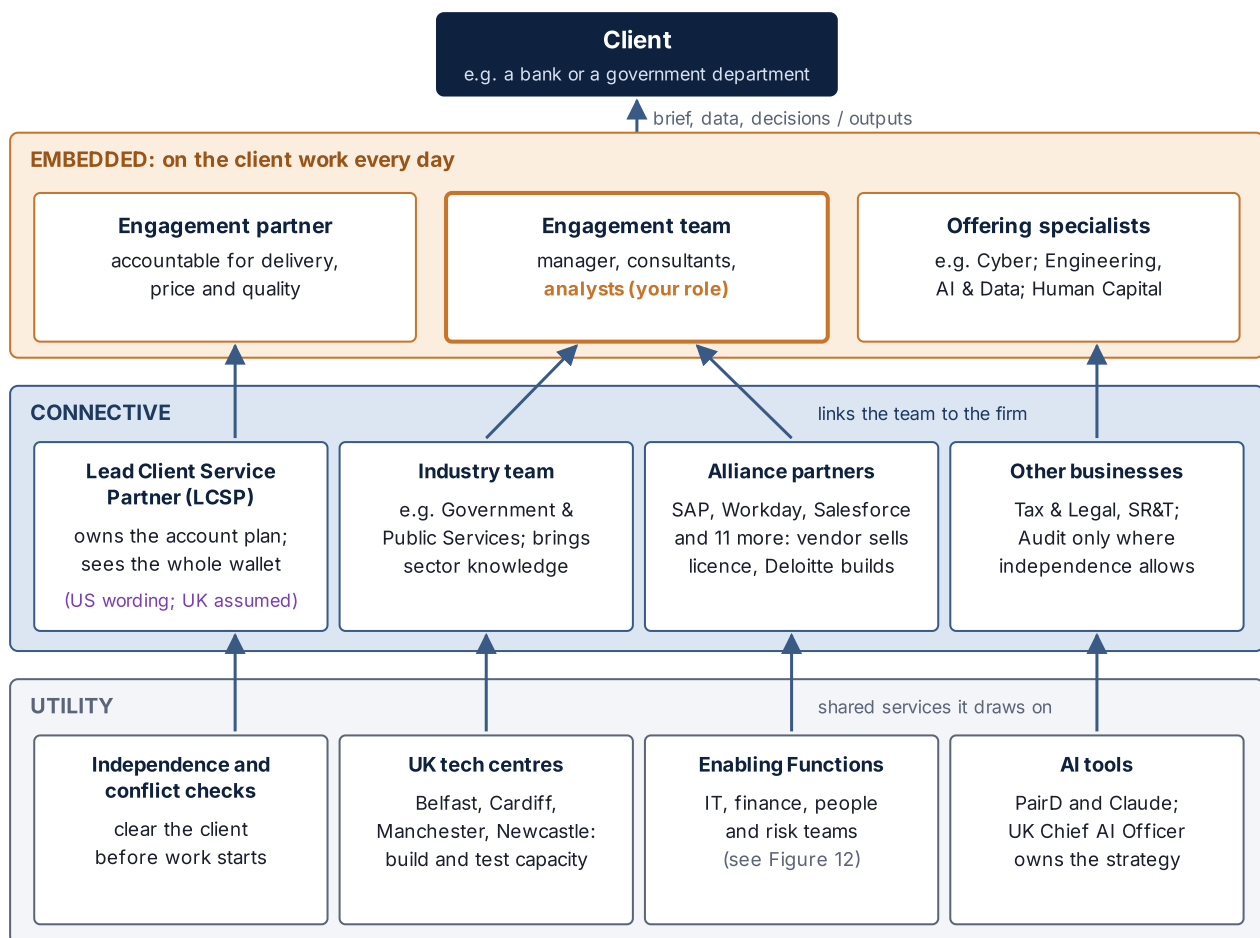
Source: [S330] Deloitte UK Early careers: Enabling Functions; [S331] search snippet of Deloitte UK professional opportunities page (unconfirmed); [S407] Deloitte UK FY26 results (30 Sep 2026); [S93] Deloitte LLP financial statements 2026 (fee-earner FTE); [S328] Consultancy.uk on PairD (Jan 2024); [S85] Deloitte UK FY25 results; [S325] Anthropic (Oct 2025). The arrows are a simplified reading of how the centre serves the businesses **INFERRED**. Read: the client-facing businesses sit on a support machine whose most consulting-relevant part is the Independence team.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"What struck me is that the UK made AI an executive job this year: a Chief AI Officer covering both client work and internal operations. Staff were already sending PairD a million prompts a month, and Claude went to 470,000 people globally. I'd like to understand how that changes an analyst's first year, and what checks sit around AI-assisted deliverables after the Australian report."

Putting it together: how a client team is wired into the firm

Figure 13 pulls the pieces into one picture of where a graduate actually sits. There are three kinds of role around every engagement. **Embedded** roles do the client work every day. **Connective** roles link the team to the rest of the firm and to vendors. **Utility** roles are shared services the team draws on without thinking about them, until something goes wrong (the pack's own framing) **INFERRED**.

Figure 13 How a client team is wired into the firm: embedded, connective and utility roles

Arrows show support flowing towards the client work. Wiring is inferred from public sources; Deloitte does not publish an engagement model. USI (Deloitte US's India delivery arm) is not shown: its role on UK work is not established.

Source: [S322] Deloitte US LCSP profiles and postings (US firm); [S301] Global Impact Report (industries); [S320] Deloitte UK T&T careers page (offerings); [S319] Deloitte UK alliances (14 partners); [S323] Consultancy.uk on UK technology centres (May 2025); [S330] Enabling Functions; [S94] Audit Transparency Report 2025 (conflict checks); [S407] Chief AI Officer (Sep 2026). The three-layer framing is the pack's own **INFERRED**. Read: the analyst sits in the middle of the top band; everything below exists to clear, staff, equip and connect that team.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"As I understand it, collaboration at Deloitte is organised around the client: a lead client partner sees the whole relationship and pulls in specialists from other offerings, and the alliances with platforms like SAP and Workday supply the technology. The limit is independence. At audit clients most of that is off the table, so the integrated model really shows up at non-audit and public sector clients."

DON'T SAY THIS

"Deloitte's culture is really collaborative." Everyone says it and it tells the interviewer nothing. Name the mechanism instead: the offering-by-industry matrix, the LCSP, alliances, and the conflict check that decides where collaboration is even allowed [S301] [S94].

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Prompt: "Will AI break the consulting pyramid?"

It will: UK fee-earning staff fell 5% in FY26 while revenue rose 2% and profit 14% [S93] [S407]; the firm offered voluntary redundancy in audit because too few people were leaving [S407]; T&T was the slowest-growing business globally at 2.5% [S300].

It won't, yet: Deloitte still hired 1,950+ graduates, apprentices and interns in FY26 [S407]; the UK CEO's line is that "the role our people play will matter more, not less" [S407]; large ERP and cyber programmes still need many people.

Suggested stance: "The base of the pyramid gets narrower and the work at the base changes from producing to checking and judging. That is why I'd want a firm that trains people on the tools early."

PART 4

How Deloitte stands out, and what only it can claim

Deloitte against nine rivals on size, shape and design choices; the handful of things only Deloitte can honestly claim; and, just as useful in an interview, where it does not lead.

The field at a glance

Deloitte competes with three kinds of firm. The other **Big Four** (PwC, EY, KPMG) have the same shape: audit plus tax plus consulting, owned by partners. **Listed technology services firms** (Accenture, IBM Consulting, Capgemini) have no audit and are owned by shareholders. **Strategy houses** (McKinsey, BCG, Bain) are partner-owned, much smaller and focused on advice. Each latest year is different, because the firms' financial years end in different months. Read the "period" column before comparing.

Firm	Ownership	Latest global revenue (period)	Consulting revenue, if disclosed	Global people	UK figure	Model
Deloitte	Network of partnerships under DTTL	US\$74.5bn, FY to 31 May 2026; +3.8% LC [S120]	FY25: US\$43.7bn (SR&T + T&T) [S81]	Nearly 500,000 [S120]	£5.81bn UK and Switzerland FY26; UK alone £5,014m [S407] [S88]	Audit-anchored multidisciplinary
PwC	Partnership network	US\$56.9bn, FY to 30 Jun 2025; +2.7% LC [S126]	Advisory US\$24.3bn [S126]	364,000 [S126]	PwC UK £4.365bn FY26; UK group incl. Middle East £6.155bn [S138]	Audit-anchored multidisciplinary
EY	Partnership network	US\$53.2bn, FY to Jun 2025; +4.0% LC [S127]	Consulting US\$16.4bn; EY-Parthenon US\$6.2bn [S127]	~406,000 [S127]	£3.78bn FY25; UK consulting -6% [S139]	Audit-anchored multidisciplinary
KPMG	Partnership network	US\$39.8bn, FY to 30 Sep 2025; +5.1% LC [S128]	Not given in US\$; Advisory +2.9% [S128]	276,030 [S128]	UK/Swiss £3.6bn FY25; Advisory -3% [S140]	Audit-anchored multidisciplinary
Accenture	Listed (NYSE)	US\$74.18bn, FY to 31 Aug 2026; +5% LC [S129]	Consulting US\$36.88bn; managed services US\$37.30bn [S129]	~814,000 [S129]	Not found	Listed tech services and consulting
IBM Consulting	Segment of listed IBM	US\$21.055bn, CY2025; +0.4% cc [S131]	All of it	Not disclosed separately	Not found	Tech company's consulting arm
Capgemini	Listed (Euronext Paris)	€22.465bn, CY2025; +3.4% cc [S132]	Not split	423,400, 66% offshore [S132]	Not found	Listed tech services
McKinsey	Private partnership	Not published; Bloomberg: "around \$15 billion to \$16 billion" [S135]	All of it	~40,000 [S135]	Not found	Strategy, moving into implementation
BCG	Private partnership	US\$14.4bn, CY2025; +7% [S133]	All of it; "over 40%" AI and tech [S133]	33,500 [S133]	Not found	Strategy, tech-heavy

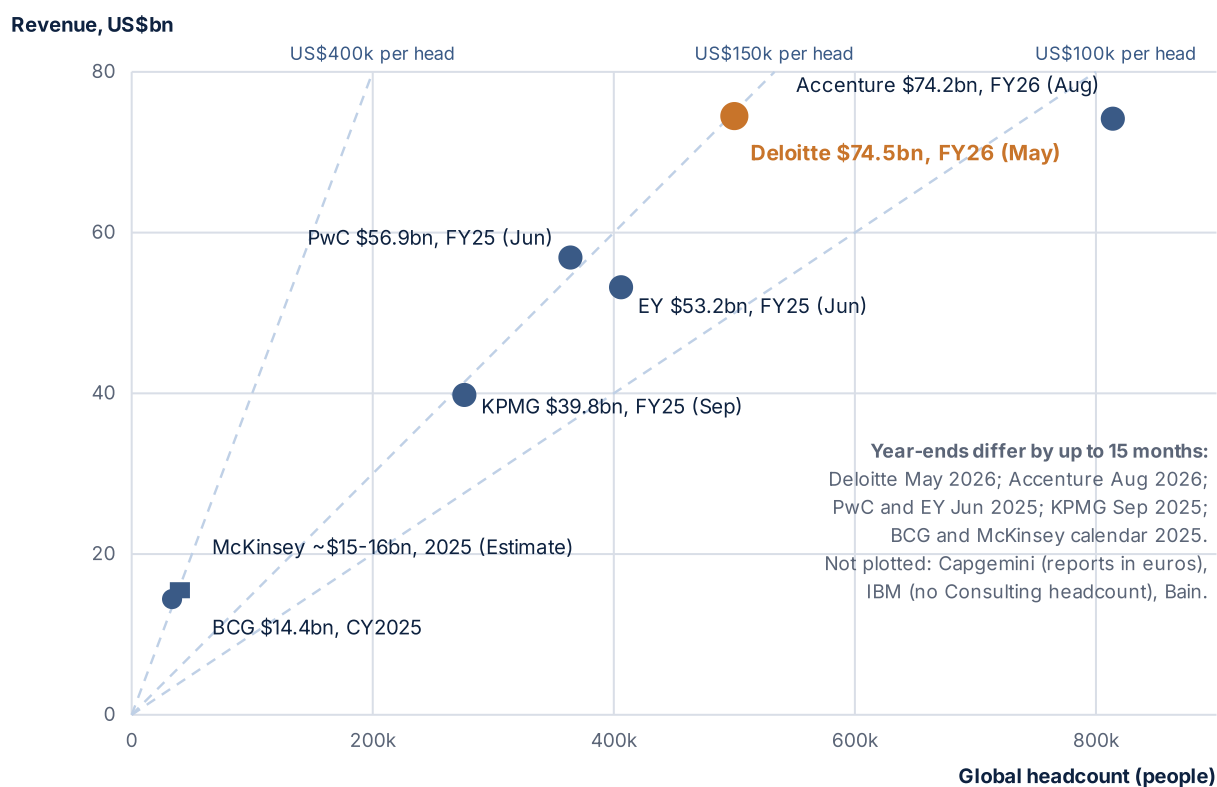
Firm	Ownership	Latest global revenue (period)	Consulting revenue, if disclosed	Global people	UK figure	Model
Bain	Private partnership	Not published	All of it	Not verified	Not found	Strategy; 67 cities in 40 countries [S406]

Table compiled 4 October 2026. LC = local currency; cc = constant currency (both strip out exchange-rate moves). PwC and EY FY26 global results had not been found as of that date, so their FY25 figures are used [S126] [S127]. UK figures have different scopes: Deloitte's headline includes Switzerland, KPMG's includes Switzerland, PwC's group includes the Middle East.

KEY TERM

Managed services (Deloitte calls its version "Operate"): running part of a client's operations or technology for years at a time, for a recurring fee, rather than doing a project and leaving. It brings steadier revenue. Half of Accenture's revenue is managed services [S129]; Deloitte's FY26 release named Operate as an area of "significant growth" without giving a number [S120] **CONFIRMED**.

Figure 9 Size against staffing: revenue and headcount, latest year



Source: [S120] Deloitte FY26 global release (Sep 2026); [S129] Accenture FY26 results (1 Oct 2026); [S126] PwC FY25 (Oct 2025); [S127] EY FY25 (Oct 2025); [S128] KPMG FY25 (Dec 2025); [S133] BCG (Apr 2026); [S135] McKinsey estimate via Bloomberg summary (Dec 2025), plotted at US\$15.5bn with a bar for the range. Deloitte headcount plotted at 500,000 ("nearly 500,000"). Dashed revenue-per-head lines are the pack's own arithmetic **INFERRED**. Read: Deloitte and Accenture earn the same, but Accenture needs about 300,000 more people; the strategy houses sit far up the steep line.

Six design choices, and where each firm sits

Size is the least interesting difference. The more useful comparison is design: six choices each firm has made, and what each choice costs. Figure 8 places each firm on each choice. Positions on five axes are

approximate judgements from the evidence in this Part; axis 4 is calculated.

1. Audit inside the firm, or independent of audit?

The Big Four keep audit. That gives them a trust brand and board-level access, and costs them most consulting at their own audit clients (Part 3, Figure 7). Everyone else is free of that limit. EY's failed split [S141] and KPMG's new US law firm, which may not serve KPMG audit clients [S142], show how much the constraint bites. A newer UK challenger, Unity Advisory, launched in April 2025 with up to US\$300m from Warburg Pincus and no audit at all; its co-founder Steve Varley pitches a firm that "crucially, has no conflicts" [S167] **CONFIRMED**.

2. Strategy to operations, or specialism?

Deloitte spans strategy (Monitor Deloitte, bought in 2013 [S134]), technology delivery (T&T), risk, deals, tax, audit and Operate [S120]. Accenture spans strategy to managed services, without audit or tax [S129]. Strategy houses are narrower, though BCG now earns over 40% of revenue from AI and tech-focused work [S133].

3. Partnership or listed company?

Partnerships fund investment from partners' profits and can take a long view. Listed firms raise capital easily but answer to shareholders every quarter: Accenture returned a record US\$11.5bn to shareholders in FY26 [S129] **CONFIRMED**. Private equity is a middle path in the mid-tier: New Mountain Capital took about 60% of Grant Thornton US's non-audit business in 2024 [S144] and Cinven bought into Grant Thornton UK in 2025 [S145] **REPORTED**. None of the Big Four has done this.

4. Pyramid shape

Revenue per head is a rough measure of the pyramid. Low revenue per head means big delivery teams and heavy offshore use; high means small teams of expensive experts. By the pack's arithmetic: BCG about US\$430k, McKinsey about US\$375-400k, PwC about US\$156k, Deloitte about US\$149k, KPMG about US\$144k, EY about US\$131k, Accenture about US\$91k, Capgemini about €53k **INFERRED** (from [S120] [S126] [S127] [S128] [S129] [S132] [S133] [S135]).

5. Alliance-led or vendor-neutral?

Deloitte and Accenture are built around platform alliances; Deloitte US cites "over 36,000 SAP-focused professionals" [S146] **CONFIRMED**. Strategy houses were traditionally neutral, though Bain now describes "a vibrant ecosystem of technology partners" [S406].

6. Time-and-materials or managed services?

Accenture is half managed services and reports bookings (signed future work) [S129]. Deloitte is mostly project work with Operate growing [S120]. Strategy houses are mostly project fees.

Figure 8 The competitive spectrum: six design axes and where each firm sits**1. Is audit inside the firm?**

positions approximate [Inferred]



Trade-off: audit brings trust and board access; independence rules bar most consulting to audit clients.

2. How wide is the service range?

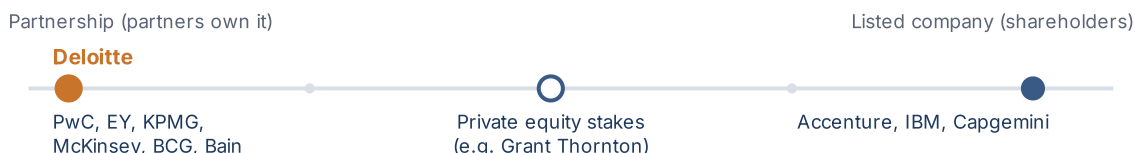
positions approximate [Inferred]



Trade-off: breadth lets one firm diagnose and deliver; specialists go deeper and earn more per person.

3. Who owns the firm?

positions approximate [Inferred]



Trade-off: partners fund investment from profit and take a long view; listed firms raise capital but face quarterly pressure.

4. Pyramid shape: revenue per person (US\$k)

calculated, latest years [Inferred]



Trade-off: low revenue per head means large teams and offshore staff; high means small, expensive expert teams.

5. Tied to technology vendors?

positions approximate [Inferred]



Trade-off: alliances bring certified scale and vendor-sourced deals; neutrality makes advice look independent. Not assessed: PwC, EY, KPMG, Capgemini

6. How is work sold?

positions approximate [Inferred]



Trade-off: projects are flexible and easy to start or stop; managed services lock in years of revenue and show up as bookings. Deloitte's "Operate" is growing, but Deloitte does not report bookings.

Copper = Deloitte. Hollow dot = not a named firm in this comparison. Positions on axes 1-3, 5 and 6 are judgements on a 1-5 scale.

Source: positions are the pack's judgement **INFERRED** , built on **[S120]** Deloitte FY26; **[S126]** PwC; **[S127]** EY; **[S128]** KPMG; **[S129]** Accenture FY26 (Oct 2026); **[S131]** IBM; **[S132]** Capgemini; **[S133]** BCG; **[S135]** McKinsey; **[S144]** **[S145]** Grant Thornton; **[S146]** Deloitte US alliances; **[S406]** Bain. Axis 4 is the pack's arithmetic from revenue and headcount in different years **INFERRED** . Read: Deloitte sits at the "everything, owned by partners, tied to vendors" end of four axes, and in the middle on shape and pricing.

What only Deloitte can claim

These are the claims that survive checking. Each comes with the evidence, the safe wording, and why it matters to you.

1. The largest of the Big Four by a wide margin, level with Accenture

Evidence: US\$74.5bn in FY26, against PwC US\$56.9bn, EY US\$53.2bn and KPMG US\$39.8bn (their latest years) [S120] [S126] [S127] [S128] **CONFIRMED**. Accenture reported US\$74.18bn for a year ending three months later [S129]. **Safe wording:** "the largest of the Big Four by a wide margin, and roughly level with Accenture as the largest professional services firm." **Why it matters:** scale funds investment such as the US\$3bn AI programme [S120] and gives graduates exposure to more sectors.

2. No. 1 in Gartner's consulting services market share, nine years running

Evidence: Deloitte's release says it is the "No. 1 consulting services provider by revenue" for "the ninth consecutive year and 14th time in total" [S125] **REPORTED** (Deloitte's own release; the Gartner report is paywalled). **Why it matters:** an outside analyst measures it, and it covers consulting only, not audit.

3. It kept consulting when the others sold theirs

Evidence: after Enron, EY sold its consulting arm to Cap Gemini (2000), KPMG Consulting floated as BearingPoint and PwC Consulting went to IBM (2002). Deloitte planned to spin off "Braxton" and abandoned the plan on 31 March 2003 [S104] **REPORTED**. **Safe wording:** "Deloitte did not complete its planned consulting spin-off, while EY, KPMG and PwC sold theirs." **Why it matters:** a twenty-year head start in running audit and consulting as one firm; consulting is now about 62% of global revenue [S81] **CONFIRMED**. The peer details rest on one contemporary report, and all three rivals have since rebuilt consulting arms.

4. Strategy through Operate, plus audit, under one brand

Evidence: Monitor Deloitte (strategy, acquired 2013) [S134], T&T and SR&T [S120], Operate [S120] and Audit & Assurance. Accenture has no audit; strategy houses have no audit or large-scale implementation; PwC, EY and KPMG have the same shape but smaller consulting businesses [S126] [S127] [S128]. **CONFIRMED** for each part; the "only one" claim is **INFERRED**. **Why it matters:** a graduate can see a problem from diagnosis to running the fix.

5. The largest single Big Four regional firm in Europe

Evidence: Deloitte EMEA: 16 firms, 132,000 people, 6,000 partners, €20bn, from 1 June 2026, with more than €1.5bn of planned extra investment [S124] **CONFIRMED**. KPMG's UK-Swiss combination is much smaller [S140]. Houston: "Deloitte EMEA uniquely strengthens our ability to invest at scale across borders" [S124]. ["Largest" and "first" are Inferred; verify before saying either.] **Why it matters:** a London graduate joins a firm that can staff and invest across 80+ countries.

6. The UK government's top consulting supplier five years running

Evidence: Tussell data: Deloitte top supplier of key consulting contracts for five years, £400m+ in fees, about four times the next firm [S335] **REPORTED**. A separate City AM analysis of Tussell data found £431m of UK government consultancy contracts to Deloitte in Labour's first year, ahead of PA Consulting (£310m) and KPMG (£301m) [S174] **REPORTED**. **Why it matters:** many T&T analysts start on public sector work, and some of it needs security clearance. It also means Deloitte is the first name critics reach for (Part 3).

7. The biggest enterprise AI rollout of its kind, at announcement

Evidence: Claude made available to more than 470,000 Deloitte people in October 2025, with 15,000 certifications [S325]; CNBC called it Anthropic's "biggest enterprise deployment ever" [S326] **CONFIRMED**.

Deloitte was also NVIDIA's Global Consulting Partner of the Year for the fifth year running [S300] **CONFIRMED**.

Why it matters: the tools you would use day to day, and the skills you could be certified in.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"Deloitte and Accenture are now almost exactly the same size, around US\$74bn. The difference is that half of Accenture is managed services, while Deloitte also has audit and tax. What draws me is the breadth: strategy, technology and the Operate side in one firm, with the portfolio holding steady when consulting dips."

DON'T SAY THIS

"Deloitte is the biggest consulting firm in the world on every measure." Accenture matches it on revenue, has about 300,000 more people and is far bigger in managed services [S129]. Gartner's ranking is by consulting revenue only [S125].

DON'T SAY THIS

"Deloitte is the only Big Four firm with a consulting business." PwC Advisory is US\$24.3bn and EY Consulting US\$16.4bn [S126] [S127]. The defensible point is historical: Deloitte did not complete its 2002-03 spin-off [S104].

DON'T SAY THIS

"Deloitte EMEA is the first firm of its kind." That is an inference, not something Deloitte or our sources state. Say "16 firms, 132,000 people, €20bn" and let the numbers do the work [S124].

Where Deloitte does not lead

Saying this plainly is a sign you have done the work. Interviewers trust candidates who know the weak spots.

- **Growth.** Deloitte grew 3.8% in local currency in FY26 [S120]. Accenture grew 5% [S129], BCG 7% [S133] and KPMG 5.1% in its FY25 [S128]. Deloitte's T&T grew only 2.5%, the slowest of its four businesses [S120] **CONFIRMED**.
- **UK consulting in FY25.** Deloitte UK T&T fell 10%, the worst of the Big Four UK consulting falls found: EY UK consulting -6% [S139], KPMG UK Advisory -3% [S140], PwC UK consulting -3% [S401] **REPORTED**.
- **Strategy prestige.** McKinsey, BCG and Bain own the top-strategy brand. BCG's revenue per head is nearly three times Deloitte's **INFERRED** (from [S120] [S133]).
- **Managed services scale and visibility.** Accenture's managed services alone are US\$37.3bn, and it reports bookings that show future work [S129]. Deloitte does not report bookings.
- **UK audit quality, 2026.** In the FRC's July 2026 inspections, KPMG scored 95% of audits good or needing only limited improvement, Deloitte 90%, EY 90% and PwC 89% [S137] **REPORTED** (one secondary outlet). Deloitte ties for second.
- **UK headline size.** Deloitte's £5.81bn includes Switzerland [S407]; PwC's UK group (with the Middle East) reported £6.155bn [S138]. On UK-only figures Deloitte (£5,014m) is bigger than PwC UK (£4.365bn), but the scopes differ [S88] [S138].
- **Reputation.** No rival had the Australian AI report [S316], though every Big Four firm has FRC fines; KPMG's five-year total was the largest [S110] **REPORTED**.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Prompt: "Why Deloitte and not Accenture?" (expect this if you mention technology).

Accenture's case: bigger technology and managed services business [S129], no audit independence limits, faster growth, and a published graduate salary of £35,190 plus a signing bonus on one listing [S402] **REPORTED**.

Deloitte's case: breadth beyond technology (tax, deals, risk, strategy) [S120]; a partnership that kept investing through a 10% consulting fall [S88]; UK onshore technology centres [S323]; the UK's top government consulting supplier [S335].

Suggested stance: "If I only wanted to build systems at scale, Accenture would be a fair choice. I want to see the business problem as well as the system, and Deloitte's mix of strategy, risk and technology in one partnership gives a graduate that view."

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Prompt: "Is the slow T&T growth a warning sign?"

Yes: global T&T grew 2.5%, slowest of the four [S120]; City AM framed it as "industry-wide pressure from artificial intelligence" [S222]; small UK firms are cutting consulting spend while paying AI companies [S239].

No: UK T&T grew 4%, the fastest UK business [S407]; MCA members forecast UK consulting growth of 5.7% for 2026 [S241]; clients are turning to consultants for AI transformation help [S240].

Suggested stance: "It is a signal that the work is changing, from big programmes measured in hours to AI-enabled delivery measured in outcomes. The firms that win will be the ones that change how they price."

PART 5

The industry from zero

What consulting sells, who buys it, how a firm turns a working day into profit, how big the market is, and the forces reshaping it. Read this before any of the opinion sections: every argument later in the pack rests on the mechanics here.

What consulting sells, and who buys it

A consultancy sells people's time and judgement to an organisation with a problem it cannot, or will not, solve alone. Strip away the branding and a client is buying one or more of five things **INFERRED** :

What the client buys	What it means in practice	Example
Expertise	Knowledge the client does not have in house.	How to move a bank's core systems to the cloud; how to meet a new regulation.
Capacity	Extra hands for a fixed period. The client may know what to do but lack the people. A lot of "consulting" spend is this.	Around 900 to 1,035 Deloitte consultants worked on Test and Trace at peak [S332][S333] REPORTED .
Independence	An outside view not tied to internal politics.	A CEO quoted in HBR: when unsure of the question, "I'm more tempted to use a big brand" [S160] CONFIRMED .
Legitimacy	A known firm's name helps a board or minister defend a decision.	"No. 1 consulting provider by revenue" is a ranking a buyer can cite [S125] REPORTED .
Implementation	Building and running the change: systems, processes, training. This is where most of the money now flows.	Source says global <i>technology</i> consulting will pass \$400bn in 2026 [S157] REPORTED .

Who signs the cheque. In large companies the buyer is usually a C-suite executive: the chief financial officer (CFO) for finance and cost work, the chief information or technology officer (CIO, CTO) for technology, the chief operating officer (COO) for operations **INFERRED** . Source Global Research, a consulting market analyst, says digital transformation projects "are most likely to be commissioned by CxOs, so companies are prepared to pay more for them" **[S157] REPORTED** . Banks and insurers buy heavily because regulation forces change on them (Part 6). The public sector (central government, the NHS, local government, defence) is the other big buyer. Old MCA data put financial services at about a third of UK fee income and the public sector at about a fifth, but that data set dates from around 2016 to 2018, so treat the shares as indicative only **[S159] REPORTED** .

KEY TERM

Engagement (or project): one piece of paid work for one client, with a start, an end and a contract.

SOW (statement of work): the contract document that sets out what will be delivered, by when, by whom and for how much. When a Deloitte analyst says "I'm on an engagement", this is what they mean.

The five kinds of firm, and how they differ

"Consulting" covers very different businesses. The useful split is by what each type mainly sells and to whom. The taxonomy below is an analyst's grouping **INFERRED**; the named examples come from the sources shown.

Type	UK examples	What they mainly sell	Typical buyer	Scale signal
Strategy houses ("MBB")	McKinsey, BCG, Bain	Board-level strategy, M&A strategy, more and more AI-led transformation	CEO, board, private equity funds	BCG: US\$14.4bn revenue, 33,500 people (2025) [S133] CONFIRMED
Big Four consulting arms	Deloitte, PwC, EY, KPMG	Strategy through to delivery: technology, finance, risk, regulation, people, operations. They also audit, which limits who they can advise.	CFO, CIO, COO, chief risk officer, government	Deloitte global US\$74.5bn (FY26), all businesses [S120] CONFIRMED
Tech and IT services firms	Accenture, IBM, Capgemini, Indian IT majors	Large technology builds, enterprise software, cloud, long-term managed services, offshore delivery	CIO, CTO	Accenture US\$74.18bn, half of it managed services (FY26) [S129] CONFIRMED
Mid-tier and boutiques	PA Consulting, Grant Thornton, BDO, Baringa; challengers Unity Advisory, Queen's Tower Advisory, Eden McCallum	Specialist or mid-market work; some pitch senior-heavy, AI-heavy or "no conflicts" teams	Mid-sized firms, PE-backed companies, public sector	PA won £310m of UK government consultancy contracts in Labour's first year [S174] REPORTED
In-house teams (and AI labs)	Corporate strategy units and "transformation offices" staffed by ex-consultants; OpenAI and Anthropic consulting ventures	The work clients used to buy from outside	n/a (they are the client)	OpenAI bought UK consultancy Tomoro AI, about 150 staff [S166] REPORTED

Size concentrates. In MCA data, large firms take 77% of UK consulting fee income, medium firms 20% and small firms 3% [\[S150\]](#) **REPORTED**. Deloitte sits at the intersection of two columns: it is a Big Four firm, and its Technology & Transformation business competes head-on with Accenture and IBM for technology delivery.

How consulting differs from its neighbours

Interviewers test whether you know what you are applying for. Many applicants blur consulting with audit, deal work or banking. The table below is the cleanest way to keep them apart. Definitions are general knowledge **INFERRED** except where a source is shown.

Business	What it delivers	How it is paid	Regulated by	Typical graduate task	Link to Deloitte consulting
Consulting	Advice and delivery of change: strategy, technology, operations, risk	Mostly time (day rates) or fixed fee; some outcome-linked fees	No licence or statutory regulator for consulting itself	Research, data analysis, slides, testing, workshop notes	This is the role.
Audit	A legally required opinion on whether financial statements give a "true and fair view"	Annual audit fee	FRC; the auditor must be independent	Testing transactions and controls	If Deloitte audits a company, Deloitte consulting is heavily restricted there [S180] CONFIRMED

Business	What it delivers	How it is paid	Regulated by	Typical graduate task	Link to Deloitte consulting
Tax	Compliance (filing returns) and tax advice	Fees by time or fixed	Professional bodies; tax law	Preparing computations, research	Separate business line (Tax & Legal, £1.36bn UK, FY26) [S407]
Deal advisory (transaction services)	Due diligence, valuation, restructuring around one transaction	Time-bound fees tied to the deal	Professional rules	Financial models, data rooms	Sits in Deloitte's SR&T business with strategy and risk
Investment banking	Raising capital; advising on mergers and acquisitions	Mostly success fees when a deal completes	FCA	Pitch books, valuation models	A neighbour, not a competitor for most consulting work
Private equity	Buys and owns companies with its own and investors' money	Management fees plus a share of investment gains	FCA (as fund managers)	Screening deals, modelling	A big <i>buyer</i> of consulting, and now an <i>owner</i> of rival firms (Grant Thornton UK) [S168] REPORTED

DON'T SAY THIS

"Consulting is basically like investment banking but for operations." The payment model is the giveaway: banks earn mainly when a deal completes; consultancies earn mainly for time or a defined deliverable, and the hard part is getting change to stick after the deal or decision.

How a consulting firm makes money

Every consulting firm runs on the same four levers. Learn them and the industry's news makes sense: AI, graduate cuts, offshore centres and outcome pricing all act on one or more of them.

KEY TERM

Day rate (rate card): the price per day the firm charges for one person of a given grade. A **rate card** is the list of rates by grade agreed with a client. Rates disclosed to Parliament for Deloitte's Test and Trace work averaged about £1,000 a day per person, with some senior consultants up to £6,624 a day [S332] **CONFIRMED**.

KEY TERM

Utilisation: the share of a person's available working time that is billed to clients. **Chargeable hours** are the hours actually billed. Juniors are expected to be highly chargeable; partners spend more time selling and managing [S93] **INFERRED**. Deloitte does not publish its utilisation targets.

KEY TERM

Leverage: how many staff work under each partner. More juniors per partner means each partner's profit share draws on more billed hours. At Deloitte UK in FY26 that was roughly 30 staff per equity partner and about 16.5 per partner of any kind (my arithmetic from 23,970 average FTE staff, 799 FTE equity partners and 1,453 partners) [S88][S93] **INFERRED**. **Realisation:** the share of the standard value of time that is actually billed and collected after discounts and write-offs [S93].

KEY TERM

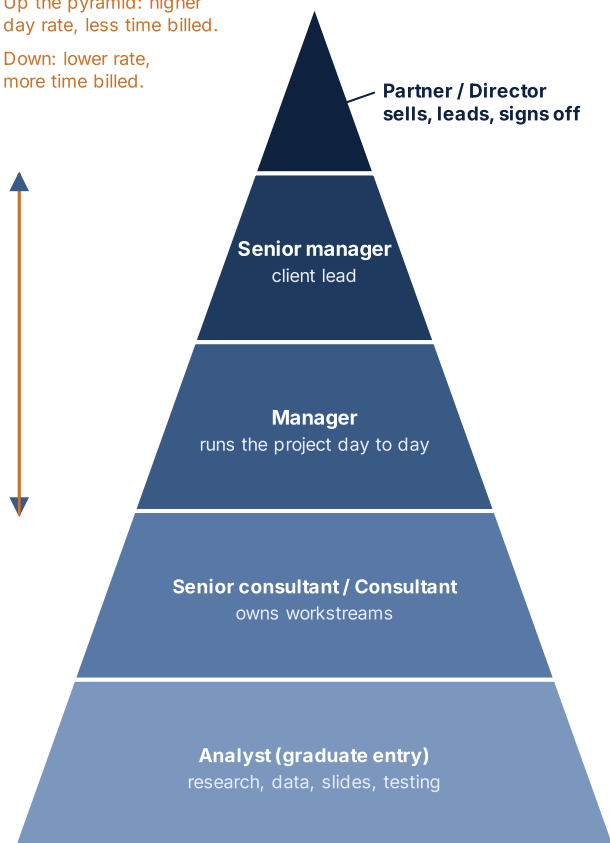
The pyramid: the staffing shape that leverage produces. A few partners and directors at the top; more managers; many consultants and analysts at the base. **Equity partner:** an owner of the partnership who shares the profit. Deloitte UK had 784 equity partners at year end FY26 [S407] **CONFIRMED**.

Put together, the arithmetic is simple. Revenue per person is billed days times day rate. Billed days are available days times utilisation. Leverage multiplies that across the team under each partner. What is left after pay, offices, technology and network fees is the profit pool that equity partners share. Deloitte's own accounts show that even fixed-fee work is tracked "via timesheet reporting" at charge-out rates [S93] **CONFIRMED**, so these levers still govern a project priced as a lump sum.

Figure 34 The consulting pyramid and how a day of work becomes revenue

THE PYRAMID (grades are typical, not Deloitte-published)

Up the pyramid: higher day rate, less time billed.
Down: lower rate, more time billed.



Deloitte UK FY26: about 30 staff per equity partner, about 16.5 per partner of any kind (Inferred from 23,970 FTE staff, 799 FTE equity partners, 1,453 partners).

HOW A DAY BECOMES REVENUE (ILLUSTRATIVE)

Available working days

about 220 a year (illustrative)

x Utilisation

75% of days billed (illustrative)

= Billed days

165 days

x Day rate

£1,000: the average Deloitte rate disclosed for Test and Trace, 2021

= Revenue per person

£165,000 a year (illustrative)

x Leverage

about 30 staff per equity partner (Deloitte UK, inferred)

= Fees behind each equity partner

less pay, offices, tech and network fees = the profit pool

Deloitte UK FY26 profit pool: £899m distributable, about £1.125m per equity partner.

Sources: day rate of about £1,000 is the average Deloitte rate disclosed for Test and Trace in 2021 [S332]; staff and partner counts from Deloitte UK FY26 metrics and accounts [S88][S93] (Sep 2026); distributable profit and profit per equity partner [S407] (30 Sep 2026). Available days (220) and utilisation (75%) are ILLUSTRATIVE, not Deloitte figures: Deloitte does not publish utilisation [S93]. Grade names are typical Big Four titles, not taken from a Deloitte grade list. Read: left, who does the work; right, how each person's days multiply into the profit pool.

Two live numbers show the levers at work. Deloitte UK's average fee-earning staff fell about 5% (21,471 to 20,346 FTE) in FY26 while revenue rose 2% and distributable profit rose 14% to £899m [S93][S407]

CONFIRMED . More revenue from fewer fee-earners is leverage and productivity moving in partners' favour

INFERRED . That is also exactly why AI is such a sensitive topic: it acts on the base of the pyramid.

Core vocabulary in one place

Bench: consultants not currently on a client project. Long bench time hurts utilisation.

Pitch / RFP: the competitive bid to win work. RFP means "request for proposal", the buyer's formal invitation to bid.

Framework agreement: a pre-approved list of suppliers a buyer (often government) can call work off without a full tender each time.

Example: the UK government's Management Consultancy Framework Four (MCF4), with 219 suppliers across 10 lots **[S117]** **CONFIRMED** .

Managed services: the consultancy runs a process or system for the client for years. Revenue recurs. Deloitte calls its offer "Operate" **[S120]**.

Time and materials (T&M): the client pays for days worked. **Fixed fee:** one price for a defined deliverable. **Outcome-based (risk and reward):** some fee depends on results. MCF4 allows all three **[S117]** **CONFIRMED** .

Offshore / nearshore delivery: doing work in lower-cost locations (India, Malaysia, the Philippines are named in reporting on the Big Four) or nearby cheaper countries **[S162]**

REPORTED . **Onshore regional centres:** lower-cost UK cities. Deloitte opened centres in Belfast, Cardiff, Manchester and Newcastle from June 2025 **[S254]** **CONFIRMED** .

Alliance partners: software vendors (SAP, Salesforce, ServiceNow, Workday, AWS and others) whose products the consultancy implements. Deloitte UK lists 14 **[S319]** **CONFIRMED** .

Systems integrator (SI): a firm that makes several software products work together inside a client. **ERP** (enterprise resource planning): core finance, HR and supply chain software such as SAP S/4HANA. Big, long and risky projects.

PMO (programme management office): the team that runs plans, governance and reporting on a large programme. **TOM** (target operating model): a design of how an organisation should work in future. **Change management:** helping people actually adopt the new way of working.

How big is the market?

Two respected bodies measure the UK market and get very different answers. Neither is wrong. They count different things.

£21.8bn

UK consulting fee income 2025, +3% (MCA / Oxford Economics, July 2026) **[S150][S151]**

£14.9bn

UK market 2024 on Source Global Research's narrower definition **[S154]**

\$275bn

Global consulting market 2025, +6% (Source, "big consulting") **[S156]**

>\$400bn

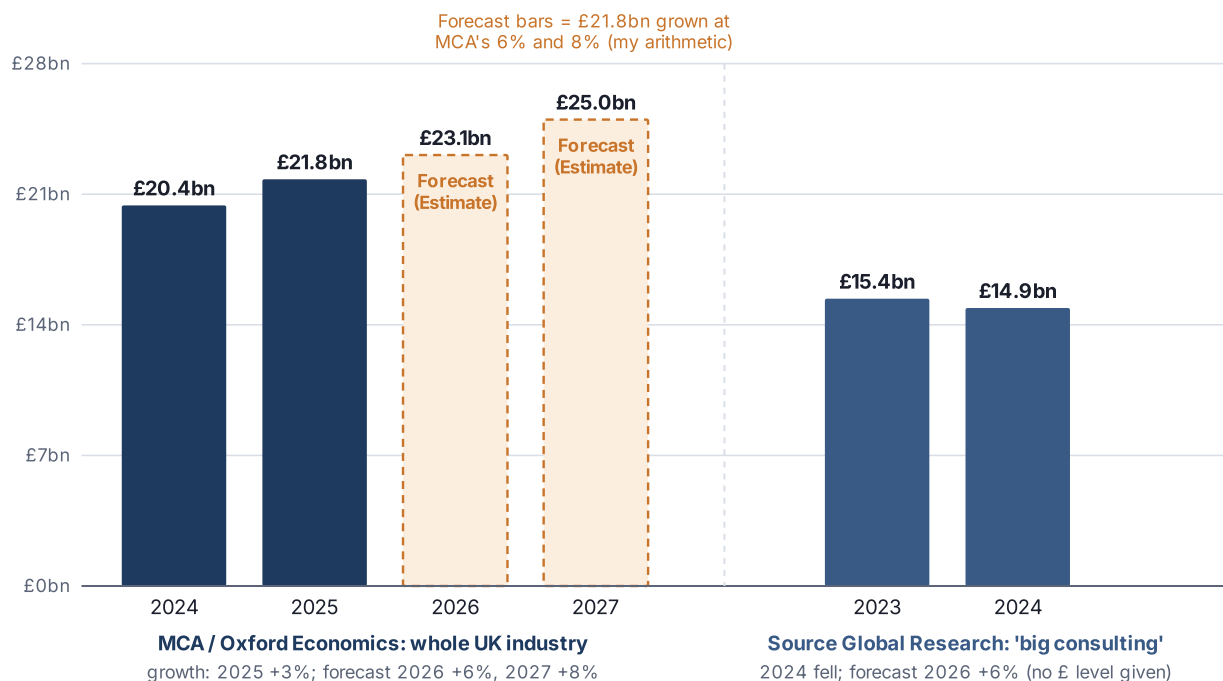
Global technology consulting, 2026 forecast, broader definition (Source) **[S157]**

MCA. The Management Consultancies Association, the UK trade body, publishes an annual report with Oxford Economics. It estimates the whole UK industry. Fee income rose 3% to £21.8bn in 2025; MCA members alone earned £10.9bn; exports rose 9% and are now 31% of fee income **[S150][S151]** **CONFIRMED** . The headline hides a split: 52% of firms grew and 46% shrank. The report says the 3% "masks a mixed performance across the sector" **[S151]** **REPORTED** . Forecasts have been cut again and again: 2026 growth was predicted at 8.7% (January 2025), then 7.8% (mid-2025), then 5.7% (early 2026); the July 2026 report says 6% for 2026 and 8% for 2027 **[S154][S150]** **REPORTED** .

Source Global Research. Source counts only "big consulting": firms with 50 or more consultants, and it excludes outsourcing and managed services [S157] **REPORTED**. On that basis the UK market was £14.9bn in 2024, down from £15.4bn [S154][S241] **REPORTED**. Source forecasts 6% UK growth in 2026 from a survey of 200 senior UK buyers. Its head of market trends, Nick Jotischky: "There's a cautious optimism that there's going to be growth in the market" [S155] **CONFIRMED**.

Global. Source sized global consulting at \$275bn in 2025, 6% growth after "a disappointing 2024". Cybersecurity was the fastest-growing service at about 9% (about \$36bn); technology and innovation was \$69.2bn (+5%); strategy just over \$60bn (+6%); risk and financial management \$58.7bn (+7%) [S156] **REPORTED**. Its separate \$400bn+ figure for technology consulting uses a broader definition. Do not add the two together [S157].

Figure 35 UK consulting market size and growth: MCA and Source measure different things



Sources: MCA / Oxford Economics 2024 £20.4bn [S152][S153] (Jul 2025); 2025 £21.8bn, forecasts +6% (2026) and +8% (2027) [S150] [S151] (Jul 2026); Source Global Research 2024 £14.9bn [S154], 2023 £15.4bn [S241] (search summary), 2026 forecast +6% [S155] (Feb 2026). Forecast bars are Estimates: the author applied MCA's forecast growth rates to £21.8bn; MCA did not publish these £ levels. Source counts only firms with 50+ consultants and excludes outsourcing and managed services [S157]. The 2024 MCA bar is the earlier estimate and was probably revised (see box below). Read: compare bars within a group, never across groups.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

The MCA's 2025 report gave £20.4bn for 2024 [S152][S153]. The 2026 report says 2025 grew 3% to £21.8bn [S150]. £21.8bn is about 7% above £20.4bn, so the 2024 base was probably revised upward to around £21.2bn **INFERRED**. If you quote growth, quote the MCA's own 3%, not a figure computed across the two reports.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"The UK market is roughly £22bn on the MCA's measure and grew only 3% last year, with nearly half of firms shrinking. The forecast recovery, 6% then 8%, depends on clients moving from planning to implementation. That suits a firm that can deliver, not only advise."

The forces reshaping the industry now

Eight forces are pushing on the consulting model at once. Figure 24 maps each force to what it changes and who gains or loses. The text below gives the numbers.

1. Generative and agentic AI, and the pyramid

If AI drafts research, slides and code, firms need fewer analysts at the base. A recruiter told City AM: "The Big Four are looking at AI very seriously to replicate junior work more cost-effectively" [S162] **REPORTED**. A summary of a May 2026 FT Big Read (paywalled, not read) quotes KPMG UK's advisory head Lisa Fernihough: "I want this organisation, us, to still exist ... That's how disruptive I believe AI will be" [S164] **REPORTED**. Mark Bunker, formerly of Deloitte, who founded Queen's Tower Advisory, reportedly targets teams that are "20 per cent humans, 80 per cent AI agents" [S164] **REPORTED**. **Agentic AI** means AI systems that take actions (book, file, update records) rather than only answer questions. Deloitte's own Tech Trends 2026 says only 11% of organisations have such systems in production [S244] **CONFIRMED**.

2. Pricing moves from days to outcomes

McKinsey is reported to link about a quarter to a third of fees to outcomes; sources disagree on the figure [S163][S164] **REPORTED**. In 2013 a partner quoted in HBR expected value-based pricing to go "from the high single digits to a third of the business within 20 years" [S160] **CONFIRMED**. A commentator writing in January 2026 called the shift "sluggish" [S163] **REPORTED**.

3. Graduate intake cuts and low attrition

Reported UK graduate intakes fell at all of the Big Four between 2023 and 2024: KPMG 1,399 to 942 (-29%), Deloitte about 1,700 to 1,400 (-18%), EY -11%, PwC -6% [S162][S143] **REPORTED**. Graduate accountancy adverts fell 44% year on year [S162] **REPORTED**. **Attrition** is the share of staff who leave each year. Big Four firms rely on it to make room for promotions. When fewer leave, firms pay people to go: Deloitte offered voluntary redundancy to up to about 175 audit staff in June 2026, citing "low rates of attrition" [S227] **CONFIRMED**. The wider market is mixed: MCA members raised graduate hiring 10% in 2025 [S150] **REPORTED**.

4. New entrants

OpenAI and Anthropic launched consulting ventures in May 2026, and OpenAI bought UK consultancy Tomoro AI (about 150 staff, clients including Tesco and Virgin Atlantic). An industry insider called it "definitely a direct play against the traditional consulting firms" [S166] **REPORTED**. Unity Advisory launched in April 2025 with up to \$300m from private equity firm Warburg Pincus, led by ex-EY UK chair Steve Varley. It offers no audit, so it has no audit conflicts [S167] **CONFIRMED**.

5. Private equity enters professional services

Private equity (PE) firms buy companies with investors' money and sell them later. Cinven completed a buyout of Grant Thornton UK in 2025, reportedly valuing it around £1.5bn; the average partner payout was reported at £682,000 [S168] **REPORTED**. In the US, New Mountain Capital took about 60% of Grant Thornton's non-audit business in 2024 [S144] **REPORTED**. None of the Big Four has taken outside capital [S144][S120] **INFERRED**.

6. UK government spend controls

In October 2023 Rachel Reeves, then shadow Chancellor, said Labour "will aim to cut consultancy spending in half over the next parliament" [S176] **CONFIRMED**. In government the target became: stop non-essential consultancy, halve it in 2025-26, save £550m in 2024-25 rising to £700m a year by 2028-29 [S173][S177] **CONFIRMED**. The data conflict sharply; Part 6 sets them side by side. Deloitte matters here because it was the

largest UK government consultancy supplier by contract value in Labour's first year, at £431m [S174]

REPORTED .

7. The US DOGE cuts

In 2025 the US Department of Government Efficiency (DOGE) drive cancelled federal contracts. The Pentagon cancelled \$5.1bn of contracts in April 2025 (claimed savings \$4bn), naming Accenture, Booz Allen Hamilton and Deloitte [S169] CONFIRMED . Fortune reported more than 120 Deloitte contracts eliminated, more than twice any other consultancy [S170] REPORTED . This hit Deloitte's US firm, a legally separate member firm from Deloitte UK, but it shows the risk of depending on government buyers INFERRED .

8. AI quality failure: Deloitte Australia

In October 2025 Deloitte Australia agreed to partially refund the A\$440,000 paid for a 237-page government report that contained a fabricated court quote and references to non-existent papers. The revised version disclosed use of "a generative AI large language model (Azure OpenAI GPT-4o)" [S316][S171] CONFIRMED . It happened in a separate member firm, yet the story ran worldwide under the Deloitte name [S316] INFERRED . It is the clearest public example of why human review of AI output is now part of the product.

Figure 24 The industry shift map: forces pushing on the consulting model

FORCE	WHAT IT CHANGES	WHO GAINS / WHO LOSES
Generative and agentic AI drafts research, slides, code	Fewer junior hours per project. The base of the pyramid narrows. Review and quality control matter more.	GAINS Firms with delivery depth and AI alliances; AI-native boutiques LOSES Hours-based junior work; size of graduate intakes
Shift to outcome pricing fees linked to results	Fees tied to results, not days worked. Delivery risk moves from the client to the consultancy.	GAINS Clients wanting cost certainty; firms with reusable assets LOSES Time-and-materials margins; firms that cannot measure outcomes
Graduate cuts, low attrition fewer leavers, fewer seats	Fewer entry seats and slower promotion. Firms pay people to leave (Deloitte audit voluntary redundancy).	GAINS Mid-sized firms still hiring (MCA members: graduate hiring up 10%) LOSES Big Four applicants; the future manager pipeline
New entrants AI labs and boutiques	OpenAI bought Tomoro AI. Unity Advisory and Queen's Tower pitch AI-led, conflict-free teams.	GAINS Clients: more choice and price pressure LOSES Big Four in mid-market and narrow AI work
Private equity capital outside money enters	Outside capital funds AI and pays out partners (Cinven bought Grant Thornton UK, about £1.5bn).	GAINS PE-backed mid-tier firms with money to invest LOSES Partnerships that fund investment from partners' profits
UK government spend controls halve consultancy spend	Departments must prove value for money. Ministerial sign-off on bigger deals. More published contract data.	GAINS Firms selling delivery and capability-building LOSES Advice-only work; suppliers heavy in central government
US DOGE cuts (2025) contracts cancelled	Pentagon cancelled \$5.1bn of contracts. Fortune: 120+ Deloitte US contracts eliminated.	GAINS Government budgets (claimed \$4bn savings) LOSES Deloitte US, Accenture, Booz Allen (about 2,500 layoffs)
AI quality failures Deloitte Australia, 2025	Partial refund on an A\$440,000 report with fabricated citations. Buyers ask how AI was used and checked.	GAINS Firms with strong review and AI governance LOSES Brand trust across the whole network

Read across each row: a force (left) changes how work is bought or staffed (middle), which moves value to some players and away from others (right).

Sources: AI and pyramid [S162] City AM (Jun 2025), [S164] Resultsense summary of FT (May 2026); pricing [S163] (Jan 2026), [S160] HBR (Oct 2013); graduates and attrition [S162], [S227] City AM (16 Jun 2026), [S150] MCA (Jul 2026); new entrants [S166] Telegraph (26 May 2026), [S167] Consultancy.uk (Apr 2025); PE [S168] (2025); government [S173] NAO (Nov 2025), [S176], [S174] City AM (Jul 2025); DOGE [S169] Nextgov (Apr 2025), [S170] Fortune (Apr 2025), [S206]; Deloitte Australia [S316] The Register (Oct 2025). Gains and losses are the author's analysis **INFERRED** . Read: each row is a cause-and-effect chain from force to winners and losers.

Where it goes in the next three to five years: five competing views

Serious people disagree. Know at least three positions and who holds them, then pick your own.

View	Who holds it	The argument
"Disruption comes slowly, then suddenly"	Christensen, Wang and van Bever, HBR, Oct 2013 [S160] CONFIRMED	Consulting moves from integrated "solution shops" to modular providers. Knowledge is "democratized". The story "will begin with smaller clients". "The steady invasion of hard analytics and technology (big data) is a certainty". Closing line: "there may be nothing as vulnerable as entrenched success". AI is the strongest version yet of the force they described INFERRED .
"AI breaks the pyramid and the scale advantage"	FT Big Read and City AM (May 2026, as summarised); The Telegraph (26 May 2026) [S164][S166] REPORTED	AI-native boutiques and AI labs take work. The Big Four's leverage model weakens. Graduate intakes fall. KPMG's Fernihough frames the threat as existential.
"Cautious recovery, driven by implementation"	Source Global Research; MCA [S155] [S150][S157]	"Clients are embarking on a year of implementation and execution, and that will often lead to a need for external support" (Nick Jotischky) [S155]. UK growth of about 6% in 2026 and 8% in 2027. 81% of tech buyers intend to rely more on external consultants [S157] REPORTED .
"Conflict-free, PE-funded, outcome-priced challengers win share"	Steve Varley, Unity Advisory [S167]; Cinven / Grant Thornton [S168]	"People are looking for a proposition that is super client-centric, has really low administrative cost, is AI-led rather than based on legacy infrastructure and, crucially, has no conflicts" [S167] CONFIRMED .
"The old pyramid persists"	Marin Ivezić, January 2026 (single commentator) [S163] REPORTED	Firms have spent billions on AI yet still staff and bill the traditional way. The move to outcome pricing is slow.

Deloitte's own line sits between the third and fifth views. UK CEO Darren Graves, in the FY26 results: "As AI makes intelligence increasingly abundant, the role our people play will matter more, not less" [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Global CEO Joe Ucuzoglu describes "a people-led, AI-powered approach that is grounded in trust" [S120] **CONFIRMED**.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Prompt: "Where will consulting be in five years?" Pick a side and give a mechanism.

Case for disruption: AI removes the junior hours that pay for the pyramid; AI labs and PE-backed challengers attack on price; SME card data already show consulting spend falling 1.9% while AI subscriptions rise [S239] **REPORTED**.

Case for resilience: clients' main AI barriers are data security (40%), skills (34%) and governance (28%), which are human and organisational problems [S240] **REPORTED**; MCA and Source both forecast growth [S150][S155].

Suggested stance: "I think demand for implementation grows while demand for junior analytical hours shrinks. The winners will be firms with delivery depth, trusted brands in regulated sectors and AI alliances, provided they change how they price and how they train juniors. So the pyramid becomes narrower at the base, not flat." Then name one fact: Deloitte UK grew profit 14% on 2% revenue growth while fee-earners fell about 5% [S407][S93].

PART 6

The role's own industry and its regulation

Consulting needs no licence. A Deloitte consultant is still boxed in by four sets of rules: audit independence, public procurement, data and AI law, and the financial-services rules that clients hire consultants to implement. This part gives each rule with its exact date, then the competitive map.

Why a lightly regulated industry still has rules that bite

Consulting itself has no statutory regulator and no licence to practise [Inferred from S180, S205]. Anyone can call themselves a management consultant. The voluntary standards come from the Management Consultancies Association (MCA), which runs the "Consulting Excellence" quality hallmark and the Chartered Management Consultant (ChMC) title, held by 2,800+ people in its 2026 report [S205][S150]

REPORTED

A consultant at Deloitte faces a different reality, for one reason: Deloitte also audits. Audit is tightly regulated, and the rules that protect auditor independence reach into what the consulting side may sell. Add the government's own buying rules, data and AI law, and the regulation that drives bank and insurer spending, and you have the rulebook that shapes a graduate's day-to-day work.

Rule set 1: auditor independence

KEY TERM

Auditor independence: the principle that an auditor must be, and be seen to be, free of interests that could bias its opinion. Selling large consulting projects to a company you audit creates a **self-review threat** (you would audit your own work) and a **financial interest** in keeping the client happy. **Public interest entity (PIE):** broadly, a company with securities listed on a regulated market, a bank or an insurer.

The EU Audit Regulation (applies from 17 June 2016)

Regulation (EU) No 537/2014 was adopted on 16 April 2014 and applied from **17 June 2016** [S182] **CONFIRMED**. It did three things that still matter [S182][S180] **CONFIRMED**:

- **A 70% fee cap.** Non-audit fees from a PIE audit client cannot exceed 70% of the average statutory audit fee over the previous three years.
- **A list of banned non-audit services** (Article 5).
- **Mandatory audit firm rotation** (Article 17): PIEs must change auditor after a set period.

The rules are retained in UK law after Brexit [Inferred; not separately verified]. The FRC's Revised Ethical Standard 2016 gave effect to them in the UK [S179][S180] **CONFIRMED**.

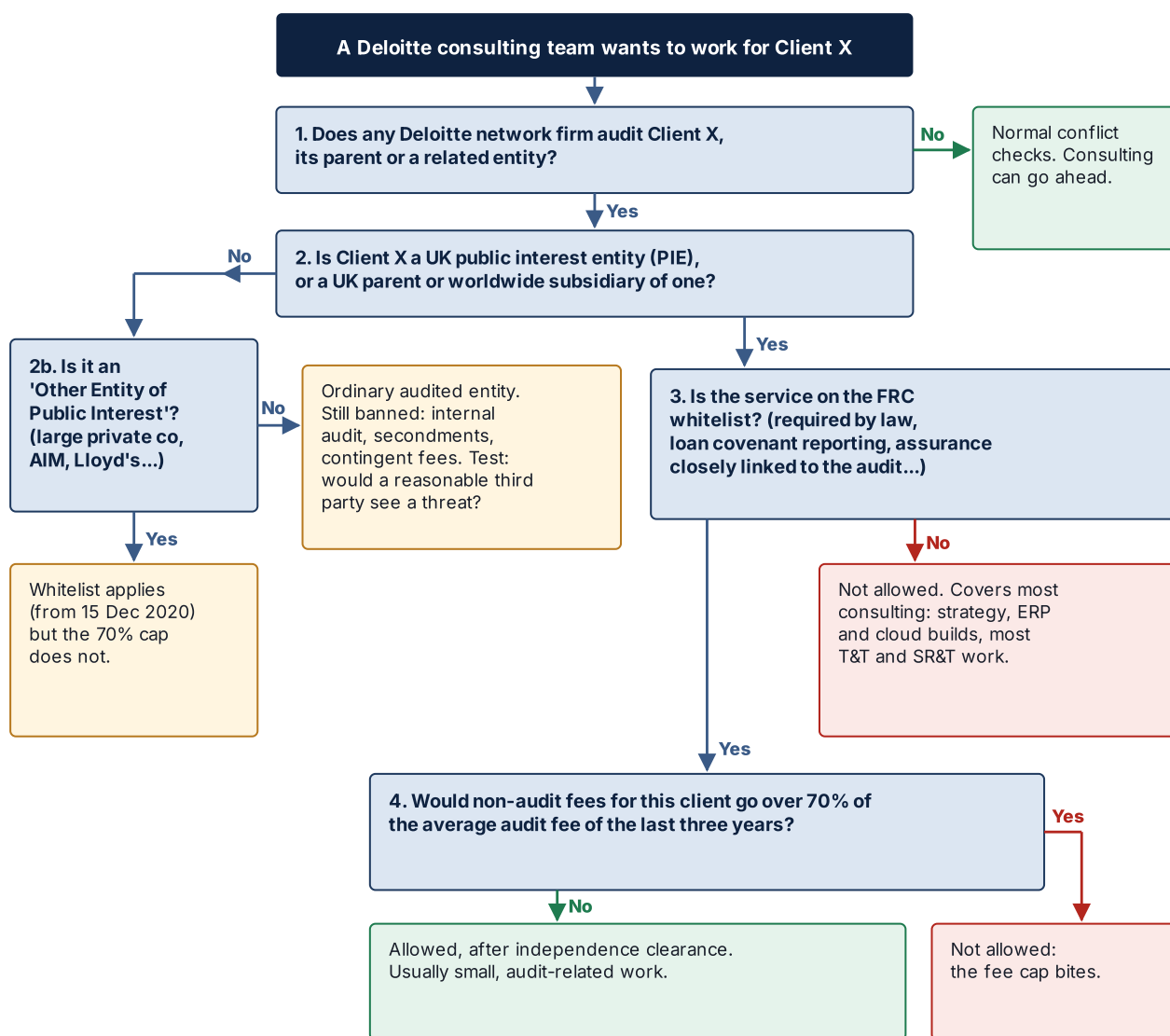
FRC Revised Ethical Standard 2019 (issued 17 December 2019, in force 15 March 2020)

The FRC (Financial Reporting Council) is the UK audit regulator. Its 2019 standard was released on **17 December 2019** and took effect on **15 March 2020** [S180] **CONFIRMED**. Per Deloitte's own February 2020 briefing, the key changes were [S180][S181] **CONFIRMED**:

- **Blacklist to whitelist.** Instead of listing what is banned, the FRC now lists what is allowed for UK PIE audit clients. Permitted services are largely those required by law and regulation, loan covenant reporting, other assurance closely linked to the audit, and reporting accountant work.
- **Bans for all audited entities** (not only PIEs) on internal audit services, secondments of staff, and contingent fees.
- **Reach across the network.** All services by the firm and its network to UK PIEs, their UK parents and their worldwide subsidiaries fall under the whitelist.
- **A new category, Other Entities of Public Interest (OEPI):** large AIM companies, Lloyd's syndicates, the largest pension schemes, and the largest private companies (more than 2,000 employees, or turnover over £200m and balance sheet over £2bn). The whitelist applies to OEPIs for periods from **15 December 2020**, but the 70% cap does not.
- **A tougher test:** would an "objective, reasonable and informed third party" conclude that independence is compromised?

FRC Revised Ethical Standard 2024 (issued 15 January 2024, in force 15 December 2024)

The current rulebook. Published **15 January 2024**, effective **15 December 2024**. It simplified the 2019 text, aligned it with the international IESBA Code, and added a restriction on fees from entities related through a single controlling party. The FRC's Mark Babington: "The revised ethical standard has been simplified to ensure auditors are clear as to the high ethical standards expected" [\[S178\]](#) **CONFIRMED**.

Figure 36 Who is allowed to buy what: the independence rules in one picture

Also always true: the audit practice cannot be paid for introducing work to the rest of the firm (operational separation).

Sources: EU Audit Regulation 537/2014, 70% cap, applies 17 Jun 2016 [S182][S180]; FRC Revised Ethical Standard 2019 (whitelist, bans, OEPI from 15 Dec 2020, third-party test) [S180][S181] (Deloitte briefing, Feb 2020); Ethical Standard 2024 in force 15 Dec 2024 [S178]; introduction fees [S312] (City AM, Feb 2021). The flow simplifies the rules for teaching; real cases go to Deloitte's independence team [S330]. Read: start at the top and answer each question for the client in front of you.

What this means on a Monday morning. Before a Deloitte consulting team can start work, the firm checks whether any Deloitte network firm audits that company or a related entity. If it is a PIE audit client, most consulting is simply not allowed [S180] [Inferred from Confirmed rules]. Deloitte UK has a whole internal team for this: Quality, Risk & Security Services, with sub-teams for Independence and conflict checks [S330] **CONFIRMED**. In practice, Deloitte's T&T business cannot sell an ERP implementation to a FTSE company Deloitte audits; that client's technology work goes to Accenture, PwC, EY or KPMG [S314] **INFERRED**. Challengers such as Unity Advisory sell "no conflicts" as a feature for exactly this reason [S167] **CONFIRMED**.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"Because Deloitte audits, the FRC's Ethical Standard means Deloitte consulting can only sell a short whitelist of mostly audit-related services to UK public interest entities it audits, and even those are capped at 70% of the average audit fee. So a large share of the integrated, strategy-to-delivery work happens at clients audited by someone else, in the public sector and in private companies. I'd expect independence checks to be a routine part of starting any engagement."

Rule set 2: operational separation of audit

On **6 July 2020** the FRC published principles requiring the Big Four (Deloitte, EY, KPMG, PwC) to operationally separate their UK audit practices. Implementation plans were due by **23 October 2020** and full implementation by **30 June 2024** [S183] **CONFIRMED**. The required outcomes [S183] **CONFIRMED**:

- Audit governance that protects auditors from the rest of the firm.
- Audit partners' profit share should not persistently exceed the audit practice's own contribution, so no cross-subsidy.
- A culture of challenge and scepticism, with auditors acting in the public interest.

Press reports of the principles add that dealings between audit and the rest of the firm must be on arm's-length terms, and that the audit practice may not be paid for introducing work to other parts of the firm [S312] **REPORTED**. On **10 October 2024** the FRC announced that all four firms had completed the transition, with independent audit boards chaired by Audit Non-Executives [S184] **CONFIRMED**. Sarah Rapson of the FRC: "The FRC is pleased with the spirit in which the firms have embraced operational separation and the progress achieved to date" [S184].

The point for you: this is separation *inside* one firm, not a legal split. Deloitte remains one LLP, registered OC303675 [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Consulting must stand on its own economics and cannot lean on audit as a door-opener **INFERRED**.

Rule set 3: audit reform, from white paper to abandonment

For seven years the plan was to replace the FRC with a stronger regulator, ARG (the Audit, Reporting and Governance Authority). That plan is now dead.

Date	What happened	Source
December 2018	Kingman Review recommends replacing the FRC, after the collapses of Carillion, BHS and Patisserie Valerie.	[S187] REPORTED
March 2021	Government white paper "Restoring trust in audit and corporate governance" proposes ARG.	[S187] CONFIRMED
July 2024	King's Speech announces a Draft Audit Reform and Corporate Governance Bill.	[S185][S186] CONFIRMED
July 2025	A minister tells the Business and Trade Committee that pre-legislative scrutiny will not happen this session.	[S186] REPORTED
20 January 2026	Government abandons the Audit Reform Bill. Business Secretary Peter Kyle confirmed; Business Minister Blair McDougall wrote to the select committee. Reason given: growth and lower burdens on large firms. ARG is dropped. The government still intends to put the FRC on a statutory footing with stronger investigative powers and mandatory industry funding. ICAEW's Alan Vallance called it a "false dawn"; FRC chief executive Richard Moriarty said the FRC would continue its work "regardless".	[S185][S186][S235] CONFIRMED

Date	What happened	Source
13 May 2026	King's Speech 2026 contains no audit reform bill and no mention of the FRC or ARGAs.	[S188] CONFIRMED

What remains, as of October 2026 [Inferred from the above]: the FRC's existing powers, the Ethical Standard 2024 and operational separation. A statutory footing for the FRC is a stated intention with no bill in the 2026 session. No law forces the Big Four to split audit from consulting in the UK. Meanwhile the FRC's July 2026 inspections rated 90% of Deloitte's inspected audits as needing no more than limited improvement (KPMG 95%, EY 90%, PwC 89%) [S236] REPORTED .

DON'T SAY THIS

"ARGA is coming." It was dropped on 20 January 2026 [S185].

"Consultants at Deloitte are regulated by the FRC." The FRC regulates audit. Consulting is caught only through the independence rules that apply to the firm as auditor.

"Deloitte can't work for any FTSE company." It can work for companies it does not audit, and for audit clients within the whitelist and the cap.

"The UK forced the Big Four to split." Separation is operational, inside each firm. EY's own voluntary attempt to split ("Project Everest") was abandoned on 12 April 2023 [S141] REPORTED .

"The EU AI Act high-risk rules apply from August 2026." The Digital Omnibus moved them (see below).

Rule set 4: how the government buys consultancy

The Procurement Act 2023

The Procurement Act 2023 and the Procurement Regulations 2024 came into force on **24 February 2025**, after a delay from October 2024. Procurements started before that date stay under the old Public Contracts Regulations 2015. A new National Procurement Policy Statement was laid on 13 February 2025 [S190] CONFIRMED . The Act brings more transparency, including published notices and contract information [S175] REPORTED . Note: a September 2024 City AM article still gives the original October 2024 start date [S175]; the delayed date is the correct one.

On **1 April 2026** the Crown Commercial Service (CCS) became the **Government Commercial Agency (GCA)** [S190] CONFIRMED . Use the new name.

MCF4: the main route to central government consulting

The Management Consultancy Framework Four (MCF4, reference RM6309) runs from **29 July 2025 to 28 July 2027**, with 219 suppliers across 10 lots. It allows time-and-materials, fixed-price or risk-and-reward pricing [S117] CONFIRMED . It replaces MCF3 (RM6187) and the restructuring and insolvency framework (RM6269), and is valued at around £1.7bn. The lots: business; strategy and policy; complex and transformation; finance; HR; procurement and supply chain; health, social care and community; infrastructure; environment and sustainability; restructuring and insolvency [S191] REPORTED . Whether Deloitte holds a place on each lot was not verified.

Consultancy spend controls, and the data that conflict

The policy is clear. The evidence on whether it is working is not. Different sources measure different things: planned versus actual spend, central departments versus the whole public sector, contracts awarded versus money paid.

Claim	Figure	What it measures	Source
Government target	Halve consultancy spend in 2025-26; save £550m in 2024-25, rising to £700m a year by 2028-29	Central government policy set from July 2024	[S173] [S177] CONFIRMED
Reported promise (Nov 2024)	Save over £1.2bn by 2026; ministerial sign-off above £600,000 or nine months	As reported by The Register; thresholds not checked against Cabinet Office guidance	[S233] REPORTED
Government says it beat the target	£910.6m actual vs £1.5bn planned, July 2024 to March 2025: £602.7m saved vs £550m target	Central departments; biggest spenders DHSC £251.9m, DESNZ £160.9m, DfT £153.1m	[S172] REPORTED
Contracts rose	£1.44bn of management consultancy contracts in Labour's first year; Deloitte largest at £431m, PA £310m, KPMG £301m	Contract awards (Tussell data, City AM, July 2025)	[S174] REPORTED
Record public sector spend	£3.7bn in 2024/25, up 6%; Deloitte top supplier of key contracts five years running, £400m+, about four times the next firm (Palladium, £102m)	Whole public sector (Tussell data via Consultancy.uk, May 2026)	[S335] REPORTED
Nobody knows the full picture	HM Treasury estimated about £1.36bn in 2022-23; "other sources suggest the figure could be significantly higher"	NAO, 21 November 2025: "The government does not collect data on how it uses consultants, only what it spends."	[S173] CONFIRMED
New wins despite the pledge	Home Office data and analytics deal worth up to £200m to Deloitte (4 years); up to £150m to PA	Framework ceilings, not guaranteed spend (late June 2026)	[S233] REPORTED

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

The two Tussell-based analyses disagree on who ranks second after Deloitte (PA Consulting at £310m in one, Palladium at £102m in the other) [\[S174\]](#)[\[S335\]](#). They use different date ranges and definitions of "key" consulting contracts. Quote "Deloitte is the largest supplier" (both agree) and avoid naming the runner-up. The civil service's chief operating officer Cat Little also warned that cuts should not "simply lead to an increase in 'professional services' or 'contingent labour'" [\[S172\]](#), which is one reason headline consultancy figures can fall while total outside spend does not.

Rule set 5: data and AI

UK data protection

The base regime is the UK GDPR plus the Data Protection Act 2018 [INFERRED](#). The **Data (Use and Access) Act 2025** amends it. Timeline [\[S194\]](#)[\[S195\]](#) [Reported, two sources agree on Royal Assent]:

- **19 June 2025:** Royal Assent; some provisions in force immediately.
- **20 August 2025:** first commencement regulations.
- **5 February 2026:** most data protection changes in force.
- **19 June 2026:** new complaints duty (organisations must acknowledge data protection complaints within 30 days).

The EU AI Act, and the Digital Omnibus delay

The EU AI Act (Regulation (EU) 2024/1689) is the EU's law on AI, with tighter rules for "high-risk" uses such as hiring, credit scoring, education and biometrics. It matters to UK consultants because UK clients that sell into the EU are caught, and because it creates advisory work. Original timeline [\[S193\]](#) **CONFIRMED**: in force 1

August 2024; prohibitions and AI-literacy duties from **2 February 2025**; general-purpose AI (GPAI) obligations from **2 August 2025**; most other provisions from **2 August 2026**.

The **Digital Omnibus on AI** then delayed the high-risk rules. Provisional agreement 7 May 2026; Parliament approval 16 June 2026; Council adoption 29 June 2026; published in the Official Journal in late July 2026 [S192] **REPORTED**. New deadlines per Orrick [S192] and Morgan Lewis [S234]:

- **2 December 2026**: Article 50 transparency for synthetic (AI-generated) content; new bans on AI-generated non-consensual intimate imagery and child sexual abuse material [S192] **REPORTED**.
- **2 December 2027**: stand-alone high-risk systems (Annex III) [S192][S234] **REPORTED**.
- **2 August 2028**: AI built into regulated products (Annex I) [S192][S234].
- **2 August 2030**: public authority systems [S192]. Relief for "small mid-caps" with under 750 staff [S192].

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Annex III high-risk date. Orrick (written after publication) and Morgan Lewis say **2 December 2027** [S192][S234]. The artificialintelligenceact.eu timeline lists **2 August 2027** [S193]. **Entry into force of the omnibus:** Orrick says 29 July 2026; another summary says 27 July 2026 [S192]. Neither was checked against the Official Journal. In an interview, say "the high-risk deadline moved into late 2027" and, if pressed, "2 December 2027 on the law-firm readings".

The UK's own approach to AI

The UK has no AI bill. The AI Opportunities Action Plan (**13 January 2025**, 50 recommendations) set a pro-innovation stance [S203] **REPORTED**. The King's Speech on **13 May 2026** had no AI bill. It did include a **Regulating for Growth Bill**, with a stronger statutory growth duty for regulators and "cross-cutting AI sandboxes", and a **Cyber Security and Resilience Bill** [S188] **CONFIRMED**. A sandbox is a controlled space where firms test new products under a regulator's eye with some rules relaxed. So a client operating in both the UK and the EU faces two very different AI regimes, which is exactly where advisers add value **INFERRED**.

Rule set 6: the client-side regulation consultants are hired to implement

Regulation is a demand engine. Financial services firms in particular buy consulting to meet hard legal deadlines. Know these six.

Rule	Key date(s)	What it requires, in plain English	The consulting work it creates INFERRED
DORA (EU Digital Operational Resilience Act, 2022/2554)	Applies from 17 Jan 2025 [S201] REPORTED	Financial firms must manage IT risk, report incidents, test resilience and oversee and register their technology suppliers. UK firms with EU entities, and IT providers (including consultancies) to EU financial firms, are caught.	Resilience testing, supplier registers, cyber
Operational resilience (FCA PS21/3, PRA SS1/21)	Transition ended 31 Mar 2025 [S199] CONFIRMED	Firms must stay within "impact tolerances" for each important business service during a severe but plausible disruption.	Mapping services, scenario testing
Consumer Duty (FCA PS22/9)	31 Jul 2023 (open products); 31 Jul 2024 (closed products and first board report) [S200] CONFIRMED	Firms must deliver good outcomes for retail customers, and prove it with data.	Outcome monitoring, product reviews, data

Rule	Key date(s)	What it requires, in plain English	The consulting work it creates INFERRED
Basel 3.1 (bank capital)	PRA delayed one year (Jan 2025) [S197] ; final rules PS1/26 on 20 Jan 2026; live 1 Jan 2027; FRTB internal models 1 Jan 2028 [S196] CONFIRMED	New rules on how much capital banks hold against risk.	Big bank programmes: data, models, reporting
UK T+1 settlement	Confirmed 19 Feb 2025; go-live 11 Oct 2027 [S198] CONFIRMED	Securities trades settle one business day after the trade instead of two.	Operations and systems change in capital markets
UK SRS S1 and S2 (sustainability reporting)	Final standards 25 Feb 2026, for voluntary use [S202] REPORTED	ISSB-based sustainability and climate disclosures. Mandatory use not confirmed in the sources.	Reporting design, data, assurance readiness

The King's Speech 2026 also includes an **Enhancing Financial Services Bill** delivering the 2025 "Leeds Reforms": Financial Ombudsman Service reform, folding the Payment Systems Regulator into the FCA, and changes to the Senior Managers and Certification Regime **[S188][S189]** **CONFIRMED** .

Figure 23 Regulation timeline for a Deloitte consultant, 2014 to 2027

Independence and audit	Public procurement	Data and AI	Client FS regulation
2014-2016			
16 Apr 2014: EU Audit Regulation 537/2014 adopted			
17 Jun 2016: EU rules apply. 70% fee cap, banned services, rotation			
2019-2021			
17 Dec 2019: FRC Ethical Standard 2019 (whitelist); in force 15 Mar 2020			
6 Jul 2020: FRC operational separation principles			
15 Dec 2020: whitelist extends to OEPIs			
Mar 2021: white paper proposes ARGAs			
2023			
	10 Oct 2023: Reeves pledges to halve consultancy spend		31 Jul 2023: Consumer Duty (open products; closed 31 Jul 2024)
2024			
15 Jan 2024: FRC Ethical Standard 2024; in force 15 Dec 2024	Jul 2024: spend controls; £550m saving target	1 Aug 2024: EU AI Act in force	
30 Jun 2024: separation deadline; FRC confirms met, 10 Oct			
Jul 2024: King's Speech announces audit bill			
2025			
	24 Feb 2025: Procurement Act 2023 in force	13 Jan 2025: UK AI Opportunities Action Plan	17 Jan 2025: DORA applies
	29 Jul 2025: MCF4 framework starts	2 Feb 2025: AI Act bans and AI literacy	19 Feb 2025: T+1 date confirmed
	21 Nov 2025: NAO: no data on how consultants are used	19 Jun 2025: Data (Use and Access) Act, Royal Assent	31 Mar 2025: operational resilience deadline
		2 Aug 2025: AI Act duties for general-purpose AI	
2026			
20 Jan 2026: Audit Reform Bill abandoned; no ARGAs	1 Apr 2026: CCS becomes Government Commercial Agency	5 Feb 2026: most DUAA data changes in force	20 Jan 2026: PRA final Basel 3.1 rules
13 May 2026: King's Speech, no audit bill		19 Jun 2026: DUAA complaints duty	25 Feb 2026: UK SRS published (voluntary)
		Late Jul 2026: AI omnibus in force (27 or 29 Jul)	
		2 Dec 2026: AI Act Article 50 transparency	
2027			
	28 Jul 2027: MCF4 framework ends	2 Dec 2027: high-risk AI (Annex III), date disputed *	1 Jan 2027: Basel 3.1 goes live
			11 Oct 2027: UK moves to T+1

* 2 Dec 2027 per Orrick and Morgan Lewis (post-omnibus); artificialintelligenceact.eu lists 2 Aug 2027. Time runs down the page; within each year band, each lane is in date order (not to scale).

Sources: independence and audit [S182][S180][S181][S183][S184][S178][S187][S185][S186][S188]; procurement [S176][S173][S177][S190][S191][S117]; data and AI [S193][S203][S194][S195][S192][S234]; client FS regulation [S200][S201][S198][S199][S197][S196][S202]. All accessed 4 Oct 2026. Dates after 4 Oct 2026 are scheduled, not yet happened. * Annex III date conflicts between sources (SOURCE UNCERTAIN). Read: colour shows which rulebook; each lane runs in date order down the page.

The competitive map of UK suppliers

Who Deloitte competes with depends on the job. On a bank's Basel 3.1 programme it faces PwC, EY, KPMG and specialists. On an SAP rollout it faces Accenture, IBM and Capgemini. On a government framework it faces PA Consulting and the mid-tier. On a board strategy question it faces McKinsey, BCG and Bain. The UK figures available are on different bases, so compare with care.

Firm	Latest UK figure	Where it is strong / what to know	Source
Deloitte UK	£5.81bn (UK and Switzerland, FY to May 2026, +2%); UK only £5,014m; UK T&T £1.75bn (+4%)	Largest UK government consultancy supplier; 14 alliance partners; four UK tech centres. Cannot sell most consulting to its PIE audit clients.	[S407][S88] [S174][S319]
PwC UK	UK revenue £4.365bn (+2%); wider UK and Middle East group £6.155bn (-3%)	Same multidisciplinary model; restructured in Oct 2024 with a ~900-person digital delivery unit	[S246][S138] [S404] REPORTED
EY UK	Fee income £3.78bn (FY25, +2%); UK consulting -6%	Tried and failed to split audit and consulting in 2023	[S139][S141] REPORTED
KPMG UK/Swiss	£3.6bn (FY25, +2%); Advisory -3%	Merged with KPMG Switzerland Oct 2024; cut about 600 UK roles in March 2026	[S140][S227]
Accenture	UK not disclosed; global US\$74.18bn, half managed services	Biggest pure technology-services rival; no audit, so no independence limits	[S129] CONFIRMED
PA Consulting, mid-tier	PA: £310m of UK government contracts in Labour's first year	Strong in public sector; Grant Thornton UK now PE-owned	[S174][S168] REPORTED
MBB	UK not disclosed; BCG US\$14.4bn global	Board strategy; BCG says over 40% of revenue is AI- and tech-focused	[S133] CONFIRMED
Challengers	Unity Advisory (up to \$300m PE backing); OpenAI's Tomoro AI	"No conflicts", AI-led, low overhead	[S167][S166]

What clients value today

- **Help with AI that works safely.** In an MCA client survey of 350+ leaders (May 2026), two in five organisations sought consulting help with digital and technology transformation. Top AI barriers: data security and privacy (40%), lack of skilled internal teams (34%), governance and roadmap problems (28%) [S240] REPORTED .
- **Judgement and trust.** MCA chief executive Tamzen Isacson: "The competitive edge now lies in being able to provide judgment, sector knowledge and trust that is earned through outcomes" [S240].
- **Expertise plus partnerships.** Source's 2026 outlook says expertise paired with strategic partnerships can be decisive in winning work, and that firms must address client worries about AI to build trust [S158] REPORTED .
- **Cyber.** The fastest-growing service globally (about 9%) and the top area where clients say they will bring in outside help [S156] REPORTED .
- **More outside help, not less, in technology.** 84% of tech buyers plan upgrades in the next year and 81% intend to rely more on external consultants [S157] REPORTED .
- **Value for money, provably.** Government buyers must "demonstrate the value-for-money case" (Reeves) [S176] CONFIRMED ; challengers sell low cost and no conflicts [S167].

PART 7

What is happening right now

The eleven stories from April to early October 2026 that a Deloitte Consulting or Technology interviewer is most likely to know, each explained from scratch, with why it matters to the firm and to you, and one question or opinion you could raise. Then the latest CFO Survey and Tech Trends in brief.

How to use this part

"Tell me about something in the news" is a near-certain question. The interviewer is testing three things: that you follow the business, that you can explain it simply, and that you can say what it means. Each story below is built in that order. Pick three you find genuinely interesting and practise them out loud. The first two (the results) are the ones you must know cold.

£5.81bn

Deloitte UK and Switzerland revenue, FY to 31 May 2026, +2% [S407]

£1.75bn

UK Technology & Transformation revenue, +4%, fastest UK business [S407]

US\$74.5bn

Deloitte global revenue FY26, +5.7% in US\$ [S221]

2.5%

Global T&T growth in local currency, slowest of four businesses [S221]

The results: Deloitte UK and Deloitte global, FY2026

Story 1 · Deloitte UK FY26: revenue +2% to £5.81bn, profit +14%

30 Sep 2026

OUTLET AND SOURCE

Deloitte UK press release, "Deloitte UK publishes 2026 financial results", 30 September 2026 [S407] [S220]; FY26 metrics document [S88]. Bloomberg's "Deloitte UK Partner Pay Grows to \$1.5 Million on AI Demand" (29 Sep) is paywalled and was not read [S223].

IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Deloitte UK's year ends on 31 May. In the year to 31 May 2026 revenue rose 2% to £5.81bn (FY25 £5.68bn) [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Careful: that headline is **UK and Switzerland consolidated**. Deloitte's footnote says "All revenue numbers presented herein, unless otherwise noted, represent UK and Switzerland consolidated" [S407]. The split is UK £5,014m and Switzerland £795m [S88] **CONFIRMED**. The four UK businesses: Technology & Transformation (T&T) £1.75bn (+4%), Tax & Legal £1.36bn (+2%), Audit & Assurance £998m (+3%), Strategy, Risk & Transactions (SR&T) Advisory £913m (+1%) [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Distributable profit, the pool shared by the owning partners, rose 14% to £899m. Average profit per equity partner rose to £1.125m (FY25 £1.051m). Equity partners rose 6.5% to a record 784 [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Context: FY25 had been the first revenue fall in about 15 years, with UK consulting down 10% [S123][S305] **REPORTED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO DELOITTE

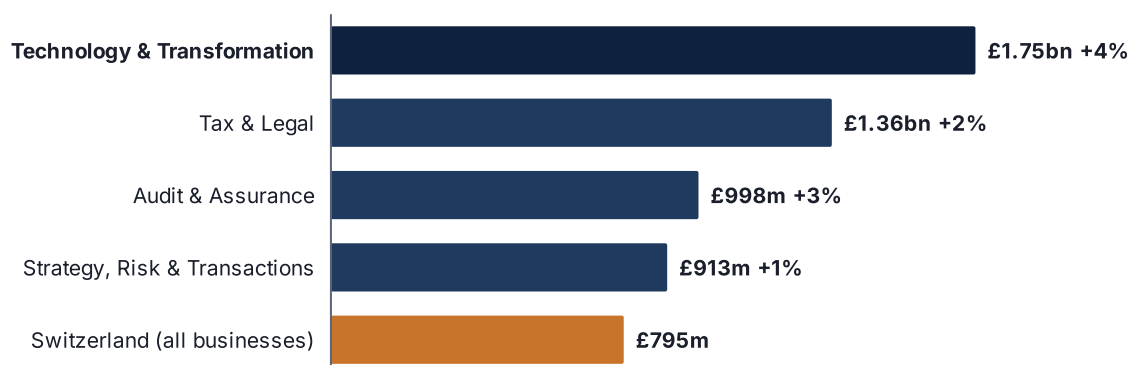
Profit grew seven times faster than revenue. Average fee-earning staff fell about 5% while revenue rose 2% [S93] **CONFIRMED**, so the gain came from efficiency and leverage, not volume **INFERRED**. The firm says its advisory businesses "returned to profitable growth", led by enterprise technology, ERP, cyber and human capital work [S407][S303] **CONFIRMED**. Technology investment rose to £180m from £158m [S407].

WHY IT MATTERS TO THE ROLE

T&T, the business you are most likely applying to, is the largest UK business and grew fastest. The firm hired 3,500 people including more than 1,950 graduates, apprentices and interns; over 6,000 of 25,000 people were promoted; the bonus pool rose 14% and average in-grade pay rose over 4% [S407] **CONFIRMED**.

RAISE THIS

"Profit rose 14% on 2% revenue growth while fee-earners fell about 5%. How much of that margin came from AI-enabled delivery, and does it change how T&T staffs a typical project?"

Figure 37 Deloitte UK FY26: revenue by business, plus Switzerland

UK four businesses = £5,014m. Plus Switzerland £795m = £5,809m (reported as £5.81bn, +2%).

UK growth rates are year on year in sterling. Switzerland growth not shown.

Sources: Deloitte UK FY26 results press release [S407] (30 Sep 2026) for the four UK businesses and growth rates; FY26 business and ESG performance metrics [S88] (Sep 2026) for UK £5,014m and Switzerland £795m **CONFIRMED**. Year to 31 May 2026. Read: the four UK bars sum to £5.01bn; the headline £5.81bn includes Switzerland, so never present the four UK businesses as adding to £5.81bn.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"£5.81bn is the UK and Switzerland figure. The UK alone was about £5.0bn, and UK T&T was £1.75bn, up 4%." Getting this precision right signals you read the release itself, not a headline.

Story 2 · Deloitte global FY26: US\$74.5bn, but T&T grew only 2.5%

24 Sep 2026

OUTLET AND SOURCE

Deloitte Global press release, "Deloitte reports FY2026 revenue", 24 September 2026 [S221][S120]; City AM, "Deloitte's tech consulting division weighs on growth", 24 September 2026 [S222].

IN PLAIN ENGLISH

The whole network (independent firms in about 150 countries under Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited) reported US\$74.5bn for the year to 31 May 2026. That is +5.7% in US dollars and +3.8% in local currency, which strips out exchange-rate effects [S221] **CONFIRMED**; the local-currency total comes from a secondary summary, Reported]. By business, in local currency: Tax & Legal +5.8%, Audit & Assurance +5%, SR&T +4.4%, T&T +2.5%. By region: Asia Pacific +7.5%, EMEA +3.5%, Americas +3.2% [S221] **CONFIRMED**. Headcount is "nearly 500,000", and Deloitte committed US\$3bn through 2030 to modernise operations and build AI-enabled products [S221] **CONFIRMED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO DELOITTE

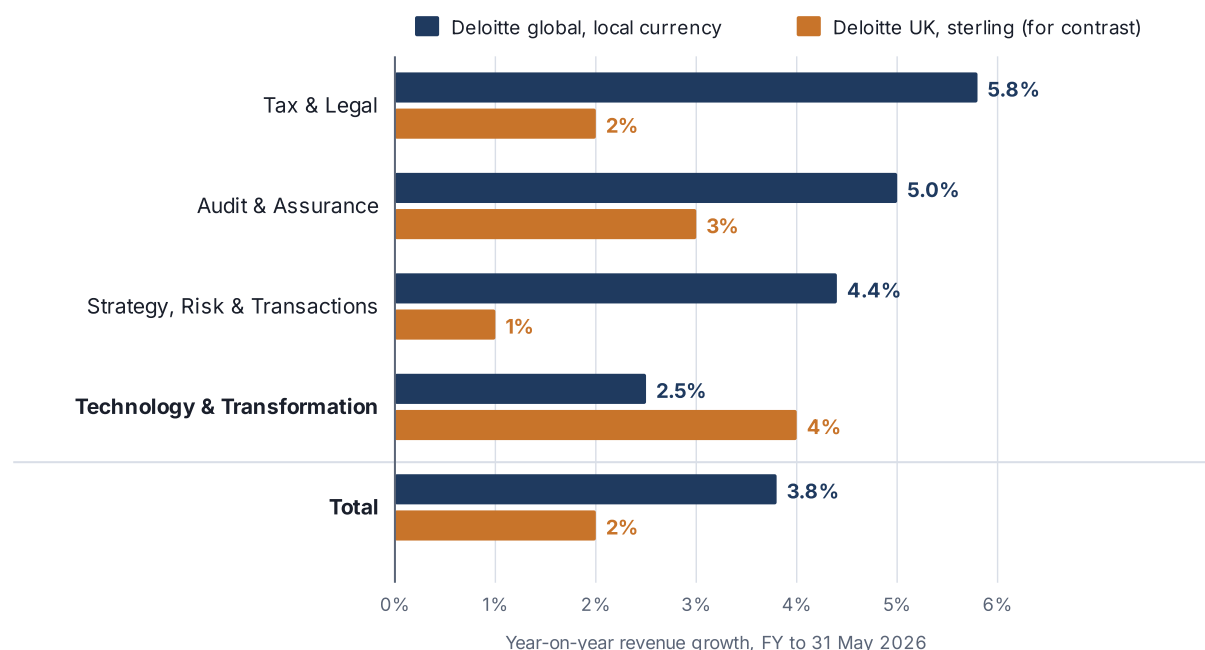
City AM framed slow T&T growth as a sign of "industry-wide pressure from artificial intelligence" [S222] **REPORTED**. The irony: the business that should gain most from AI grew slowest, plausibly because AI lets clients do more themselves and compresses hours on big implementations **INFERRED**. Accenture, now almost the same size at US\$74.18bn, grew 5% in local currency [S129] **CONFIRMED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO THE ROLE

Globally T&T was the slowest business; in the UK it was the fastest. That contrast is a sharp, specific talking point few applicants will have.

RAISE THIS

"Globally T&T grew slowest, but in the UK it grew fastest. Is that the ERP and cyber mix, the public sector, or the regional technology centres?"

Figure 38 Deloitte global FY26 growth by business: T&T slowest globally, fastest in the UK

Sources: Deloitte Global FY2026 revenue release [S221][S120] (24 Sep 2026), growth in local currency; total 3.8% local currency is from a secondary summary **REPORTED**. UK bars (sterling, UK and Switzerland total for the Total row) from [S407] (30 Sep 2026). Global and UK rates use different currencies and are shown for contrast only. Read: compare the T&T pair.

Leadership, people and the pyramid

Story 3 · Darren Graves becomes UK CEO; Deloitte UK appoints its first Chief AI Officer

1 Jun 2026

OUTLET AND SOURCE

Deloitte UK press release, "Deloitte UK appoints first Chief AI Officer", 1 June 2026 [S226]; FY26 results [S407]; Accountancy Today, 1 April 2026 (headline only) [S251].

IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Darren Graves became CEO and senior partner of Deloitte UK on 1 June 2026. His predecessor Richard Houston became CEO of the new Deloitte EMEA firm. Jane Whitlock became Chair of the UK Board [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Graves joined as a tax graduate in 2001 [S251] **REPORTED**. Hayley McKelvey joined the UK Executive as the first Chief AI Officer, "responsible for driving the firm's AI strategy across client services and internal operations" [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Hammad Rafique was named managing partner of T&T and Dave Sharman of SR&T [S226] **CONFIRMED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO DELOITTE

Putting AI on the executive committee makes it a whole-firm question, not one service line. A CEO from tax rather than consulting is also worth noticing.

WHY IT MATTERS TO THE ROLE

Hammad Rafique leads the business you are applying to. Graves's official line on AI and jobs is "As AI makes intelligence increasingly abundant, the role our people play will matter more, not less" [S407]. McKelvey: "Harnessing the power of AI responsibly and strategically, both for our clients and in our own operations, is my priority" [S226].

RAISE THIS

"The Chief AI Officer covers both client work and internal operations. In practice, which moves first: changing how Deloitte delivers, or selling AI to clients?"

Story 4 · Deloitte UK offers voluntary redundancy to up to 175 auditors

16 Jun 2026

OUTLET AND SOURCE

City AM, "More Big Four blues as Deloitte plans to slash UK audit roles", 16 June 2026 [S227]; Bloomberg the same day (paywalled, headline only) [S228].

IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Deloitte offered voluntary redundancy on enhanced terms to up to about 175 auditors, under 3% of Audit & Assurance and under 1% of the UK firm. The reason given was "low rates of attrition" [S227] [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Big Four firms rely on people leaving each year to make room for promotions and new graduates. When fewer leave in a weak job market, the pyramid clogs, so firms pay people to go **INFERRED**. KPMG cut about 600 UK roles in March 2026 [S227] **REPORTED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO DELOITTE

It shows how the FY26 profit jump was achieved, and that the people model is under strain.

WHY IT MATTERS TO THE ROLE

Low attrition means fewer entry seats, more competition for promotion and a more selective intake.

RAISE THIS

"If attrition stays low, does the classic pyramid still work, or does the shape move toward a diamond, with fewer juniors and more mid-level specialists?"

Story 5 · 1,353 early-career starters at Deloitte; Big Four overhaul graduate training for AI 10 and 23 Sep 2026

OUTLET AND SOURCE

Consultancy.uk, "2026 intake of early-career staff to hit 1,500 at Deloitte", 10 September 2026 [S231]; Resultsense summary of City AM, "How AI is changing Big Four graduate training in the UK", 23 September 2026 [S229]; Deloitte UK, 1 September 2025 (prior year) [S232].

IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Deloitte UK said 1,353 graduates, apprentices and industrial placement students would join across 21 UK offices, 44% outside London, including 182 BrightStart apprentices (the headline says 1,500; the body says 1,353) [S231] **REPORTED**. In 2025 the intake was about 1,400 across 17 locations, and starters met Deloitte's GenAI platform PairD in induction [S232] **CONFIRMED**. The Big Four told City AM they are front-loading exams, pushing trainees into judgement work earlier and coaching communication and teamwork, because AI now does much of the data work juniors used to do [S229] **REPORTED**. KPMG's chief people officer: "Graduates will become more involved in reviewing and exercising judgement rather than simply producing outputs" [S229].

WHY IT MATTERS TO DELOITTE

It must keep a pipeline of future managers while AI absorbs junior tasks. Cut too hard now and there are no seniors in eight years **INFERRED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO THE ROLE

Entry is flat, not growing. Year-one work will be more judgement-based and client-facing than for past cohorts, so communication and critical thinking weigh more in assessment.

RAISE THIS

"If AI handles first drafts and data work, how does Deloitte make sure analysts still learn the fundamentals the drafts are built on?"

Clients, government and the market

Story 6 · Deloitte wins a Home Office data deal worth up to £200m despite the spend pledge

1 Jul 2026

OUTLET AND SOURCE

The Register, "UK.gov vows to cut consultancy spending, then hands up to £350M to consultancies", 1 July 2026 [S233].

IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Deloitte won a four-year Home Office data and analytics deal worth up to £200m, and PA Consulting one worth up to £150m [S233] **REPORTED**. "Up to" means a ceiling, not guaranteed spend **INFERRED**. It came despite the government's pledge to cut consultancy spend (Part 6 sets out the conflicting data).

WHY IT MATTERS TO DELOITTE

Government is one of Deloitte UK's largest client sectors, and Deloitte is the largest UK government consultancy supplier [S174][S335] **REPORTED**. Government says "fewer consultants" but still needs data, digital and AI skills it cannot hire fast enough **INFERRED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO THE ROLE

Many T&T analysts start on public sector work; some programmes need security clearance.

RAISE THIS

"Is the real trend 'less advice, more delivery'? And how does Deloitte help departments build their own capability so they need it less over time?"

Story 7 · UK firms cut consulting spend as they buy AI tools directly

9 Sep 2026

OUTLET AND SOURCE

City AM, "UK firms slash consulting spend amid rising AI adoption" (Business Spend Pulse), 9 September 2026 [S239].

IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Card-spend data from fintech Capital on Tap (mostly small firms) showed median consulting fees down 1.9% year on year in August 2026 while total corporate spending rose 2.2%. About one in seven firms now pays AI companies such as Anthropic and ElevenLabs, up from one in thirteen a year earlier. The share of businesses paying professional services firms fell to 18.6%, "the steepest drop in any category" [S239] **REPORTED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO DELOITTE

This is the AI substitution risk in numbers. Caveat: it is small-business data; Deloitte's clients are mostly large companies and government, so read it as direction of travel **INFERRED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO THE ROLE

The work that survives is the work AI cannot easily do: complex integration, change management, regulated and high-trust decisions.

RAISE THIS

"If small firms substitute AI tools for consultants, which parts of a large T&T engagement are most and least exposed?"

Story 8 · MCA: 2025 growth only 3%; clients want help making AI work

23 Jan, 6 May, 6 Jul 2026

OUTLET AND SOURCE

Consultancy.uk on MCA data: 23 January 2026 [S241], 6 May 2026 [S240] and 6 July 2026 [S150].

IN PLAIN ENGLISH

The MCA cut its 2026 forecast to 5.7% in January, then reported in July that UK fee income grew 3% to £21.8bn in 2025, with 6% forecast for 2026 and 8% for 2027 [S241][S150] **REPORTED**. Its May client survey of 350+ leaders found two in five organisations seeking help with digital and technology transformation; top AI barriers were data security and privacy (40%), lack of skilled internal teams (34%) and governance problems (28%) [S240] **REPORTED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO DELOITTE

The barriers clients name map onto Deloitte's offer: data engineering, cyber, risk and change management.

WHY IT MATTERS TO THE ROLE

"AI" alone is not the product. Getting data, security and governance right is.

RAISE THIS

"If clients' biggest AI barrier is data security, are cyber and data teams now the front door to AI work?"

Story 9 · Accenture FY26 US\$74.2bn; PwC UK revenue +2%

1 Oct and Sep 2026

OUTLET AND SOURCE

Accenture Q4 FY26 results (SEC filing), 1 October 2026 [S238]; PwC UK results via Accountancy Today, 21 September 2026 [S246][S138]; Irish Times headline, 16 September 2026 [S247].

IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Accenture reported FY26 revenue of US\$74.2bn (+5% local currency), split almost evenly between consulting (US\$36.9bn) and managed services (US\$37.3bn), with about 814,000 people, and guided 3% to 6% growth for FY27 [S238] **CONFIRMED**. Managed services means running clients' systems for years. PwC UK revenue rose 2% to £4.365bn and profit per partner 8% to £935,000; its wider UK and Middle East group fell 3% to £6.155bn [S246] **REPORTED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO DELOITTE

Accenture and Deloitte are now almost the same size (US\$74.2bn vs US\$74.5bn), but Accenture grows faster and half its revenue recurs [S221][S238] [Inferred comparison].

WHY IT MATTERS TO THE ROLE

"Why Deloitte, not Accenture?" is a classic question. One honest answer: Deloitte combines technology delivery with audit, tax, risk and deals expertise in one firm **INFERRED**.

RAISE THIS

"Accenture earns half its revenue from managed services. Should Deloitte push harder into that, given independence rules limit it at audit clients?"

Rules and reputation

Story 10 · EU delays AI Act high-risk deadlines; UK drops its Audit Reform Bill

24 Jun 2026 / Jan 2026

OUTLET AND SOURCE

Morgan Lewis, "EU Approves Delays and Other Amendments to Certain EU AI Act Obligations", 24 June 2026 [S234]; ICAEW, "Government abandons Audit Reform Bill", January 2026 [S235]; Scottish Financial News, 20 January 2026 [S185].

IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Through the "Digital Omnibus", the EU moved stand-alone high-risk AI duties from 2 August 2026 to 2 December 2027, and AI in regulated products to 2 August 2028; bans and AI-literacy duties still apply [S234] [Confirmed by several law-firm summaries]. One tracker gives 2 August 2027 for the high-risk date (see Part 6) [S193]. In the UK, the government confirmed on 20 January 2026 that it would not proceed with the Audit Reform and Corporate Governance Bill, so ARGA will not be created [S185][S235] **CONFIRMED**. The FRC's July 2026 inspections rated 90% of Deloitte's inspected audits as good or needing limited improvement (KPMG 95%) [S236] **REPORTED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO DELOITTE

The AI Act delay may slow urgent compliance work but extends the advisory pipeline into 2027. No audit bill means no forced split of audit and consulting in the UK, which keeps the multidisciplinary model intact **INFERRED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO THE ROLE

Regulation creates consulting work (AI governance, risk, assurance), and independence rules shape which clients you can serve.

RAISE THIS

"Do clients treat the December 2027 deadline as breathing room, or are leaders using it to build AI governance properly?"

Story 11 · Reputation and risk: US settlement, Australian AI refund, FRC investigations

Aug 2026 and ongoing

OUTLET AND SOURCE

US Department of Justice, 25 August 2026 [S242]; The Register, 6 October 2025 [S316]; Accountancy Age, 23 July 2025 [S252]; Accountancy Today, 10 July 2025 [S253].

IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Deloitte's US firm agreed to pay US\$21.5m to settle allegations that its diversity programmes breached anti-discrimination terms in federal contracts. The DOJ states these "are allegations only and there has been no determination of liability" [S242] **CONFIRMED**. In October 2025 Deloitte Australia partly refunded a government department for a report with fabricated references, after disclosing use of a generative AI model [S316] **CONFIRMED**. In the UK the FRC is investigating Deloitte's audits of Glencore (2013 to 2020) and of collapsed fintech Stenn [S252][S253] **REPORTED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO DELOITTE

Each is a trust risk, and trust is what clients buy. The member firms are legally separate, but the brand is shared [S302] **CONFIRMED**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO THE ROLE

You will use AI tools as an analyst, and you will be accountable for checking every source and number.

RAISE THIS

Neutrally: "After the Australian report, what quality checks does Deloitte UK apply when GenAI is used in client deliverables?"

The latest Deloitte CFO Survey

The Deloitte UK CFO Survey asks chief financial officers of large UK companies about confidence, risks and plans every quarter. It is the firm's best-known piece of research and a classic interview talking point.

Edition	Headlines
Q2 2026 , published 20 July 2026; fieldwork 1 to 13 July; 58 CFOs (10 FTSE 100, 21 FTSE 250) [S224] CONFIRMED	73% report improved optimism about AI's business impact over the past year (59% in Q4 2025, 39% in Q3 2024). 93% expect UK business investment in digital technology to rise in the next 12 months. 78% expect AI to lift productivity within five years; 50% within 12 months. Geopolitics is still the top risk, but its rating fell to 68/100 from 79. Cost control is the biggest dampener on graduate hiring, followed by AI, then outsourcing.
Q1 2026 , published 13 April 2026; 79 CFOs [S225] CONFIRMED	Net confidence fell to -57% from -13% as conflict in the Middle East hit sentiment. Then chief economist Ian Stewart: "The conflict in the Middle East is reshaping business sentiment". 68% said cost control was a strong focus (up from 51%).
Next	Q3 2026 is due around mid-October 2026 [Inferred from cadence]. The "Q3 2026 CFO Signals" now in the news is Deloitte's US survey of North American CFOs; do not mix them up [S256] .

The story in one line: CFO mood swung from shock in Q1 to recovery in Q2, with AI optimism rising throughout, and cost control weighing on graduate hiring. Debapratim "Debo" De succeeded Ian Stewart as Deloitte UK chief economist from 1 June 2026 and now writes the weekly Monday Briefing [\[S248\]](#) **REPORTED**.

Tech Trends 2026 in brief

Deloitte's 17th annual Tech Trends report (10 December 2025) says the question has moved from "what can we do with AI?" to "how do we move from experimentation to impact?" [\[S244\]](#) **CONFIRMED**. Five trends:

- 1. AI goes physical:** AI in robots and autonomous devices that act in the real world.
- 2. The agentic workforce:** AI agents that take actions. Only 11% of organisations have them in production; the hard part is redesigning processes "agent-first" rather than automating old workflows.
- 3. The AI infrastructure reckoning:** unit costs fall but total AI bills rise with use; firms mix cloud, on-premises and edge computing.
- 4. The great rebuild:** AI reshapes how IT functions are organised; leaner teams tied to business outcomes.
- 5. The AI dilemma in cyber:** AI creates new weaknesses but also stronger defences, such as automated red-teaming (simulated attacks).

Quote to use: Kelly Raskovich, "the distance between emerging and mainstream is collapsing" [\[S244\]](#). A related September 2026 Deloitte study of 25,000 UK workers estimated they spend about £958m a year of their own money on GenAI tools for work, and nearly a third of users use it without their employer knowing ("shadow AI") [\[S243\]](#) **REPORTED**.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Prompt: "Which story are you following, and what do you think?" Pick one where you can add a mechanism. Example stance: "Tech Trends says only 11% of organisations have agentic AI in production, and Deloitte's own survey found a third of GenAI users hide it from their employer. Both point the same way: the bottleneck is process redesign and governance, not the models. That is consulting work, and it is why I think T&T's growth depends on change management as much as engineering." Counterpoint to acknowledge: SME data show some clients buying AI tools instead of advisers [\[S239\]](#).

How to stay current between now and the interview

- **Weekly (20 minutes):** Consultancy.uk and City AM's professional services coverage for Big Four news; Deloitte's Monday Briefing for the economy.
- **Quarterly:** the Deloitte UK CFO Survey (next due mid-October 2026); Accenture's quarterly results as the best public read on tech-consulting demand.
- **Before the interview:** re-read the Deloitte UK and global results releases, and check for anything new on the Deloitte UK press room.

The full list, with what each source is good for, cadence and links, is in the separate Reading_List.md file.

PART 8

Forming your own view: both sides of every argument

Nine live debates an interviewer could raise, each with the strongest case on both sides, what Deloitte's own leaders have said, a defensible stance you can adapt, and how to hold it under challenge. Start with the five-step method in Figure 39.

The method: how to build an opinion in 45 seconds

Interviewers do not mark you on whether your view matches theirs. They mark whether you can commit to a position, explain the mechanism, back it with a dated fact, concede the strongest counterpoint and say what it means. A view without a mechanism sounds like a guess. A view without a concession sounds naive.

Figure 39 How to build an opinion in an interview: claim, mechanism, evidence, concession, so-what



Say it in about 45 seconds. If challenged, go back to step 2 (mechanism) rather than repeating step 1 louder.

Method diagram by the author. The evidence line uses Deloitte UK FY26 figures [S407][S93] (Sep 2026). Read: work down the steps; the concession (copper) is the step most candidates skip.

DON'T SAY THIS

"There are pros and cons on both sides." It is true and it scores nothing. Give both sides, then choose.
 "It depends" is acceptable only if you immediately say *on what*, and which way you lean.

Debate 1: Will AI break the consulting pyramid?

CASE THAT IT WILL

AI drafts the research, slides and code that juniors used to produce. Big Four UK graduate intakes fell between 2023 and 2024 (KPMG -29%, Deloitte -18%) [S143] **REPORTED**. A recruiter says the Big Four want AI "to replicate junior work more cost-effectively" [S162]. Queen's Tower Advisory, founded by Mark Bunker, formerly of Deloitte, reportedly targets teams of "20 per cent humans, 80 per cent AI agents" [S164] **REPORTED**. Deloitte UK's fee-earners fell about 5% in FY26 while revenue rose 2% [S93] **CONFIRMED**.

CASE THAT IT WON'T

Clients' main AI barriers are data security (40%), skills (34%) and governance (28%), which need people [S240] **REPORTED**. Deloitte still hired more than 1,950 graduates, apprentices and interns in FY26 [S407]. MCA members raised graduate hiring 10% in 2025 [S150]. A commentator found that despite billions spent, firms still staff and bill the old way [S163] **REPORTED**. Firms need juniors today to have managers in eight years **INFERRED**.

What Deloitte's leaders have said. Darren Graves: "As AI makes intelligence increasingly abundant, the role our people play will matter more, not less. AI can't replace lived experience or replicate the judgement and unwritten know-how built..." [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Hayley McKelvey: "The challenge is no longer getting people to use GenAI, it's how businesses meet this growing demand in a way that is secure, responsible and creates lasting value" [S243].

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Suggested stance: "AI reshapes the pyramid rather than breaking it. The base gets narrower and the junior job changes from producing first drafts to checking and judging them. Deloitte UK grew profit 14% on 2% revenue while fee-earners fell about 5%, which is that shift starting. The risk I'd watch is training: if juniors never build the analysis themselves, where do future managers come from?"

How to hold it if challenged. If told "AI will replace analysts entirely", go back to mechanism: clients pay for accountable judgement and for change that sticks inside their organisation, and Deloitte Australia's refund shows what happens when AI output goes unchecked [S316]. Concede that numbers at the base will probably keep falling.

Debate 2: Should the Big Four split audit from consulting?

CASE FOR SPLITTING

Independence rules block consulting at PIE audit clients: a whitelist and a 70% fee cap [S180]

CONFIRMED . Conflicts are the challengers' main pitch: Unity Advisory sells "no conflicts" [S167]. Regulators already forced operational separation inside the firms by 30 June 2024 [S183][S184]. A split would let consulting raise outside capital for AI, as PE-backed rivals do [S168] **INFERRED** .

CASE AGAINST

The mix smooths income: in FY25 Deloitte UK consulting fell 10% but total revenue fell only 1% because tax and audit grew [S305] **REPORTED** . EY's attempt ("Project Everest") was abandoned on 12 April 2023 after a reported US\$600m cost [S141] **REPORTED** . The UK dropped the Audit Reform Bill on 20 January 2026, so no law is forcing a split [S185]. Breadth is a recruiting and client selling point [S308].

What Deloitte's leaders have said. Global CEO Joe Ucuzoglu, after EY's split collapsed in 2023, said keeping the model was "not even a close call" and that previous separations had "never once played out as intended" [S308] **REPORTED** . In 2022 Deloitte called split reports "categorically untrue" [S309] **REPORTED** .

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Suggested stance: "I'd keep them together, because the portfolio works: FY25 showed audit and tax cushioning a 10% consulting fall. The cost is real, since consulting cannot serve many large audit clients, but operational separation already deals with the quality concern, and EY's failed split shows how hard and expensive unwinding is."

How to hold it if challenged. If pushed on conflicts, accept the cost openly and name it precisely (whitelist, 70% cap, separation). Then argue it is a constraint to manage, not a reason to split. Do not claim the conflict is imaginary.

Debate 3: Is the government right to cut consultancy spend?

CASE FOR CUTTING

Test and Trace paid Deloitte staff about £1,000 a day each, some seniors up to £6,624 [S332]

CONFIRMED , while only 17% of people got results within 24 hours against a 90% target [S332] **REPORTED** . Consultants were still 45% of central staff in April 2021 [S333]. The NAO says government "does not collect data on how it uses consultants" [S173]. Mazzucato and Collington argue over-reliance weakens state capability [S337] **REPORTED** .

CASE AGAINST

The NAO found 86% of survey respondents said consultants made valuable contributions [S334] **CONFIRMED** . Government explained use by "skills shortages" and "comparatively low salaries in the civil service" [S333]. Cuts may shift spend into "professional services" or "contingent labour" (Cat Little) [S172]. Spend did not actually fall on some measures: £1.44bn of contracts in Labour's first year [S174]; £3.7bn record public sector spend in 2024/25 [S335] **REPORTED** .

What Deloitte's leaders have said. No direct Deloitte UK leadership comment on the spend controls was found in the research. Use the firm's results framing instead: growth came from technology delivery, ERP and cyber [S407].

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Suggested stance: "Right aim, blunt tool. Cutting advice that civil servants could do is sensible. But departments still need data and digital delivery they cannot hire fast enough, which is why the Home Office still bought up to £200m of data work from Deloitte. The better test is whether each contract leaves capability behind. I'd want Deloitte to be measured on that."

How to hold it if challenged. If told "you would say that, applying to Deloitte", agree that the incentive exists, and point to the evidence on both sides, including Test and Trace's poor 24-hour figure. Credibility comes from conceding the bad example.

Debate 4: Is outcome-based pricing good for clients?

CASE FOR

It aligns incentives: the firm earns when the client gains. McKinsey reportedly ties a quarter to a third of fees to outcomes [S163][S164]

REPORTED . Government frameworks already allow risk-and-reward pricing (MCF4) [S117]

CONFIRMED . If AI makes work faster, day rates reward slowness; outcome fees do not **INFERRED** .

CASE AGAINST

Outcomes are hard to measure and attribute: did revenue rise because of the project or the market? Firms price in risk, so outcome deals can cost more **INFERRED** . Progress is "sluggish" [S163]. Deloitte's accounts show even fixed-fee work is managed by timesheets at charge-out rates [S93] **CONFIRMED** , so the internal model is still time-based.

What Deloitte's leaders have said. No public Deloitte UK statement on outcome pricing was found. Deloitte does sell multi-year managed services ("Operate"), named as an area of significant growth [S120] **CONFIRMED** .

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Suggested stance: "Good for clients where the outcome is measurable and within the firm's control, such as cost savings on a process Deloitte runs. Risky where outcomes depend on the client's own decisions. So I'd expect a mix: outcome fees on managed services and automation, time-based fees on strategy and complex change."

How to hold it if challenged. If asked "so should all fees be outcome-based?", say no and give a mechanism: a firm cannot accept risk for results it does not control, and if it does, it will charge a premium for that risk.

Debate 5: Offshore delivery centres or UK regional centres?

CASE FOR OFFSHORE

Lower cost. Capgemini runs 66% of its staff offshore [S132] **REPORTED**. Deloitte's US-India organisation (USI) is reported at over 100,000 people [S324] **REPORTED**. Big Four firms are moving more work to India, Malaysia and the Philippines [S162] **REPORTED**. Revenue per head shows the effect: Accenture about US\$91k vs Deloitte about US\$149k globally [S129][S120] **INFERRED**.

CASE FOR UK REGIONAL CENTRES

Security clearance and data sovereignty for public sector and defence; same time zone; cheaper than London. Deloitte opened Belfast, Cardiff, Manchester and Newcastle centres from June 2025, starting with 750 technologists and aiming for 1,500 within three years [S254][S323] **CONFIRMED**. 44% of the 2026 early-career intake is outside London [S231] **REPORTED**. The EU AI Act and data rules raise the value of local delivery **INFERRED**.

What Deloitte's leaders have said. Then T&T managing partner Rob Cullen said the centres accelerate "our ambition to become the largest onshore technology capability in UK" [S323] **REPORTED**. Whether UK engagements use USI was not established in the research.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Suggested stance: "Both, by work type. Commodity build and testing will keep going offshore on cost. But Deloitte UK's biggest client is government, where clearance and data location matter, so onshore regional centres are a real competitive advantage, not only a cost move. They also widen who can join, which is good for hiring."

How to hold it if challenged. If told "onshore is just more expensive", accept it on unit cost, then argue total cost: rework, security vetting and time-zone delays. If you are willing to work in a regional centre, say so; it is a credible signal.

Debate 6: Should graduates fear AI?

CASE FOR WORRY

Fewer seats: Big Four intakes fell [S143]; Deloitte's 2026 early-career intake of 1,353 is flat against about 1,400 in 2025 [S231][S232] **REPORTED**. UK CFOs say AI is the second-biggest dampener on graduate hiring after cost control [S224] **CONFIRMED**. Accountancy graduate adverts fell 44% [S162].

CASE AGAINST

Firms are redesigning training, not abolishing it: juniors are pushed into judgement work earlier [S229]. Deloitte promoted over 6,000 of 25,000 people and raised in-grade pay over 4% [S407]. 93% of CFOs expect digital investment to rise [S224], which needs people to deliver it. Graduates who use AI well become more productive earlier **INFERRED**.

What Deloitte's leaders have said. Graves: people will "matter more, not less" [S407]. Starters are introduced to the firm's GenAI platform, PairD, during induction [S232] **CONFIRMED**.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Suggested stance: "Not fear, but adjust. The entry bar rises because the first job now starts at checking and judging, not producing. That favours graduates who can question an AI output, explain it to a client and spot what is missing. That's the skill I'm trying to show."

How to hold it if challenged. If asked "why hire you rather than use AI?", answer with accountability and context: AI produces drafts; a client needs someone who understands their organisation and will stand behind the answer.

Debate 7: Is Deloitte's EMEA merger smart?

CASE FOR

Scale to invest: Deloitte EMEA combines 16 firms with 132,000 people, 6,000 partners and €20bn revenue from 1 June 2026, with more than €1.5bn of incremental investment over four years in GenAI, sovereign cloud and sector solutions [S124] **CONFIRMED**. Clients want cross-border delivery. KPMG merged its UK and Swiss firms in 2024 [S140], so rivals are consolidating too.

CASE AGAINST

Bigger partnerships decide more slowly; EY's split failed partly on member-firm opposition [S310] **REPORTED**. EMEA growth was only 3.5% in FY26, behind Asia Pacific's 7.5% [S221] **CONFIRMED**. Local client relationships could weaken. Integration takes management attention in a difficult market **INFERRED**.

What Deloitte's leaders have said. Richard Houston: "Deloitte EMEA uniquely strengthens our ability to invest at scale across borders to accelerate innovation in areas that matter most to our clients" [S124]. Joe Ucuzoglu: "Our clients expect leading expertise wherever it is based, alongside seamless cross-border and technology-enabled delivery at speed" [S306] **REPORTED**. Country firms keep "local market responsibility" [S306].

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Suggested stance: "Smart on investment logic. AI and sovereign cloud need spending on a scale no single country firm can fund easily, and a partnership cannot raise outside capital. The test will be whether it can staff cross-border work quickly without losing the local relationships that win it. It's too early to judge results, since it only started on 1 June."

How to hold it if challenged. If told it is "just empire-building", point to the specific investment commitment and the partnership capital constraint. Concede that the benefits are promised, not yet proven.

Debate 8: Partnership or company: which funds AI better?

CASE FOR OUTSIDE CAPITAL

Listed or PE-backed firms can invest ahead of profits. Accenture returned US\$11.5bn to shareholders in FY26 and still funds acquisitions [S129] **CONFIRMED**. Grant Thornton UK (Cinven) and Unity Advisory (up to \$300m from Warburg Pincus) raised outside money [S168][S167]. Partners who retire soon may resist long-term investment that cuts their payouts **INFERRED**.

CASE FOR PARTNERSHIP

No quarterly earnings pressure: the firm absorbed FY25's consulting fall without a share-price shock [S305] **INFERRED**. Deloitte still committed US\$3bn through 2030 to AI and modernisation [S221] and raised UK technology investment to £180m [S407] **CONFIRMED**. Owners are the people serving clients, which aligns incentives on quality **INFERRED**.

What Deloitte's leaders have said. The US\$3bn commitment and the EMEA €1.5bn plan are the firm's answer: invest from pooled partner profits at larger scale [S221][S124].

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Suggested stance: "A large partnership can fund AI, but only by pooling across countries, which is exactly what EMEA does. PE money moves faster, but it comes with an exit date. For a firm whose product is trust and independence, I think the partnership is the better long-term owner, provided partners accept lower payouts in heavy investment years."

How to hold it if challenged. If told "PE firms will out-invest you", compare scales: US\$3bn committed globally against up to \$300m for Unity. Concede that speed of decision is the partnership's weak point.

Debate 9: Should Deloitte push harder into managed services?

CASE FOR

Recurring revenue: half of Accenture's US\$74.18bn is managed services, which grew 6% while its consulting grew 3% [S129] **CONFIRMED**. Long contracts smooth the cycle that hurt Deloitte UK consulting in FY25 [S305]. AI makes running processes cheaper, so the margin goes to whoever runs them **INFERRED**. Deloitte already names "Operate" as an area of significant growth [S120].

CASE AGAINST

Independence rules bar many managed services at audit clients [S180] **INFERRED**. Lower margins and heavy offshore staffing: Accenture's revenue per head is about US\$91k against Deloitte's US\$149k [S129][S120] **INFERRED**. It ties up capital and people for years, and pulls the brand from advice toward outsourcing **INFERRED**.

What Deloitte's leaders have said. The FY26 global release highlights Operate growth; no UK-specific statement on managed services strategy was found [S120].

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Suggested stance: "Yes, selectively: where Deloitte has built a system, running it afterwards keeps the relationship and the data, and AI will make that work more profitable. But it should not chase Accenture's volume model, because audit independence limits the market and its edge is advice plus delivery."

How to hold it if challenged. If asked "why not copy Accenture outright?", give the structural reason (audit independence limits who you can run services for) and the economic one (different revenue-per-head model).

A one-page cheat sheet

Debate	Suggested stance (one line)	The one fact to cite
Will AI break the pyramid?	Reshape, not break: narrower base, more judgement	UK profit +14% on revenue +2%; fee-earners -5% [S407][S93]
Split audit and consulting?	Keep together; manage the conflict	FY25: consulting -10%, firm -1% [S305]
Cut government consultancy?	Right aim, blunt tool; test capability left behind	Home Office data deal up to £200m [S233]
Outcome pricing?	Where outcomes are measurable and controllable	MCF4 allows risk-and-reward pricing [S117]
Offshore or onshore?	Both; onshore wins on government and data	Four UK centres, 750 to 1,500 technologists [S254]

Debate	Suggested stance (one line)	The one fact to cite
Should graduates fear AI?	Adjust: the job starts at judging	CFOs: AI second-biggest dampener on grad hiring [S224]
EMEA merger?	Smart investment logic; unproven	132,000 people, €1.5bn over four years [S124]
Partnership vs company?	Partnership, if it pools at scale	US\$3bn AI commitment to 2030 [S221]
More managed services?	Yes, selectively; not Accenture's volume model	Accenture: half its revenue is managed services [S129]

PART 9

The interview: process, question bank, questions to ask

How Deloitte UK actually assesses early-careers candidates in 2026/27, what is official and what is hearsay, a dated plan from today to a September 2027 start, how to prepare the Final Stage topic discussion, 56 practice questions with scaffolds, and the questions you should ask them.

The process in one view

Deloitte UK uses one common process for its Graduate, Industrial Placement, Summer Vacation Scheme and BrightStart programmes. It has five stages: an online application, an Immersive Online Assessment, a Job Simulation, a Final Stage Assessment and the outcome [\[S260\]](#) **CONFIRMED**. Two independent careers publishers describe the same five stages [\[S263\]](#) [\[S264\]](#).

One warning before anything else. Most English-language prep material describes the **US** Deloitte Consulting process, which uses group case interviews and several case rounds. Deloitte UK's current official page describes something different: no case interview and no group exercise, but a prepared topic discussion and a long skills and motivation interview [\[S260\]](#). Where the two disagree, this pack trusts deloitte.com/uk.

5

Stages, the same for graduate, placement and summer scheme roles [\[S260\]](#)

4 weeks

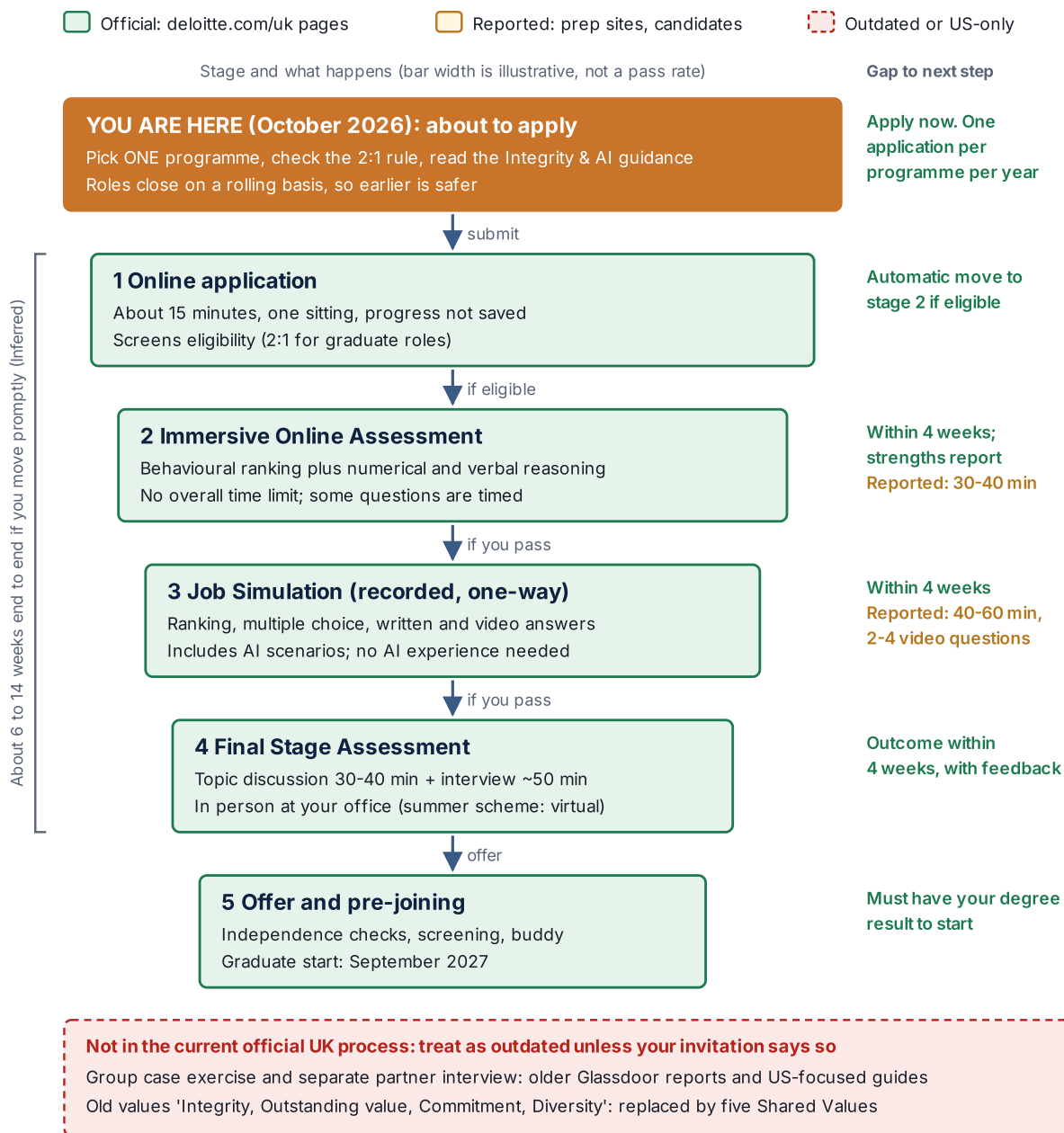
Official maximum gap between each stage [\[S260\]](#)

30-40 min

Final Stage topic discussion, two-way with an assessor [\[S260\]](#)

~50 min

Final Stage skills and motivation interview [\[S260\]](#)

Figure 25 The recruitment funnel, and where you are now

Source: [S260] Deloitte UK early careers assessment page (current, read 4 Oct 2026); [S261] Early careers FAQ; [S263] TargetJobs (17 Apr 2025) and [S264] WikiJob (9 Jun 2025) for reported timings; [S288] for video question counts; [S289] [S292] for the older group-case and partner-interview reports; [S266] [S264] for values. The 6 to 14 week total is an Inferred estimate. Read: green text is what Deloitte UK says today; amber is what candidates and prep sites report; the red box is what you should not expect.

Stage by stage: what happens, what it tests, how sure we are

Stage	What happens	Timing	What it assesses	Confidence
1. Online application	A form of about 15 minutes in one sitting; progress is not saved. Have GCSE and A-level details to hand. You can explain extenuating circumstances [S260].	If you meet the criteria you move to stage 2 automatically [S260].	Eligibility. Graduate roles need a 2:1 in any discipline and a degree by September 2027 [S260] [S272].	Official CONFIRMED . TargetJobs says results in two weeks [S263]; trust the official "automatic".

Stage	What happens	Timing	What it assesses	Confidence
2. Immersive Online Assessment	Two parts: a behavioural test where you rank responses to workplace scenarios, and a cognitive test of numerical and verbal reasoning [S260].	No overall limit, some timed questions; one sitting [S260]. Reported as about 30 [S263] or 40 minutes [S264].	Your natural working style and reasoning. You get a strengths report within four weeks; it is not the result [S260].	Structure official CONFIRMED ; length REPORTED . "Game-based, 35 questions" claims come from prep vendors only.
3. Job Simulation	One-way, recorded. Ranking, multiple choice, written responses and video responses, including scenarios that reference AI. All AI information you need is given in the question [S260].	Within four weeks of stage 2 [S260]. Reported 40 to 60 minutes, 2 to 4 video questions, 30 to 60 seconds to think, 2 to 3 minutes to answer [S263] [S264] [S288].	How you would handle the actual job: emails, prioritising, summarising data, presenting yourself.	Components official CONFIRMED ; timings and tasks REPORTED . Deloitte UK does not name the video platform [S260].
4. Final Stage Assessment	Exercise 1: Topic Discussion, a two-way discussion of a topic you were given to research in advance. Exercise 2: Skills and Motivation interview [S260].	30 to 40 minutes, then about 50 minutes [S260]. In person at your linked office; virtual and interview-only for the Summer Vacation Scheme [S260].	Analysis, communication, judgement under questioning; then your "alignment with the capabilities we look for at Deloitte" [S260].	Official CONFIRMED . TargetJobs reports a choice of four pre-set topics [S263] REPORTED .
5. Outcome	Offer, then onboarding through Deloitte's Candidate Zone; or feedback and the option to reapply next academic year [S260].	Within four weeks, with feedback [S260]. WikiJob reports 1 to 3 weeks [S264].	n/a	Official CONFIRMED .

KEY TERMS

Job Simulation: Deloitte's name for stage 3, a recorded assessment where you respond to realistic tasks on screen. Nobody watches live. **One-way video:** you record answers to on-screen prompts; reviewers watch later. **Strengths report:** an automatically generated summary of your working style, sent after stages 2 and 3. **Linked office:** the Deloitte office your application is tied to, where the in-person final stage happens.

Official advice worth taking literally

- On ranking tasks: "go with your gut instinct, don't try to second guess what it is we might be looking for" [S260].
- Practise on the official Candidate Zone tests. Deloitte warns that paid third-party sites claiming insight "lack Deloitte endorsement" [S260].
- Read Deloitte's **Integrity & AI guidance** before any assessment. Breaking it is treated as a breach of process [S260] [S261]. Do not use generative AI to write your answers.
- "Find a comfortable and quiet place to complete the assessment" [S260].
- At the final stage: "Our assessors are here to get the best out of you, they are not trying to trip you up or trick you" [S260].

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Group exercises and partner interviews. Some undated Glassdoor UK reports mention a group exercise, a case study and a partner interview [S289] **REPORTED**. US-focused guides say Deloitte “consistently uses a group case interview” [S292]. The current UK official page lists only the topic discussion and the interview [S260]. Expect those two unless your invitation says otherwise **INFERRED**.

Values. WikiJob still says interviews are built around “Integrity, Outstanding value, Commitment, Diversity” [S264]. That is an older Deloitte list. The current Shared Values are in the question bank below [S266].

Blind recruitment. In September 2015 Deloitte UK said recruiters would not see which school or university candidates attended and introduced contextual data [S267] [S268]. Current pages mention extenuating circumstances and inclusive design but do not confirm the 2015 policy is still in use [S260] [S261].

Opening dates. The official timelines page still shows the 2024 cycle (Consulting and Advisory opened 5 October 2024) [S262]. Exact 2027-entry dates were not confirmed.

What happens after an offer

BEFORE YOU JOIN

- **Personal independence.** “You will be required to clear Personal Independence checks before you join us” [S261] **CONFIRMED**. Deloitte audits many listed companies, so staff may not hold certain financial interests in audit clients. Expect to declare investments, including shares held in an ISA **INFERRED**.
- **Screening.** A Deloitte careers snippet describes an online questionnaire, right-to-work and address checks and a consent declaration, run by an external screening provider [S293] **REPORTED** (not seen on a fetched page).
- **Security clearance.** No Deloitte source says government clearance (BPSS or SC) is standard for graduates. It is likely only for people staffed on some public sector or defence work **INFERRED**.
- **A Deloitte buddy** supports you before you start [S261] **CONFIRMED**.

STARTING AND TRAINING

- **Start date.** “Our graduate programmes start in September” and you must have your degree result [S261]. The 2027 advert says Autumn 2027 intake [S272].
- **Scale.** 1,353 early-careers joiners started in the first week of September 2026; 44% (590) were based outside London across 21 locations [S271] **CONFIRMED**.
- **Qualifications.** Graduate programmes include professional qualifications [S269] [S272]; technology roles may include certifications such as CISA [S270].
- **Technical academies** (12 weeks, paid) in software, cloud, cyber and data are a separate route; 130 people moved from them into technology roles in 2026 [S271].
- **Deloitte University EMEA** moved in 2024 from near Brussels to a purpose-built campus east of Paris: up to 500 delegates a day, 22,000 m², 260 bedrooms [S283] [S284]. Whether UK graduates go in year one is not stated.

Your timeline from today (4 October 2026)

You have not applied yet. That is the most urgent fact in this pack. Deloitte says it will “close applications early when we get a very high volume of submissions” [S261], and the 2027 Consulting Graduate advert says roles close “on a rolling basis” [S272]. In the 2024 cycle, Consulting and Advisory opened on 5 October [S262]. You may apply to only **one** programme per academic year; if you apply to more, only the first counts and you cannot transfer [S261] [S262].

When (estimate)	Stage	What to do
This week (5 to 11 Oct 2026)	Choose and apply	Decide: Graduate (if you graduate by Sept 2027), Summer Vacation Scheme or Industrial Placement. Pick one team (Part 2 and [S320]). Read the Integrity & AI guidance. Submit the 15-minute form.
Days after applying	Immersive Online Assessment	Do the Candidate Zone practice tests first [S260]. Then take it in one quiet sitting. Answer as yourself.
Late Oct to Nov 2026	Job Simulation	Rehearse 60 to 90-second spoken answers to Q1 to Q10 below. Practise one written summary and one email. Record yourself twice.
Nov 2026 to Jan 2027	Final Stage	When the topic arrives, follow the six-day plan below. Prepare 12 STAR stories mapped to the values. Learn Part 12's answers. Plan travel to your office.
Dec 2026 to Feb 2027	Outcome	Accept. If unsuccessful, ask for the feedback and plan to reapply next year [S260].
Spring to summer 2027	Pre-joining	Independence declarations and screening. Keep your degree on track: the offer needs a 2:1 [S272].
September 2027	Start	Graduate start date [S261] [S272].

Dates are an **INFERRED** estimate built from the official “within four weeks” gaps [S260]. Your actual invitations set the real dates.

The Final Stage topic discussion

Deloitte sends you a topic to research and analyse before the day. On the day you discuss it for 30 to 40 minutes with an assessor who “will ask questions throughout” [S260] **CONFIRMED**. TargetJobs reports that candidates choose from four pre-selected topics [S263] **REPORTED**. Older reports describe a 5-minute presentation followed by questions, with broad topics such as “globalisation” [S264] **REPORTED** (older format). A short structured opening works for both formats, so prepare one **INFERRED**.

How a two-way discussion is likely assessed

Deloitte does not publish the scoring grid [S260]. Based on the official format, expect the assessor to look for these things **INFERRED**:

What they watch	What good looks like
Structure	You frame the question, give two or three points and land a view within the first three minutes.
Evidence	Numbers with a date and a source. Fewer, better facts beat a long list.
Judgement	You commit to a view and name its biggest risk.
Listening	You answer the question asked, and build on the assessor's points.
Handling challenge	You hold a view when the evidence supports it and change it openly when it does not.
Commercial sense	You say who would act, what it would cost and how a firm like Deloitte could help.

A structure for your opening (about 4 to 5 minutes)

- 1. Frame** (30 seconds): what the question really is, and who it matters to.
- 2. Context** (1 minute): two or three facts that set the scene, each dated and sourced.

3. **Analysis** (2 minutes): two or three drivers. For each, the mechanism (how it works) and one piece of evidence.
4. **Your view** (30 seconds): a clear position.
5. **Risks and what would change your mind** (30 seconds).
6. **Hand over**: "I'd be interested in your view on X." This invites the two-way discussion on your ground.

A six-day preparation plan

Day 1. Define the question. List who wins, who loses and who decides.

Day 2. Collect 8 to 10 facts from primary sources (government, regulator, company results). Note dates.

Day 3. Choose your view. Write the strongest counter-argument.

Day 4. Write the 5-minute opening. Cut it to one page of notes.

Day 5. Ask a friend to interrupt you with Q49 to Q52 below.

Day 6. Add one Deloitte link: which team would help a client with this, and how.

Eight practice prompts

These are **practice prompts**, not reported Deloitte topics, except the first, which WikiJob reports as a past broad topic [S264]. Real 2025/26 topics were not visible in any source read for this pack.

Prompt	A starting angle and evidence	Label
Is globalisation reversing, and what should a UK business do about it?	Geopolitics topped UK CFOs' risk list in 16 of the last 18 quarters [S224].	Reported topic [S264]
Should the UK government cut its use of consultants?	Record £3.7bn public sector consulting spend in 2024/25 [S335]; NAO on missing spend data [S334]; The Big Con [S337].	Practice
Will AI agents shrink or grow the consulting industry?	11% of organisations have agentic AI in production [S244]; SME consulting spend down 1.9% while AI tool spend rises [S239].	Practice
How should a large UK employer deal with "shadow AI"?	Nearly a third of GenAI users use it without their employer knowing [S243].	Practice
Should UK companies wait for AI regulation before scaling AI?	EU high-risk AI duties delayed to 2 December 2027 [S234].	Practice
What should a board do after a ransomware attack on a competitor?	60% of CFOs named cyber-attacks a key risk in Q1 2026 [S225]; Deloitte Cyber's focus areas [S269].	Practice
Can technology fix UK productivity?	93% of CFOs expect digital investment to rise; 78% expect AI to lift productivity within five years [S224].	Practice
Should professional services firms keep audit and consulting together?	Deloitte's 2003 decision [S104]; EY's abandoned split [S310]; UK Audit Reform Bill dropped in January 2026 [S235].	Practice

The question bank

56 questions, grouped by where you are likely to meet them. Each is labelled: **(Official)** where Deloitte UK describes the question type itself, **(Reported [Sxx])** where a candidate or careers publisher reports it, and **(Practice)** where this pack built it from official categories. These are scaffolds, not scripts. Put your own stories in them.

KEY TERM

STAR: a way to tell a work story. **Situation** (the context in one or two sentences), **Task** (what you had to achieve), **Action** (what *you* did, the longest part), **Result** (what changed, ideally with a number).

A. Job Simulation: recorded video and written tasks

Stage 3. You answer on screen to a recorded prompt or type a written reply. Nobody is live. Answer in the first 15 seconds, then give evidence.

Q1. "Introduce yourself to the members of your team and the senior colleagues who haven't met you yet." (Reported [S264])

Tests: A short, confident self-introduction pitched to a mixed audience. **Structure:** One-line headline (who you are, what you study, what you bring), one proof point, then what you look forward to working on with them. Aim for about 60 seconds. **Weave in:** Name the business in Deloitte's own words: Technology & Transformation, one of the four businesses since the 2024 restructure [S307] [S407]. **Trap:** Reading your CV aloud. The reviewer is picturing a colleague, not a list.

Q2. "What does successful collaboration mean to you?" (Reported [S264])

Tests: The Shared Value "Collaborate for measurable impact". **Structure:** Define it in one line (shared goal, clear roles, a result you can measure), give a short example with a number, then say what you would do differently next time. **Weave in:** Deloitte's wording: teams deliver "tangible, measurable, attributable impact" [S266]. **Trap:** Describing harmony. Deloitte's value is about outcomes you can measure.

Q3. "Give me an example of a time you've been creative." (Reported [S264])

Tests: Lead the way; solving problems inside constraints. **Structure:** STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result). Make the creative step explicit: what you tried that others had not. **Weave in:** The Technology careers page asks for people who are "resilient and innovative" and enjoy "solving problems" [S270]. **Trap:** An art project with no outcome. Choose creativity that solved a problem for someone.

Q4. "What technology do you think could have a big impact on the industrial workplace?" (Reported [S264])

Tests: Curiosity about technology plus commercial sense. **Structure:** Name one technology. Explain the mechanism (what changes on the shop floor). Say who pays and who gains. Name one risk. **Weave in:** Deloitte's Tech Trends 2026 lists "AI goes physical" (AI in robots and devices) and says only 11% of organisations have agentic AI in production [S244]. **Trap:** A list of buzzwords. Pick one technology and explain how it creates value.

Q5. How would you approach being successful in a new team? (Reported [S288], paraphrased)

Tests: Adaptability and a learning mindset. **Structure:** Weeks one and two: listen and map the people, goals and ways of working. Then deliver one small thing well. Then ask for feedback. **Weave in:** The Consulting page asks for a "strong learning orientation" [S269]; new joiners get a Deloitte buddy [S261]. **Trap:** Promising to change things on day one.

Q6. A senior colleague asks for help late in the day when you already have a deadline. What do you do? (Reported [S288], paraphrased)

Tests: Prioritisation, honesty and the value "Take care of each other". **Structure:** Clarify how urgent each task is. Tell both people about the trade-off. Agree a plan, and involve your manager if the two clash. **Weave in:** Shared Value "Take care of each other" [S266]. **Trap:** Quietly doing both badly, or refusing without a conversation.

Q7. A colleague emails to say they have found a discrepancy in your work. Write your reply. (Reported [S288], paraphrased)

Tests: Ownership, integrity and written tone. **Structure:** Thank them. Acknowledge the issue. Say what you will check and by when. Confirm the fix. Say how you will stop it happening again. **Weave in:** Shared Value "Serve with integrity" [S266]. **Trap:** A defensive tone, or blaming the data.

Q8. Written task: summarise this data about AI adoption and make a recommendation. (Reported [S288])

Tests: Synthesis, structured writing and the "so what". **Structure:** Recommendation first, in one line. Three supporting points from the data. One risk and how to manage it. **Weave in:** Use only the data given. Deloitte says the information you need about AI is inside the question, and no prior AI experience is needed [S260]. **Trap:** Padding with outside facts, or hedging with no recommendation.

Q9. Email task: reply to a co-worker who says their workload is unmanageable. (Reported [S288])

Tests: Empathy and judgement about when to escalate. **Structure:** Acknowledge how they feel. Ask one or two specific questions. Offer a concrete step (reprioritise, take one task). Suggest raising it with the manager together. **Weave in:** "Take care of each other" [S266]. **Trap:** Trying to fix a resourcing problem alone without the manager.

Q10. AI scenario (practice version): your team wants to use a generative AI tool to draft a client summary.**What do you check?** (Official category [S260]; this wording is Practice)

Tests: Judgement about responsible AI use, not technical AI knowledge. **Structure:** Four checks: data (is client data allowed in this tool?), accuracy (check every fact and citation), disclosure (does the client know?), and a named human who signs it off. **Weave in:** In 2025 Deloitte Australia repaid part of a government contract after a report contained fabricated citations; the revised report disclosed it used Azure OpenAI GPT-4o [S316]. Candidates must also follow Deloitte's Integrity & AI guidance in the assessments themselves [S260]. **Trap:** Saying AI should be banned, or assuming its output is right.

B. Motivation

Final Stage, Skills and Motivation interview. These are about fit and research. Part 12 gives you full answers for "Why Deloitte?".

Q11. "Why Deloitte?" (Reported [S264] [S287] [S289])

Tests: Depth of research, and whether your reason is specific to this firm. **Structure:** Use the Part 12 structure: how the firm is built, the evidence, what it means for you. **Weave in:** In FY25 restated T&T revenue fell 10% but total revenue fell only 1% [S89] [S305]; UK technology investment rose to £180m in FY26 [S407]. **Trap:** "Biggest" or "great culture". Every candidate says it.

Q12. "Why this service line?" (Technology & Transformation, Strategy, Risk & Transactions, or a named team) (Reported [S264])

Tests: Whether you know what the team does and who buys it. **Structure:** Name the team. Say what its clients buy. Name the skill you would build. Give evidence of your interest. **Weave in:** UK T&T offerings: Enterprise, Technology & Performance; Engineering, AI & Data; Cyber; Customer; Human Capital; Defence & Security [S320]. UK T&T revenue £1.75bn, up 4% [S407]. **Trap:** Choosing a team you cannot describe in one sentence.

Q13. "Why consulting?" (Reported [S289])

Tests: A realistic picture of the job. **Structure:** What consultants do (help a client solve a problem it cannot solve alone, for a fee). What you like about that. Your evidence. One honest trade-off you accept (pressure, travel, changing teams). **Weave in:** In an MCA client survey the top barriers to AI were data security and privacy (40%), lack of skilled internal teams (34%) and governance (28%) [S240]. Those are gaps clients pay consultants to fill. **Trap:** "It keeps my options open." That signals you will leave.

Q14. "Why this role, and what can you bring to it?" (Reported [S287])

Tests: Fit between your strengths and the job. **Structure:** Two strengths, each matched to something the role needs, each with a short proof. **Weave in:** The Consulting page asks for curious, open-minded people who enjoy collaboration and relationship-building, with a strong learning orientation [S269]. **Trap:** Strengths with no evidence.

Q15. "What sets you apart from other candidates?" (Reported [S287])

Tests: Self-awareness without arrogance. **Structure:** One distinctive combination (for example your subject plus a job or project), the proof, and why it would help a client. **Weave in:** Tie it to a named team from [S320]. **Trap:** Running down other candidates.

Q16. "Why Deloitte rather than another Big Four firm?" (Practice; generic example in [S265])

Tests: Knowledge of competitors. **Structure:** One fact about the field. One Deloitte difference. The link to you. **Weave in:** Deloitte global revenue US\$74.5bn in FY26 against PwC's US\$56.9bn in FY25 [S120] [S126]; Deloitte says Gartner ranked it No. 1 consulting provider by revenue for the ninth year running [S125]. **Trap:** Criticising rivals. Compare, do not attack.

Q17. "Where do you see yourself in five years?" (Practice; generic example in [S265])

Tests: Ambition and whether you will stay. **Structure:** Talk about skills, not titles: a platform or qualification, client responsibility, leading a small workstream. **Weave in:** Deloitte UK promoted over 6,000 people in June 2026 [S280]. **Trap:** "Doing an MBA" or "starting my own company".

C. Strengths and competency

Final Stage interview. Use STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result). Spend most of the time on Action and say "I", not "we".

Q18. "Tell me about yourself" / "Walk me through your CV." (Reported [S289])

Tests: Clarity, and whether your story leads to this role. **Structure:** Present (what you study now), past (two experiences that led here), future (why this role). About 90 seconds. **Weave in:** End on the team you want to join [S320]. **Trap:** A chronological life story.

Q19. "Tell me about a time you were challenged and how you overcame it." (Reported [S264])

Tests: Resilience. **Structure:** STAR. The challenge in two sentences; your actions in detail; a result with a number. **Weave in:** The Technology page asks for people who are "resilient" [S270]. **Trap:** A challenge where you did nothing personally.

Q20. "What do you see as your best role in a team?" / "How do you work best in a team?" (Reported [S264] [S289])

Tests: Self-knowledge and flexibility. **Structure:** Name your natural role (for example, the person who structures the problem). Give an example. Say when you take a different role. **Weave in:** "Collaborate for measurable impact" [S266]. **Trap:** Saying "leader" by default.

Q21. "What is your proudest achievement?" (Reported [S264] [S287])

Tests: What you value and how hard you will work. **Structure:** One achievement with effort and a measurable result. Say why it matters to you. **Weave in:** Link the skill to client work in your chosen team [S269]. **Trap:** Grades on their own.

Q22. "What are two of your strengths?" (Reported [S264])

Tests: Self-awareness. **Structure:** Two strengths, each with a short example and what it would give a team. **Weave in:** Your Immersive Online Assessment produces a strengths report [S260]. Use its language if it fits you. **Trap:** Strengths you cannot prove.

Q23. "What's your greatest weakness?" (Reported [S264])

Tests: Honesty and ability to improve. **Structure:** A real weakness, one example of its effect, what you now do about it, and evidence of progress. **Weave in:** "Serve with integrity" [S266]. **Trap:** A disguised boast ("I work too hard").

Q24. "Tell me about a time you ran into conflict working with someone." (Reported [S287])

Tests: Maturity; the values "Take care of each other" and "Foster inclusion". **Structure:** STAR. Spend time on how you understood their view and how you reached an agreed outcome. **Weave in:** [S266]. **Trap:** A story with a villain.

Q25. "Tell me about a time you made a mistake." (Reported [S287])

Tests: Integrity. **Structure:** Own it quickly. Fix it. Tell the people affected. Explain what you changed to prevent it. **Weave in:** "Serve with integrity" [S266]; Deloitte treats breaches of its assessment rules seriously [S260]. **Trap:** A mistake that turns out to be someone else's fault.

Q26. "Give me an example of when you've been responsible for a project." (Practice; generic example in [S265])

Tests: Planning and ownership, the daily work of a junior consultant. **Structure:** Scope, plan, track, report, deliver. Name the tool you used to track it. **Weave in:** Analysts "collaborate across disciplines" with strategy, design, engineering and data colleagues [S321]. **Trap:** No dates, no numbers, no sense of what you did.

Q27. "Tell me about a time you demonstrated leadership." (Practice; generic example in [S265])

Tests: "Lead the way". **Structure:** Leadership without a title counts: you set direction, got others moving and got a result. **Weave in:** [S266]. **Trap:** Equating leadership with being in charge.

D. Values: Deloitte's five Shared Values

Deloitte's current Shared Values are: **Lead the way; Serve with integrity; Take care of each other; Foster inclusion; Collaborate for measurable impact** [S266]. Older guides list "Integrity, Outstanding value, Commitment, Diversity" [S264]. Do not use the old list. Each question below is a practice prompt built on one value.

Q28. Lead the way: "Tell me about a time you changed how something was done." (Practice [S266])

Tests: Initiative. **Structure:** What was wrong, what you proposed, how you persuaded people, what improved. **Weave in:** Deloitte says it aims to be "not only leading the profession, but also reinventing it" [S266]. **Trap:** A change nobody else noticed.

Q29. Serve with integrity: "A client calls when nobody else is in the office and asks you to shred one of their documents without telling anyone. What do you do?" (Practice; generic example in [S265])

Tests: Integrity and escalation. **Structure:** Do not act. Say politely you need to check. Escalate to your manager the same day. Keep a note. **Weave in:** Joiners must clear personal independence checks [S261]; conflict checks run before engagements are accepted [S94]. **Trap:** Agreeing to keep the client happy.

Q30. Take care of each other: "Tell me about a time you noticed someone struggling. What did you do?" (Practice [S266])

Tests: Care with good boundaries. **Structure:** What you noticed, how you raised it, what you did, and when you involved someone else. **Weave in:** [S266]. **Trap:** Becoming the hero who fixed everything alone.

Q31. Foster inclusion: "Tell me about a time you made sure a quieter voice was heard." (Practice [S266])

Tests: Inclusive behaviour. **Structure:** The situation, what you changed (process or habit), and the effect on the outcome. **Weave in:** Deloitte UK introduced school- and university-blind recruitment in 2015 [S267]; 44% of September 2026 starters are based outside London [S271]. **Trap:** Talking about inclusion in general with no action.

Q32. Collaborate for measurable impact: "Tell me about a team result you can measure." (Practice [S266])

Tests: Teamwork that produces a number. **Structure:** Team goal, your part, the measure, the result. **Weave in:** "tangible, measurable, attributable impact" [S266]. **Trap:** No number at all.

E. Commercial awareness

Topical questions are a listed category in the Final Stage interview [S263]. Use the pattern: the story in one line, the mechanism, the effect on Deloitte, your view.

Q33. "Tell me about something in the news and how it will affect Deloitte." (Reported [S264])

Tests: Whether you follow business news and can link it to the firm. **Structure:** The story in one line; the mechanism; the effect on Deloitte's revenue, people or risk; your view. **Weave in:** Deloitte won a Home Office data contract worth up to £200m despite the government's pledge to cut consultancy spend [S233]. **Trap:** A story you cannot connect to Deloitte.

Q34. "Deloitte grew revenue 2% but distributable profit 14% in FY26. What does that tell you?" (Practice [S407])

Tests: Basic financial reasoning. **Structure:** Margin rose. Possible drivers: pricing, mix, cost control (voluntary redundancy in audit [S227]), efficiency from technology. Say what you would want to know next. **Weave in:** £5.81bn is UK and Switzerland consolidated; UK T&T was £1.75bn [S407]. **Trap:** Calling £5.81bn the UK-only figure.

Q35. "Globally Technology & Transformation grew slowest (2.5%), but in the UK it grew fastest (4%). Why?" (Practice [S300] [S407])

Tests: Hypothesis thinking. **Structure:** Offer two or three hypotheses and how you would test each. Do not claim to know. **Weave in:** ERP and cyber demand [S400]; public sector data work [S233]; regional technology centres [S323]. **Trap:** Stating one cause as fact.

Q36. "What does the creation of Deloitte EMEA mean for UK clients and for a graduate?" (Practice [S124])

Tests: Understanding of the firm's structure. **Structure:** What changed, why (pooled investment), what it could mean for clients, and what it could mean for you. **Weave in:** From 1 June 2026: 16 firms, 132,000 people, about €20bn revenue, over €1.5bn of investment over four years in GenAI, sovereign cloud and sector solutions [S124]. **Trap:** Implying the UK firm has disappeared. The UK firm still exists and has its own CEO [S407].

Q37. "The government says it wants to cut consultancy spend. Is that bad news for Deloitte?" (Practice [S233] [S334] [S335])

Tests: Balanced judgement. **Structure:** Both sides, then a view: less advice, more delivery and capability-building. **Weave in:** Public sector consulting hit a record £3.7bn in 2024/25 with Deloitte the top supplier [S335]; the NAO says government lacks consistent spend data [S334]. **Trap:** Cheerleading for consultants.

Q38. "Accenture and Deloitte are now about the same size. How do they differ?" (Practice [S129] [S120])

Tests: Competitor knowledge. **Structure:** Size, mix, ownership, constraints. **Weave in:** Accenture FY26 US\$74.18bn, half managed services, about 814,000 people, listed [S129]; Deloitte US\$74.5bn, partnership with audit and tax [S120]. **Trap:** Claiming Deloitte is the biggest on every measure.

F. Technology and AI

Expect at least one of these for a Technology & Transformation role. Plain-English explanations beat jargon.

Q39. "Explain an ERP implementation (or a cloud migration) to a non-technical client." (Practice [S269] [S270])

Tests: Communication. **Structure:** Analogy, then what changes for staff, then why these programmes go wrong (data quality, change management, scope). **Weave in:** UK T&T growth came partly from "ERP implementation" demand [S407]. ERP (enterprise resource planning) is the core software that runs finance, HR and supply chain. **Trap:** Jargon and acronyms.

Q40. "What cyber risk should every UK board worry about?" (Practice [S269])

Tests: Risk thinking. **Structure:** One risk, how it happens, the business impact, two actions. **Weave in:** Deloitte's Cyber team works on ransomware recovery, supply-chain security and resilience [S269]; 60% of CFOs named cyber-attacks a key risk in Q1 2026 [S225]. **Trap:** Describing technology with no business consequence.

Q41. "Your teammate used a generative AI tool to draft client content and did not check it. What do you do?" (Practice [S260] [S261])

Tests: Integrity and courage. **Structure:** Raise it privately first, check the content together, involve the manager if it has gone to the client. **Weave in:** The Australian refund [S316]; Hayley McKelvey's line on using AI "responsibly and strategically" [S226]. **Trap:** Ignoring it, or reporting before talking to your teammate.

Q42. "Will AI replace graduate consultants?" (Practice [S229] [S407])

Tests: A balanced view and your own place in it. **Structure:** What AI takes (first drafts, data work), what stays (judgement, client trust, change), how training is shifting. **Weave in:** Darren Graves: "the role our people play will matter more, not less" [S407]; Big Four firms moving trainees into judgement work earlier [S229]; CFOs name AI the second biggest dampener on graduate hiring after cost control [S224]. **Trap:** Either extreme: "nothing will change" or "we are all doomed".

Q43. "Only 11% of organisations have agentic AI in production. Why so few?" (Practice [S244])

Tests: Understanding of AI adoption. **Structure:** Define agentic AI (AI that takes actions, not only answers). Give the barriers: process redesign, data, risk and governance. **Weave in:** Tech Trends 2026 says the hard part is redesigning processes "agent-first" [S244]. **Trap:** Blaming the technology alone.

Q44. "Deloitte research found nearly a third of GenAI users use it without their employer knowing. What would you advise a client?" (Practice [S243])

Tests: Turning a finding into advice. **Structure:** The risk (data leakage), the cause (staff want tools), the fix (approved tools, policy, training). **Weave in:** Workers spend about £958m a year of their own money on GenAI for work; only 17% have in-house tools [S243]. **Trap:** Recommending a ban.

G. Deloitte-specific

Questions that only make sense at Deloitte. Getting these right separates you from candidates who prepared generically.

Q45. "What do you know about how Deloitte is structured?" (Practice [S407] [S302])

Tests: Basic firm knowledge. **Structure:** Network, then the UK firm, then the four businesses, then where your team sits. **Weave in:** Deloitte LLP is a member of Deloitte EMEA, which is a member of DTTL; "DTTL and Deloitte EMEA do not provide services to clients" [S407]. Advisory is T&T plus SR&T Advisory [S407]. **Trap:** Calling Deloitte one global company.

Q46. "Why hasn't Deloitte split audit from consulting, as EY tried to?" (Practice [S104] [S308] [S310])

Tests: Understanding of the business model. **Structure:** History, the argument for staying together, the costs, your view. **Weave in:** Deloitte dropped its own consulting spin-off in 2003 [S104]; Global CEO Joe Ucuzoglu said keeping the model was "not even a close call" [S308]; EY abandoned its split in April 2023 [S310]. **Trap:** Taking a side without the costs.

Q47. "What are personal independence rules and why do they matter to you?" (Practice [S261] [S314])

Tests: Whether you understand the audit link. **Structure:** Deloitte audits companies, so staff must not hold certain financial interests in audit clients. It also limits what consulting can sell to those clients. **Weave in:** "You will be required to clear Personal Independence checks before you join us" [S261]; non-audit fees for listed audit clients are capped at 70% of the average audit fee [S314]. **Trap:** Not knowing that Deloitte is also an auditor.

Q48. "What did you learn from the Deloitte Australia AI report case?" (Practice [S316])

Tests: Maturity on a sensitive topic. **Structure:** Facts in two sentences, the lesson (human checks, disclosure), what you would do as an analyst. **Weave in:** The refund was on an AU\$440,000 contract; the report contained fabricated citations [S316]. It was a separate member firm, but the story ran under the Deloitte name [S302]. **Trap:** Gloating, or pretending it did not happen.

H. Final-stage topic discussion follow-ups

The topic discussion is "two-way": the assessor asks questions throughout [S260]. These practice follow-ups test whether you can think on your feet. Prepare a short answer to each for your topic.

Q49. "What is the strongest argument against your view?" (Practice, built on the official format [S260])

Tests: Intellectual honesty. **Structure:** State the counter-argument fairly, say why you still hold your view, or say what would change it. **Weave in:** Use the counter-case evidence from your topic notes. **Trap:** Saying there isn't one.

Q50. "If you were advising the CFO, what would you tell them to do on Monday?" (Practice [S260])

Tests: Turning analysis into action. **Structure:** One action, one owner, one measure of success. **Weave in:** CFO priorities from the Deloitte CFO Survey [S224]. **Trap:** Another round of analysis.

Q51. "What evidence would change your mind?" (Practice [S260])

Tests: Scientific thinking. **Structure:** Name one data point and the threshold that would flip your view. **Weave in:** Point to a specific published number you used. **Trap:** "Nothing would."

Q52. "How would a firm like Deloitte help here, and how would it get paid?" (Practice [S260])

Tests: Commercial sense. **Structure:** The service, the team that sells it, the pricing model (time and materials, fixed fee or managed service). **Weave in:** Deloitte sells "Operate" managed services as well as projects [S120]. **Trap:** Forgetting that consulting is a business.

I. Curveballs

Unexpected questions test composure. Pause, structure, answer.

Q53. "Teach me something in two minutes." (Practice)

Tests: Clarity and structure. **Structure:** One idea, one analogy, one example, check understanding. **Weave in:** Choose something from your degree. **Trap:** Something too big to fit in two minutes.

Q54. "What is one weakness of Deloitte?" (Practice [S316] [S318] [S227])

Tests: Honesty and balance. **Structure:** One real weakness, why it exists, what the firm is doing about it. **Weave in:** Reputational spillover between member firms [S316]; FRC sanctions [S318]; low attrition led to audit voluntary redundancies [S227]. **Trap:** Refusing to name one, or naming one with venom.

Q55. "Should governments use consultants at all?" (Practice [S337] [S332] [S334])

Tests: Balanced judgement on a contested issue. **Structure:** The case for (skills, speed), the case against (cost, dependence), your conditions. **Weave in:** Test and Trace: about £1,000 a day per Deloitte consultant [S332]; The Big Con argues reliance weakens state capability [S337]; the NAO found 86% of survey respondents said consultants added value [S334]. **Trap:** One-sided either way.

Q56. "If you don't get this offer, what will you do?" (Practice [S260])

Tests: Resilience and real motivation. **Structure:** Learn from the feedback, build the skill, reapply. **Weave in:** Deloitte gives feedback after the final stage and lets you reapply next academic year [S260]. **Trap:** Naming a competitor as your plan B.

Questions to ask them

You will usually get a few minutes at the end of the interview. Ask one or two. Each question below shows you read primary material and want to understand the job. Pick the ones that fit the interviewer (Part 10).

Question	Source	Why it impresses
"T&T grew 4% in FY26, faster than the other UK businesses. Where inside T&T is that growth coming from: AI work, or core ERP and cyber?"	[S407] [S400]	Uses the right number for the right unit, and asks about the work you would do.
"Globally T&T grew slowest at 2.5%, but in the UK it grew fastest. What is the UK doing differently?"	[S300] [S407]	Compares two primary releases. Few candidates will have read both.
"With a Chief AI Officer now on the UK Executive, how has your own day-to-day work changed this year? What do you expect a graduate to do that AI does not?"	[S274] [S407]	Personal, current and about the real job. Interviewers like talking about their own work.
"What quality checks does your team use when generative AI helps produce a client deliverable?"	[S316] [S226]	Shows you understand the risk without raising the Australian case aggressively. Ask it neutrally.
"Deloitte EMEA launched on 1 June with over €1.5bn of planned investment. Do UK graduates see more cross-border work as a result?"	[S124]	Shows you follow structural news and think about what it means for juniors.
"Hammad Rafique moved from leading T&T in Financial Services to leading all of UK T&T in June. Has that changed which sectors new analysts get staffed on?"	[S274] [S275]	Names the leader of the business you are joining, correctly. Best for a manager or director.
"With the independence rules on audit clients, where does your team find most of its integrated, multi-business work?"	[S261] [S314]	Shows you understand the multidisciplinary model and its main constraint.
"How does staffing work for a graduate based in, say, Manchester or Belfast on national client work?"	[S271] [S323]	Practical and grounded in the 44% regional intake and the technology centres.
"The Shared Values include 'Collaborate for measurable impact'. How does your team measure impact on a typical engagement?"	[S266]	Turns a values statement into a real operating question.
"Darren Graves talks about reinventing the firm for the next generation. What has that meant for graduates in your team since June?"	[S273]	Links the new CEO's message to your own future. Best for a director or partner.

DON'T SAY THIS

Do not ask about salary, holidays or how fast you can be promoted in the interview. Do not name the video platform or quote paid prep sites as if they were inside knowledge; Deloitte distances itself from them [S260]. Do not use the old values list [S264].

PART 10

Who you will meet: interviewer and leadership briefing

No interviewers are named for you, so this part describes the types of people you will meet at each stage, how to pitch to each, how to adjust in the room, and a dated briefing on the leaders whose names you should recognise.

Interviewer types by stage

Stage	Who	Evidence	How to pitch
Application, Online Assessment	Nobody live. Automated eligibility check and scoring.	[S260] CONFIRMED	Accuracy and honesty. Answer ranking tasks as yourself.
Job Simulation	Recorded answers reviewed later by the recruitment team or assessors. Platform not named by Deloitte UK.	[S260] CONFIRMED ; vendor [S287] REPORTED	Imagine a busy manager watching many videos. Answer in the first 15 seconds, then give evidence.
Topic Discussion	An "assessor".	[S260] CONFIRMED	Two-way. Structure first, then depth on follow-ups. Defend a view; accept good challenge.
Skills and Motivation interview	A "senior person from your chosen service line".	[S264] REPORTED	Competency stories plus a clear "why this team".
Possible extra or older format	Senior managers, directors or partners.	[S286] [S289] REPORTED	Shorter, commercial, judgement-focused.

The early-careers recruitment team runs logistics; its staff give advice on the official page [S260]. Final-stage assessors are usually practitioners, often managers or senior managers, sometimes directors **INFERRED**. In Deloitte's grade structure a **manager** runs day-to-day project work, a **senior manager** runs larger workstreams and client relationships, and a **director** or **partner** owns the client relationship and sells the work **INFERRED**.

How to pitch to each type

RECRUITER OR ASSESSOR

Their question: does this candidate meet the criteria and show the capabilities?

Give them: clear STAR stories that are easy to score, the Shared Values in action, a calm manner.

Avoid: vague answers that leave them nothing to write down.

MANAGER OR SENIOR MANAGER

Their question: can I give this person work on Monday?

Give them: reliability, learning speed, Excel and PowerPoint basics, how you handle a deadline and feedback.

Avoid: grand strategy talk with no sign you can do the work.

DIRECTOR OR PARTNER

Their question: would I put this person in front of a client, and will they stay?

Give them: one sharp, defended view on the client market, real motivation, integrity.

Avoid: long answers. Lead with the point.

The pitches above are **INFERRED** from the stage evidence in [S260], [S264] and [S286]. They are general patterns, not Deloitte policy.

Reading the interviewer, and adjusting honestly

Adjusting to your interviewer is about relevance: giving the level of detail they need. It is not about pretending to be someone else or flattering them. Use these signals **INFERRED** :

Signal	What it probably means	Adjust by
Detailed follow-ups on how you did something	They are testing whether you can do the work.	Give steps, tools and numbers. Keep stories concrete.
Questions about clients, markets or "so what"	They think commercially, often a senior person.	Lead with your conclusion. Link to client value.
They interrupt or look at the clock	Your answer is too long.	Finish the sentence, give the result, stop.
They push back on your view	A test of judgement, not a sign you are failing.	Restate their point fairly, then hold or update with a reason.
They share their own experience	Rapport is building.	Ask one genuine follow-up question, then return to your answer.

DON'T DO THIS

Do not research interviewers' private lives or social media, or mention personal details about them. Do not mirror opinions you do not hold. If you learn your interviewer's name, it is fine to read their public Deloitte profile for their team and role, and nothing more.

Leaders to recognise

You do not need to drop names. You do need to recognise them if an interviewer mentions them, and not get them wrong. Public professional information only, as at 4 October 2026.

Name	Role, since	Career path facts	Source
Darren Graves	Senior Partner and Chief Executive, Deloitte UK, from 1 June 2026	Joined as a Business Tax graduate in 2001; moved to M&A Tax; partner in 2012; led UK Transactions Tax; from 2022 Managing Partner for North and South Europe Tax & Legal. Talks about "reinventing the firm for the next generation".	[S273] [S96] CONFIRMED
Jane Whitlock	Chair of the UK Board from 1 June 2026	Audit and assurance partner; former Midlands practice senior partner; has sat on the NSE board.	[S276] [S407] title CONFIRMED ; [S285] background REPORTED
Hammad Rafique	Managing Partner, Technology & Transformation, from 1 June 2026; UK Executive	Previously Head of Insurance Consulting, then from 2024 Head of T&T in Financial Services; 17 years at Accenture, reaching Managing Director. Succeeded Robert Cullen.	[S274] [S276] CONFIRMED ; career [S275] REPORTED
Dave Sharman	Managing Partner, Strategy, Risk & Transactions Advisory, from June 2026	Previously the UK firm's Chief Operating Officer.	[S274] [S276] CONFIRMED
Hayley McKelvey	Deloitte UK's first Chief AI Officer; UK Executive from 1 June 2026	Over 20 years in technology and transformation; previously Chief AI Officer for UK Tax & Legal. Remit covers AI "across client services and internal operations".	[S274] [S282] [S407] CONFIRMED

Name	Role, since	Career path facts	Source
Matt Batham	UK Managing Partner, People and Purpose, from October 2026	Long-serving international tax partner; was global People & Purpose leader for Tax & Legal. Predecessor Jackie Henry appears in 2026 early-careers releases.	[S281] [S271] [S280] CONFIRMED (very recent)
Richard Houston	CEO, Deloitte EMEA, from 1 June 2026	Led Deloitte UK and North and South Europe from 2019; joined Deloitte in 2002 after Arthur Andersen, RBS and HSBC.	[S273] [S124] CONFIRMED ; career [S297] REPORTED
Joe Ucuzoglu	Deloitte Global CEO	Previously Deloitte US CEO and US Audit & Assurance CEO; BS in Accounting, University of Southern California.	[S278] CONFIRMED
Debapratim (Debo) De	Deloitte UK Chief Economist from 1 June 2026	Succeeded Ian Stewart; writes the weekly Monday Briefing.	[S248] REPORTED

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

- **Joe Ucuzoglu's start date.** WS6 gives December 2022 from his profile [S278]; WS2 could not verify a date on a primary page [S73]. Say "Deloitte's Global CEO" without a date.
- **Hammad Rafique's previous title.** Consultancy.uk says Head of T&T in Financial Services [S275]; Deloitte's own release says UK Head of Financial Services [S274]. Say "previously led Financial Services work in T&T".
- **Richard Houston's and Jane Whitlock's career detail** came from search snippets, not fetched pages [S297] [S285].
- **Darren Graves's election.** Reported as uncontested [S290] [S97]; only the headline was seen. Do not raise it.
- **People and Purpose.** Matt Batham took over in October 2026 [S281]. If an interviewer mentions Jackie Henry, that is the predecessor.
- **Head of UK early careers or student recruitment.** No name found. Do not guess.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"I noticed Darren Graves joined as a tax graduate in 2001 and is now CEO [S273]. That kind of path is one reason I want to start at a firm that develops people from graduate level."

PART 11

The scenario playbook: frame method, ladder, composure set, CV grill

One answer protocol and one priority order that work on any scenario Deloitte puts in front of you, from the ranking items in the online assessment to a director pushing back in the final interview. Then the eight ways interviewers test whether your answer holds, how to keep your body calm, the 30-scenario ladder, five hard scenarios worked in full, and a drill for surviving a three-levels-deep grilling on your CV.

Why scenarios decide this process

Deloitte UK tests judgement at every stage of its early-careers process. The **Immersive Online Assessment** (stage 2) has a behavioural part built on "realistic workplace scenarios" where you rank possible actions from most to least likely [S350] **CONFIRMED**. The **Job Simulation** (stage 3) adds ranking, selecting responses, written answers and recorded video answers. Deloitte says "some scenarios may refer to workplace tools like AI" and that it is interested in "how you think and make decisions ..." and consider using AI responsibly in a professional setting, not your technical AI knowledge" [S350] **CONFIRMED**. The **Final Stage** skills and motivation interview, about 50 minutes, includes scenario-based questions according to TargetJobs [S260] [S263] **REPORTED**.

So the same skill is scored three times, in three formats: a click-to-rank screen, a 2-minute recording, and a live conversation where someone can push back. This Part gives you one method that works in all three. It has two pieces. A **protocol** tells you what to say, in what order, in about a minute. A **priority order** tells you which concern wins when two good things collide. Learn both until they are automatic, because Deloitte's own advice on the ranking tasks is to "go with your gut instinct" [S260] **CONFIRMED**. The aim of practice is to train your gut, not to game the test.

KEY TERMS

Scenario question: "What would you do if...?" It asks about a situation you have not met, so it tests judgement rather than memory. **Situational judgement test (SJT):** the written or on-screen version, where you rank or pick from given options. **Frame:** the logic that holds your answer together (what matters most and why). An interviewer "breaks the frame" when they push until you drop that logic. **Escalate:** pass a decision to someone more senior or to a specialist team, openly and early.

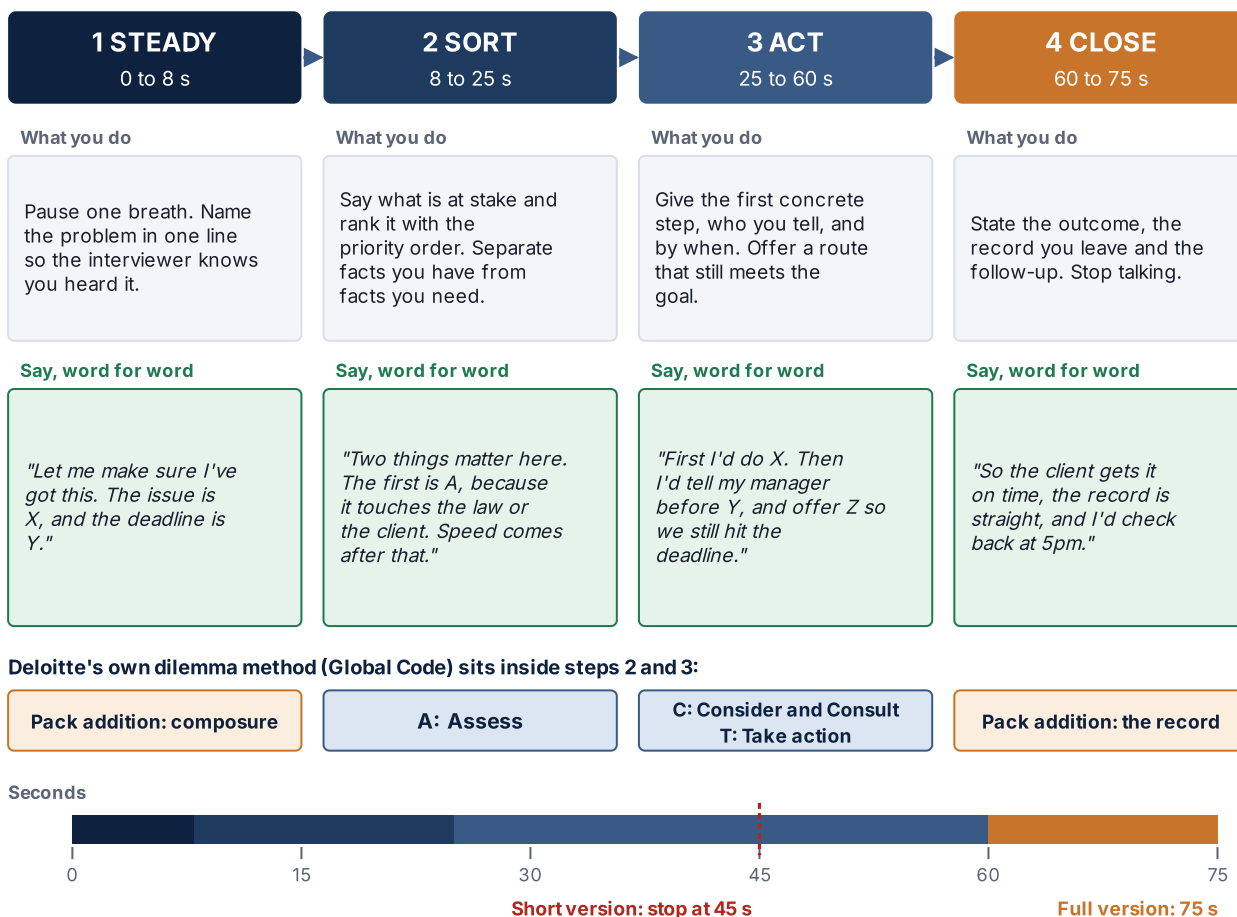
SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Deloitte does not publish how its ranking items are scored or which "capabilities" the final interview scores against [S260]. The timings below for video answers come from TargetJobs (30 seconds to 2 minutes) and a prep vendor (2 to 3 minutes, from a search summary only) [S263] [S288] **REPORTED**. The answer method in this Part is this pack's synthesis of Deloitte's own Code, the law it cites and standard interview practice **INFERRED**. It is a tool for thinking, not a leaked marking scheme.

The four-step answer protocol

Every scenario answer, spoken or written, follows four steps: **steady**, **sort**, **act**, **close**. A full spoken answer takes 45 to 75 seconds. That is long enough to show judgement and short enough to leave room for the follow-up, which is where most marks are won or lost **INFERRED**. In a recorded video answer with 2 to 3 minutes available, use the same four steps and spend the extra time in step 3, on the twist you expect next.

Figure 26 The four-step answer protocol



Source: Deloitte Global Principles of Business Conduct, October 2025, for the ACT method (Assess; Consider and Consult; Take action) [S340]; timing bands are this pack's guidance **INFERRED**, set against reported video answer lengths of 30 seconds to 3 minutes [S263] [S288]. Read: left to right is the order you speak in; the bar at the bottom shows roughly how long each step takes in a 75-second answer.

Step 1: Steady (about 0 to 8 seconds)

Take one slow breath out. Then repeat the problem back in one line. This does two jobs. It buys you thinking time without dead air, and it shows the interviewer you heard the actual question rather than the one you hoped for. If a fact is missing that changes the answer, ask one question now, not five.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"Let me make sure I've got this. The client wants the pack tonight, and the data in it isn't checked yet."

"Before I answer: is the client also a Deloitte audit client? That changes what I can do." (Use only when it really changes the answer.)

Step 2: Sort (about 8 to 25 seconds)

Say what is at stake, then rank it out loud using the priority order in the next section. Separate what you know from what you would need to find out. This is the step most candidates skip. They jump straight to action, which makes the answer sound like a reflex instead of a judgement. Deloitte's own Code tells its people to "consider all available information to assess the situation, use professional judgment, consult with relevant stakeholders as appropriate and, where necessary, take action" [S340] **CONFIRMED**. Step 2 is the "assess" part of that sentence.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"Two things matter here. The first is client confidentiality, because that's a legal and Code issue. The second is the deadline. The first one decides how I do it. The second decides how fast."

Step 3: Act (about 25 to 60 seconds)

Give the first concrete step, the person you tell and the time by which you tell them. Then give the route that still meets the goal. An answer that only says "I would refuse" or "I would escalate" scores badly because it stops the work **INFERRED**. Deloitte's Code calls its method **ACT**: Assess the situation, Consider and Consult, Take action. It adds: "Speaking up is taking action!" and "No one at Deloitte should have to navigate a difficult situation alone" [S340] **CONFIRMED**. So "I'd talk to my manager" is a proper action in Deloitte's own terms, as long as you also say what you would do meanwhile.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"First I'd do the analysis in the firm's approved tool, not a public one. Then I'd tell my manager before 6pm that one section rests on an assumption, and offer to firm it up by 10am."

Step 4: Close (about 60 to 75 seconds)

State the outcome, the record you leave behind and the follow-up. Then stop. Silence after a clean close is fine. The record matters because it is what protects you, your manager and the client later. The McKinsey opioid case ended with a former senior partner agreeing to plead guilty to obstruction for deleting files [S390] **CONFIRMED**. A junior does not need that level of drama to learn the point: write it down.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"So the client gets the pack on time, nothing confidential leaves the firm, and the email to my manager is the record. I'd check back at 5pm."

DON'T SAY THIS

"It depends." (Alone, it sounds like dodging. Say what it depends on, then answer both branches.) "I'd just do what the partner says." (Rank is not a reason.) "I'd report them straight to the regulator." (A junior escalates inside the firm first, unless the firm itself is the problem; Deloitte's Speak Up channel exists for that case [S340] [S343].) "I'd go above my manager's head immediately." (One level at a time, unless it is an ethics or legal matter [Inferred from S340].)

The priority order when good things collide

Most hard scenarios are not good against bad. They are two good things that cannot both win: the deadline and the check, the client's wish and the rule, your manager's request and the partner's. You need a fixed order, decided in advance, so you are not inventing your values under pressure. For this role the order is:

1. Law, independence and the firm's name.

2. The client's real interest and fair treatment of every stakeholder.
3. The process and the record (change control, documentation, accurate timesheets, approved tools).
4. Speed and convenience.

Each level beats every level below it. Within a level, use judgement. And when nothing above is at stake, speed wins: most of the job is simply getting good work done fast.

Figure 27 The priority order for collisions



Source: Deloitte Global Principles of Business Conduct, October 2025 [S340]; Shared Values [S342]; UK GDPR principles and fines [S353]; Bribery Act 2010 s.7 [S355]; Economic Crime and Corporate Transparency Act 2023 s.199 [S361] [S362]; UK MAR Arts 7, 10, 14 [S358] [S359] [S360]; FRC Revised Ethical Standard 2024 [S364]; ICAEW Code 2026 [S372]; Procurement Act 2023 s.82 [S367]; APM change control [S377]; Deloitte UK 2025 Transparency Report on approved GenAI tools [S345]; Deloitte on human accountability for AI [S347]. The ordering itself is this pack's synthesis **INFERRED**. Read: top to bottom is the order of precedence.

Why each level sits where it does

Level	The Deloitte and legal basis	What it means in a scenario
1. Law, independence, the firm's name	Shared Value "Serve with integrity": "Upholding that trust is our single most important responsibility" [S340] [S342]. Breaching the Code can lead to consequences "up to and including dismissal" [S340]. UK GDPR fines reach "£17.5 million, or 4% of your total worldwide annual turnover" [S353]. The Bribery Act makes a firm liable for an associated person's bribe unless it had "adequate procedures" [S355]. Since 1 September 2025 a large organisation can be guilty if an associate commits fraud intending to benefit it or its clients [S361] [S362]. UK MAR bans insider dealing and unlawful disclosure [S360]. The FRC Ethical Standard bars an audit firm from taking "a management role" at an audited entity [S364].	Confidential client data never leaves approved systems. No backdating, no inflated numbers, no tipping. If the client is a Deloitte audit client, you give options and the client's management decides. Anything in this band beats any deadline, any seniority and any client request. The firm's name sits here because one person's breach becomes the firm's breach: Deloitte Australia repaid part of a A\$440,000 fee after an AI-assisted report contained nonexistent references [S388].
2. The client's real interest and fair treatment	Code, integrity: "We are straightforward and honest in our professional opinions" and "truthful about ... the knowledge we possess, and the experience we have" [S340]. Objectivity: no "bias, conflict of interest, or undue influence" [S340]. ICAEW adds "undue reliance on ... technology" as an objectivity threat [S372]. Shared Values: "Foster inclusion" and "Take care of each other" [S342]. Procurement Act s.82: no supplier may get an "unfair advantage" [S367].	"The client" means the client organisation, not whichever executive is shouting. A sponsor who wants a red risk hidden from the board is asking you to act against the client's interest. Fair treatment covers the quiet stakeholders too: the remote worker left out of the workshop, the competing supplier in a procurement.
3. The process and the record	APM: change control is how requests to change the agreed baseline are "captured, evaluated and then approved, rejected or deferred" [S377]. Code: "We record hours worked timely and accurately" [S340]. Deloitte UK runs GenAI through "use-case approval" and a "clearing house" and gives staff secure internal tools [S345]. JD: "Using firm-approved AI tools responsibly" [S3]. "Accountability is squarely a human domain" [S347].	New asks go through change control, even small ones. Timesheets show the truth. AI goes through approved tools, and you check its output. The process exists so a large programme stays honest and so you can prove later what happened.
4. Speed and convenience	Shared Value "Collaborate for measurable impact": "tangible, measurable, attributable impact" [S342]. Clients pay for results on time.	Speed is a real value. But it only operates inside levels 1 to 3. One twist: speed of <i>escalation</i> belongs to level 1. Capita's containment was "not enacted for 58 hours" after an alert and it was fined £14m [S394]. Raise problems fast even when the fix will be slow.

THE ONE SENTENCE THAT HOLDS EVERY FRAME

"I'll keep it legal and honest first, do right by the client second, follow the process and leave a record third, and go as fast as those three allow."

Say it to yourself before every scenario. Say it aloud only if an interviewer asks how you make these calls in general.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Prompt: should the client's interest ever rank above the process? **For:** processes can be slow and a rigid junior can hurt a client by waiting for sign-off on something obvious. **Against:** the process exists because individuals under pressure misjudge the client's interest; change control protects the client from scope creep and surprise cost [S377]. **Suggested stance:** the client's interest ranks higher, which is why you raise a process that is hurting the client openly and fast. You do not quietly bypass it.

Ranking items: applying the order to multiple choice

In the Immersive Online Assessment you see a short workplace scenario and four or five possible actions. You rank them from the one you would most likely take to the one you would least likely take [S350] **CONFIRMED**. The Job Simulation includes the same kind of item, some about AI [S350]. Deloitte does not publish the scoring key. Typical SJT design, which this pack infers applies here, scores how close your order is to an expert order, so getting the top and bottom right matters most **INFERRED**.

The five-pass method

- 1. Bottom first.** Any option that breaches level 1 (shares confidential data, misstates facts, hides a problem, breaks a law) goes to the bottom. If two do, the one that does more harm, or is harder to undo, goes lowest.
- 2. Then the do-nothing options.** Ignoring the problem, or passing it on without a view, sits just above the breaches.
- 3. Top next.** The best option protects every level that is at stake and still moves the work forward. It usually involves acting and telling someone.
- 4. Middle by level.** Between two safe options, the one that serves a higher level ranks higher. If they serve the same level, prefer the one that consults at the right level and leaves a record.
- 5. Gut check.** Read your order top to bottom. Would you be comfortable explaining it to the partner and to the client? If not, swap.

PRACTICE ITEM (INVENTED, NOT A REAL DELOITTE QUESTION)

You are two weeks into a cloud migration project. At 6pm your manager asks for a two-page summary of 40 client staff interview transcripts by 9am. The transcripts include staff names and frank comments about their managers. A fellow analyst says: "Paste them into a free chatbot. Ten minutes, done." You have access to the firm's approved AI tool. Rank these actions.

Rank	Option	Reasoning using the priority order
1	C. Check the engagement has no restriction on AI use, draft in the firm's approved tool, verify every claim against the transcripts, and note in your covering email that it was AI-assisted.	Protects level 1 (data stays inside approved systems [S340] [S345]), level 2 (accurate content, disclosed method), level 3 (approved tool, a record) and level 4 (on time). Deloitte Australia's refund shows why verification and disclosure matter [S388].
2	D. Work through the night by hand and deliver at 9am without telling anyone how long it took.	Safe on levels 1 to 3 and on time. Loses marks because it is silent and unsustainable; "Take care of each other" applies to yourself too [S342]. Some experts might swap D and E.
3	E. Tell your manager at 6pm you cannot do it by 9am and ask for a new deadline.	Honest and safe, but gives up on the client's deadline without trying a compliant route.
4	B. Delete the names, then paste the transcripts into the free chatbot.	Still sends confidential client information outside the firm without permission [S340]. Removing names reduces personal-data risk but the comments may still identify people. A level 1 breach, slightly less harmful than A.
5	A. Paste the full transcripts into the free chatbot, then check the summary carefully.	Discloses named personal data and confidential client material outside the firm [S340] [S353]. Checking afterwards does not undo the disclosure. Bottom.

DON'T DO THIS

Don't use AI, a friend or a paid "insights" site during the assessment. Deloitte's rules say online assessments "must be completed independently and without AI assistance", that you record an integrity statement first, and that a breach means removal from the process [S351] **CONFIRMED**. Inside the firm, using GenAI in assessments "constitutes gross misconduct" [S345].

Eight ways interviewers break a frame

A live interviewer listens to your first answer and then tests whether it holds. Deloitte's own recruiters say assessors "are not trying to trip you up or trick you" [S260] **CONFIRMED**, so read the moves below as probes rather than hostility. Most are the natural follow-ups a manager would ask if you gave that answer at work. Your job is to stay in the frame: keep the same priority order, change your plan only if new facts justify it, and stay pleasant.

Figure 28 Eight frame-breaking tactics and the counter to each**1. Interruption**

What it looks like

They cut in mid-answer with a new question.

Counter*"Happy to come to that. One sentence to finish the point that changes the answer, then I'm yours."***2. Flat contradiction**

What it looks like

"That's wrong." No reason given.

Counter*"You may be right. What would change my mind is X. On what I know now, I'd still do Y, because Z."***3. Silence**

What it looks like

You finish. They say nothing and keep looking at you.

Counter*Count three seconds. Then: "That's my answer. Would it help if I went deeper on the escalation step?"***4. Escalation**

What it looks like

"Now the partner insists." The stakes rise each round.

Counter*"Then it isn't my call alone. I'd take it one level up, to the engagement lead or Risk, and tell the partner I'm doing so."***5. Authority squeeze**

What it looks like

"I'm the director. Just do it."

Counter*"I want to help you hit this. I can't do it that way, but I can do this instead, by 6pm."***6. False choice**

What it looks like

"So: miss the deadline or break the rule. Which?"

Counter*"Neither, if I raise it now. The third option is to deliver the safe part on time and flag the rest."***7. Knowledge trap**

What it looks like

A detail you cannot know: "What does Article 7 say?"

Counter*"I don't know the text by heart. The principle is don't trade or tip on price-sensitive news, and I'd check with Risk."***8. Invitation to badmouth**

What it looks like

"Your old manager sounds useless."

Counter*"I learnt a lot there. What I'd do differently myself is X." Then move on.*

Source: this pack's synthesis of standard interview practice **INFERRED**; the escalation counter follows Deloitte's Code, which encourages people to consult "team leaders or others in their chain of command, Ethics, or Talent/HR" **[S340]**; the knowledge-trap counter follows the Code's integrity rule on being truthful about "the knowledge we possess" **[S340]**; UK MAR Art 7 **[S358]**. Read: each card shows the move and the exact line that holds your frame.

Tactic	What they are really testing	How to hold, and what not to do
1. Interruption	Can you stay organised when your structure is broken? Do you get flustered or defensive?	Finish one sentence at most, then go where they lead. Do not restart your whole answer later. If the interruption was the more important question, say so: "Good point, that's the bigger issue."
2. Flat contradiction	Do you cave the moment a senior person disagrees? Or do you dig in without listening?	Name what evidence would change your view, then keep your view if that evidence is absent. Caving loses the frame; arguing loses the room. Integrity in the Code means "straightforward and honest in our professional opinions" [S340] .
3. Silence	Will you fill the gap by retracting, over-explaining or adding a worse idea?	Silence is not a signal you were wrong. Count three seconds, then offer to go deeper on one part. Never add "or I suppose I could just do what they asked".
4. Escalation	Does your answer survive higher stakes and more senior pressure?	The higher the stakes, the higher the person you consult, not the faster you give in. Deloitte's Code says retaliation against those who raise concerns "is not tolerated" [S340] .

Tactic	What they are really testing	How to hold, and what not to do
5. Authority squeeze	Will rank alone change your answer?	Separate the goal from the method. Agree to the goal, decline the method, offer an alternative with a time. Seniority changes who decides, not what the law says.
6. False choice	Can you see a third option under pressure?	There is almost always a third route: deliver part on time, flag the rest, raise it early. Name it. If there truly is no third route, choose by the priority order and say so.
7. Knowledge trap	Will you bluff?	Say you do not know the detail, state the principle you do know, and say who you would check with. Bluffing about law in an interview is exactly the behaviour they fear on a client site.
8. Invitation to badmouth	Will you blame others, and will you talk about people behind their backs?	Decline the bait warmly. Talk only about what you did and would do differently. The Code applies to behaviour "both inside and outside of the Deloitte workplace" [S340], and assessors read badmouthing as a preview of how you will talk about clients.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

When you genuinely change your mind after a push: "That's a fair point I hadn't weighed. With that fact, I'd change step two to X. The rest stays the same." Changing a step because of a new fact is judgement. Changing your values because of a frown is losing the frame.

Staying calm physically: what the evidence supports

A frame holds only if your body lets your working memory work. Three techniques have peer-reviewed evidence behind them. None is magic, and each study tested something slightly different from a Deloitte interview, so each comes with a caveat.

Technique	What the study found	How to use it	Caveat
Cyclic sighing (exhale-focused breathing)	Balban et al. 2023, <i>Cell Reports Medicine</i> : a one-month randomised study of 5-minute daily practices. Cyclic sighing gave more improvement in mood and a bigger drop in breathing rate than mindfulness meditation ($p < 0.05$) [S385] CONFIRMED .	Practise 5 minutes a day in the weeks before. On the day, do a few rounds in the waiting room: a full breath in through the nose, a short second top-up breath, then a long slow breath out through the mouth.	The study measured daily practice over a month, not one breath before an interview. One author disclosed an advisory role with WHOOP [S385]. A few slow exhales are low cost and low risk INFERRED .
Reappraise anxiety as excitement	Brooks 2014, <i>Journal of Experimental Psychology: General</i> : people who reappraised anxiety as excitement "feel more excited and perform better" than those who tried to calm down, across singing, public speaking and maths tasks. Saying "I am excited" out loud worked [S384] CONFIRMED . Jamieson et al. 2010: students told that arousal improves performance did better on GRE maths, including on the real test 1 to 3 months later [S386] CONFIRMED .	Do not tell yourself to calm down. Say "I'm excited" quietly before you go in. Treat a racing heart as fuel. Both states are high arousal, so relabelling is easier than switching off [S384].	Lab and test settings, mostly with students. Effects are modest. It helps performance; it does not make the feeling disappear.
Expressive writing	Ramirez and Beilock 2011, <i>Science</i> : a brief exercise writing about worries just before an exam "significantly improved students' exam scores, especially for students habitually anxious about test taking" [S387] CONFIRMED . Park, Ramirez and Beilock 2014 found a similar effect for maths anxiety [S395].	About 10 minutes before you leave, or the night before: write freely about what you fear will go wrong in the interview. Then put it away.	Classroom exams, not interviews. <i>Science</i> published an erratum in 2014 [S387]. Best evidence is for people who are habitually anxious.

THE COMPOSURE ROUTINE ON THE DAY [INFERRED, BUILT ON S384, S385, S387]

1. **That morning:** 10 minutes of expressive writing about your worries. Bin the page.
2. **In the waiting room:** three to five cyclic sighs. Then say "I'm excited" quietly to yourself.
3. **In the room:** use the four-step protocol. A fixed structure means your working memory goes on the content, not on organising it.
4. **When pushed:** breathe out before you answer. One exhale is your "steady" step.

The scenario ladder: every JD duty line, three rungs

The ladder turns each of the ten duty lines in the Technology Strategy & Transformation graduate job description (D1 to D10, decoded in Part 1) into three practice scenarios of rising difficulty [S2] [S3]. The **easy** rung is a craft task: can you do the work well? The **medium** rung adds a stakeholder pulling against you. The **hard** rung puts an ethical or legal line in play, so the priority order decides the answer. The full 30 cards follow this section, in the same order as the grid.

Figure 29 The scenario ladder: every JD duty line, three rungs

JD duty line	Rung 1: EASY	Rung 2: MEDIUM	Rung 3: HARD
D1 Senior client engagement	First call with the CIO	Director doubts your experience	Client wants the bad news buried
D2 IT operating model	Explain IT as business partner	IT head resists the new model	Two sponsors, two operating models
D3 Digital core and landscape	Map the application landscape	Vendor already chosen before analysis	Legacy system nobody understands
D4 Business case and value	Sense-check a benefits number	Benefits that do not add up	Partner wants a bigger number
D5 Net zero and inclusion	Add carbon to the case	Workshop excludes remote colleagues	Green claim without evidence
D6 Transformation delivery (PMO)	Update the RAID log	Status report turning amber	Go-live with a known defect
D7 Requirements	Run a requirements interview	Business and IT disagree	Scope creep from a senior user
D8 Documents and client materials	Tighten a slide for tomorrow	Typo found after sending	Pack contradicts the client's data
D9 Firm-approved AI tools	Which AI tool to use	Colleague pastes data into ChatGPT	AI draft cites a fake source
D10 Teaming across T&T	Hand-off to the delivery centre	Alliance partner oversells the client	Two practices, one client, conflict

Difficulty rises left to right: easy = a craft task, medium = a stakeholder pulls against you, hard = an ethical or legal line is in play.

Source: duty lines from the Deloitte UK Technology Strategy Consulting graduate posting (Belfast, ref 25060) [S2] and its sister placement posting for D9 [S3]; scenario titles are this pack's practice scenarios **INFERRED**, not reported Deloitte questions. Read: pick a row, work left to right; do not move to the hard rung until you can do the easy one in under 75 seconds.

HOW TO PRACTISE THE LADDER

Practise one row per day for ten days. Say each answer aloud, timed, using the four steps. Then have a friend play the interviewer and use two of the eight tactics on your hard-rung answer. Record yourself once a week; the Job Simulation is recorded, so you need to be comfortable talking to a camera [S260].

The composure set: five hard role-specific scenarios

These five are the scenarios where candidates most often lose the frame, because each pits a senior person, a deadline or their own pride against the priority order. Each card gives the setup, the trap, the answer, why it works, the twist an interviewer will add, and a decision tree. Figure 30 draws the trees for the two highest-stakes cards. The other three trees are written out in the cards.

Composure set 1 · Two seniors, one deadline

HARD**SETUP**

It is 1pm. The engagement partner asks you for a cut of the cost baseline for a 5pm call with the client CFO. Ten minutes later the client's IT director, whom you sit next to on site, asks you to rebuild the application inventory for her 5pm meeting with her own boss. Each task is about four hours. Your manager is on leave today.

THE TRAP

Saying yes to both and failing one at 4.55pm. Or picking by rank ("the partner wins") without telling the other person. Or picking by proximity (the client is sitting next to you).

WHAT TO SAY

"I can't do both properly by 5. Both matter, so I wouldn't choose silently. I'd tell both of them now, within ten minutes, and ask whoever owns my priorities on this engagement to decide. With my manager away, that's the engagement lead. While I wait, I'd start the piece that is client-facing at board level, the CFO call, and I'd tell the IT director what I can give her by 5: a cleaned version of the existing inventory with the gaps marked. Then I'd confirm the decision in a two-line email."

WHY IT WORKS

It applies the order: nothing in level 1 is at stake, so the call is level 2 (the client's interest), then level 3 (the record), then speed. It follows the Code's encouragement to consult "others in their chain of command" rather than deciding alone [S340]. It respects the idea that one person is accountable for a decision, as in a RACI matrix [S379]. It offers a partial delivery instead of a silent miss, which is "Collaborate for measurable impact" in practice [S342].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Both of them say: don't bother anyone, just do mine." Hold: "I understand. I'll give you an honest time instead of a hopeful one. I'd rather tell you now that 5pm isn't possible for both than tell you at 4.55." Then you still tell the engagement lead, because a missed client deadline is their risk too.

DECISION TREE

Can both be done well by the deadline? **Yes:** do both, confirm times. **No:** tell both people now. Then: is there an owner of your priorities you can reach? **Yes:** they decide; start the more client-critical task meanwhile. **No:** choose by the priority order (legal or board-facing first), offer the other person a partial deliverable with a time, and write it down.

Composure set 2 · Asked to skip a control

HARD**SETUP**

It is 7pm before a steering committee. A director on your team says: "The firm's AI tool is too slow. Paste the client's survey export into ChatGPT, get me the themes, and we're done by eight." The export contains client employees' names and comments. Variants an interviewer may use instead: "Backdate

your timesheet so last week's hours go on the new code", or "Skip the conflict check, we start on Monday regardless".

THE TRAP

Complying because a director asked. Or refusing with a lecture and no alternative, which leaves the director stranded and makes you look rigid.

WHAT TO SAY

"I want to get you those themes tonight. I can't put client data into a public tool, because that's disclosing it outside the firm. What I can do is run it in our approved tool or theme it by hand from the top 200 comments, and you'll have it by 8.30. If 8.30 is too late, I'll tell the engagement partner now so the timing risk isn't on you alone."

WHY IT WORKS

Deloitte's Code prohibits "disclosure of confidential and personal information entrusted to us unless granted permission" [S340]. The JD itself specifies "firm-approved AI tools" [S3]. Deloitte UK runs GenAI through use-case approval and gives staff secure tools that analyse confidential data "within its secure digital ecosystem" [S345]. Personal data brings UK GDPR, whose principles include integrity and confidentiality [S353]. For the timesheet variant, the Code says "We record hours worked timely and accurately" [S340], and since September 2025 a firm can be criminally liable if an associate commits fraud intended to benefit it or its client [S361] [S362]. For the conflict-check variant, Deloitte UK says "all proposed engagements ... go through a conflict check before they are accepted" [S345].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Everyone does it. I'm the director and I'm telling you to." Hold: "I believe you that it's common. I still can't do it, and I'd rather be the person who got you a slightly later answer than the person who caused a data incident on your engagement. Do you want me to raise it with the partner, or shall I just crack on with the approved route?" If the pressure continues, the Code's route is to consult the chain of command or Ethics, and retaliation for raising concerns "is not tolerated" [S340].

DECISION TREE

See Figure 30, tree A.

Composure set 3 · Overheard deal talk

HARD

SETUP

You are queuing for coffee near the office. Two people you recognise from another Deloitte team are discussing, fairly loudly, a "Project Falcon" and that a FTSE 250 company you know is "being bought at a big premium next month". You are not on that work. A friend who works in finance is texting you about shares that evening.

THE TRAP

Treating it as gossip. Telling your friend "I can't say, but I wouldn't sell". Trading yourself. Or pretending you heard nothing and doing nothing.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd assume it could be inside information, so I wouldn't trade, tip or repeat it to anyone, including friends. I'd tell my manager or the Risk or Ethics team, briefly, what I heard, where and when, because a leak in a public place is something the firm needs to know about, and they may need to manage it. I wouldn't confront the colleagues myself or try to judge whether it was price-sensitive. That's Risk's call."

WHY IT WORKS

UK MAR defines inside information as "information of a precise nature, which has not been made public ... which, if it were made public, would be likely to have a significant effect on the prices" [S358]. It bans insider dealing, recommending it, and unlawful disclosure [S360]. Disclosure is lawful only "in the normal exercise of an employment, a profession or duties" [S359], so need-to-know sharing inside the engagement team is fine; telling a friend is not. Deloitte's Code prohibits "the use of confidential

information about our clients for personal advantage or for the benefit of third parties" [S340] and asks everyone to report suspected noncompliance whoever is involved [S340].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Your friend says: just tell me if I should hold or sell." Hold: "I can't talk about clients, and please don't ask me about shares." Even a hint is a recommendation. *"The colleagues are senior. Won't reporting them damage your career?"* Hold: "The Code says retaliation isn't tolerated [S340]. And I'm not accusing anyone. I'm reporting a risk so the firm can deal with it."

DECISION TREE

See Figure 30, tree B.

Composure set 4 · Your AI-assisted figure was wrong

HARD

SETUP

Yesterday your team sent a client a benefits analysis. You built one section with help from the firm's approved AI tool. This morning you notice the tool had combined two years of savings into one, so a headline figure is overstated by about a third. The client has not mentioned it. Your manager is in back-to-back meetings.

THE TRAP

Quietly fixing the file and hoping. Blaming the tool. Or panicking and emailing the client directly before telling your team.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd message my manager now, short and factual: the figure, the correct figure, how it happened, and that it's my section. I'd suggest a correction note to the client today, with the corrected page. While they decide, I'd re-check every other number I produced with the tool, so we only correct once. Afterwards I'd add a step to my own checklist: any AI-assisted number gets traced back to its source before it leaves my hands."

WHY IT WORKS

Deloitte's own guidance says "an AI model cannot be meaningfully held accountable for its outputs, accountability is squarely a human domain" [S347]. The Code's integrity rule and duty to report apply [S340]. The ICAEW Code names "undue reliance on ... technology" as a threat to objectivity [S372]. And the firm has lived this: Deloitte Australia agreed to repay part of a A\$440,000 fee after an AI-assisted government report was found to contain nonexistent references and an erroneous summary of a court case [S388] **CONFIRMED**.

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Your manager says: nobody will notice, just fix it in the next version." Hold: "I'd rather the client hears it from us today than finds it at their board. If the decision is to correct it in the next version, I'd want that decision written down and the client told the figure is being revised." That keeps level 2 (the client's real interest) above level 4 (convenience).

DECISION TREE

Has the wrong figure left the firm? **No**: fix it, tell your manager, check related numbers. **Yes**: tell your manager now. Then: could the client act on it before a correction? **Yes**: push for a same-day correction note. **No**: agree a correction route and date, in writing. In every branch: never fix silently, never blame the tool, re-check everything else you touched.

Composure set 5 · Deadline with half the data

HARD

SETUP

A steering committee pack is due to the client at 9am. One input, the licence costs from the client's procurement team, has not arrived. Without it, the total cost of the preferred option could be out by 10 to 20 per cent. It is 10pm, and procurement are not answering.

THE TRAP

Guessing the number and presenting it as fact. Or holding the whole pack back, so the committee meets with nothing.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd deliver on time with what's solid and make the gap impossible to miss. I'd use last year's licence figure as a labelled assumption, show the total as a range, and put a line on the summary slide saying which number is provisional and when it'll be firm. I'd tell my manager tonight, so they aren't surprised in the meeting, and I'd log it as an assumption and a dependency in the RAID log. First thing tomorrow I'd chase procurement through the client's programme lead."

WHY IT WORKS

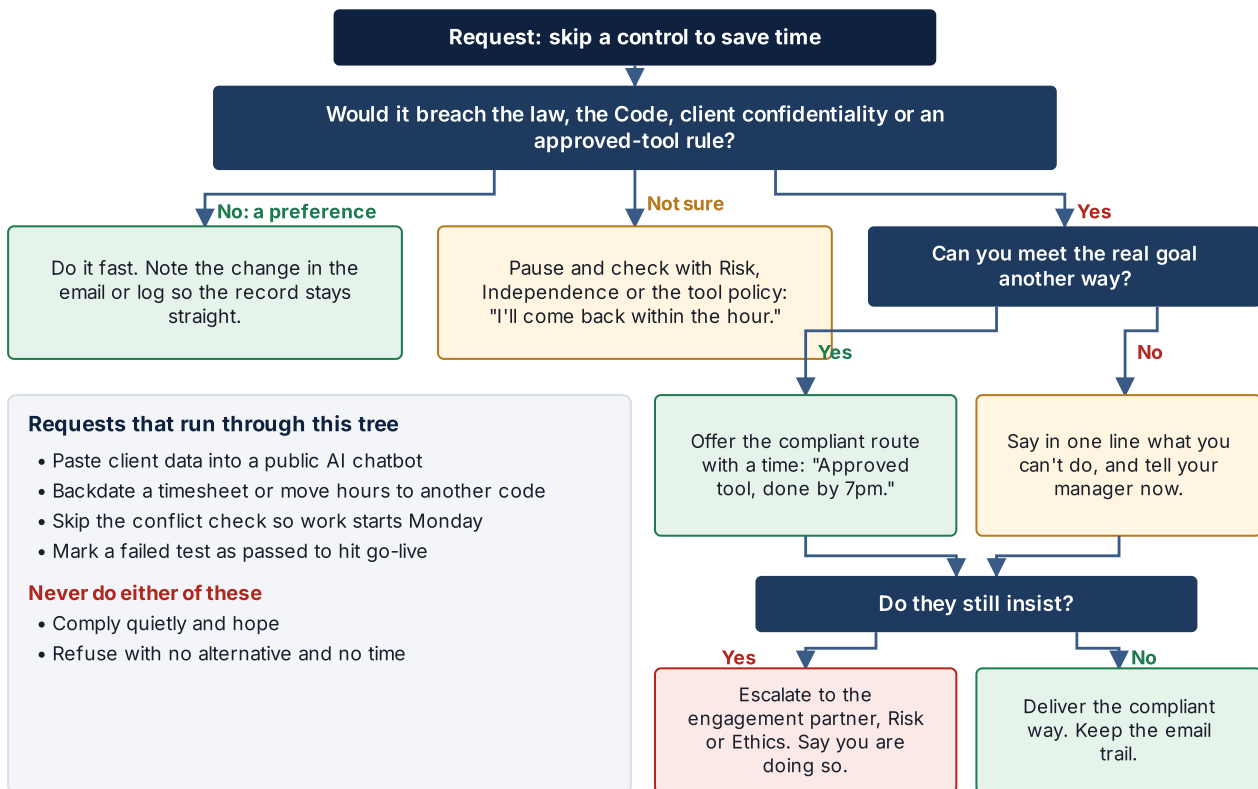
The Code asks for being "straightforward and honest in our professional opinions" [S340]: a clearly labelled assumption is honest, a silent guess is not. Representing an estimate as fact to win the next phase could even become a fraud risk [S361]. A RAID log (risks, assumptions, issues, dependencies) exists for exactly this, and APM notes that issues can turn into change requests [S377]. The pyramid principle, leading with the answer and then the support, still works with a range [S374].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"The client sponsor says: the board hates ranges, give me one number." Hold: "I can give you one central number on the slide, with the range and the assumption in a footnote. If the board asks, you'll have the answer ready." You give the sponsor what they need without hiding the uncertainty from the board.

DECISION TREE

Can you get the missing fact before the deadline? **Yes:** get it. **No:** would the gap change the recommendation? **Yes:** tell your manager tonight and agree whether to delay that one decision, not the whole pack. **No:** deliver on time with a labelled assumption and a range, log it, and chase the fact in the morning.

Figure 30 Two decision trees for the composure set**A. A senior person asks you to skip a control****B. You overhear what may be inside information**

Source: Deloitte Global Principles of Business Conduct, October 2025 (confidentiality, hours, consultation, non-retaliation) [S340]; Deloitte UK 2025 Transparency Report (approved GenAI tools, conflict checks) [S345]; JD duty "firm-approved AI tools" [S3]; UK MAR Arts 7, 10 and 14 [S358] [S359] [S360]. The tree structure is this pack's synthesis **INFERRED**; it is not Deloitte's internal procedure, which is not public. Read: start at the dark box at the top of each tree and follow the arrows; green boxes end the problem, amber boxes mean check before acting, red boxes mean stop or escalate.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Deloitte UK's own code of conduct, its insider-list procedures and its GenAI-with-client-data policy are not public [S340] [S345]. The trees use the public Global Code, the Transparency Report and the law. On day one, your induction will give you the firm's real procedures; follow those where they differ.

The CV grill: holding your ground three levels deep

The skills and motivation interview will include "tell me about a time" questions and probably "run me through your CV" [S260] [S289]. A good interviewer does not stop at your first answer. They dig three levels deep on one line of your CV, and the frame you have to hold is simple: **every level must match the one above it**. If your first sentence inflates, the third level will find it.

LEVEL 1: THE CLAIM

"Tell me about your role as society treasurer." They hear your headline and pick the word that sounds biggest ("led", "transformed", "managed").

LEVEL 2: THE MECHANISM

"How exactly did you do that? Why that approach?" They test whether you did it or watched it, and whether you understood why it worked.

LEVEL 3: THE PROOF AND THE COUNTERFACTUAL

"How do you know it was you? What would have happened without you? What did it cost?" They test honesty and self-awareness.

Prospects, the UK careers service, recommends the STARR structure (situation, task, action, result, reflection), "five to eight STARR examples", and a focus on "what you specifically did and decided", with tangible outcomes [S382] **CONFIRMED**. Deloitte's Code adds the integrity rule that governs the whole grill: "We are truthful about ... the knowledge we possess, and the experience we have" [S340]. In Deloitte's terms, claiming more than you did is an integrity question.

Eight attacks and the answers that hold

The attack	What it tests	A frame-holding answer (adapt, never invent)
1. "What did YOU do?"	Whether "we" hides a passenger.	"Three things were mine. I built the tracker, I ran the weekly check-in, and I wrote the final report. The design was the team's." Count your actions on your fingers; specific verbs beat adjectives.
2. "So what was the result, in numbers?"	Commercial instinct and honesty about measurement.	Give the number and how you know it. If nothing was measured, say so and give the honest proxy: "We didn't track hours saved. What I can tell you is the reimbursement backlog went from 30 claims to zero in a term."
3. "What would you do differently?"	Reflection, the second R in STARR [S382].	One specific change, why, and evidence you have since done it: "I'd have tested it with users first. I did that on my next project and it saved a rewrite." Never "nothing", never a fake weakness.
4. "That sounds like your team's work."	Whether you inflate under pressure or fold.	"It was a team result, and I'm proud of the team. My part was X, and the evidence is Y: the file history, the minutes, my supervisor's reference." Agree with the true part; hold the true claim.
5. "Why should I believe that?"	Composure when your honesty is questioned.	Stay warm. Offer a detail only the doer would know ("the hardest bit was that the bank export split names across two columns") and a way to verify it. Do not get defensive; it is a fair question.
6. "Isn't that just X?" (admin, a bar job, a society role)	Whether you can translate ordinary experience into the job.	"On paper, yes. What made it relevant to consulting was one thing: I had to get a decision from people who didn't report to me." Then link to a JD duty line, for example D1 rapport or D6 status reporting [S2].
7. "What were you doing in this gap?"	Honesty and self-possession, not the gap itself.	True, short, no apology spiral: what happened, what you did in it, what you are ready for now. You can explain extenuating circumstances on the application form [S260].

The attack	What it tests	A frame-holding answer (adapt, never invent)
8. "Why that grade?"	Ownership without excuses. Graduate entry typically requires a 2:1 [S350] .	State the fact, give the cause in one sentence without blame, say what changed, then give current evidence: "My first-year maths mark was low because I under-prepared for exams. I changed how I revise and my second-year mark in the same area was 68."

DON'T SAY THIS

"I basically ran the whole thing." (Level 2 will ask how, level 3 will ask who else was there.) "My team let me down." (Tactic 8 in disguise.) "I can't remember the numbers." (Prepare them; see the drill below.) "We used ChatGPT to write it." (Fine to mention honestly if relevant, but then expect "how did you check it?" and have an answer [\[S347\]](#).)

The four-line drill for every CV bullet

Before any interview, take every bullet on your CV and write four lines under it. If you cannot fill all four, either cut the bullet or go and find the evidence. This is how you survive level 3.

1. **Claim:** the one sentence you would say first, with an honest verb (built, ran, wrote, fixed, persuaded).
2. **Evidence:** what proves it, and who could confirm it (a file, minutes, a reference, a link).
3. **Number:** the one figure that shows scale or result, and how you know it. If none, the honest proxy.
4. **Lesson:** what you would do differently, and where you have since applied it.

CV bullet	Claim	Evidence (and who confirms)	Number (and how you know)	Lesson
<i>Practice example (invented): treasurer, university hiking society</i>	<i>I moved the society's budget from paper to a shared spreadsheet.</i>	<i>The spreadsheet's version history; committee minutes approving it; the society president.</i>	<i>Reimbursement time down from about three weeks to one, from the claims log dates.</i>	<i>I'd have asked members first; two committee members kept using paper for a month.</i>

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

When an attack lands and you need a second: "That's a fair challenge. Let me be precise about what was mine." It is the CV version of step 1 of the protocol: steady, then sort.

ONE-PAGE SUMMARY OF THIS PART

- **Protocol:** steady, sort, act, close. 45 to 75 seconds. Deloitte's ACT method (Assess; Consider and Consult; Take action) sits inside it [\[S340\]](#).
- **Priority order:** law, independence and the firm's name; the client's real interest and fairness; the process and the record; speed. "Legal and honest first, the client second, process and record third, as fast as those allow."
- **Ranking items:** bottom first (breaches), then do-nothing options, then the top (protects everything at stake and moves the work), then the middle by level.
- **Frame-breakers:** change a step for a new fact, never your values for a frown.
- **Composure:** write out worries, sigh out slowly, call it excitement [\[S384\]](#) [\[S385\]](#) [\[S387\]](#).
- **CV grill:** Claim, Evidence, Number, Lesson for every bullet.

PART 11 CONTINUED

Scenario cards: three rungs for every duty line

Thirty worked scenarios, one easy, one medium and one hard for each of the ten duty lines in the JD. Each card shows the trap, a scaffold answer in your own voice, the rule that makes it right, and the follow-up that tests whether you hold.

Every card uses the four-step protocol from the first half of this Part. **Steady**: pause, acknowledge, check the facts. **Sort**: rank what is at stake. **Act**: say the concrete next step, usually with a named person. **Close**: confirm, record, follow up. The ranking in the Sort step never changes:

THE PRIORITY ORDER USED ON EVERY CARD

1. Law, independence and the firm's name > 2. The client's real interest and fair treatment of people > 3. Process and an honest record > 4. Speed. When two pull against each other, the higher one wins. Deloitte's own dilemma method says it in three words, ACT: Assess, Consider and Consult, Take action, and adds "Speaking up is taking action!" [S340] **CONFIRMED**.

Scenarios are illustrative, written for a first-year Analyst in Technology Strategy & Transformation (TST). Clients are generic on purpose. Numbers inside setups are invented for the exercise; every rule cited under "Why it works" is sourced.

D1 • Senior client engagement and rapport

The duty: "We work with their most senior leaders and top-level executives", and you will learn "How to build rapport with clients and ensure they have confidence in your capability" [S2].

D1 • Rung 1: First call with the CIO

EASY

SETUP

Three weeks into an IT operating model review for a UK retailer, your manager messages from a delayed train: "Five minutes late, can you open the call with the CIO?" (Chief Information Officer, the top technology executive). You have never met her.

THE TRAP

Filling time with improvised opinions, or apologising so much that you waste a senior person's time.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: re-read the call objective. **Sort**: her time matters most; my job is to start well, not run the content. **Act**: "Good morning, I'm [name], an analyst on the Deloitte team. [Manager] joins in five minutes. So we use your time well, could I confirm today's goal, agreeing the phase two interview list, and play back last week's three themes?" **Close**: log questions I can't answer as actions; hand over with a one-line summary.

WHY IT WORKS

The JD names client confidence in your capability as a skill to build [S2]. The Code: "We are truthful about ... the knowledge we possess, and the experience we have" [S340]. Opening with the objective is Minto's point-first rule [S374].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"So, should we outsource infrastructure?" Hold: "That's exactly what phase two will answer. What I can share now is what your team told us." Give facts; park the opinion for your manager.

D1 · Rung 2: Director doubts your experience

MEDIUM

SETUP

In a requirements workshop at a central government department, a client director asks you: "How many of these have you actually done?" You are seven months into the job. The room goes quiet.

THE TRAP

Inflating ("quite a few") breaches integrity. Shrinking ("I'm only an analyst") tells the room to discount you.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: the question is fair. **Sort:** honesty first, then his real worry: is this team competent? **Act:** "Honestly, this is my second programme of this kind. What I bring today is the detail: I've read all your process maps and I own the requirements log. The wider team has run this work many times, and [manager] can take you through that." **Close:** "If there's a specific concern about the approach, I'll note it now so we answer it before we finish."

WHY IT WORKS

The Code requires truth about "the experience we have" [S340]. "Serve with integrity" calls client trust "our single most important responsibility" [S342]. Firm credentials are shown by the people who own them **INFERRED**.

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"So we're paying for you to learn?" Fees are the partner's conversation. "That's a fair challenge; I'll make sure [manager] picks it up with you today." Then tell your manager straight after.

D1 · Rung 3: Client wants the bad news buried

HARD

SETUP

The sponsor at a UK insurer asks you, in a corridor, to leave the red data-migration risk off Thursday's steering committee pack: "the board will panic". You keep the RAID log (Risks, Assumptions, Issues, Dependencies).

THE TRAP

Agreeing to please her, or refusing flatly and starting a confrontation you do not own.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: "I understand the worry about how it lands." **Sort:** hiding a red risk misleads the client's own board; presentation is my manager's and partner's call. **Act:** "I can't remove it on my own, but I'll take your concern to [manager] today. Could we show it with the mitigation plan and a named owner, so the board sees a risk being managed?" **Close:** same-day note to my manager quoting the request; the log stays unchanged.

WHY IT WORKS

The Code: be "straightforward and honest in our professional opinions", and consult, because "No one at Deloitte should have to navigate a difficult situation alone" [S340]. Misstating status to win the next phase is a fraud risk; the failure-to-prevent-fraud offence has applied since 1 September 2025 [S361] **CONFIRMED**.

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Your partner already agreed." Hold: "Then it'll be a quick conversation. I'll confirm with them before I change anything." Never act on a second-hand approval.

D2 · IT operating model

The duty: "helping organisations move away from IT, the department of computers, to technology as a business partner and enabler"; TST's first listed offering is "Technology Operating Model" [S2]. An operating model is how a function is organised, funded, sourced and governed.

D2 · Rung 1: Explain IT as business partner

EASY

SETUP

In a current-state interview at a UK housing association, the finance lead asks what "moving IT from cost centre to business partner" means for her team. A cost centre is a unit judged mainly on what it spends.

THE TRAP

A jargon answer, or promising outcomes the review has not yet found.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: treat it as a real question; it is the heart of the project. **Sort:** clear and accurate beats impressive.

Act: "Today IT is mostly judged on keeping systems running cheaply. As a business partner, IT would plan with you, agree what technology finance needs to hit its goals, and be measured on those goals too. For your team, that might mean a named IT contact in budget season instead of raising tickets."

Close: "Does that match what you'd want? I'll note it as evidence for the review."

WHY IT WORKS

It mirrors the JD [S2] and the TST page aim to "increase the value, agility, efficiency and experience of technology investments" [S41]. Answer first, then example, is the Minto pyramid [S374].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"So will my team get cut?" Hold: "I don't know, and the review hasn't reached recommendations. I can promise your view goes into the evidence." Never speculate about headcount.

D2 · Rung 2: IT head resists the new model

MEDIUM

SETUP

At a UK logistics company, the head of infrastructure says the proposed model (moving his services to a managed provider) will cut his team and he will not support it. He asks what the draft report says.

THE TRAP

False reassurance, leaking draft findings to keep him onside, or writing him off as a blocker.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: acknowledge this is personal for him. **Sort:** drafts are confidential and belong to the sponsor; his concern is real evidence and deserves fair treatment. **Act:** "I can't share draft recommendations; they aren't final and they belong to [sponsor]. What I can do is capture your concerns properly. What would any new model have to get right for your team and the service?" **Close:** log it in the stakeholder map; tell my manager today and suggest a one-to-one with the engagement lead.

WHY IT WORKS

On a power/interest grid he is high on both: "manage closely" [S380] **REPORTED**. The Code bars disclosing confidential information without permission [S340]. "Take care of each other" puts "respect, fairness" first [S342].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Then I'll tell the CIO your team is out of its depth." Hold: do not trade information for peace. "That's your right. I'd still rather your points shape the work." Escalate to your manager at once.

D2 · Rung 3: Two sponsors, two operating models**HARD****SETUP**

At a UK utility, the CIO privately asks you to make the options slides favour one central IT function. The COO (Chief Operating Officer) separately asks you to favour IT embedded in each business unit. You draft the options pack.

THE TRAP

Tilting slides towards whoever spoke last or ranks higher, or settling the politics yourself.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: thank each; note the request. **Sort:** objectivity and the organisation's interest beat either executive's preference; the decision sits with the client's governance. **Act:** to each: "I'll make sure both options are scored fairly against the agreed criteria." To my manager: "Both sponsors have asked me for different outcomes. Could the steering committee re-confirm the criteria and weights, and we score both openly?" **Close:** the scoring workbook records every criterion, weight and source.

WHY IT WORKS

The Code: "We do not allow bias, conflict of interest, or undue influence, to alter our interactions" [S340]. The ICAEW Code names "undue influence of ... individuals" as an objectivity threat [S372]. A RACI gives each decision one Accountable owner [S379]: here, the steering committee. For a Deloitte audit client, "informed management" must decide [S364].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Remember who signs off your invoices." That is commercial pressure: do not negotiate it, report it to the partner the same day. The Code also covers influence that is only "perceived" [S340].

D3 · The digital core and the technology landscape

The duty: "create a digital core" and "Discovering how technologies support everything an organisation does, and which technologies work best for each part of a business" [S2]. The digital core is the ERP (enterprise resource planning) and core platforms that finance, supply chain and HR run on.

D3 · Rung 1: Map the application landscape**EASY****SETUP**

A UK retailer sends a 400-row application inventory. You have two days for a first landscape view: a one-page map of which systems support which business capabilities. Rows have blanks, duplicates and missing owners.

THE TRAP

A beautiful diagram on dirty data, or quietly deleting rows you think are duplicates.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: confirm the purpose: steering pack or internal working view? **Sort:** accuracy and traceability before polish. **Act:** "I'd group applications by capability (finance, supply chain, stores, HR, customer), tag owner, platform and contract end date, and flag blanks and suspected duplicates in a column instead of deleting them. End of day one, I'd send a rough view plus the data-gap list." **Close:** every count traces to row IDs; gaps go to the client's application owner as questions.

WHY IT WORKS

Buckets that do not overlap and leave nothing out are MECE (mutually exclusive, collectively exhaustive) [S375]. Improving the value of technology investments is TST's stated aim [S41]. An early check-in saves a day of rework **INFERRED**.

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

The client now wants it tomorrow. Hold: trade scope, not accuracy. "I can do the top three capabilities fully and mark the rest draft."

D3 · Rung 2: Vendor already chosen before analysis**MEDIUM****SETUP**

Early in an ERP platform selection for a UK manufacturer, a client executive says the vendor is already decided and asks you to "make the analysis fit". Deloitte has alliances with several shortlisted vendors.

THE TRAP

Reverse-engineering the scores. With alliance revenue in play, a rigged selection also looks like the firm steering for itself.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: ask what the reasons are; there may be good ones. **Sort:** objectivity and the firm's name first; the client may choose, but our report must be honest. **Act:** "It's your decision. I'd suggest our report shows the criteria and scores as they come out, with your strategic reasons recorded beside them. That gives your board a decision it can defend." I tell my manager the same day. **Close:** the scoring workbook stays unaltered; the instruction is noted.

WHY IT WORKS

Deloitte UK lists 14 alliance partners, including SAP, Oracle and Workday [S319] **CONFIRMED**. The Code bans "undue influence" over judgement [S340]. Decisions belong to the client's "informed management" [S364]. Business relationships go through conflict checks [S35].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Your firm partners with that vendor anyway." Hold: "That's exactly why our scoring has to be clean. I'll flag the alliance point to [manager] so it's handled properly."

D3 · Rung 3: Legacy system nobody understands**HARD****SETUP**

On an ERP replacement for a UK water company, the cutover plan (the step-by-step switch from old system to new) assumes the legacy billing system is documented. It is not. It holds critical customer data, and its only expert retires in a month.

THE TRAP

Assuming someone senior has spotted it, or announcing a crisis in a big meeting before you have facts.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: check what documentation exists, the leaving date and which cutover tasks depend on it. **Sort:** customers' billing and data first; it belongs in the RAID log; the date makes it urgent. **Act:** "I think this is a red risk. Several cutover tasks assume documentation that doesn't exist, and the only expert leaves at month end. I'd suggest a knowledge-capture sprint with him from next week, and a client decision on extending his contract." **Close:** logged with owner and date; on the next status report.

WHY IT WORKS

Tracking risks and deadlines is core junior work [S9]. Issues can become change requests [S377]. UK GDPR requires accurate personal data [S353]. Capita's £14m ICO fine followed a 58-hour delay in acting on an alert [S394] **CONFIRMED**: speed of escalation matters.

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

The expert refuses to be "interrogated" in his last month. Hold: "Take care of each other" [S342]. Frame it as recognising his knowledge; his line manager sets it up, in short sessions, recorded with consent.

D4 · Business case and value

The duty: "improving financial performance, accelerating speed to market" and "Help assess technology investments, identify opportunities to improve value, agility, efficiency, and user experience" [S2]. A business case sets out costs, benefits and risks so a client can decide whether to invest.

D4 · Rung 1: Sense-check a benefits number

EASY

SETUP

Your manager asks you to sanity-check a £12m savings figure in a UK retailer's cloud migration business case before it goes to the client tomorrow.

THE TRAP

Re-reading the slide and saying "looks fine", or rebuilding the whole model overnight.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: ask how deep a check, and by when. **Sort:** accuracy over speed, inside the deadline. **Act:** "Three checks. Trace the £12m to its source cells. Test scale against the client's IT cost baseline. Check the basis: annual or five-year, gross or net of migration cost. If it's five-year and gross but the slide says 'per year', the label is wrong." **Close:** a short note with cell references; my manager decides the wording.

WHY IT WORKS

Assessing technology investments is in the JD [S2]. The ICAEW Code asks professionals to "Act diligently" [S372]. Answer first, then evidence, is Minto [S374].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Just tell me if it's roughly right." Hold: one line, plus the caveat that matters: "Roughly right, but it's five-year, not annual." Short is fine; dropping the caveat is not.

D4 · Rung 2: Benefits that do not add up

MEDIUM

SETUP

On a finance transformation business case for a central government department, you find 30 FTE (full-time equivalent posts) of savings already claimed in another programme's approved case.

THE TRAP

Deleting the savings yourself, or ignoring it because the client supplied the number.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: re-check both documents and versions. **Sort:** a board approving a double-counted case wastes public money; accuracy first, raised through my manager. **Act:** "I've found an overlap. The 30 FTE in our benefit line also appear in the other programme's approved case. Unless the two are coordinated, the department counts the same saving twice. Shall I draft a note for the client's finance business partner to confirm?" **Close:** an issue in the RAID log with an owner; the model's change log records the edit.

WHY IT WORKS

Benefits must be mutually exclusive, the first half of MECE [S375]. Departments must "demonstrate the value-for-money case" for consultancy [S176] **CONFIRMED**. Honest professional opinions are a Code duty [S340].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Everyone does it, and the other programme won't deliver anyway." Hold: "Then the case can say so openly, as a dependency. What we can't do is count it twice without saying."

D4 · Rung 3: Partner wants a bigger number**HARD****SETUP**

Late evening. A partner asks you to lift the productivity assumption in an ERP investment case so it clears the client's hurdle rate (the minimum return needed to approve an investment): "Make it 18%, not 10%."

THE TRAP

Doing it because of seniority, or refusing as an accusation. There may be evidence you have not seen.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: ask, do not accuse. **Sort:** misleading a client's investment decision touches the law and the firm's name. **Act:** "Happy to update it. Could you point me to the evidence for 18% so I can source it in the assumptions log? Our benchmark supports about 10%. If we can't source it, could we show 18% as an upside scenario beside the base case?" **Close:** the assumptions log records who changed what and why. If pushed with no basis, I consult my manager or Ethics.

WHY IT WORKS

The Code: honest opinions, and "Speaking up is taking action!" [S340]. Since 1 September 2025 a large organisation can be guilty if an associate commits fraud meant to benefit it or its client [S361][S362]

CONFIRMED . "Retaliation against those who raise ethical concerns is not tolerated" [S340].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"It's an assumption. Don't be naive." Hold: "Agreed, it's a judgement. I just want it written down with its basis, so it holds up if their board asks." Keep it about the record, not the person.

D5 · Net zero and inclusive ways of working

The duty: transforming how clients run "in ways that drive net zero and incorporate inclusive ways of working" [S2]. Net zero means cutting greenhouse gas emissions as far as possible and balancing the rest with removals.

D5 · Rung 1: Add carbon to the case**EASY****SETUP**

A UK retailer asks whether its cloud migration business case should include a carbon estimate. Your manager wants your view at tomorrow's stand-up.

THE TRAP

Stating "cloud is greener" as fact, or brushing it off as out of scope.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: check whether carbon is in the agreed scope. **Sort:** accuracy first, then the client's stated goal. **Act:** "Yes, as a separate line, kept apart from the financial benefits, because the client says net zero matters. But it needs sources: current data-centre energy use, the provider's published figures, and a range, not a point. If we can't source it, we say what data we'd need." **Close:** offer a one-slide method note; flag any scope change to my manager.

WHY IT WORKS

Net zero is written into the JD [S2]. "Lead the way" includes "leading the way to a more sustainable world" [S342]. UK sustainability reporting standards were published for voluntary use in February 2026 [S202] **REPORTED** . APM: define scope early [S378].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

The client wants a precise figure by Friday, with no data. Hold: give the method and a range labelled "Estimate", plus when a real figure becomes possible.

D5 · Rung 2: Workshop excludes remote colleagues

MEDIUM

SETUP

Your all-day design workshop at a UK bank's head office is in person only. Three key client staff who work part-time or remotely cannot attend, including one area's process owner.

THE TRAP

Running it anyway and "catching them up later", or rescheduling without asking anyone.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: confirm who is missing and which sessions affect them. **Sort:** fair treatment and good requirements beat the convenience of the plan. **Act:** to my manager: "Three of the people closest to the process can't make Thursday. Could we add a video link for the two sessions on their area, inside their working hours? If not, I'll run a 45-minute follow-up with them before sign-off." **Close:** the notes record attendance and how absent colleagues' input was captured.

WHY IT WORKS

"Inclusive ways of working" is in the JD [S2]. "Foster inclusion": Deloitte is "at our best when we foster an inclusive culture" [S342]. Requirements should be agreed by the people who own the process

INFERRED .

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"They can read the minutes." Hold: "They can, and they will. The risk is designing a process their team runs without them, so I'd like their input before sign-off." Frame it as a quality risk, because it is one.

D5 · Rung 3: Green claim without evidence

HARD

SETUP

The client wants the final report to say the programme "delivers net zero IT". Your data supports only a modest cut in data-centre energy use. The report carries Deloitte's name.

THE TRAP

Letting marketing language into a Deloitte deliverable, or lecturing the client.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: re-check the data and method. **Sort:** honesty and the firm's name first; an unsupported claim also exposes the client. Final wording is my manager's and partner's call. **Act:** "I want the strongest claim the data supports. Today that's a reduction in energy use for in-scope IT, not net zero. Could we say it 'reduces emissions from in-scope IT, a step towards net zero', give the range, and list what going further would take?" **Close:** a footnote with method and sources; I raise the wording with my manager before the draft goes.

WHY IT WORKS

The Code: "We are truthful about the services we provide" [S340]. "Serve with integrity" calls trust "our single most important responsibility" [S342]. As UK sustainability reporting matures [S202], climate claims face more scrutiny INFERRED .

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"We'll put it in our press release anyway." Hold: "That's your call for your release. Our report has to say what our evidence shows." The relationship conversation is the partner's.

D6 · Large-scale transformation, design through implementation

The duty: "you will work on large-scale technology transformations, from the design through to implementation" [S2]. For a first-year Analyst this mostly means PMO (project management office) work: RAID logs, status reports, plans and meeting packs INFERRED .

D6 · Rung 1: Update the RAID log

EASY

SETUP

At 6pm you are handed the programme RAID log for tomorrow's 10am status meeting. Half the actions have no owner; several dates have passed.

THE TRAP

Typing guessed owners in as fact, or perfecting the formatting until 2am.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: ask which items will actually be discussed. **Sort:** an accurate record beats a complete-looking one. **Act:** sort by RAG status (red, amber, green) and due date; for the top ten, propose owners from past minutes, marked "proposed, to confirm". Then to my manager: "Twelve actions have no owner. I've proposed owners for the top ten, to confirm in the meeting. Two are overdue and red." **Close:** confirm owners in the meeting; update the log the same day.

WHY IT WORKS

Junior postings openly list "tracking deadlines, and preparing materials" [S9]. A RACI gives each task one Accountable person [S379], so owners are agreed, not assigned by you. Answer-first notes are Minto [S374].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Just put names in, nobody will notice." Hold: "I'll put them in as proposed, so nobody is surprised in the meeting." Just as quick, and honest.

D6 · Rung 2: Status report turning amber

MEDIUM

SETUP

Your testing workstream will miss a milestone by two weeks because the test environment arrived late. The weekly status report goes to the client tomorrow. Last week it was green.

THE TRAP

Keeping it green and hoping to recover, or putting the bad news in the report before your manager has heard it.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: confirm the cause, the size of the slip and my confidence. **Sort:** honest reporting first; my manager hears before the client. **Act:** "The environment arrived nine days late; at current pace we miss by two weeks. Options: two extra testers from the delivery centre for three weeks, or move two low-priority interfaces to the next release. I'd recommend the first." **Close:** the report shows amber with cause, impact, recovery plan and the decision needed, by when.

WHY IT WORKS

APM: "Formal change control is required when tolerances are breached" [S377]. A Deloitte director describes client check-ins "so we can manage any potential risks" [S55]. Misreporting progress to secure more work is a fraud risk [S361].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

The client's workstream lead asks you to stay green "until we've tried to recover". Hold: "I'll show amber with your recovery plan in it. That gives you credit for the plan."

D6 • Rung 3: Go-live with a known defect**HARD****SETUP**

On an HR and payroll rollout for a large public sector employer, the client wants to go live on Monday. Testing has an open severity-one defect (the highest level): overtime is miscalculated for some part-time staff.

THE TRAP

Marking the test as passed to protect the date, or acting as if go/no-go is your decision.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: confirm who is affected and any workaround. **Sort:** paying people correctly and handling their data lawfully outrank the schedule; the client's accountable owner decides, with full information. **Act:** "It isn't my call, but the go/no-go meeting must see this clearly. The defect underpays some part-time staff. Options: go live with a checked manual adjustment for that group, or delay one pay cycle." **Close:** the decision and any accepted risk are minuted with the owner's name.

WHY IT WORKS

User acceptance testing lets users "determine whether to accept the system" [S381] **REPORTED**. The Accountable person signs off [S379]. UK GDPR requires accurate personal data [S353]. A failed test reported as passed is a false record [S340].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Deloitte gets blamed for any delay. Close it as a known issue." Hold: reclassifying is fine only if the client's accountable owner accepts it in writing, with a workaround. You never close it yourself.

D7 • Requirements

The duty: "Working with individuals from our clients' business and IT teams to understand what the problems and needs are, and transforming those into technical requirements" [S2]. A requirement is a testable statement of what a system must do.

D7 • Rung 1: Run a requirements interview**EASY****SETUP**

You have 45 minutes with an operations manager at a central government department to capture requirements for a new case-management system.

THE TRAP

Asking "what features do you want?" and collecting a wish list, or steering her to a system you know.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: prepare the objective, the current process map and about eight open questions. **Sort:** the problem before solutions. **Act:** "Could you walk me through the last case you handled? Where did it slow down? What happens when that step goes wrong?" Then play back: "So the need is to see all correspondence on a case in one place, and success is fewer missed deadlines. Is that right?" **Close:** same-day write-up; each requirement testable, linked to its source, and sent to her to confirm.

WHY IT WORKS

A sister posting describes "Getting to the bottom of client's problems through interactive workshops and labs" [S8]. Asking "why" before "how" is the diagnostic issue tree [S376] **REPORTED**. Good requirements are testable, traced and agreed **INFERRED**.

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

She starts naming members of the public in real cases. Hold: "I don't need names; the pattern is enough." Data minimisation is a UK GDPR principle [S353], and some government material needs vetting before you see it [S370].

D7 · Rung 2: Business and IT disagree**MEDIUM****SETUP**

At a UK retailer, store operations want real-time stock visibility. IT says it is impossible within budget. Each side asks you, separately, to back them.

THE TRAP

Picking a side to be liked, or setting the priority yourself.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: listen to both; write down each claim. **Sort:** my job is to make the trade-off visible; the client's product owner decides. **Act:** "It isn't my call, but I can make the choice clearer. Can we separate the need from the solution? If the need is stock accurate to within an hour, does it have to be real time? IT, what would hourly cost?" Then two or three options with cost, benefit and risk go to the product owner. **Close:** the decision and reasons go in the decision log.

WHY IT WORKS

The Scrum Guide makes the Product Owner "one person, not a committee" [S373]. A solution issue tree breaks "how" into options [S376]. "Collaborate for measurable impact" is a Shared Value [S342]. For an audit client, management must decide [S364].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"You're the consultant, just tell us who's right." Hold: give a recommendation with evidence, clearly labelled as one, and leave the decision with the owner.

D7 · Rung 3: Scope creep from a senior user**HARD****SETUP**

A client finance director keeps emailing you new requirements outside change control (the agreed process for approving scope changes) and expects them in the release two weeks away.

THE TRAP

Quietly building them in (untested, unpaid, a risk to the release), or a blunt "no" to a senior client.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: thank him; the ideas may be good. **Sort:** a stable release and the agreed contract come first, handled so the relationship holds. **Act:** "Thank you, these are useful. To get them in safely, I'll log them as change requests today so the product owner can weigh them against the sprint goal. I'll come back by Thursday with the time each would take." I copy my manager. **Close:** change register, plus a weekly summary to the sponsor of requested, approved and deferred items.

WHY IT WORKS

APM change control: log, assess impact on "benefits, scope, quality, time, resources, costs, risks", then approve, reject or defer [S377]. Scrum: "No changes are made that would endanger the Sprint Goal" [S373]. Clear scope prevents later misunderstanding [S378].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"I'm paying for this programme. Just do it." Hold: "Understood. The fastest safe route is through the product owner this week." If it repeats, your manager takes it to the engagement lead; the commercial point is theirs.

D8 · Documents and client materials

The duty: "Creating documents crucial to the delivery and execution of the programme, alongside materials presented back to clients" [S2]. In practice: steering committee packs, design documents and workshop materials, mostly in PowerPoint

INFERRED .

D8 · Rung 1: Tighten a slide for tomorrow

EASY

SETUP

At 7pm your manager says your three-slide summary is "too busy" and needs rewriting for a 9am client meeting.

THE TRAP

Shrinking the font, defending every point, or working all night.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: ask one question: "What's the one decision the client needs to make tomorrow?" **Sort:** clarity over completeness. **Act:** "I'd rewrite each title as a full sentence stating the point, keep three supporting points with numbers under each, and move detail to an appendix. Version two by 9pm, with a note: 'Titles now tell the story in order; detail is in the appendix.'" **Close:** every number ties to its source; template and spelling checked.

WHY IT WORKS

Minto: ideas are easiest to grasp "organized as a pyramid under a single point" [S374]. Supporting points that do not overlap are MECE [S375]. Several review rounds on client documents are normal **INFERRED**.

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

At 8am your manager rewrites it again, differently. Hold: no ego. Make the change, keep a version log, and later ask which principle to apply next time.

D8 · Rung 2: Typo found after sending

MEDIUM

SETUP

An hour after a client pack went to twelve client stakeholders, you spot a cost shown as £12m that the source gives as £1.2m.

THE TRAP

Hoping nobody notices, or sending your own panicked correction to all twelve without your manager.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: verify the error and whether it changes any conclusion. **Sort:** honesty with the client, through the agreed route; fast, but speed comes last. **Act:** message my manager within minutes: "The cost slide shows £12m; the source says £1.2m. The conclusion is unchanged. Suggested fix: a corrected version with a one-line note. Draft attached." **Close:** once agreed, the correction goes out, the version log is updated, and I add a number tie-out step to my checklist.

WHY IT WORKS

The Code requires honesty with clients [S340]; the ICAEW Code asks for due care [S372]. Owning every line of a deliverable is the lesson of Deloitte Australia's 2025 report refund [S388] **CONFIRMED**.

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

The email also went to an outside supplier, and the appendix lists staff names and salaries. Hold: that may be a personal data breach, which covers accidental disclosure. Escalate at once to your manager and the firm's incident route; the client may have 72 hours to notify the ICO [S354].

D8 · Rung 3: Pack contradicts the client's data**HARD****SETUP**

The night before a board pack goes out, you see the client's latest quarterly data. Volumes have fallen sharply, and the savings behind the headline recommendation rest on the old, higher volumes. Seniors have signed off.

THE TRAP

Staying quiet because it is late and approved, or changing the recommendation yourself.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: check the version and date of both data sets. **Sort:** the board must not decide on a false basis; that and the firm's name outrank the deadline. **Act:** phone my manager tonight, then send the comparison: "Last week's data shows volumes well below the pack's baseline. If right, the headline savings fall by about two-thirds. I've checked twice. Options: hold the pack a day, or send it with a flagged caveat and an update to follow." **Close:** record what was found and decided.

WHY IT WORKS

The Code requires honest opinions and consultation: "No one at Deloitte should have to navigate a difficult situation alone" [S340]. Trust is "our single most important responsibility" [S342].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Too late, the partner signed off. Send it." Hold: "Could I have two minutes with the partner? I'd rather they decide knowing this." If still told to send, ask for the instruction in writing and consult further. Speak Up is open to you, and retaliation is not tolerated [S340].

D9 · Firm-approved AI, used responsibly

The duty: "Using firm-approved AI tools responsibly to support client delivery" [S3]. Two words carry the weight: firm-approved.

D9 · Rung 1: Which AI tool to use**EASY****SETUP**

You want an AI assistant to summarise fifteen sets of stakeholder interview notes. You are not sure which tools the firm approves for client material.

THE TRAP

A personal account on a public chatbot "just this once", or avoiding AI altogether out of fear.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: ask before starting. **Sort:** client confidentiality first, then the record. **Act:** "I'd ask my manager which tools are approved for client data on this engagement, and whether the contract allows AI use. Then I'd use the approved tool, strip out names it doesn't need, and check each summary against the notes." **Close:** keep the source notes, mark that AI assisted, and treat each reviewed summary as my own work.

WHY IT WORKS

Deloitte UK rates GenAI a "Very High", new priority risk, controlled by use-case approval and a "clearing house" process [S345] **CONFIRMED**. Its internal tool PairD works "within its secure digital ecosystem" [S345]. The Code bars disclosing confidential information [S340]. Deloitte: "accountability is squarely a human domain" [S347].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Use whatever's quickest." Hold: "I'll use the approved tool; it's just as quick and keeps us inside policy."

D9 • Rung 2: Colleague pastes data into ChatGPT

MEDIUM

SETUP

You see a fellow analyst paste client interview transcripts, with names and job titles, into a public AI chatbot to save time.

THE TRAP

Ignoring it as "not my business", or calling it out in front of the team.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: speak privately, straight away. **Sort:** confidentiality and a possible breach first; care for the colleague next. **Act:** "I think that's a public tool, and client data isn't meant to go in there. Can we stop and tell [manager] now? It's better coming from you, and I'll come with you." If they refuse, I raise it myself the same day. **Close:** the manager and the firm's route decide if it is reportable; I note what I saw and when.

WHY IT WORKS

The Code's duty to report covers "a colleague" [S340]. A personal data breach includes accidental "unauthorised disclosure"; notifiable ones go to the ICO within 72 hours [S354] **CONFIRMED**. "Take care of each other" is why you offer to go with them [S342].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"Everyone does it, and I've deleted the chat." Hold: deleting does not undo the disclosure, and destroying records can make things far worse, as McKinsey's obstruction plea showed [S390]. Escalate the same day.

D9 • Rung 3: AI draft cites a fake source

HARD

SETUP

A senior colleague drafted, with AI help, a section of a client report on operational resilience. It cites a regulation paragraph and a study you cannot find anywhere. The report is due tomorrow.

THE TRAP

Quietly deleting the citations but keeping the claims, or assuming they exist because a senior wrote them.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: search the primary sources: legislation.gov.uk, the regulator's site, the journal. **Sort:** the firm's name and client trust first. **Act:** "I can't verify two references in that section. I've checked the regulator's site and the journal; they may be AI errors. Can we find the real sources, or remove the claims they support?" **Close:** every citation verified and logged, the claims re-checked, and AI use disclosed if the contract requires it.

WHY IT WORKS

In 2025 Deloitte Australia agreed to repay part of a roughly A\$440,000 government report found to contain nonexistent references [S388] **CONFIRMED**. "Because an AI model cannot be meaningfully held accountable for its outputs, accountability is squarely a human domain" [S347]. The ICAEW Code warns against "undue reliance on ... technology" [S372].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

"The point is right even if the reference is off. Cite something similar." Hold: a citation must support the exact claim. If no real source does, the claim goes, or is labelled as our judgement.

D10 • Teaming across the wider T&T practice

The duty: "you will be working with teams across our wider Technology and Transformation practice, understanding how we bring our range of technical expertise and combine them" [S2]. This is the matrix: offerings, industries, alliances and delivery centres.

D10 · Rung 1: Hand-off to the delivery centre

EASY

SETUP

On Friday you must hand a testing workstream to an offshore delivery-centre team six hours ahead of the UK. On Monday you move to another project.

THE TRAP

A 6pm email saying "see attached", with context only you understand.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: list what the new team needs to work without me. **Sort:** continuity for the client, then a written record. **Act:** "I'd write a handover pack: scope, status of each test, open defects with owners, environments and access, contacts, and what 'done' looks like. Then a call in the overlap window to walk through open defects, asking them to play back the top three priorities." **Close:** access through the proper request; a daily written update for the first week.

WHY IT WORKS

Deloitte UK postings ask for clear communication "with clients and colleagues both on and offshore" [S51] **CONFIRMED**. Deloitte has opened UK technology centres in Belfast, Cardiff, Manchester and Newcastle [S323] **REPORTED**. "Collaborate for measurable impact" means "teaming across businesses, geographies, and skill sets" [S342].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

The team lead has no client system access yet and asks to borrow your login. Hold: never. Using someone else's credentials is unauthorised access under the Computer Misuse Act [S363]. Chase the access request and tell your manager about the delay.

D10 · Rung 2: Alliance partner oversells the client

MEDIUM

SETUP

In a joint client meeting, a software alliance partner's salesperson promises the client features that are not on the vendor's published product roadmap.

THE TRAP

Contradicting the vendor in front of the client, or staying silent while the client plans around features that may never arrive.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: no confrontation in the room. **Sort:** the client's interest and honest advice come before the alliance relationship. **Act:** in the room: "That's an important point. Could we capture an action to confirm the timing in writing?" Afterwards I tell my manager, with the roadmap reference, and suggest the plan and business case don't assume the feature until it is confirmed. **Close:** the action log shows the confirmation request, owner and date.

WHY IT WORKS

Deloitte UK works with 14 alliance partners [S319] **CONFIRMED**. Typically the vendor sells the licence and Deloitte sells the implementation **INFERRED**, so clients must trust that the advice is independent. The Code requires objectivity and truthfulness [S340].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

The rep messages you: "Don't rock the boat, we bring you a lot of work." Hold: pass it to your manager. The Code bans influence even "perceived to" affect judgement [S340].

D10 · Rung 3: Two practices, one client, conflict**HARD****SETUP**

Your TST team is advising a central government department on reducing reliance on one outsourced IT service. You hear another Deloitte practice is bidding to run a managed service there, which could compete with, or gain from, your recommendation.

THE TRAP

Passing your engagement's findings to the bid team "to help the firm", or ignoring what you heard.

WHAT TO SAY

Steady: separate what I know from what I heard. **Sort:** law and the firm's name first: procurement rules and client confidentiality. **Act:** "I wouldn't share anything from our engagement with the bid team. I'd tell my manager today what I heard, so the engagement partner and the firm's risk team can check whether there is a conflict to disclose or manage." **Close:** stay inside my engagement's boundaries; note when I raised it.

WHY IT WORKS

Deloitte UK conflict-checks all proposed engagements and declines those it cannot manage [S35]

CONFIRMED. The Procurement Act 2023 makes authorities manage conflicts, and a supplier with an unfair advantage can be excluded [S366][S367]. PwC Australia's tax leak shows the cost of reusing one client's information for another [S392]; McKinsey's FDA case shows non-disclosure is itself the failure [S391].

THE TWIST, AND HOW TO HOLD

Over coffee, a bid-team colleague asks: "What's their real budget pressure?" Hold: "Sorry, I can't talk about my client's work. Best to go through the engagement partner." Then tell your manager.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"When something goes wrong on a project, I steady myself and check the facts, then rank what's at stake: the law and the firm's name first, then the client and the people affected, then the process, and speed last. Then I take one concrete step with a named person and write it down. Your Code calls that ACT, and says speaking up is taking action." [S340]

PART 12

Why Deloitte, in three lengths, and the counter-case

A “why Deloitte” answer built on how the firm works, not on adjectives. Three versions to learn, a table to replace weak lines, an honest case for the alternatives, and a one-page figure to revise from.

The idea behind every version

Most candidates say why they like Deloitte. A stronger answer explains how Deloitte is built, shows evidence that the design works, and says what that means for the job you would do. This is a **mechanism-based** answer: it explains cause and effect.

The mechanism here is the **multidisciplinary model**. Deloitte keeps audit, tax, advisory and technology in one partnership. Deloitte's own description: “Our multidisciplinary model, deep domain and industry knowledge, and commitment to upholding quality and trust in the corporate reporting ecosystem allow us to provide integrated solutions” [S300]. Deloitte decided to keep its consulting business in 2003, when rivals sold or floated theirs [S104].

KEY TERMS

Partnership: the firm is owned by its equity partners, who share the profit; there are no outside shareholders. **Distributable profit:** the profit available to share among equity partners (£899m in FY26) [S407]. **Independence:** rules that stop an auditor selling most other services to the companies it audits, so the audit stays objective [S314].

The 30-second version

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

“I want to start where the shape of the firm helps me learn. Deloitte keeps audit, tax, advisory and technology in one partnership, and last year showed why that matters: in FY25 technology and transformation revenue fell 10%, but the firm fell only 1% [S89] [S305]. That stability is what pays for things like £180 million of technology investment and a new Chief AI Officer [S407]. And in FY26, Technology & Transformation was the fastest-growing UK business, on ERP, cyber and human capital work [S407]. That is the work I want to learn.”

Why it works: one mechanism, two numbers, one link to the job. Each claim has a source you could name if asked.

The 2-minute version

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"I looked at why Deloitte is built the way it is, because that tells me what the job would really be like.

First, it is a portfolio. Deloitte UK has four businesses. In FY25 T&T revenue fell 10% but total revenue fell only 1%, because tax and audit kept growing [S89] [S305]. In FY26 revenue rose 2% and distributable profit 14% [S407]. So the firm can keep hiring and investing through a weak consulting year. It hired more than 1,950 graduates, apprentices and interns in FY26 [S407].

Second, it turns that stability into investment. UK technology investment rose to £180 million, and Hayley McKelvey joined the UK Executive as the first Chief AI Officer [S407] [S274]. Globally Deloitte has committed US\$3 billion to AI through 2030 [S300] and rolled Claude out to more than 470,000 people, with 15,000 to be certified [S325].

Third, alliances. Deloitte UK works with 14 platform partners, including SAP, Workday, ServiceNow and Salesforce [S319]. Clients pay for certified people who can make those platforms work, and that is a concrete skill I can build early.

I also see the limits. Independence rules mean Deloitte often cannot consult for its own audit clients [S314]. And the Australian report case showed how one member firm's AI error affects the whole brand [S316]. That makes me care about quality checks as much as speed.

So my reason is specific: a firm whose structure lets it keep investing in technology delivery, in the business where I can learn a platform skill and see AI change delivery from the inside."

The close: one specific thing you would work on

Interviewers often end with "What would you want to work on?" A precise answer signals that you have pictured the job.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"The thing I would most like to work on is responsible AI in delivery: helping a team in Engineering, AI & Data use tools like Claude safely, with the checks that would have caught the citation errors in the Australian report [S320] [S325] [S316]. Deloitte is clearly investing there, with a Chief AI Officer whose remit covers client work and internal operations [S407]. I would like to help that investment show up as better work for clients."

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Choose your own "one thing". Options: responsible AI in delivery (above); ERP and finance transformation, the largest named growth driver [S407]; cyber resilience [S269]; public sector data work, given the Home Office contract [S233]. **For** picking AI: it is where the firm is investing. **Against:** many candidates will say AI. A suggested stance: pick the one you have real evidence for in your own CV, and link it to AI only if you can do so honestly.

What most candidates say, and what you can say

Most candidates say	You can say	Source
"Deloitte is the biggest, a global leader."	"Deloitte says Gartner has ranked it No. 1 in consulting by revenue for nine years running. What interests me is why: the multidisciplinary model."	[S125] [S300]

Most candidates say	You can say	Source
"I like the variety of clients."	"UK T&T was £1.75bn in FY26, up 4%, driven by ERP, cyber and human capital work. That is the work I would actually do."	[S407]
"Deloitte has a great culture of collaboration."	"People sit in an offering and an industry, so teams form around client problems. Independence rules limit that at audit clients, so I would expect most integrated work at non-audit and public sector clients."	[S301] [S314] INFERRED
"Deloitte invests in innovation and AI."	"A new UK Chief AI Officer, £180m of UK technology investment, Claude for 470,000+ people and 15,000 certifications."	[S407] [S325]
"I want to make an impact."	"Deloitte has been the top UK government consulting supplier for five years. I also know the counter-case: the NAO says spend data is unreliable."	[S335] [S334]
"Strong training and brand."	"More than 1,950 early-careers hires in FY26, and 12-week technical academies feeding technology roles."	[S407] [S271]
"Deloitte is stable."	"It is stable because it is a portfolio: in FY25 T&T fell 10% but the firm fell 1%."	[S89] [S305]

DON'T SAY THIS

"Deloitte UK made £5.81bn." The £5.81bn figure is UK and Switzerland consolidated. Say "the UK and Swiss firm", or use the UK business-line figures [S407].

The counter-case: why someone might reasonably choose elsewhere

Knowing the honest case for rivals makes your answer more credible. If an interviewer asks "why not X?", acknowledge what X does well, then give your Deloitte-specific reason. Never run a rival down.

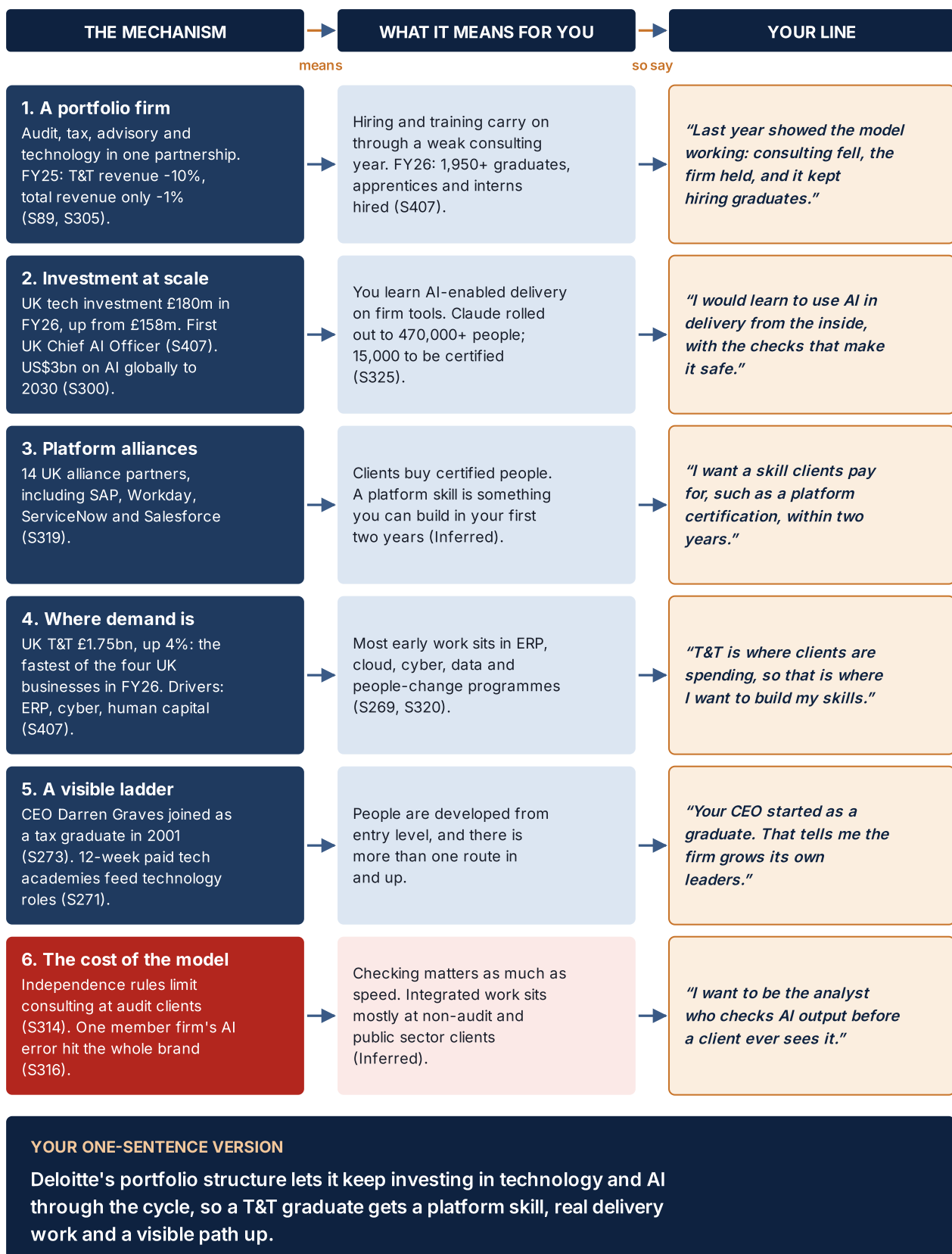
Alternative	The honest case for it	How to answer "why not X?"
Accenture	About the same size as Deloitte (US\$74.18bn in FY26) with about 814,000 people; half its revenue is managed services. As a listed company with no audit business, it has no independence limits on who it can sell to [S129].	"Accenture is the purer technology play. I want technology delivery next to tax, risk and deals expertise in one firm, which is Deloitte's model [S300]."
MBB (McKinsey, BCG, Bain)	Smaller teams and more board-level strategy work. BCG grew 7% to US\$14.4bn in 2025 with 33,500 people, and over 40% of revenue is now AI and technology work [S133].	"I am more interested in making change happen than in strategy alone. Deloitte both advises and delivers, which is where I want to learn first."
PwC	Same model and similar UK scale: UK revenue £4.365bn, up 2%, in FY26 [S138]. It set up a standalone technology and AI unit in the UK in 2024 [S404].	"PwC is a fair comparison. I chose Deloitte for the specific T&T evidence: fastest UK growth in FY26, the four regional technology centres and the alliance base [S407] [S323] [S319]."
EY	Same model, but it nearly split audit from consulting in 2022-23, so it has thought hard about conflicts [S310]. EY UK consulting fell 6% in FY25 [S139].	"EY's debate was interesting. I prefer a firm that has settled its model and is investing behind it, such as Deloitte EMEA's €1.5bn plan [S124]."
KPMG	The fastest Big Four grower globally in its last year (5.1%), though UK/Swiss Advisory fell 3% [S128] [S140].	"KPMG is growing well globally. For technology delivery in the UK, Deloitte's T&T scale and its alliances were more compelling to me."
A boutique	Faster responsibility, a deep niche and no independence red tape INFERRED. Less scale, fewer alliance certifications.	"I want breadth first, then I can specialise. A large firm gives me more teams and sectors to try."
Industry or the civil service	The Big Con argues capability should be built inside organisations, not rented [S337]. At its peak, consultants made up a large share of Test and Trace central staff [S333].	"I take that argument seriously. Good consulting work should leave the client more capable, and that is the kind of work I would want to do."

Deloitte-specific risks to weigh honestly

- Restated UK T&T revenue fell 10% in FY25, with several rounds of job cuts [S89] [S305].

- Low attrition led to voluntary redundancy offers in UK audit in June 2026 [S227] [S407].
- Reputational spillover from separate member firms, such as the Australian AI report [S316] and a US DEI settlement with no admission of liability [S242].
- The FRC is investigating Deloitte's audits of Glencore and Stenn [S252] [S253].

None of these is a reason to avoid applying. Knowing them shows you have looked at the firm with open eyes.

Figure 31 Why Deloitte on one page: the mechanism, what it means for you, what you say

Source: [S407] Deloitte UK FY26 results (30 Sep 2026); [S89] [S305] FY25; [S300] Deloitte Global FY26 (24 Sep 2026); [S325] (6 Oct 2025); [S319] [S269] [S320] Deloitte UK pages; [S273] (30 Mar 2026); [S271] (1 Sep 2026); [S314] (Dec 2019); [S316] (6 Oct 2025).
 Read: each row moves left to right, from a fact about the firm to what it means for a graduate to a line you can say.

PART 13

Cheat sheet

One page for the waiting room. The reasoning behind each line is in Parts 9, 11 and 12.

Figure 32 The cheat sheet on one page

THE PROTOCOL: STEADY, SORT, ACT, CLOSE (45 TO 75 SECONDS)



THE PRIORITY LADDER: A HIGHER RUNG ALWAYS WINS



THE PROTOCOL, IN WORDS

1 Steady (0 to 8 s). One slow breath out. Repeat the problem in one line. Ask one question only if a missing fact changes the answer.

2 Sort (8 to 25 s). Say what is at stake and rank it on the ladder. Separate what you know from what you would need to find out.

3 Act (25 to 60 s). The first concrete step, who you tell, and by when. Then the route that still meets the goal.

4 Close (60 to 75 s). The outcome, the record you leave, the follow-up. Then stop.

Deloitte's Code calls its method ACT: Assess, Consider and Consult, Take action. "Speaking up is taking action!" [S340]

THE NEVER LIST

- Put client data into a public AI tool [S340] [S345]
- Send AI output you have not checked line by line [S347][S388]
- Overstate your experience to a client [S340]
- Move, pad or under-record hours [S340]
- Make management decisions for a Deloitte audit client [S364]
- Reuse one client's information for another, or tip anyone off [S340][S359]
- Accept lavish hospitality during a live bid [S357]
- Delete files when a matter may be investigated [S390]
- Pass a failed test, or drop a red risk to please a sponsor **INFERRED**
- Use someone else's login, or keep access after you leave a project [S363]
- Use AI in Deloitte's assessments or interviews [S351]

EIGHT FRAME-BREAKS, AND THE COUNTER

After your first answer, the interviewer tests whether it holds. Keep the same priority order; change a step only for a new fact.

1. **Interruption.** Finish one sentence, then go where they lead. Do not restart the whole answer.
2. **Flat contradiction.** Name the evidence that would change your view; keep the view if it is absent [S340].
3. **Silence.** Count three seconds, then offer to go deeper on one part. Never retract to fill the gap.
4. **Escalation.** Higher stakes mean a more senior person to consult, not a faster climb-down [S340].
5. **Authority squeeze.** Agree the goal, decline the method, offer an alternative with a time.
6. **False choice.** Name the third route: deliver part on time, flag the rest, raise it early.
7. **Knowledge trap.** Say you do not know the detail, state the principle, say who you would check with [S340].
8. **Invitation to badmouth.** Decline warmly. Talk only about what you did and would do differently.

LINES TO HAVE READY

- "I'll keep it legal and honest first, do right by the client second, follow the process and leave a record third, and go as fast as those three allow."
- "Let me confirm with my manager and come back to you by three o'clock."
- "Here is what I know, what I do not know, and what I would do next."
- "That is outside what we agreed. Let me log it and check how we fit it in." [S377]
- "I would only use firm-approved AI tools and verify every source." [S3]
- "I got that wrong. Here is the fix, and here is who I have told."

NUMBERS, IF ASKED

- Deloitte UK FY26 (year to 31 May 2026): **£5.81bn**, +2%, UK and Switzerland consolidated (UK £5,014m; Swiss £795m) [S407][S88]
- UK T&T **£1.75bn**, +4%, the largest UK business; Tax & Legal £1.36bn; Audit & Assurance £998m; SR&T Advisory £913m [S407]
- Profit £899m, +14%; £1.125m per equity partner; 784 equity partners; about 25,000 people [S407]
- Global FY26: US\$74.5bn, +3.8% local currency; T&T slowest at +2.5% [S70]
- Deloitte EMEA from 1 June 2026: about €20bn, 132,000 people [S277]
- Claude for 470,000+ people, 15,000 to be certified [S116]
- UK consulting market £21.8bn, +3% in 2025 [S150]

QUESTIONS TO ASK (PICK TWO)

- "T&T grew slowest globally but fastest in the UK. What is the UK doing differently?" [S70][S407]
- "With a Chief AI Officer now on the UK Executive, how has your own work changed?" [S274]
- "What checks does your team use when GenAI helps draft a client deliverable?" [S316]
- "With the independence rules, where does your team find most of its integrated work?" [S314]

THE 30-SECOND WHY DELOITTE

"I want to start where the shape of the firm helps me learn. Deloitte keeps audit, tax, advisory and technology in one partnership. In FY25 T&T revenue fell 10%, but the firm fell only 1% [S89][S305]. That stability pays for £180m of technology investment and a new Chief AI Officer [S407]. In FY26 T&T was the fastest-growing UK business, on ERP, cyber and human capital work. That is the work I want to learn." [S407]

Sources: [S407] Deloitte UK FY26 results (30 Sep 2026); [S88] FY26 metrics; [S70] Deloitte Global FY26 (24 Sep 2026); [S340] Global Code (Oct 2025). The protocol, ladder and counters are this pack's synthesis of the Code's ACT method **INFERRED**; Part 11 gives the full reasoning. Read: the strip is the method; the boxes are what you say.

PART 14

Glossary

Every term of art in this pack, in plain English, in one alphabetical list. Use it as a lookup while you read, and as a self-test before an interview.

Each entry gives a short definition. Where a term changes how you should talk or act at Deloitte, a line starting "Why it matters here" says how. Source markers appear on Deloitte-specific and regulatory facts; general consulting vocabulary carries none because it is standard usage. Dates and figures are as of 4 October 2026.

Terms A to Z

70% cap

The rule that non-audit fees from a public interest entity audit client cannot exceed 70% of the average audit fee over the previous three years [\[S182\]](#)[\[S364\]](#). Why it matters here: it limits how much consulting Deloitte can sell to companies it audits.

ACT method

Deloitte's Global Code frame for ethical dilemmas: Assess the situation, Consider and Consult, Take action. The Code adds "Speaking up is taking action!" [\[S340\]](#). Why it matters here: it is a ready-made structure for any ethics scenario question.

Agentic AI

AI systems that take actions (send, book, update, approve) rather than only producing text. Deloitte's Tech Trends 2026 says only 11% of organisations have such systems in production [\[S244\]](#). Why it matters here: the hard part is redesigning the process, which is consulting work.

Agile

A way of delivering projects in short cycles, testing with users and adjusting as you learn, instead of fixing every requirement up front. Scrum is the most common agile framework.

Alliance partner

A technology vendor whose software a consultancy implements. Deloitte UK lists 14, including SAP, Salesforce, ServiceNow, Workday, AWS, Google and Oracle [\[S319\]](#). Why it matters here: much T&T graduate work runs on these platforms.

ARGA (Audit, Reporting and Governance Authority)

The regulator that was meant to replace the FRC. The government abandoned the Audit Reform Bill on 20 January 2026, so ARGA will not be created [\[S185\]](#)[\[S186\]](#).

Audit & Assurance (A&A)

Deloitte's audit business. It gives independent opinions on whether company accounts are true and fair. UK revenue £998m in FY26 [\[S407\]](#).

Audit committee

A board committee of a company, mostly independent directors, that oversees its auditor. Non-audit services to a public interest entity need its approval [\[S364\]](#).

Audit Governance Board (AGB)

Deloitte UK's majority-independent board that oversees the audit practice, set up under operational separation. It continues under the new UK Board [\[S93\]](#)[\[S94\]](#).

Basel 3.1

The UK version of the final global bank capital rules. The PRA's final rules take effect on 1 January 2027 [\[S196\]](#)[\[S197\]](#). Why it matters here: banks buy help with data, models and reporting to comply.

Bench

Consultants not currently staffed on a client project. Time on the bench is not chargeable, so long bench periods hurt utilisation.

Big Four

The four largest professional services networks: Deloitte, PwC, EY and KPMG. Deloitte is the largest by revenue, at US\$74.5bn in FY26 [\[S70\]](#)[\[S126\]](#).

BPSS (Baseline Personnel Security Standard)

The UK government's basic pre-employment check (identity, right to work, employment history, unspent convictions) for people with access to government assets. It is not a formal clearance but underpins SC [S369][S370]. Deloitte UK does not say it is required for all graduates.

BrightStart

Deloitte UK's school-leaver apprenticeship route. 182 BrightStart apprentices were among the September 2026 intake [S231][S260].

Bribery Act 2010, section 7

Makes a commercial organisation guilty if someone associated with it pays a bribe to win business for it, unless it had "adequate procedures" to prevent bribery [S355][S357]. Why it matters here: it is why gifts and hospitality rules are strict.

Chargeable hours

Hours recorded against a client code and billed. Deloitte's Code requires hours to be recorded "timely and accurately" [S340].

Change control

The process for logging, assessing and approving or rejecting any change to an agreed project scope [S377]. Why it matters here: the correct answer when a client asks for "one small extra thing".

Change management

Helping people adopt a new system or way of working through communication, training and support. Technology projects often fail here, not in the build.

Chartered Management Consultant (ChMC)

A professional accreditation run with the MCA. Over 2,800 holders in the 2026 MCA report [S150].

Chief AI Officer

A new seat on Deloitte UK's Executive, held by Hayley McKelvey from June 2026, responsible for AI strategy "across client services and internal operations" [S407].

Cloud migration

Moving a client's systems and data from its own data centres to a cloud provider such as AWS, Microsoft Azure or Google Cloud.

Conflict check

The test every proposed engagement goes through before acceptance. Deloitte declines work where a conflict "cannot be eliminated or reduced to an acceptable level" [S94].

Consumer Duty

FCA rules requiring retail financial firms to deliver good outcomes for customers. In force 31 July 2023 for open products and 31 July 2024 for closed products [S200].

Contextual recruitment

Judging grades against a candidate's school and circumstances. Deloitte UK announced it in September 2015 with Rare Recruitment, alongside school- and university-blind interviews [S267][S268]. Whether it still runs in the 2027 cycle is not confirmed.

Cutover

The planned switch from an old system to a new one, often over a weekend, with a rehearsed plan and a rollback option if it fails.

Data controller and data processor

Under UK GDPR the controller decides why and how personal data is used; the processor handles it on the controller's behalf. A processor must tell the controller about a breach without undue delay [S354]. A consultancy is often the processor.

Data (Use and Access) Act 2025 (DUAA)

The UK law amending data protection rules. Royal Assent 19 June 2025; most changes in force from 5 February 2026 [S194][S195].

Delivery centre

A lower-cost site where project work is done at scale. Deloitte UK opened technology centres in Belfast, Cardiff, Manchester and Newcastle from June 2025, starting with 750 technologists and aiming for 1,500 [S254].

Deloitte Digital

Deloitte's brand for customer, marketing and creative work, built partly through agency purchases such as Heat (2016) and Acne (2017) [S405]. Why it matters here: it links creative design to technology delivery.

Deloitte EMEA

A combined firm of Deloitte LLP and other European, Middle Eastern and African member firms, live from 1 June 2026: about €20bn revenue, 132,000 people and over €1.5bn of planned investment [S93][S124]. Richard Houston is its CEO [S407].

Deloitte LLP

The UK firm, a limited liability partnership registered in England and Wales, number OC303675, at 1 New Street Square, London [S407].

Deloitte NSE (North and South Europe)

The regional holding entity that was Deloitte LLP's parent until 31 May 2026. It served no clients and has been replaced by Deloitte EMEA [S93][S94].

Deloitte University EMEA

Deloitte's residential learning campus, moved in 2024 from near Brussels to a purpose-built site near Paris [S283].

Distributable profit

The profit shared among equity partners, on a management accounts basis. £899m in FY26 for the UK and Switzerland [S93][S407].

DORA (Digital Operational Resilience Act)

EU regulation on ICT risk, incident reporting, resilience testing and oversight of technology suppliers in financial services. Applies from 17 January 2025 [S201].

DTTL (Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited)

The UK private company limited by guarantee that coordinates the Deloitte network. It "does not provide services to clients", and member firms cannot bind each other [S83].

ECCTA failure to prevent fraud

Section 199 of the Economic Crime and Corporate Transparency Act 2023: a large organisation commits an offence if an associated person commits fraud to benefit it, unless it had reasonable prevention procedures. In force 1 September 2025 [S361][S362].

Enabling Functions

Deloitte UK's name for its internal support teams, such as HR, IT, finance and Quality, Risk & Security, which runs conflict and independence checks [S330].

Engagement

One piece of paid client work, defined by a contract, a team and a fee. Also called a project.

Equity partner

An owner of the LLP who contributes capital and takes a share of profit. Deloitte UK had 784 at the 2026 year end, a record [S407].

ERP (enterprise resource planning)

Core business software for finance, HR and supply chain, such as SAP S/4HANA. ERP programmes are large, long and risky.

Ethical Standard

The FRC's rulebook on auditor independence. The current version took effect on 15 December 2024. Its test is whether an "objective, reasonable and informed third party" would see a threat [S364].

EU AI Act

The EU's risk-based AI law, in force 1 August 2024. The 2026 Digital Omnibus moved the main high-risk deadline to 2 December 2027 [S192][S193][S234]. Why it matters here: it creates AI governance work for UK firms selling into the EU.

Final Stage Assessment

Stage 4 of Deloitte UK's process. For graduates: an in-person Topic Discussion (30 to 40 minutes) and a Skills and Motivation Interview (about 50 minutes). The Summer Vacation Scheme final stage is a virtual interview only [S260].

Financial year (Deloitte)

Deloitte's year ends on 31 May, so "FY26" means June 2025 to May 2026 [S93].

Fixed fee

A contract with an agreed total price. Deloitte still tracks progress through hours at charge-out rates [S93]. Why it matters here: overruns come out of the firm's margin.

Framework agreement

A pre-approved list of suppliers that public buyers can call off work from without a full tender each time. MCF4 is the main one for consultancy [S191].

FRC (Financial Reporting Council)

The UK regulator of auditors and accountants. It sets the Ethical Standard, inspects audits and can fine firms. It fined Deloitte a record £15m over Autonomy in 2020 [S105].

GCA (Government Commercial Agency)

The UK government's central buying agency, renamed from Crown Commercial Service on 1 April 2026 [S190].

Generative AI (GenAI)

AI that produces new text, images or code from a prompt. Large language models are the main kind.

Global Principles of Business Conduct

Deloitte's global code of ethics (October 2025 edition), covering integrity, confidentiality, anti-corruption, respect and responsible AI. Each member firm adds local rules [S340].

Hallucination

When an AI model states something false with confidence, such as an invented citation. Deloitte Australia partly refunded a government report in 2025 after fabricated references were found [S113]. Why it matters here: you must check every AI-assisted source and number.

Human in the loop

A person reviews and owns AI output before it is used. Deloitte's own guidance says accountability for AI output is "squarely a human domain" [S347].

Hypothesis-driven

Starting with a likely answer and testing it with data, instead of collecting everything first. It saves time and keeps analysis focused.

Immersive Online Assessment

Stage 2 of Deloitte UK's process: a behavioural part (rank responses to workplace scenarios) and a cognitive part (numerical and verbal reasoning), with a strengths report afterwards [S260].

Independence

An auditor's freedom from interests that could bias its opinion. The Ethical Standard bans any service that would put the firm in a management role at an audit client [S364]. Why it matters here: consultants must not make decisions for an audit client.

Industry (Deloitte)

The client sector a professional aligns to: Consumer; Energy, Resources & Industrials; Financial Services; Government & Public Services; Life Sciences & Health Care; Technology, Media & Telecom [S301].

Inside information

Precise, non-public information about a listed company that would likely move its share price if published (UK MAR Article 7) [S358]. Sharing it outside normal duties is unlawful [S359].

Integrity & AI guidance

Deloitte UK's rules for applicants on using AI in assessments. Breaking them is treated as a breach of process [S261][S351]. Why it matters here: write your own answers.

ISQM (UK) 1

The standard requiring an audit firm to run a system of quality management. Deloitte UK's 2025 review found two deficiencies, "neither severe nor pervasive" [S94].

Issue tree

A diagram that breaks a big question into smaller ones. Diagnostic trees ask "why"; solution trees ask "how". Branches should be MECE [S376].

Job Simulation

Stage 3 of Deloitte UK's process: a recorded, one-way assessment with ranking, multiple-choice, written and video answers, including scenarios that mention AI [S260].

Lead Client Service Partner (LCSP)

The partner who owns Deloitte's whole relationship with a large client and coordinates account plans and pursuits across offerings [S322]. Sources describe the US firm; the UK use is assumed similar **INFERRED**.

Leverage

The number of staff per partner. Deloitte UK has about 16.5 staff per partner (FY26, own calculation) [S88][S93]. More leverage means more billable hours behind each partner's profit.

LLM (large language model)

An AI model trained on huge amounts of text to predict and generate language, such as Anthropic's Claude or OpenAI's GPT models.

LLP (limited liability partnership)

A UK legal form where partners (members) own the business and share profit, but are not personally liable for its debts in the way old-style partners were [S93].

Local currency growth

Growth with exchange-rate effects stripped out. Deloitte's FY26 global revenue grew 3.8% in local currency but 5.7% in US dollars [S70].

Managed services

Running a system or process for a client on an ongoing contract, often for years. Revenue is recurring, and the provider carries operational risk.

MAR (UK Market Abuse Regulation)

The law banning insider dealing, unlawful disclosure of inside information and market manipulation [S358][S360].

MCA (Management Consultancies Association)

The UK consulting trade body. It put UK consulting fee income at £21.8bn in 2025 [S150].

MCF4 (Management Consultancy Framework Four)

The government's main consultancy framework, run by the GCA from 29 July 2025 to 28 July 2027, with 10 lots and 219 suppliers [S117][S191].

MECE

"Mutually exclusive, collectively exhaustive": split a problem into parts that do not overlap and together cover everything [\[S375\]](#).

Member firm

A legally separate national or regional Deloitte firm in the DTTL network. Each is liable only for its own acts [\[S83\]](#).

Monitor Deloitte

Deloitte's strategy consulting brand, from the 2013 purchase of Monitor Group [\[S134\]](#). Since the 2024 restructure it sits within SR&T [\[S307\]](#).

Multidisciplinary model

One firm offering audit, tax, consulting and deals advice under one brand. Deloitte kept consulting in 2003 when its rivals sold theirs [\[S104\]](#).

Non-audit services

Anything an audit firm sells to an audit client other than the audit. For public interest entities only a short permitted list is allowed [\[S364\]](#).

Offering

A Deloitte practice defined by what it does. UK T&T offerings include Enterprise, Technology & Performance; Engineering, AI & Data; Cyber; Customer; Human Capital; and Defence & Security [\[S320\]](#).

Offshore and nearshore delivery

Doing work in lower-cost countries far away (offshore, such as India) or nearby (nearshore). The Big Four are moving more work to India, Malaysia and the Philippines [\[S162\]](#).

Operate

Deloitte's managed-services offer. The FY26 global release names it an area of "significant growth" [\[S70\]](#).

Operational resilience

FCA and PRA rules requiring firms to keep important business services within set impact tolerances during severe disruption. Transition ended 31 March 2025 [\[S199\]](#).

Operational separation

The FRC requirement that the Big Four ring-fence their UK audit practices with separate governance and finances. All four met it by 2024 [\[S183\]](#)[\[S184\]](#).

Outcome-based pricing

Fees linked to results delivered (cost saved, revenue gained) rather than hours worked. Growing slowly across consulting [\[S163\]](#).

PairD

Deloitte's internal generative AI assistant, rolled out in the UK from October 2023 and to 75,000 people in Europe and the Middle East by January 2024 [\[S328\]](#). UK staff sent about 1 million prompts a month in FY25 [\[S85\]](#).

Partner annuity

A pension paid to retired Deloitte UK partners out of current profit. Closed to new entrants from 1 June 2021; liabilities £1,545m, payments mainly capped at 8% of operating profit [\[S93\]](#).

PEP (profit per equity partner)

Distributable profit divided by equity partners. Deloitte UK's average was £1.125m in FY26 [\[S407\]](#).

Personal independence

Checks every joiner must clear before starting, restricting financial interests in audit clients [\[S261\]](#). Why it matters here: you may need to sell some shares.

PIE (public interest entity)

Listed companies, banks and insurers, which face the strictest audit rules, including the whitelist and the 70% cap [\[S182\]](#)[\[S364\]](#).

PIRG (Public Interest Review Group)

Deloitte UK's panel for engagements with high public-interest or reputational risk. In FY25 it considered 32 matters and declined 9% [\[S94\]](#).

PMO (programme management office)

The team that runs plans, governance, reporting and risk logs for a large programme. A common first role for graduates.

Procurement Act 2023

The UK public procurement law, in force from 24 February 2025 [\[S190\]](#). Buyers must identify and manage conflicts of interest [\[S366\]](#)[\[S368\]](#).

Pyramid (staffing)

The shape of a consulting firm: few partners at the top, many juniors at the base. AI threatens the base by automating junior tasks [\[S162\]](#).

Pyramid Principle

Barbara Minto's rule for clear writing: put the main point first, then group supporting points beneath it [\[S374\]](#).

RACI

A table showing who is Responsible, Accountable, Consulted and Informed for each task, ideally with one Accountable person [\[S379\]](#).

RAID log

A project list of Risks, Assumptions, Issues and Dependencies, reviewed regularly.

Rate card

The standard daily charge-out rate for each grade. Deloitte recognises revenue using hours at charge-out rates [S93]. Deloitte does not publish its rates.

Realisation

The share of the standard value of time that is actually billed and collected after discounts and write-offs.

RFP (request for proposal)

A buyer's formal invitation for firms to bid for a piece of work. The firm's reply, often with a presentation, is the pitch.

Salaried partner

A partner by title who is an employee, not an owner. Deloitte UK had 654 on an FTE basis in FY26 [S88].

SaaS (software as a service)

Software rented by subscription and run by the vendor in the cloud, such as Salesforce or Workday.

SC (Security Check)

UK government clearance for posts needing long-term access to SECRET material. It builds on BPSS [S370].

Scope

What a project will and will not deliver. Defining it clearly prevents later disputes [S378]. Scope creep is unpaid growth in that list.

SCQ (Situation, Complication, Question)

Minto's way to open a piece of communication by stating what is true, what has changed, and the question that raises [S374].

Scrum

An agile framework with a team of 10 or fewer, three roles (Developers, a Product Owner and a Scrum Master) and work in Sprints [S373].

Shared Values

Deloitte's five values: Lead the way; Serve with integrity; Take care of each other; Foster inclusion; Collaborate for measurable impact [S266].

Skills and Motivation Interview

The roughly 50-minute final-stage interview on "alignment with the capabilities we look for" [S260]. Expect strengths and "tell me about a time" questions.

SOW (statement of work)

The contract document that says what will be delivered, by when, by whom and for what fee.

Speak Up

Deloitte's third-party-run channel for raising ethics concerns, anonymously if needed. Retaliation is not tolerated [S340][S343].

Sprint

A fixed cycle of one month or less in Scrum. Changes that endanger the Sprint Goal are not made mid-sprint [S373].

SR&T Advisory (Strategy, Risk & Transactions)

One of Deloitte's two consulting businesses, covering strategy, risk and deals work. UK revenue £913m in FY26 [S407].

Stakeholder map

A grid plotting people by power and interest, to decide who to manage closely and who to keep informed [S380].

STAR (or STARR)

An answer structure: Situation, Task, Action, Result, plus Reflection. Prospects suggests preparing five to eight examples [S382].

Strengths-based interview

Questions about what you enjoy and do well naturally, rather than only past examples. Deloitte's online assessment is designed to find "your unique strengths" [S350].

Summer Vacation Scheme

Deloitte UK's summer internship, using the same process as graduate roles but with a virtual interview-only final stage [S260].

Systems integrator (SI)

A firm that makes several software products work together inside a client's organisation.

T+1

Settling share trades one business day after the trade. The UK plans to move to T+1 by 11 October 2027 [S198].

T&M (time and materials)

Billing for hours actually worked at agreed rates, plus expenses. The client carries the overrun risk [S93].

T&T (Technology & Transformation)

Deloitte's largest business, covering technology implementation, data, AI, cyber and transformation. UK revenue £1.75bn in FY26, up 4% [S407].

Target operating model (TOM)

A design for how an organisation should work in future: people, processes, technology and governance.

Tax & Legal

Deloitte's tax compliance, tax advice and legal business. UK revenue £1.36bn in FY26 [S407].

Topic Discussion

The first final-stage exercise: a 30 to 40 minute two-way discussion with an assessor on a topic you research in advance [S260].

Transparency report

An annual report the audit firm must publish on governance, audit quality and risk. Deloitte UK's 2025 report rates its reputational risk "Very High" [S94].

Trustworthy AI

Deloitte's framework for responsible AI, launched 2020. Its dimensions include fair and impartial, transparent and explainable, responsible and accountable, safe and secure, robust and reliable, and respectful of privacy [S346][S348].

UAT (user acceptance testing)

The final test in which business users check a system meets their needs before they accept it [S381]. Users, not the build team, sign it off.

UK Board

Deloitte UK's top governance body from 1 June 2026, replacing the UK Oversight Board. Jane Whitlock chairs it [S93][S407].

UK GDPR

The UK's main data protection law. Notifiable breaches go to the ICO within 72 hours; top fines are £17.5m or 4% of turnover [S353][S354].

UK SRS (UK Sustainability Reporting Standards)

UK versions of the ISSB climate and sustainability disclosure standards, published 25 February 2026 for voluntary use [S202].

USI (US-India delivery)

The US Deloitte firm's delivery organisation in India, reported at over 100,000 people [S324] **REPORTED**. Its role in UK work is not established.

Utilisation

The share of a consultant's available hours that are chargeable to clients. Deloitte does not publish its targets.

Whitelist

The short list of non-audit services an auditor may provide to a public interest entity audit client, mostly audit-related or required by law [S180][S364].

Zora AI

Deloitte's suite of AI agents for finance, HR, procurement and other functions, launched March 2025 with NVIDIA technology and sold on subscription [S327].

PART 15

Source table

Every [Sxx] marker in this pack resolves here. FETCHED means the full page was read. SNIPPET means only a search summary was seen, so treat it with more caution. PAYWALLED means the headline was recorded but the article was not read.

All sources, by ID

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S1	Deloitte UK (Avature ATS)	UK Early Careers programme search (168 results)	live listing	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers	FETCHED	Primary; all 9 pages parsed
S2	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Technology Strategy Consulting - Technology Strategy & Transformation, Full Time Graduate, Belfast (25060)	live Oct 2026	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers/JobDetail/Technology-Strategy-Consulting-Technology-Strategy-Transformation/25060	FETCHED	Primary; THE JD
S3	Deloitte UK (ATS)	TST Industrial Placement, Belfast (25056)	live Oct 2026	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers/JobDetail/Technology-Strategy-Consulting-Technology-Strategy-Transformation/25056	FETCHED	Primary
S4	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Business Transformation Consulting - Customer Products, Graduate, Edinburgh (24840)	live Oct 2026	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers/JobDetail/Business-Transformation-Consulting-Customer-Products/24840	FETCHED	Primary
S5	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Business Transformation Consulting - Human Capital, BrightStart, Belfast (25094)	live Oct 2026	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers/JobDetail/Business-Transformation-Consulting-Human-Capital/25094	FETCHED	Primary
S6	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Enterprise Applications Consulting - Human Capital, Graduate, Belfast (25096)	live Oct 2026	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers/JobDetail/Enterprise-Applications-Consulting-Human-Capital/25096	FETCHED	Primary
S7	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Enterprise Applications Consulting - Sales & Service, Graduate, Belfast (24859)	live Oct 2026	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers/JobDetail/Enterprise-Applications-Consulting-Sales-Service/24859	FETCHED	Primary
S8	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Finance Transformation Consulting - Business Analyst, Graduate, Belfast (24991)	live Oct 2026	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers/JobDetail/Finance-Transformation-Consulting-Business-Analyst/24991	FETCHED	Primary
S9	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Risk & Controls Consulting - Defence & Resilience, Graduate, Edinburgh (24843)	live Oct 2026	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers/JobDetail/Risk-Controls-Consulting-Defence-Resilience/24843	FETCHED	Primary
S10	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Risk & Controls Consulting - Strategy & Transformation, Graduate, Edinburgh (24841)	live Oct 2026	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers/JobDetail/Risk-Controls-Consulting-Strategy-Transformation/24841	FETCHED	Primary
S11	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Mergers & Acquisitions - Business Valuations, Graduate, Edinburgh (24175)	live Oct 2026	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers/JobDetail/Mergers-Acquisitions-Business-Valuations/24175	FETCHED	Primary
S12	Deloitte UK	Early Careers Consulting	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/our-business-areas/early-careers-consulting.html	FETCHED	Primary; nav also lists services, industries, alliances
S13	Deloitte UK	Early Careers Programmes	undated (2026/27 dates)	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/early-careers/early-careers-programmes.html	FETCHED	Primary
S14	Deloitte UK	Early Careers Application Timelines	2026/27	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/early-careers/early-careers-application-timelines.html	FETCHED	Primary
S15	Deloitte UK	Early Careers Opportunities in Advisory	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/our-business-areas/early-careers-opportunities-in-advisory.html	FETCHED	Primary
S16	Deloitte UK	Early Careers Opportunities in Technology	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/our-business-areas/early-career-technology.html	FETCHED	Primary; covers IT Audit, Tax tech, Forensic tech (not T&T)
S17	Deloitte UK	Early Careers Assessment	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/early-careers/early-careers-assessment.html	FETCHED	Primary
S18	Deloitte UK	Career Development (qualifications)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/career-development.html	FETCHED	Primary
S19	Deloitte UK	Rewards & Benefits	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/careers-rewards-and-benefits.html	FETCHED	Primary

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S20	Deloitte UK	Our Locations	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/our-locations.html	FETCHED	Primary
S21	Deloitte UK	Life at Deloitte in Belfast	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/our-locations/life-at-belfast.html	FETCHED	Primary
S22	Deloitte UK press room	Deloitte UK publishes 2026 financial results	2026-09-30	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-publishes-2026-financial-results.html	FETCHED	Primary (read via fetch summary; one driver sentence from search snippet)
S23	Deloitte UK	Business and ESG performance metrics for FY26 (PDF)	2026-09	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2026/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2026-business-and-esg-performance-metrics.pdf	FETCHED	Primary, full text read
S24	Deloitte LLP	Consolidated and LLP Financial Statements 2026 (PDF)	2026-09	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2026/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2026-financial-statements.pdf	FETCHED	Primary, audited
S25	Deloitte UK press room	Deloitte UK promotes over 6,000 people and increases equity partners to a record high	2026-05-29	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-promotes.html	FETCHED	Primary
S26	Deloitte UK	The Extended Leadership Team	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/governance/the-extended-leadership-team.html	FETCHED	Primary but possibly stale after June 2026 changes
S27	Consultancy.uk	Deloitte picks Hammad Rafique as managing partner for Technology & Transformation	2026-05-21	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/44180/deloitte-picks-hammad-rafiq-as-managing-partner-for-technology-transformation	FETCHED	Single trade source; consistent with search snippets
S28	Consultancy.uk	Hayley McKelvey becomes Deloitte's first AI chief	2026-06-02	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/44322/hayley-mckelvey-becomes-deloittes-first-ai-chief	FETCHED	Corroborated by S22
S29	Consultancy.uk	2026 intake of early-career staff to hit 1,500 at Deloitte	2026-09-10	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/45536/2026-intake-of-early-career-staff-to-hit-1500-at-deloitte	FETCHED	Trade press; headline vs body figures differ (1,500 vs 1,353)
S30	TechMarketView	Technology & Transformation lifts Deloitte UK in FY26	2026-09-30	https://www.techmarketview.com/ukhotviews/archive/2026/09/30/technology-transformation-lifts-deloitte-uk-in-fy26	FETCHED	Analyst press; partial
S31	City AM	Deloitte UK advisory arm rebounds to growth as new boss insists AI 'can't replace lived experience'	2026-09-30	https://www.cityam.com/deloitte-uk-advisory-arm-rebounds-to-growth-as-new-boss-insists-ai-cant-replace-lived-experience/	FETCHED	Press; consistent with S22
S32	Resultsense	Deloitte UK grows 2% as new chief backs human judgement	2026-09-30	https://www.resultsense.com/news/2026-09-30-deloitte-uk-results-graves-ai/	FETCHED	Minor outlet; use for colour only
S33	Business Quarter	Deloitte technology growth slows amid AI shift	2026-09	https://businessquarter.co.uk/deloitte-technology-growth-slows-amid-ai-shift/	FETCHED	Minor outlet; EMEA firm count differs from S24
S34	Deloitte Global press room	Deloitte reports FY2026 revenue	2026-09-24	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement.html	FETCHED	Primary
S35	Deloitte UK	Audit Transparency Report 2025 (PDF)	2025	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2025/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2025-audit-transparency-report.pdf	FETCHED	Primary; FY25 data (FY26 report not yet listed)
S36	Deloitte Global	Global Principles of Business Conduct (PDF)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-shared/docs/global-principles-of-business-conduct.pdf	FETCHED	Primary
S37	Deloitte Global	What we believe (ethics & integrity)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/story/purpose-values/what-we-believe-ethics-integrity.html	FETCHED	Primary; links to S36
S38	FRC	Ethical Standard for Auditors (page)	2024	https://www.frc.org.uk/library/standards-codes-policy/audit-assurance-and-ethics/ethical-standard-for-auditors/	FETCHED	Regulator
S39	FRC	Revised Ethical Standard 2024 (PDF)	2024-01-15 (effective 2024-12-15)	https://www.frc.org.uk/documents/6703/Revised_Ethical_Standard_2024_orZHKLq.pdf	FETCHED	Regulator; paras 2.3, 2.4, 5.4.0 read
S40	Deloitte UK	Consulting services hub	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/services/consulting.html	FETCHED	Primary
S41	Deloitte UK	Technology Strategy & Transformation (service page)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/services/consulting/services/technology-strategy-and-transformation.html	FETCHED	Primary; Matt Stallard contact
S42	Deloitte UK	Engineering, AI & Data (service page)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/services/consulting/services/engineering-ai-data.html	FETCHED	Primary; Paul Mordue
S43	Deloitte UK	Enterprise Technology & Performance (service page)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/services/consulting/services/enterprise-technology-performance.html	FETCHED	Primary; contact only, no leader title

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S44	Deloitte UK	Human Capital (service page)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/services/consulting/services/human-capital.html	FETCHED	Primary; Kate Sweeney
S45	Deloitte UK	Strategy & Transactions (service page)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/services/consulting/services/strategy-transactions.html	FETCHED	Primary; "Managing Partner" scope not stated
S46	Deloitte UK	Finance Transformation (service page)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/services/consulting/services/finance-transformation.html	FETCHED	Primary
S47	Deloitte UK	Supply Chain & Network Operations (service page)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/services/consulting/services/supply-chain-network-operations.html	FETCHED	Primary
S48	Deloitte UK	Operations, Industry & Domain Solutions (service page)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/services/consulting/services/operations-industry-domain-solutions.html	FETCHED	Primary
S49	Deloitte UK (ATS)	UK Careers experienced-hire search (591 listed; 551 parsed)	live listing	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKCareers/SearchJobs	FETCHED	Primary; counts are mine, 40 postings missed through connection resets
S50	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Senior Manager, Workday Adaptive Workforce and Finance Planning Lead (23684)	live	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKCareers/JobDetail/Senior-Manager-Workday-Adaptive-Workforce-and-Finance-Planning-Lead-Technology-Transformation/23684	FETCHED	Primary
S51	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Manager, SAP Financial Accounting (FI) (24137)	live	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKCareers/JobDetail/Manager-SAP-Financial-Accounting-FI/24137	FETCHED	Primary
S52	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Manager, Production Planning and Detailed Scheduling (PPDS), SAP Supply Chain (24568)	live	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKCareers/JobDetail/Manager-Production-Planning-and-Detailed-Scheduling-PPDS-SAP-Supply-Chain/24568	FETCHED	Primary; self-description claim
S53	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Manager, Programme Set Up and Organisational Transformation, Major Programmes, Human Capital (24205)	live	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKCareers/JobDetail/Manager-Programme-Set-Up-and-Organisational-Transformation-Major-Programmes-Human-Capital/24205	FETCHED	Primary
S54	Deloitte UK (ATS)	Senior Manager, Solution Architect (Kinaxis/Anaplan), Supply Chain Transformation (22568)	live	https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKCareers/JobDetail/Senior-Manager-Solution-Architect-Kinaxis-Anaplan-Supply-Chain-Transformation/22568	FETCHED	Primary
S55	Deloitte UK	My story: Melanie (Director, T&T, Human Capital)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/meet-our-people/my-story-melanie.html	FETCHED	Primary, employer-curated
S56	Deloitte UK	My story: Pritesh (Senior Manager, T&T)	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/meet-our-people/my-story-pritesht.html	FETCHED	Primary, employer-curated
S57	Deloitte UK press room	Deloitte's Summer Vacation Scheme offers real life work experience to 460 students	2025-06-30	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloittes-summer-vacation-scheme.html	FETCHED	Primary; 2025 cohort
S58	Glassdoor (via search)	Salary: Deloitte Consulting Graduate Analyst in London	2026	https://www.glassdoor.co.uk/Salaries/deloitte-consulting-graduate-analyst-in-london-salary-SRCH_KOQ,46.htm	SNIPPET	Self-reported; low confidence
S59	Bright Network / Prosple (via search)	Deloitte graduate listings 2027	2026	https://www.brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-employer-company/deloitte/	SNIPPET	Fetch blocked (403); snippet only
S60	Consultancy.uk	Deloitte - People (news list: Kanwar FS lead Mar 2025; Bristol 700 people Sep 2025)	2026	https://www.consultancy.uk/firms/deloitte/people	FETCHED	Headlines and standfirsts only
S61	Harvard Business Review	Reinventing Performance Management	2015-04	https://hbr.org/2015/04/reinventing-performance-management	PAYWALLED	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ
S62	Deloitte UK press room (via search)	Deloitte UK announces Darren Graves as senior partner and chief executive	2025/26	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-announces-new-senior-partner-and-chief-executive.html	SNIPPET	Career detail (graduate 2001, partner 2012, NSE Tax & Legal MP 2022) from snippet only
S63	Deloitte UK	Purpose & values	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/story/purpose-values.html	FETCHED	Primary; one line used
S64	Consultancy.uk	PwC news list	2026	https://www.consultancy.uk/firms/pwc	FETCHED	Headlines only, not articles
S65	Deloitte UK	Annual Reports index	2026	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/governance/annual-reports.html	FETCHED	Index used to locate S23, S24, S35
S66	Deloitte UK	Pay Report 2025 (PDF)	2025	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2025/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2025-pay-report.pdf	FETCHED	Grade names (Senior Consultant, Senior Manager, Associate Director, Director) appear
S70	Deloitte Global	Deloitte reports FY2026 revenue	2026-09-24	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement.html	FETCHED	Primary; business/region growth only, no USD split

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S71	Deloitte Global	Deloitte reports FY2025 revenue	2025-09-30	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement-2025.html	FETCHED	Primary
S72	Deloitte Global	Deloitte reports FY2024 revenue	2024-09-12	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement-2024.html	FETCHED	Primary; includes restructure quote and US\$3bn GenAI
S73	Deloitte (CBC site)	Deloitte reports record FY2023 revenue	2023-09-07	https://www.deloitte.com/cbc/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement-2023.html	FETCHED	Primary
S74	Deloitte (KZ site)	2022 global revenue announcement	2022-09-08	https://www.deloitte.com/kz/en/about/press-room/2022-global-revenue-announcement.html	FETCHED	Primary
S75	Deloitte (CBC site)	Deloitte reports FY2021 revenue	2021-09-08	https://www.deloitte.com/cbc/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement-2021.html	FETCHED	Primary
S76	Accounting Today	Deloitte sees global revenue grow 5.5% to \$47.6B despite coronavirus	2020-09-15	https://www.accountingtoday.com/news/deloitte-sees-global-revenue-grow-5-5-to-47-6b-despite-coronavirus	FETCHED	Trade press, reliable
S77	Deloitte (India site)	Deloitte announces record revenue of US\$46.2 billion	2019-09	https://www.deloitte.com/in/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement-2019.html	FETCHED	Primary
S78	PR Newswire (Deloitte release)	Deloitte announces record revenue of US\$43.2 billion	2018-09-18	https://prnewswire.com/ru/press-releases/deloitte-announces-record-revenue-of-us432-billion-693567201.html	FETCHED	Primary via wire; FY2017 implied by + US\$4.4bn
S79	Accounting Today	Deloitte Increases Global Revenue in FY2016	2016-09	https://www.accountingtoday.com/news/deloitte-increases-global-revenue-in-fy2016	FETCHED	Trade press
S80	PR Newswire (Deloitte release)	Deloitte announces revenues of US\$35.2 billion	2015-09-22	https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/deloitte-announces-revenues-of-us352-billion-300146439.html	FETCHED	Primary via wire
S81	Deloitte Global	2025 Global Impact Report: Performance metrics and reporting frameworks (PDF)	2025	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-shared/docs/about/gir/global-performance-metrics-reporting.pdf	FETCHED	Primary; USD split by business/region/industry; people data
S82	Deloitte Global	Facts & Figures	live page	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/governance/facts-and-figures.html	FETCHED	Primary; purpose and legal footer
S83	Deloitte Global	About the network	live page	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/governance/network-brand-alliances/about-the-network.html	FETCHED	Primary; legal structure
S84	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK publishes 2026 financial results	2026-09-30	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-publishes-2026-financial-results.html	FETCHED	Primary
S85	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK publishes 2025 financial results	2025-09-30	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-publishes-2025-financial-results.html	FETCHED	Primary
S86	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK reports financial results (FY2024)	2024-09-30	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-reports-financial-results.html	FETCHED	Primary
S87	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK reports 2023 financial results	2023-09-29	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-reports-2023-financial-results.html	FETCHED	Primary
S88	Deloitte UK	Business and ESG performance metrics for FY26 (PDF)	2026-09	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2026/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2026-business-and-esg-performance-metrics.pdf	FETCHED	Primary; FY24-FY26 series
S89	Deloitte UK	Business and ESG Performance Metrics for FY25 (PDF)	2025-09	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2025/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2025-business-and-esg-performance-metrics.pdf	FETCHED	Primary; people metrics
S90	Deloitte UK	Business and ESG Performance Metrics for FY23 (PDF)	2023-09	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2023/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2023-business-and-esg-performance-metrics.pdf	FETCHED	Primary
S91	Deloitte UK	Business and ESG Performance Metrics FY22 (PDF)	2022-09	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2022/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2022-business-and-esg-performance-metrics.pdf	FETCHED	Primary
S92	Deloitte UK	Performance metrics for FY21 (PDF)	2021-09	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2021/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2021-business-and-esg-performance-metrics.pdf	FETCHED	Primary; FY19-FY21
S93	Deloitte LLP (OC303675)	Consolidated and LLP Financial Statements 2026 (PDF)	signed 2026-09-25	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2026/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2026-financial-statements.pdf	FETCHED	Primary audited accounts (BDO); same filing as Companies House

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S94	Deloitte UK	Audit Transparency Report 2025 (PDF)	2025	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2025/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2025-audit-transparency-report.pdf	FETCHED	Primary; governance, ISQM, PIRG, risk register
S95	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK promotes over 6,000 people and increases equity partners to a record high	2026-05-29	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-promotes.html	FETCHED	Primary
S96	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK announces Darren Graves as senior partner and chief executive	~2026-03-31	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-announces-new-senior-partner-and-chief-executive.html	FETCHED	Primary; exact date not shown in fetch
S97	International Accounting Bulletin	Deloitte UK appoints Darren Graves as next chief executive	2026-03-31	https://www.internationalaccountingbulletin.com/news/deloitte-uk-appoints-darren-graves/	FETCHED	Trade press
S98	Consultancy.eu	Deloitte brings EMEA firms together to form €20 billion integrated business	2026-03-02	https://www.consultancy.eu/news/13295/deloitte-brings-emea-firms-together-to-form-20-billion-integrated-business	FETCHED	Trade press
S99	City AM	Big Four giant Deloitte forms \$20bn EMEA unit amid tech disruption	2026 (Feb/Mar; date not shown)	https://www.cityam.com/big-four-giant-deloitte-forms-20bn-emea-unit-amid-tech-disruption/	FETCHED	Quality press; "unanimous" vote single-source
S100	City AM	Deloitte's tech consulting division weighs on growth	2026-09 (approx.)	https://www.cityam.com/deloittes-tech-consulting-division-weighs-on-growth/	FETCHED	Quality press; its "T&T declined" conflicts with S70
S101	Irish Times	Deloitte UK's revenues fall for first time in 15 years yet partners' pay rises	2025-09-30	https://www.irishtimes.com/business/2025/09/30/deloitte-uks-revenues-fall-for-first-time-in-15-years-yet-partners-pay-rises/	FETCHED	Quality press
S102	International Accounting Bulletin	Deloitte initiates job cuts in UK amid consulting slowdown (citing Bloomberg)	2025-10-01	https://www.internationalaccountingbulletin.com/news/deloitte-uk-job-cuts/	FETCHED	Trade press relaying Bloomberg
S103	Wikipedia	Deloitte	live	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Deloitte	FETCHED	Tertiary; used only for history and the 2020 RI settlement
S104	InfoWorld	Deloitte abandons plans to spin off consulting unit	2003-04-01	https://www.infoworld.com/article/2235062/deloitte-abandons-plans-to-spin-off-consulting-unit.html	FETCHED	Contemporary press
S105	Financial Reporting Council	Sanctions against Deloitte and two audit partners in relation to Autonomy Corporation Plc	2020-09-17	https://www.frc.org.uk/news-and-events/news/2020/09/sanctions-against-deloitte-and-two-audit-partners-in-relation-to-autonomy-corporation-plc/	FETCHED	Regulator primary
S106	Consultancy.uk	FRC fines Deloitte £4 million over Serco tagging scandal	2019-07	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/21773/frc-fines-deloitte-4-million-over-serco-tagging-scandal	FETCHED	Trade press
S107	Euronews	Deloitte Mitie fine	2022-04-21	https://www.euronews.com/next/2022/04/21/deloitte-mitie-fine	FETCHED	Press
S108	Sharecast	FRC fines Deloitte over SIG accounts	2022-12-22	https://www.sharecast.com/news/news-and-announcements/frc-fines-deloitte--11782448.html	FETCHED	Financial newswire
S109	Accountancy Age	Deloitte's Glencore audits under FRC scrutiny	2025-07-23	https://www.accountancyage.com/2025/07/23/deloittes-glencore-audits-under-frc-scrutiny/	FETCHED	Trade press
S110	Consultancy.uk	Big Four fined more than £100 million by FRC over five years	2025-06-24	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/40601/big-four-fined-more-than-100-million-by-frc-over-five-years	FETCHED	Trade press
S111	US SEC	Press release 2022-176 (Deloitte China)	2022-09-29	https://www.sec.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2022-176	FETCHED	Regulator primary
S112	CGTN	China's finance ministry fines Deloitte \$31m for auditing defects	2023-03-18	https://news.cgtn.com/news/2023-03-18/China-s-finance-ministry-fines-Deloitte-31m-for-auditing-defects-1igZ7JwcjPq/index.html	FETCHED	State media relaying MoF; Reuters/Yahoo snippet corroborates
S113	The Register	Deloitte refunds Australian government over AI in report	2025-10-06	https://www.theregister.com/2025/10/06/deloitte_ai_report_australia/	FETCHED	Tech press; Fortune/ACS snippets corroborate
S114	Consulting.us	Hit hard by federal consulting cuts, Deloitte begins layoffs	2025-04-07	https://www.consulting.us/news/11661/deloitte-hit-hard-by-us-federal-consulting-cuts-introduces-layoffs	FETCHED	Trade press; notes DOGE data was questioned
S115	Insurance Journal	RI Settles With Deloitte for \$12M Over 2024 Ransomware Attack on Benefits System	2026-05-04	https://www.insurancejournal.com/news/east/2026/05/04/868122.htm	FETCHED	Trade press
S116	Anthropic	Deloitte and Anthropic partnership	2025-10-06	https://www.anthropic.com/news/deloitte-anthropic-partnership	FETCHED	Primary (partner company); CNBC snippet corroborates
S117	Government Commercial Agency (ex-CCS)	Management Consultancy Framework Four RM6309	live page	https://www.gca.gov.uk/agreements/RM6309	FETCHED	Government primary; no day rates visible

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S118	CPA Practice Advisor	Deloitte Reports \$47.6 Billion in Revenue; 5.5% Growth	2020-09-15	https://www.cpapracticeadvisor.com/2020/09/15/deloitte-reports-47-6-billion-in-revenue-5-5-growth/40209/	SNIPPET	Used only for FY2020 headcount 334,800
S119	big4accountingfirms.com / consultancy.eu	Deloitte Revenue 2017; Deloitte doubles global revenues to \$65 billion	2017 / 2023-10-02	https://big4accountingfirms.com/the-blog/deloitte-revenue-2017/ ; https://www.consultancy.eu/news/9310/deloitte-doubles-global-revenues-to-65-billion-in-space-of-a-decade	SNIPPET / FETCHED	FY2017 headcount snippet only; consultancy.eu figures conflict with Deloitte primary, so not used
S120	Deloitte Global	Deloitte reports FY2026 revenue	2026-09 (late Sept)	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement.html	FETCHED	Primary
S121	Deloitte Global	Deloitte reports FY2025 revenue	2025-09-30	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement-2025.html	FETCHED	Primary
S122	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK publishes 2026 financial results	2026-09-30	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-publishes-2026-financial-results.html	FETCHED	Primary; total is UK and Switzerland consolidated (resolved via S88, S407)
S123	Irish Times	Deloitte UK's revenues fall for first time in 15 years yet partners' pay rises	2025-09-30	https://www.irishtimes.com/business/2025/09/30/deloitte-uks-revenues-fall-for-first-time-in-15-years-yet-partners-pay-rises/	SNIPPET	Single outlet snippet; Deloitte UK 2025 release exists at deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-publishes-2025-financial-results.html (not fetched)
S124	Deloitte EMEA	Deloitte announces the launch of an EMEA firm	2026-02-23	https://www.deloitte.com/emea/en/press-room/deloitte-announces-the-launch-of-an-emea-firm.html	FETCHED	Primary
S125	Yahoo Finance (Deloitte press release)	Deloitte ranked No. 1 Consulting Service Provider worldwide by revenue in 2026 Gartner Market Share report for ninth consecutive year	2026-06-25	https://finance.yahoo.com/technology/articles/deloitte-ranked-no-1-consulting-150000418.html	FETCHED	Firm's own claim; Gartner report paywalled (https://www.gartner.com/en/documents/6549902 is the 2024 edition, PAYWALLED-NOT-READ)
S126	Consulting.us / Accounting Today	PwC grows global revenue by 2.7% to \$56.9 billion	2025-10	https://www.consulting.us/news/12580/pwc-grows-global-revenue-by-27-to-569-billion	SNIPPET	PwC primary page returned 403; multiple outlets agree
S127	EY Global	EY announces global revenue of US\$53.2b for fiscal year 2025	2025-10	https://www.ey.com/en_gl/newsroom/2025/10/ey-announces-global-revenue-of-us-53-2b-for-fiscal-year-2025	FETCHED	Primary
S128	KPMG International	KPMG delivers 5.1% rise in global revenue	2025-12	https://www.kpmg.com/xx/en/media/press-releases/2025/12/kpmg-delivers-rise-in-global-revenue.html	FETCHED	Primary
S129	Accenture plc (SEC Form 8-K exhibit)	Accenture Reports Fourth-Quarter and Full-Year Fiscal 2026 Results	2026-10-01	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0001467373/000146737326000037/q4fy26earnings8-kexhibit.htm	FETCHED	Primary
S130	Fortune	Accenture \$865 million reinvention, exiting people without AI skills	2025-09-27	https://www.fortune.com/2025/09/27/accenture-865-million-reinvention-exiting-people-ai-skills	SNIPPET	Reported; headcount figures from snippet
S131	IBM (SEC filings, 2025 10-K / annual report)	IBM 2025 Annual Report	2026-02	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/51143/000005114326000027/ibmars2025.pdf	SNIPPET	Consulting figures from search extract of filing; headcount 264,300 from stockanalysis.com snippet citing SEC data
S132	Capgemini	Full-year 2025 results	2026-02	https://www.capgemini.com/news/press-releases/full-year-2025-results/	SNIPPET	Primary URL, figures from snippet
S133	BCG	BCG Reports \$14.4 Billion in Revenue, Marking 22nd Consecutive Year of Growth	2026-04-23	https://www.bcg.com/press/23april2026-bcg-revenue-22nd-consecutive-year-growth	FETCHED	Primary
S134	Accounting Today	Deloitte Acquires Strategic Consulting Firm Monitor	2013-01	https://www.accountingtoday.com/news/deloitte-acquires-strategic-consulting-firm-monitor	SNIPPET	Reported; price ~US\$116m per snippet, not used in text
S135	Slashdot (summarising Bloomberg)	McKinsey Plots Thousands of Job Cuts in Slowdown for Consulting Industry	2025-12-16	https://slashdot.org/story/25/12/16/1727251/mckinsey-plots-thousands-of-job-cuts-in-slowdown-for-consulting-industry	FETCHED	Secondary summary of Bloomberg (Bloomberg original PAYWALLED-NOT-READ)
S136	Financial Reporting Council	Annual Review of Audit Quality 2025 (PDF mirror)	2025-07	https://ftp.caailey.com/intl_cnt/frc/FRC_Annual_Review_of_Audit_Quality_2025.pdf	FETCHED	Primary FRC document via mirror; text extracted; per-firm values in chart not machine-readable
S137	Big4News	KPMG tops UK Big Four in FRC's 2026 audit quality inspections	2026-07	https://www.big4news.com/p/kpmg-tops-uk-big-four-in-frcs-2026	FETCHED	Single secondary outlet; FRC 2026 PDF not read
S138	Accountancy Today	PwC UK revenue rises 2% to £4.365bn as partner profits increase	2026-09-21	https://www.accountancytoday.co.uk/2026/09/21/pwc-uk-revenue-rises-2-to-4-365bn-as-partner-profits-increase/	SNIPPET	Fetch 403; group figures also in Irish Times snippet

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S139	International Accounting Bulletin	EY reports 2% increase in UK fee income in FY25	2025-10	https://www.internationalaccountingbulletin.com/news/ey-uk-fee-income-fy25/	SNIPPET	EY UK primary release at ey.com/en_uk/newsroom/2025/10/... not fetched
S140	KPMG UK	KPMG UK/Swiss Group annual results	2026-01	https://kpmg.com/uk/en/media/press-releases/2026/01/kpmg-uk-swiss-group-annual-results.html	FETCHED	Primary
S141	Accountancy Age	EY split timeline: The abandoned break-up plan	2023-04-13	https://accountancyage.com/2023/04/13/ey-split-timeline-the-abandoned-break-up-plan/	SNIPPET	Reported; US\$600m cost from secondary snippet
S142	Arizona Supreme Court	Arizona Leads the Way in Expanding Access to Justice (KPMG ABS)	2025-02-27	https://www.azcourts.gov/Portals/0/201/News%20Release%20-%20Arizona%20Supreme%20Court%20Authorizes%20KPMG%20ABS%20Certification%20FINAL.pdf	SNIPPET	Primary URL, content via snippet
S143	HRreview	Big Four accounting firms slash graduate hiring as AI takes on junior tasks	2025-06-24	https://hrreview.co.uk/hr-news/recruitment/big-four-slash-graduate-hiring-ai-takes-junior-tasks/382529	FETCHED	Original data source not named in article
S144	CPA Practice Advisor	Grant Thornton Closes Deal With Private Equity Firm New Mountain Capital	2024-06-03	https://www.cpapracticeadvisor.com/2024/06/03/gra/106284/	SNIPPET	Reported
S145	Accountancy Age	Grant Thornton partners paid £682k as Cinven deal closes	2025-04-16	https://accountancyage.com/2025/04/16/grant-thornton-partners-paid-682k-as-cinven-deal-closes/	SNIPPET	Reported
S146	Deloitte US	Ecosystems & Alliances Relationships	n.d.	https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/alliances/deloitte-alliances.html	FETCHED	Primary; no total alliance count on page
S147	Consultancy.uk	PwC sells mobility tax and immigration business for \$2.2 billion	2021-10-20	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/29277/pwc-sells-mobility-tax-and-immigration-business-for-22-billion	FETCHED	Reported, several outlets agree
S148	Consultancy.uk (MCA data)	Rising exports drove UK consulting industry growth in 2025	2026-07-06	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/44832/rising-exports-drove-uk-consulting-industry-growth-in-2025	FETCHED	Secondary report of MCA Annual Industry Report 2026
S149	Source Global Research	The UK Consulting Market in 2026	2026-02	https://sourceglobalresearch.com/reports/9749-the-uk-consulting-market-in-2026	FETCHED	Landing page only; full report PAYWALLED-NOT-READ
S150	Consultancy.uk	Rising exports drove UK consulting industry growth in 2025	2026-07 (MCA report pub. 6 Jul 2026 per article)	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/44832/rising-exports-drove-uk-consulting-industry-growth-in-2025	FETCHED	Reports MCA figures; secondary to MCA
S151	Oxford Economics	MCA Annual Industry Report 2026	2026-07-10	https://www.oxfordeconomics.com/resource/mca-annual-industry-report-2026/	FETCHED	Co-author of MCA report; primary
S152	MCA	British consulting sector surges ahead with record exports and strong growth forecasts	2025-07-07	https://www.mca.org.uk/press-releases/british-consulting-sector-surges-ahead-with-record-exports-and-strong-growth-forecasts	FETCHED	Primary
S153	MCA	MCA Annual Industry Report 2025 Executive Summary (PDF)	2025-07	https://www.mca.org.uk/wp-content/uploads/2025/07/MCA-Annual-Industry-Report-2025-Executive-Summary.pdf	FETCHED	Primary; text extracted from PDF
S154	Consultancy.uk	UK consulting leaders projecting growth of 5.7% in 2026	early 2026 (date not shown)	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/42874/uk-consulting-leaders-projecting-growth-of-57-in-2026	FETCHED	Reports MCA survey and Source £14.9bn
S155	Source Global Research	The UK Consulting Market in 2026	2026-02	https://sourceglobalresearch.com/reports/9749-the-uk-consulting-market-in-2026	FETCHED (landing page; full report PAYWALLED-NOT-READ)	Primary summary only
S156	Source Global Research	Which consulting services are clients set to buy in 2025's unreliable market? (Emma Carroll)	2025-06-10	https://www.sourceglobalresearch.com/blog-post/which-consulting-services-are-clients-set-to-buy-in-2025s-unreliable-market	FETCHED	Primary
S157	Consultancy.uk	Global technology consulting market to surpass \$400 billion in 2026	2025-12-19	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/42532/global-technology-consulting-market-to-surpass-400-billion-in-2026	FETCHED	Reports Source data
S158	Source Global Research	The 2026 consulting outlook: our expert predictions	2025-12	https://www.sourceglobalresearch.com/reports/9600-the-2026-consulting-outlook-our-expert-predictions	FETCHED (landing page)	Primary summary only
S159	Consultancy.org	United Kingdom consulting industry	undated, data c.2016-18	https://www.consultancy.org/consulting-industry/united-kingdom	FETCHED	Outdated; use only for indicative sector shares

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S160	Harvard Business Review (edited extract hosted by Eden McCallum)	Consulting on the Cusp of Disruption (Christensen, Wang, van Bever)	2013-10	https://edenmccallum.com/wp-content/uploads/2015/07/Consulting_on_the_Cusp_of_Disruption_2013.pdf	FETCHED	Edited extract of original HBR article
S161	Harvard Business Review	Consulting on the Cusp of Disruption	2013-10	https://hbr.org/2013/10/consulting-on-the-cusp-of-disruption	SNIPPET	Bibliographic confirmation (reprint R1310F)
S162	City AM	Big Four slash graduate jobs as AI takes on entry level work	2025-06-23 (upd. 30 Jun)	https://www.cityam.com/big-four-slash-graduate-jobs-as-ai-takes-on-entry-level-work/	FETCHED	Single outlet; widely re-reported
S163	futureofconsulting.ai (Marin Ivezic)	2026 Consulting's AI Revolution Update: Billions Spent, But the Old Pyramid Persists	2026-01-25	https://futureofconsulting.ai/ai-leadership/2026-consultings-ai-revolution-update/	FETCHED	Commentator blog; investment figures need primary check
S164	Resultsense	AI threatens Big Four scale advantage as UK boutiques attack	2026-05-28	https://www.resultsense.com/news/2026-05-28-ai-consulting-big-four-reckoning/	FETCHED	Summary of FT and City AM; second-hand quotes
S165	Financial Times	"AI dismantles consulting scale advantage as boutiques target Big Four" (Big Read, title as given by S164)	2026-05	URL not obtained	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ	Title per S164 only
S166	The Telegraph (via Yahoo Finance)	The AI consultants coming for the Big Four (Louis Goss)	2026-05-26	https://finance.yahoo.com/sectors/technology/articles/ai-consultants-coming-big-four-090143074.html	FETCHED	Single outlet
S167	Consultancy.uk	Big Four challenger Unity Advisory launches with backing of private equity	2025-04-29	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/39958/big-four-challenger-unity-advisory-launches-with-backing-of-private-equity	FETCHED	Corroborated by Accountancy Age, IAB snippets
S168	PE Insights / Accountancy Age	Cinven completes buyout of Grant Thornton UK; Grant Thornton partners paid £682k as Cinven deal closes	2025-04	https://pe-insights.com/cinven-completes-buyout-of-grant-thornton-uk-in-deal-expected-to-value-firm-at-up-to-1-5bn/ ; https://accountancyage.com/2025/04/16/grant-thornton-partners-paid-682k-as-cinven-deal-closes/	SNIPPET	Two outlets in snippets
S169	Nextgov/FCW	Pentagon hits Accenture, Booz Allen and Deloitte with contract cancellations	2025-04	https://www.nextgov.com/acquisition/2025/04/pentagon-hits-accenture-booz-allen-and-deloitte-contract-cancellations/404525/	FETCHED	Also Washington Technology
S170	Fortune	DOGE's private contract crackdown has eliminated more than 120 Deloitte contracts	2025-04-03	https://www.fortune.com/2025/04/03/doge-private-contract-crackdown-deloitte-consultancies	SNIPPET	Not fetched
S171	AP via US News / Washington Post	Deloitte to partially refund Australian government for report with apparent AI-generated errors	2025-10-07	https://www.usnews.com/news/business/articles/2025-10-07/deloitte-to-partially-refund-australian-government-for-report-with-apparent-ai-generated-errors	SNIPPET	Fetch returned 503; details from search snippets of AP story
S172	PublicTechnology	Government slashed £600m of consultancy spend in FY25	2026-01-15	https://www.publictechnology.net/2026/01/15/business-and-industry/government-slashed-600m-of-consultancy-spend-in-fy25/	FETCHED	Reports government figures
S173	National Audit Office	Government's use of external consultants	2025-11-21	https://www.nao.org.uk/insights/governments-use-of-external-consultants/	FETCHED	Primary
S174	City AM	Government consultants pledge under threat as spending jumps	2025-07-22	https://www.cityam.com/government-consultants-pledge-under-threat-as-spending-jumps/	FETCHED	Tussell data analysis; single outlet
S175	City AM	Big Four under pressure as government looks to slash £5.4bn consultant bill	2024-09-19	https://www.cityam.com/big-four-under-pressure-as-government-looks-to-slash-5-4bn-consultant-bill/	FETCHED	Note: says Procurement Act effective Oct 2024, later delayed to Feb 2025
S176	Civil Service World	Labour government would halve consultancy spending, Reeves says	2023-10-10	https://www.civilserviceworld.com/news/article/labour-reeves-consultancy-spending-covid-corruption-commissioner-hs2-major-projects-review	FETCHED	Primary quotes
S177	City AM	Reeves vows to halve consultancy bill, but government can't track spending	2025-11	https://www.cityam.com/reeves-vows-to-halve-consultancy-bill-but-government-cant-track-its-spending/	SNIPPET	Corroborates targets
S178	FRC	FRC updates the Ethical Standard for auditors	2024-01-15	https://www.frc.org.uk/news-and-events/news/2024/01/frc-updates-the-ethical-standard-for-auditors/	FETCHED	Primary
S179	ICAS	The FRC Ethical Standard	undated	https://www.icas.com/regulation-technical-resources/regulation/ethics/frc-ethical-standard	FETCHED	Professional body
S180	Deloitte (IAS Plus)	Governance in brief: New audit independence rules, the Revised Ethical Standard 2019	2020-02	https://iasplus.com/content/48b2c486-fc0b-42e0-b477-43d596acea7	FETCHED	Deloitte's own technical briefing; PDF text extracted
S181	ACCA	Revisions to the FRC's Ethical Standard	undated	https://www.accaglobal.com/uk/en/member/sectors/internal-audit/our-publications/revisions-to-the-frcs-ethical-standard.html	FETCHED	Professional body

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S182	EUR-Lex	Regulation (EU) No 537/2014	2014-04-16 (applies 2016-06-17)	https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2014/537/oj	FETCHED	Primary; only citation page rendered
S183	FRC	FRC principles for operational separation of audit practices	2020-07-06	https://www.frc.org.uk/news/july-2020/frc-principles-for-operational-separation-of-a-(1)	FETCHED	Primary
S184	FRC	Big Four audit firms conclude transition period of operational separation	2024-10-10	https://www.frc.org.uk/news-and-events/news/2024/10/big-four-audit-firms-conclude-transition-period-of-operational-separation/	FETCHED	Primary
S185	Scottish Financial News	UK government abandons Audit Reform Bill	2026-01-20	https://www.scottishfinancialnews.com/articles/uk-government-abandons-audit-reform-bill	FETCHED	Corroborated by ICAEW S186
S186	ICAEW	Government abandons Audit Reform Bill	2026-01	https://www.icaew.com/insights/viewpoints-on-the-news/2026/jan-2026/government-abandons-audit-reform-bill	SNIPPET	Fetch rendered only navigation
S187	Wikipedia	Audit, Reporting and Governance Authority	ongoing	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Audit,_Reporting_and_Governance_Authority	FETCHED	Tertiary; out of date after 2023
S188	Prime Minister's Office (gov.uk)	The King's Speech 2026: background briefing notes	2026-05-13	https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/6a046665c0cc74b4523e4d3b/The_King_s_Speech_2026_-_background_briefing_notes.pdf	FETCHED	Primary; full text searched
S189	Deloitte UK blog	King's Speech 2026: what does it mean for financial services regulation?	2026-05-14	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/blogs/ecrs/kings-speech-2026-what-does-it-mean-for-financial-services-regulation.html	FETCHED	Deloitte primary
S190	Government Commercial Agency	The Procurement Act 2023	2026	https://www.gca.gov.uk/about-gca/the-procurement-act-2023	FETCHED	Primary; confirms CCS to GCA 1 Apr 2026
S191	Find a Tender / BidStats / GovData	Management Consultancy Framework Four (MCF4)	2024-11 to 2026-01	https://www.find-tender.service.gov.uk/Notice/036921-2024	SNIPPET	Details from aggregator snippets; not fetched
S192	Orrick	EU AI Act Update: Digital Omnibus Finalizes 8 Compliance Changes	2026-07	https://www.orrick.com/en/Insights/2026/07/EU-AI-Act-Update-Digital-Omnibus-Finalizes-8-Compliance-Changes	FETCHED	Law firm; dates partly conflict with S193
S193	artificialintelligenceact.eu (Future of Life Institute)	Implementation timeline	updated 2026	https://artificialintelligenceact.eu/implementation-timeline/	FETCHED	Annex III date (2 Aug 2027) conflicts with S192
S194	Wikipedia	Data (Use and Access) Act 2025	ongoing	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Data_(Use_and_Access)_Act_2025	FETCHED	Tertiary; Royal Assent date matches Norton Rose, Mayer Brown snippets
S195	Pearl Cohen / Bratby Law (search snippets)	UK Data (Use and Access) Act main provisions enter into force	2026	https://www.pearlcohen.com/uk-data-use-and-access-act-main-provisions-enter-into-force/	SNIPPET	Commencement dates
S196	Regulation Tomorrow (Eversheds Sutherland)	Implementation of Basel 3.1: PRA publishes final rules	2026-01	https://www.regulationtomorrow.com/2026/01/implementation-of-basel-3-1-pra-publishes-final-rules/	FETCHED	Law firm summary of PRA PS1/26
S197	Bank of England	The PRA announces a delay to the implementation of Basel 3.1	2025-01	https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/news/2025/january/the-pra-announces-a-delay-to-the-implementation-of-basel-3-1	SNIPPET	Primary, not fetched
S198	FCA / Payment Expert	FCA welcomes final report of Accelerated Settlement Taskforce; UK confirms T+1 in October 2027	2025-02-19	https://paymentexpert.com/2025/02/19/uk-announces-2027-t1-settlements-move/	SNIPPET	Multiple outlets agree
S199	FCA	PS21/3 Building operational resilience	2021-03	https://www.fca.org.uk/publications/policy-statements/ps21-3-building-operational-resilience	SNIPPET	Primary title; deadline confirmed by several firms
S200	FCA	PS22/9: A new Consumer Duty	2022-07	https://www.fca.org.uk/publications/policy-statements/ps22-9-new-consumer-duty	SNIPPET	Primary title; dates confirmed by several firms
S201	Deloitte UK Legal	The Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA): the legal implications	undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/services/legal/services/the-digital-operational-resilience-act-dora-the-legal-implications.html	SNIPPET	17 Jan 2025 date widely confirmed
S202	Global Financial Regulation blog (Mayer Brown)	UK Government publishes final sustainability and climate-related reporting standards	2026-03	https://www.globalfinregblog.com/2026/03/uk-government-publishes-final-sustainability-and-climate-related-reporting-standards/	SNIPPET	Date 25 Feb 2026 per snippets
S203	Reed Smith / Bird & Bird	AI Opportunities Action Plan; UK AI regulatory tracker	2025-01 / 2026	https://www.reedsmith.com/articles/uk-government-ai-opportunities-action-plan-approach-towards-ai-regulation/	SNIPPET	Law firm commentary
S204	Deloitte UK	Legal / Terms of use	current	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/legal/legal.html	FETCHED	Primary

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S205	MCA	Consulting Industry Reports	current	https://www.mca.org.uk/reports	FETCHED	Primary
S206	Inc. / Washington Technology	Layoffs hit consulting giant Booz Allen as DOGE-cancelled contracts take a toll	2025	https://www.inc.com/bruce-crumley/layoffs-hit-consulting-giant-booz-allen-as-doge-cancelled-contracts-take-a-toll/91194205	SNIPPET	Not fetched
S207	Bloomberg	McKinsey plans to use AI agents to help choose client teams	2026-05-01	https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-05-01/mckinsey-plans-to-use-ai-agents-to-help-choose-client-teams	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ	Headline only
S220	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK publishes 2026 financial results	2026-09-30	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-publishes-2026-financial-results.html	FETCHED	Primary
S221	Deloitte Global	Deloitte reports FY2026 revenue	2026-09-24	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement.html	FETCHED	Primary; local-currency 3.8% from CPA Practice Advisor summary
S222	City AM	Deloitte's tech consulting division weighs on growth	2026-09-24	https://www.cityam.com/deloittes-tech-consulting-division-weighs-on-growth/	FETCHED	Quality press; CEO quote truncated on fetch
S223	Bloomberg	Deloitte UK Partner Pay Grows to \$1.5 Million on AI Demand	2026-09-29	https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-09-29/deloitte-uk-partner-pay-grows-to-1-5-million-on-ai-demand	PAYWALLED	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ; summary only
S224	Deloitte UK	Deloitte CFO Survey Q2 2026: Growing AI optimism	2026-07-20	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-cfo-survey-quate-two-2026-growing-ai-optimism.html	FETCHED	Primary
S225	Deloitte UK	UK finance leaders' confidence drops as geopolitical risk dominates agenda (CFO Survey Q1 2026)	2026-04-13	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/uk-finance-leaders-confidence-drop-as-geopolitical-risk-dominat-april-2026.html	FETCHED	Primary
S226	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK appoints first Chief AI Officer	2026-06-01	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-appoints-first-chief-ai-officer-2026.html	FETCHED	Primary
S227	City AM	More Big Four blues as Deloitte plans to slash UK audit roles	2026-06-16	https://www.cityam.com/more-big-four-blues-as-deloitte-plans-to-slash-uk-audit-roles/	FETCHED	Quality press; corroborated by S228
S228	Bloomberg	Deloitte UK Plans Voluntary Redundancies for Up to 175 Audit Staff	2026-06-16	https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-06-16/deloitte-uk-to-shed-up-to-175-auditors-in-voluntary-job-cuts	PAYWALLED	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ; headline only
S229	Resultsense (summarising City AM)	How AI is changing Big Four graduate training in the UK	2026-09-23	https://www.resultsense.com/news/2026-09-23-big-four-graduate-training-ai/	FETCHED	Secondary summary of City AM; no Deloitte-specific detail
S230	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK promotes over 6,000 people and increases equity partners to a record high	2026-05-29	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-promotes.html	FETCHED	Primary
S231	Consultancy.uk	2026 intake of early-career staff to hit 1,500 at Deloitte	2026-09-10	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/45536/2026-intake-of-early-career-staff-to-hit-1500-at-deloitte	FETCHED	Trade press; headline "1,500" vs body 1,353 (body used)
S232	Deloitte UK	Deloitte welcomes next generation of talent with nearly 1,500 graduate and apprentice hires	2025-09-01	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-welcomes-next-generation-of-talent.html	FETCHED	Primary; prior-year baseline
S233	The Register	UK.gov vows to cut consultancy spending, then hands up to £350M to consultancies	2026-07-01	https://www.theregister.com/public-sector/2026/07/01/ukgov-vows-to-cut-consultancy-spending-then-hands-up-to-350m-to-consultancies/5264864	FETCHED	Single outlet; based on procurement notices
S234	Morgan Lewis	EU Approves Delays and Other Amendments to Certain EU AI Act Obligations	2026-06-24	https://www.morganlewis.com/pubs/2026/06/eu-approves-delays-and-other-amendments-to-certain-eu-ai-act-obligations-what-businesses-should-know	FETCHED	Law firm; dates matched by Gibson Dunn, Travers Smith snippets
S235	ICAEW	Government abandons Audit Reform Bill	2026-01	https://www.icaew.com/insights/viewpoints-on-the-news/2026/jan-2026/government-abandons-audit-reform-bill	SNIPPET	Page body did not load; facts from search summaries
S236	Big4News (citing FRC)	KPMG tops UK Big Four in FRC's 2026 audit quality inspections	2026-07-22	https://www.big4news.com/p/kpmg-tops-uk-big-four-in-frcs-2026	FETCHED	Secondary; FRC primary at frc.org.uk/news-and-events/news/2026/07/ not fetched
S237	FRC	Annual Review of Audit Quality 2026 (linked from S236)	2026-07	https://www.frc.org.uk/news-and-events/news/2026/07/frc-annual-review-of-audit-quality-equips-investors-and-audit-committees-to-make-better-decisions/	SNIPPET	Not fetched; URL from S236
S238	Accenture (SEC 8-K)	Accenture Reports Fourth-Quarter and Full-Year Fiscal 2026 Results	2026-10-01	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1467373/000146737326000037/q4fy26earnings8-kexhibit.htm	FETCHED	Primary
S239	City AM	UK firms slash consulting spend amid rising AI adoption	2026-09-09	https://www.cityam.com/business-spend-pulse-uk-firms-slash-consulting-spend-amid-rising-ai-adoption/	FETCHED	SME card data (Capital on Tap)

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S240	Consultancy.uk	UK consulting clients turning to sector for AI transformation support	2026-05-06	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/44009/uk-consulting-clients-turning-to-sector-for-ai-transformation-support	FETCHED	Reports MCA/Savanta survey
S241	Consultancy.uk	UK consulting leaders projecting growth of 5.7% in 2026	2026-01-23	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/42874/uk-consulting-leaders-projecting-growth-of-57-in-2026	FETCHED	Reports MCA survey
S242	US Department of Justice	Deloitte agrees to pay \$21.5M to resolve alleged employment discrimination violations	2026-08-25	https://www.justice.gov/opa/pr/deloitte-agrees-pay-215m-resolve-alleged-employment-discrimination-violations	FETCHED	Primary; US firm, not UK
S243	Consultancy.uk	UK workers spend nearly £1 billion personally for GenAI at work	2026-09-24	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/45683/uk-workers-spend-nearly-1-billion-personally-for-genai-at-work	FETCHED	Reports Deloitte research
S244	PR Newswire (Deloitte)	AI Comes of Age: Deloitte's 17th Annual Tech Trends Report	2025-12-10	https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/ai-comes-of-age-deloittes-17th-annual-tech-trends-report-reveals-how-leading-organizations-are-scaling-ai-for-outcomes-and-impact-302637130.html	FETCHED	Primary (firm release)
S245	Deloitte UK	Tech Trends 2026 landing page	n/d	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/services/consulting/perspectives/tech-trends.html	SNIPPET	Primary; not fetched
S246	PwC UK / Accountancy Today	PwC UK 2026 financial results / PwC UK revenue rises 2% to £4.365bn	2026-09 (AT dated 2026-09-21)	https://www.pwc.co.uk/press-room/press-releases/corporate-news/pwc-uk-2026-financial-results--transformation-delivering-results.html	SNIPPET	PwC page returned 403; figures from search summaries
S247	Irish Times	PwC UK revenues slide for first time in more than a decade	2026-09-16	https://www.irishtimes.com/business/2026/09/16/pwc-uk-revenues-slide-for-first-time-in-more-than-a-decade/	SNIPPET	Headline only; refers to consolidated group
S248	Accountancy Today / Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK appoints Debapratim De as chief economist	2026-06-04	https://www.accountancytoday.co.uk/2026/06/04/deloitte-uk-appoints-debapratim-de-as-chief-economist/	SNIPPET	Also deloitte.com press release seen in search
S249	Fortune	Deloitte AI Australia government report hallucinations refund	2025-10-07	https://fortune.com/2025/10/07/deloitte-ai-australia-government-report-hallucinations-technology-290000-refund	SNIPPET	Multiple outlets agree
S250	CNBC	Anthropic lands its biggest enterprise deployment ever with Deloitte deal	2025-10-06	https://www.cnn.com/2025/10/06/anthropic-deloitte-enterprise-ai.html	SNIPPET	Multiple outlets agree
S251	Accountancy Today	Deloitte UK appoints Darren Graves as new CEO	2026-04-01	https://www.accountancytoday.co.uk/2026/04/01/deloitte-uk-appoints-darren-graves-as-new-ceo/	SNIPPET	403 on fetch; start date confirmed by S220/S230
S252	Accountancy Age	Deloitte's Glencore audits under FRC scrutiny	2025-07-23	https://www.accountancyage.com/2025/07/23/deloittes-glencore-audits-under-frc-scrutiny/	SNIPPET	Ongoing investigation
S253	Accountancy Today	FRC opens investigations into Stenn audits by Azets and Deloitte	2025-07-10	https://www.accountancytoday.co.uk/2025/07/10/frc-opens-investigations-into-stenn-audits-by-azets-and-deloitte/	SNIPPET	Ongoing investigation
S254	Yahoo Finance	Deloitte to establish four technology centres across UK	2025-05-21	https://finance.yahoo.com/news/deloitte-establish-four-technology-centres-143758537.html	FETCHED	Reports Deloitte announcement
S255	City AM	Big Four slash graduate jobs as AI takes on entry level work	c.2025 (not verified)	https://www.cityam.com/big-four-slash-graduate-jobs-as-ai-takes-on-entry-level-work/	SNIPPET	Date unverified; figures widely repeated
S256	Yahoo Finance (Deloitte US)	Deloitte CFO Signals Survey (Q3 26): CFO Confidence Rebounds	2026-09	https://finance.yahoo.com/economy/articles/deloitte-cfo-signals-survey-q326-104500728.html	SNIPPET	US survey, not UK
S257	KPMG UK	KPMG UK records revenue of £2.99billion in a challenging market	2026-01	https://kpmg.com/uk/en/media/press-releases/2026/01/kpmg-uk-records-good-revenue-in-challenging-market.html	SNIPPET	Not fetched
S258	Final Round AI (secondary)	McKinsey Layoffs 2026	2026	https://www.finalroundai.com/blog/mckinsey-layoffs-2026	SNIPPET	Low-quality source; treat as unverified
S259	Employee Benefits	Deloitte increases bonus pool for UK employees by 14 %	2026-09-30	https://www.employeebenefits.co.uk/pay-strategy/2026/09/30/deloitte-increases-bonus-pool-for-uk-employees-by-14/	SNIPPET	Corroborates S220/S230
S260	Deloitte UK	Early careers assessment (application process)	Undated, current 2026	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/early-careers/early-careers-assessment.html	FETCHED	Primary; high
S261	Deloitte UK	Early careers FAQ	Undated, current	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/early-careers/early-careers-faq.html	FETCHED	Primary; high
S262	Deloitte UK	Early careers application timelines	Shows 2024 cycle dates	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/early-careers/early-careers-application-timelines.html	FETCHED	Primary but stale for 2027 entry
S263	TargetJobs	Your guide to the Deloitte application process: from start to finish	17 Apr 2025	https://targetjobs.co.uk/careers-advice/accountancy-banking-and-finance/your-guide-deloitte-application-process-start-finish	FETCHED	Reputable careers publisher; quotes Deloitte team

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S264	WikiJob	Deloitte Application Process for 2026: A Step-By-Step Guide	Updated 9 Jun 2025	https://www.wikijob.co.uk/interview-advice/company-interview-questions/deloitte	FETCHED	Candidate-reported questions; values section outdated
S265	WikiJob	Deloitte Interview Questions 2026: A Complete Guide	Updated 12 Jun 2025	https://www.wikijob.co.uk/industry/accountancy-professional-services/deloitte-consulting-interview-questions	FETCHED	Generic examples, not candidate reports
S266	Deloitte Global	Shared Values (Global Principles of Business Conduct)	Undated, current	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/story/purpose-values/global-principles-of-business-conduct/shared-values.html	FETCHED	Primary; high
S267	Accountancy Age	Deloitte seeks to end unconscious class bias with recruitment revamp	29 Sep 2015	https://accountancyage.com/2015/09/29/deloitte-seeks-to-end-unconscious-class-bias-with-recruitment-revamp/	FETCHED	Trade press; high for 2015 facts
S268	Recruiter	Deloitte partners with Rare Recruitment to improve graduate and school-leaver recruitment	29 Sep 2015	https://www.recruiter.co.uk/2015/09/29/deloitte-partners-rare-recruitment-improve-graduate-and-school-leaver-recruitment	SNIPPET	Corroborates S267; Rare named
S269	Deloitte UK	Early Careers Consulting	Undated, current	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/our-business-areas/early-careers-consulting.html	FETCHED	Primary; team list
S270	Deloitte UK	Early Careers Technology	Undated, current	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/our-business-areas/early-career-technology.html	FETCHED	Primary
S271	Deloitte UK press room	Deloitte opens doors for 1,500 new graduates, apprentices, and early careers talent	1 Sep 2026	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-opens-doors-for-1500-new-graduates-apprentices-and-early-careers-talent.html	FETCHED	Primary; high
S272	Higherin	Register Your Interest: Consulting Graduate Programme 2027 at Deloitte	2026 (listing expired)	https://higherin.com/jobs/43729/deloitte/register-your-interest-consulting-graduate-programme-2027	FETCHED	Job board copy of Deloitte advert
S273	Deloitte UK press room	Deloitte UK announces new senior partner and chief executive	30 Mar 2026	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-announces-new-senior-partner-and-chief-executive.html	FETCHED	Primary; high
S274	Deloitte UK press room	Deloitte UK appoints first Chief AI Officer	1 Jun 2026	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-appoints-first-chief-ai-officer-2026.html	FETCHED	Primary; high
S275	Consultancy.uk	Deloitte picks Hammad Rafique as managing partner for Technology & Transformation	2026 (exact date not shown in fetch)	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/44180/deloitte-picks-hammad-rafiq-ue-as-managing-partner-for-technology-transformation	FETCHED	Trade press; career detail single-source
S276	Deloitte UK	Leadership and governance	Undated, current	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/governance/leadership-and-governance.html	FETCHED	Primary; current Executive list
S277	Deloitte EMEA press room	Deloitte announces the launch of an EMEA firm	23 Feb 2026	https://www.deloitte.com/emea/en/press-room/deloitte-announces-the-launch-of-an-emea-firm.html	FETCHED	Primary; high
S278	Deloitte Global	Joe Ucuzoglu profile	Undated, current	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/people/profiles/gbod-joe-ucuzoglu.html	FETCHED	Primary; high
S279	Deloitte UK press room	Deloitte UK publishes 2026 financial results	2026 (FY to 31 May 2026; publication date not shown)	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-publishes-2026-financial-results.html	FETCHED	Primary; high
S280	Deloitte UK press room	Deloitte UK promotes over 6,000 people and increases equity partners to a record high	29 May 2026	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-promotes.html	FETCHED	Primary; high
S281	Deloitte UK	Matt Batham profile	Undated, references Oct 2026	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/people/profiles/matbatham+dd4c778d.html	FETCHED	Primary; very recent change
S282	Consultancy.uk	Hayley McKelvey becomes Deloitte's first AI chief	2 Jun 2026	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/44322/hayley-mckelvey-becomes-deloittes-first-ai-chief	FETCHED	Trade press; corroborates S274
S283	Deloitte UK	Deloitte University EMEA: A world-class approach to developing tomorrow's talent	Undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/story/impact/deloitte-university-emea.html	FETCHED	Primary
S284	BESIX	BESIX delivers Deloitte's new University centre EMEA just outside Paris (France)	2024	https://www.besix.com/en/news/besix-delivers-deloittes-new-university-centre-emea-just-outside-paris-france	SNIPPET	Location detail (Bailly-Romainvilliers) from search summary
S285	Accountancy Today	Deloitte UK appoints Jane Whitlock as board chair	10 Apr 2026	https://www.accountancytoday.co.uk/2026/04/10/deloitte-uk-appoints-jane-whitlock-as-board-chair/	SNIPPET	Title confirmed by S276
S286	PrepLounge forum	Deloitte UK Final interview with senior manager for technology consulting	6 and 12 Jan 2022	https://www.preplounge.com/consulting-forum/deloitte-uk-final-interview-with-senior-manager-for-technology-consulting-12464	FETCHED	Anecdote; experienced hire, not graduate

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S287	GameAssessmentPrep	Deloitte HireVue Questions 2026-2027	Aug 2026	https://www.gameassessmentprep.com/hirevue/questions/deloitte	FETCHED	Prep vendor; mixes US and UK reports
S288	Hacking the Case Interview (via search summary)	Deloitte Job Simulation: Complete Guide (2026)	2026	https://www.hackingthecaseinterview.com/pages/deloitte-job-simulation	SNIPPET	Page 403; reported questions from search summary only
S289	Glassdoor UK	Deloitte Graduate Consultant / London interview questions	Various, dates not visible	https://www.glassdoor.co.uk/Interview/Deloitte-Graduate-Consultant-Interview-Questions-ELIE2763.0,8_KO9,28.htm	SNIPPET	Page 403; anecdote, undated
S290	Accountancy Daily	Deloitte picks Darren Graves for top job in uncontested vote	2026	https://www.accountancydaily.co/deloitte-picks-darren-graves-top-job-uncontested-vote	SNIPPET	Headline-level only
S291	Indeed UK	Background Check at Deloitte (Q&A)	Undated	https://uk.indeed.com/cmp/Deloitte/faq/background-check	SNIPPET	Low reliability, user-generated
S292	Hacking the Case Interview	Deloitte Final Round Interview: Format and 8 Tips	2026	https://www.hackingthecaseinterview.com/pages/deloitte-final-round-interview	SNIPPET	US-centric; page 403
S293	Deloitte UK careers (search result summary)	Pre-employment screening / independence text (exact page unconfirmed; candidate page: Experienced Careers Programmes & Networks or 2024 intake press release)	Undated	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/professional-careers/experienced-careers-programmes-networks.html	SNIPPET	Security Watchdog detail not seen on a fetched page
S294	Search result summary (source page unclear, likely Deloitte UK or Bright Network)	Graduate Learning Academy and induction content	Undated	https://www.brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-employer-company/deloitte/	SNIPPET	Low confidence on attribution
S297	Deloitte Global	Richard Houston profile	Undated	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/people/profiles.rhouston+cd5eff6c.html	SNIPPET	Career detail from search summary of primary page
S300	Deloitte Global	Deloitte reports FY2026 revenue	2026-09-24	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement.html	FETCHED	Primary
S301	Deloitte Global	Global Impact Report: Business	2025	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/governance/global-impact-report/global-report-business.html	FETCHED	Primary; FY25 figures
S302	Deloitte Global	About the network	n.d.	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/governance/network-brand-alliances/about-the-network.html	FETCHED	Primary
S303	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK publishes 2026 financial results	2026-09 (late)	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-publishes-2026-financial-results.html	FETCHED	Primary; 25,000 headcount figure to verify against full release
S304	Accountancy Today	Deloitte UK revenue rises 2% to £5.81bn as distributable profit climbs 14%	2026-09-30	https://www.accountancytoday.co.uk/2026/09/30/deloitte-uk-revenue-rises-2-to-5-81bn-as-distributable-profit-climbs-14/	SNIPPET	Corroborates S303
S305	Scottish Financial News	Profits rise 4% at Deloitte UK despite first revenue decline in 15 years	2025	https://www.scottishfinancialnews.com/articles/profits-rise-4-at-deloitte-uk-despite-first-revenue-decline-in-15-years	FETCHED	Single outlet for FY25 business splits
S306	Consultancy.eu	Deloitte brings EMEA firms together to form €20 billion integrated business	2026-03-02	https://www.consultancy.eu/news/13295/deloitte-brings-emea-firms-together-to-form-20-billion-integrated-business	FETCHED	Single trade outlet; verify on deloitte.com
S307	Consultancy.com.au	Deloitte launches global restructure and merges advisory businesses	2024-03-19	https://www.consultancy.com.au/news/8995/deloitte-launches-global-restructure-and-merges-advisory-businesses	FETCHED	Trade press
S308	Going Concern	Deloitte Global CEO Joe Ucuzoglu Just Mic Dropped EY's Messy Split Drama	2023-03-10	https://www.goingconcern.com/deloitte-global-ceo-joe-ucuzoglu-just-mic-dropped-ey-s-messy-split-drama/	FETCHED	Reports internal video; not primary
S309	Accounting Today	Deloitte denies plan to split firm	2022-06-10	https://www.accountingtoday.com/news/deloitte-denies-plan-to-split-firm	FETCHED	Quotes Deloitte statement
S310	Accountancy Age	EY split timeline: The abandoned break-up plan	2023-04-13	https://accountancyage.com/2023/04/13/ey-split-timeline-the-abandoned-break-up-plan/	FETCHED	Trade press
S311	International Tax Review / SCMP	EY cancels 'Project Everest' after months of wrangling	2023-04	https://www.internationaltaxreview.com/article/2biwi2cm9onjwgv7qed4w/ey-cancels-project-everest-after-months-of-wrangling	SNIPPET	Consistent with S310
S312	City AM	Regulator gives green light on Big Four plans for audit separation	2021-02-24	https://www.cityam.com/regulator-gives-green-light-on-big-four-plans-for-audit-separation/	FETCHED	Press; FRC primary not fetched
S313	MinterEllison / Lexology	FRC operational separation principles	2020-07	https://www.minterellison.com/articles/overview-frc-operational-separation-principles-july-2020	SNIPPET	Law-firm summary of FRC principles

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S314	ICAS / ACCA / Accountancy Daily	FRC strengthens auditor independence requirements; FRC bans majority of non-audit services	2019-12	https://www.icas.com/news-insights-event/s/news/ethics/frc-strengthens-auditor-independence-requirements	SNIPPET	Accountancy Daily fetch returned 403; several outlets agree
S315	Academy of Management Journal	Greenwood & Suddaby, Institutional entrepreneurship in mature fields: The Big Five accounting firms, 49(1) 27-48	2006	https://journals.aom.org/doi/abs/10.5465/amj.2006.20785498	SNIPPET	PDF fetch returned 503; abstract only
S316	The Register	Deloitte refunds Australian government over AI in report	2025-10-06	https://www.theregister.com/2025/10/06/deloitte_ai_report_australia/	FETCHED	Corroborated by S317
S317	Fortune / Washington Post	Deloitte to partially refund Australian government for report with apparent AI-generated errors	2025-10-07	https://fortune.com/2025/10/07/deloitte-ai-australia-government-report-hallucinations-technology-290000-refund	SNIPPET	Corroborates S316
S318	Consultancy.uk	Big Four fined more than £100 million by FRC over five years	c.2024	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/40601/big-four-fined-more-than-100-million-by-frc-over-five-years	FETCHED	Glencore investigation detail from Accountancy Age snippet (2025-07-23)
S319	Deloitte UK	UK Ecosystems & Alliances	n.d.	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/alliances.html	FETCHED	Primary
S320	Deloitte UK	Professional Opportunities in Technology & Transformation	n.d.	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/our-business-areas/professional-opportunities-in-technology-and-transformation.html	FETCHED	Primary
S321	Bright Network / Prosple	Deloitte 2027 graduate scheme listings (Business Transformation Consulting; T&T)	2026	https://www.brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-jobs/deloitte/business-transformation-consulting-customer-products-graduate-scheme-2027-1	SNIPPET	Fetch 403; wording from search snippets only
S322	Deloitte US (profiles, apply.deloitte.com)	Lead Client Service Partner profiles and CRE postings	n.d.	https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/about/people/profiles.maprice+70a902a.html	SNIPPET	US firm; UK equivalent assumed similar INFERRED
S323	Consultancy.uk	Deloitte pledges hundreds of technology centre jobs in UK	2025-05-22	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/40161/deloitte-pledges-hundreds-of-technology-centre-jobs-in-uk	FETCHED	Multiple outlets agree
S324	People Matters / Consultancy.in	Deloitte Hyderabad / USI headcount	2023-2025	https://www.consultancy.in/news/1939/deloitte-to-double-hyderabad-staff-to-nearly-80000-in-the-near-future	SNIPPET	Trade press estimates
S325	Anthropic	Deloitte and Anthropic partnership	2025-10-06	https://www.anthropic.com/news/deloitte-anthropic-partnership	FETCHED	Primary (partner)
S326	CNBC	Anthropic lands its biggest enterprise deployment ever with Deloitte deal	2025-10-06	https://www.cnn.com/2025/10/06/anthropic-deloitte-enterprise-ai.html	SNIPPET	Corroborates S325
S327	PR Newswire (Deloitte US)	Deloitte Unveils Zora AI, Agentic AI for Tomorrow's Workforce	2025-03-18	https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/deloitte-unveils-zora-ai-agentic-ai-for-tomorrows-workforce-302404892.html	FETCHED	Primary press release; targets
S328	Consultancy.uk	Deloitte rolls out generative AI tool PairD to EMEA employees	2024-01-11	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/36277/deloitte-rolls-out-generative-ai-tool-paird-to-emea-employees	FETCHED	ICAEW and AI Magazine snippets agree
S329	Deloitte US	Operationalizing gen AI at enterprise scale (Sidekick)	n.d.	https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/what-we-do/capabilities/applied-artificial-intelligence/articles/operationalizing-gen-ai-enterprise-scale.html	FETCHED	Primary, US member firms
S330	Deloitte UK	Early careers: Enabling Functions	n.d.	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/our-business-areas/early-careers-enabling-functions.html	FETCHED	Primary
S331	Deloitte UK / search	Professional opportunities: Enabling Functions (Cardiff)	n.d.	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/discover-deloitte/our-business-areas/professional-opportunities-enabling-functions.html	SNIPPET	Not fetched
S332	Consultancy.uk	Test and Trace spends £1 million per day on Deloitte consultants	2021-07-02	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/28374/test-and-trace-spends-1-million-per-day-on-deloitte-consultants	FETCHED	Draws on PAC/NAO evidence
S333	PublicTechnology	Test and Trace still dependent on thousands of external consultants, watchdog finds	2021-06-28	https://www.publictechnology.net/2021/06/28/business-and-industry/test-and-trace-still-dependent-thousands-external-consultants-watchdog-finds/	FETCHED	Reports NAO findings
S334	National Audit Office	Government lacks a clear picture on how much it spends on consultants	2025-11-21	https://www.nao.org.uk/press-releases/government-lacks-a-clear-picture-on-how-much-it-spends-on-consultants/	FETCHED	Primary
S335	Consultancy.uk (Tussell data)	Government spending on consulting grows to record £3.7 billion	2026-05-26	https://www.consultancy.uk/news/44186/government-consulting-spend-hits-37-billion	FETCHED	Tussell underlying data not read
S336	Tussell	Analysis of public sector frameworks: Deloitte case study	n.d.	https://www.tussell.com/analysis-of-public-sector-frameworks-deloitte-case-study	FETCHED	Landing page only; full report gated

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S337	Wikipedia	The Big Con (Mazzucato and Collington book)	n.d.	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Big_Con_(Mazzucato_and_Collington_book)	FETCHED	Secondary summary; book not read; LSE review fetch returned empty
S338	Accenture SEC filings / PwC UK press release	Accenture FY25 results; PwC UK 2025 financial results	2025	https://www.pwc.co.uk/press-room/press-releases/corporate-news/2025-financial-results-resilience-in-a-year-of-transformation-and-change.html	SNIPPET	Not fetched; verify figures
S339	Deloitte LLP consent letter (via Centrica) / filings	Deloitte LLP registration statement (OC303675)	n.d.	https://www.centrica.com/media/5355/deloitte-consent-letter.pdf	SNIPPET	Wording "Deloitte NWE LLP" is dated
S340	Deloitte Global	Global Principles of Business Conduct: It starts with integrity (PDF)	Oct 2025	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-shared/docs/global-principles-of-business-conduct.pdf	FETCHED	Primary; full text read
S341	Deloitte Global	Global Principles of Business Conduct (web page)	n.d. (live 2026)	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/story/purpose-values/global-principles-of-business-conduct.html	FETCHED	Primary; overview and Speak Up links
S342	Deloitte Global	Shared Values - Deloitte Global Code	n.d. (live 2026)	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/story/purpose-values/global-principles-of-business-conduct/shared-values.html	FETCHED	Primary; verbatim values
S343	Deloitte Global	Deloitte Speak Up	n.d. (live 2026)	https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/story/purpose-values/global-principles-of-business-conduct/speak-up.html	FETCHED	Primary
S344	Deloitte UK	Report an ethics concern (Ethics contacts)	n.d. (live 2026)	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/legal/deloitte-ethics-contacts.html	FETCHED	Primary; UK contact name and LLP footer
S345	Deloitte UK	Audit Transparency Report 2025 (accessible PDF)	2025 (FY to 31 May 2025)	https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2025/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2025-audit-transparency-report-accessible.pdf	FETCHED	Primary; ethics, independence, GenAI risk sections read
S346	Deloitte UK	Trustworthy AI	n.d. (live 2026)	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/issues/generative-ai/trustworthy-ai.html	FETCHED	Primary; dimension definitions (labels rendered as images/short text)
S347	Deloitte US	Trusted generative AI (Abrash and Ammanath)	n.d.	https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/what-we-do/capabilities/applied-artificial-intelligence/articles/trusted-generative-ai.html	FETCHED	Primary (US member firm)
S348	PR Newswire (Deloitte release)	Deloitte Introduces Trustworthy AI Framework to Guide Organizations in Ethical Application of Technology	Aug 2020 (exact day not shown in text read)	https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/deloitte-introduces-trustworthy-ai-framework-to-guide-organizations-in-ethical-application-of-technology-in-the-age-of-with-30118495.html	FETCHED	Primary release; "six-part framework"
S349	Deloitte Netherlands	Trustworthy Artificial Intelligence	n.d.	https://www.deloitte.com/nl/en/services/risk-advisory/services/trustworthy-artificial-intelligence.html	FETCHED	Primary; refers to "six key dimensions"
S350	Deloitte UK	Early Careers Assessment	n.d. (live 2026)	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/early-careers/early-careers-assessment.html	FETCHED	Primary; full process read
S351	Deloitte UK	Integrity & AI guidance (early careers)	n.d. (live 2026)	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/early-careers/integrity-guidance.html	FETCHED	Primary
S352	Deloitte UK	Early Careers FAQ	n.d. (live 2026)	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/early-careers/early-careers-faq.html	FETCHED	Primary
S353	ICO	A guide to the data protection principles	live 2026 (under review re DUAA)	https://ico.org.uk/for-organisations/uk-gdpr-guidance-and-resources/data-protection-principles/a-guide-to-the-data-protection-principles/	FETCHED	Regulator
S354	ICO	Personal data breaches: a guide	live 2026	https://ico.org.uk/for-organisations/report-a-breach/personal-data-breach/personal-data-breaches-a-guide/	FETCHED	Regulator
S355	legislation.gov.uk	Bribery Act 2010, section 7	2010 (revised)	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2010/23/section/7	FETCHED	Statute
S356	legislation.gov.uk	Bribery Act 2010, section 1	2010	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2010/23/section/1	FETCHED	Statute
S357	Ministry of Justice / gov.uk	The Bribery Act 2010: Guidance (s.9)	2011	https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/5d80cfc3ed915d51e9aff85a/bribery-act-2010-guidance.pdf	FETCHED	Statutory guidance
S358	legislation.gov.uk	UK MAR (Reg 596/2014) Article 7	2014 (as retained/amended)	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/eur/2014/596/article/7	FETCHED	Assimilated law
S359	legislation.gov.uk	UK MAR Article 10	2014	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/eur/2014/596/article/10	FETCHED	Assimilated law
S360	legislation.gov.uk	UK MAR Article 14	2014	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/eur/2014/596/article/14	FETCHED	Assimilated law

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S361	legislation.gov.uk	Economic Crime and Corporate Transparency Act 2023, section 199	2023	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2023/56/section/199	FETCHED	Statute
S362	Crown Prosecution Service	Organisations must prepare now for new fraud prevention law	2025 (pre-Sept)	https://www.cps.gov.uk/cps/news/organisations-must-prepare-now-new-fraud-prevention-law	FETCHED	Prosecutor; confirms 1 Sept 2025
S363	legislation.gov.uk	Computer Misuse Act 1990, section 1 (and s.17)	1990 (revised)	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1990/18/section/1	FETCHED	Statute
S364	Financial Reporting Council	Revised Ethical Standard 2024 (PDF)	2024 (effective 15 Dec 2024)	https://www.frc.org.uk/documents/6703/Revised_Ethical_Standard_2024_orZHKLq.pdf	FETCHED	Regulator standard; sections read
S365	Financial Reporting Council	Ethical Standard for auditors (landing page)	live 2026	https://www.frc.org.uk/library/standards-codes-policy/audit-assurance-and-ethics/ethical-standard-for-auditors/	FETCHED	Regulator
S366	legislation.gov.uk	Procurement Act 2023, section 81	2023	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2023/54/section/81	FETCHED	Statute
S367	legislation.gov.uk	Procurement Act 2023, section 82	2023	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2023/54/section/82	FETCHED	Statute
S368	legislation.gov.uk	Procurement Act 2023, section 83	2023	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2023/54/section/83	FETCHED	Statute
S369	gov.uk (Cabinet Office)	Government baseline personnel security standard	v7.0 June 2024	https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/government-baseline-personnel-security-standard	FETCHED	Government
S370	gov.uk	National security vetting: clearance levels	2024	https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/united-kingdom-security-vetting-clearance-levels/national-security-vetting-clearance-levels	FETCHED	Government
S371	ICAEW	ICAEW Code of Ethics (landing page)	live 2026	https://www.icaew.com/technical/ethics/icaew-code-of-ethics/icaew-code-of-ethics	FETCHED	Professional body; "came into force on 1 July 2026"
S372	ICAEW	ICAEW Code of Ethics 2026 (PDF), section 110	2026	https://www.icaew.com/-/media/corporate/files/technical/ethics/code-of-ethics/icaew-code-of-ethics-2026.ashx	FETCHED	Professional body
S373	Schwaber & Sutherland	The 2020 Scrum Guide (PDF)	Nov 2020	https://scrumguides.org/docs/scrumguide/v2020/2020-Scrum-Guide-US.pdf	FETCHED	Primary
S374	Minto Books International	barbaraminto.com home page	live 2026	https://www.barbaraminto.com/	FETCHED	Primary (author's own site)
S375	Wikipedia	MECE principle	live 2026	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/MECE_principle	FETCHED	Secondary; use with care
S376	Wikipedia	Issue tree	live 2026	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Issue_tree	FETCHED	Secondary; cites Chevallier, McKinsey, PM Strategy Unit
S377	APM	What is change control?	live 2026	https://www.apm.org.uk/resources/what-is-project-management/what-is-change-control/	FETCHED	Professional body
S378	APM	What is scope management?	live 2026	https://www.apm.org.uk/resources/what-is-project-management/what-is-scope-management/	FETCHED	Professional body
S379	Wikipedia	Responsibility assignment matrix	live 2026	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Responsibility_assignment_matrix	FETCHED	Secondary
S380	Wikipedia	Stakeholder analysis	live 2026	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Stakeholder_analysis	FETCHED	Secondary
S381	Wikipedia	User acceptance testing	live 2026	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/User_acceptance_testing	FETCHED	Secondary; quotes ISTQB glossary
S382	Prospects (Jisc)	Competency-based interviews	live 2026	https://www.prospects.ac.uk/careers-advice/interview-tips/competency-based-interviews	FETCHED	UK careers authority
S383	Prospects (Jisc)	Assessment centres	live 2026	https://www.prospects.ac.uk/careers-advice/interview-tips/assessment-centres	FETCHED	UK careers authority
S384	J Exp Psychol Gen (via PubMed 24364682)	Brooks AW, Get excited: reappraising pre-performance anxiety as excitement	2014 (epub Dec 2013)	https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/24364682/	FETCHED	Peer-reviewed; abstract read
S385	Cell Rep Med (via PubMed 36630953)	Balban MY et al., Brief structured respiration practices enhance mood and reduce physiological arousal	Jan 2023	https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/36630953/	FETCHED	Peer-reviewed RCT; abstract read
S386	J Exp Soc Psychol (via PubMed 20161454)	Jamieson JP et al., Turning the knots in your stomach into bows	2010	https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/20161454/	FETCHED	Peer-reviewed; abstract read

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL (all accessed 2026-10-04)	Status	Note
S387	Science (via PubMed 21233387)	Ramirez G, Beilock SL, Writing about testing worries boosts exam performance in the classroom	Jan 2011	https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/21233387/	FETCHED	Peer-reviewed; abstract read; erratum 2014
S388	The Guardian	Deloitte to pay money back to Albanese government after using AI in \$440,000 report	6 Oct 2025	https://www.theguardian.com/australia-news/2025/oct/06/deloitte-to-pay-money-back-to-albanese-government-after-using-ai-in-440000-report	FETCHED	Quality press
S389	Financial Times	Deloitte issues refund for error-ridden Australian government report that used AI	6 Oct 2025	https://www.ft.com/content/934cc94b-32c4-497e-9718-d87d6a7835ca	PAYWALLED	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ; headline only
S390	NPR	McKinsey and Company to pay \$650M for role in opioid crisis	13 Dec 2024	https://www.npr.org/2024/12/13/nx-s1-5155962/mckinsey-purdue-opioid-prosecution-do-j	FETCHED	Quality press
S391	ProPublica	McKinsey Never Told the FDA It Was Working for Opioid Makers While Also Working for the Agency	Oct 2021 (indexed 4 Oct 2021)	https://www.propublica.org/article/mckinsey-never-told-the-fda-it-was-working-for-opioid-makers-while-also-working-for-the-agency	FETCHED	Investigative outlet; exact pub day inferred from index date
S392	ABC News (Australia)	PwC Australia CEO Tom Seymour steps down after tax documents leak scandal	9 May 2023	https://www.abc.net.au/news/2023-05-09/pwc-australia-ceo-steps-down-after-tax-documents-leak-scandal/102323102	FETCHED	Public broadcaster
S393	The Guardian	Deloitte hit by cyber-attack revealing clients' secret emails	25 Sep 2017	https://www.theguardian.com/business/2017/sep/25/deloitte-hit-by-cyber-attack-revealing-clients-secret-emails	FETCHED	Quality press
S394	The Register	Capita fined £14M after 58-hour delay exposed 6.6M records	15 Oct 2025	https://www.theregister.com/2025/10/15/ico_fines_capita_14m/	FETCHED	Trade press; ICO penalty notice itself not fetched
S395	J Exp Psychol Appl (via PubMed 24708352)	Park D, Ramirez G, Beilock SL, The role of expressive writing in math anxiety	2014	https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/24708352/	FETCHED	Peer-reviewed; supports S387
S400	TechMarketView	Technology & Transformation lifts Deloitte UK in FY26	2026-09-30	https://www.techmarketview.com/ukhotviews/archive/2026/09/30/technology-transformation-lifts-deloitte-uk-in-fy26	FETCHED	Says UK revenue just over £5bn (+3%), conflicts with Deloitte's £5.81bn; trust Deloitte
S401	City AM	PwC UK profits edge up as headcount reductions take effect	2025	https://www.cityam.com/pwc-uk-profits-edge-up-as-headcount-reductions-take-effect/	FETCHED	PwC UK FY25: £6.35bn, 123 partner cuts, consulting -3%
S402	Bright Network	Accenture Consulting Graduate Programme 2026/2027	n.d.	https://www.brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-jobs/accenture/consulting-graduate-programme-london-2026-2027	SNIPPET	Fetch 403; salary from snippet only
S403	Wikipedia	Moss Adams	n.d.	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Moss_Adams	SNIPPET	Baker Tilly merger 3 June 2025, Hellman & Friedman
S404	International Accounting Bulletin	PwC UK launches restructuring to form standalone tech and AI unit	2024-10-07	https://www.internationalaccountingbulletin.com/news/pwc-uk-restructuring-ai/	FETCHED	Reported
S405	PR Newswire; Consultancy.uk	Deloitte Digital acquires Heat (2016); Deloitte Digital acquires Acne Agency (2017)	2016; 2017	https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/deloitte-digital-announces-acquisition-of-award-winning-advertising-agency-heat-300227772.html ; https://www.consultancy.uk/news/13861/deloitte-digital-acquires-swe-dish-creative-consultancy-acne-agency	SNIPPET	Reported
S406	Bain & Company	About	n.d.	https://www.bain.com/about/	FETCHED	Founded 1973; 67 cities in 40 countries
S407	Deloitte UK	Deloitte UK publishes 2026 financial results (full text incl. notes to editors)	2026-09-30	https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-publishes-2026-financial-results.html	FETCHED	Read in full by lead including footnotes; primary

PART 16

Gaps and open questions

What this pack could not establish, why, and how you can find out yourself; where sources disagree and what the pack did about it; and an honest check against the brief.

How to use this part

No outside researcher can see inside a private partnership. Some things Deloitte simply does not publish (day rates, utilisation targets, scoring rubrics). Some pages were paywalled or blocked. And several research workstreams hit a shared limit on web searches, so they switched to reading primary pages directly. This part lists every gap the research files recorded, grouped by topic. Use it three ways:

- **Do not bluff on these points.** If an interviewer raises one, say what you know and what you could not confirm. That is a strength, not a weakness.
- **Turn some into questions.** Gaps marked "ask" make good, genuine questions at an event or at the end of an interview.
- **Check the dated ones.** Some will close on a known date (for example, when London roles go live on 5 October 2026 [S14]).

What could not be established

The role, the JD and recruitment

What is missing	Why	How you could find out
A London T&T graduate advert. THE JD used in Part 1 is a Belfast posting [S2].	London Consulting roles were not live on 4 October; they open on 5 October [S14].	Check the board on or after 5 October. Compare the London text with Part 1's decode line by line.
Graduate salary.	Not published on any Deloitte page read. Only self-reported snippets (about £34k to £39k) [S58][S59] REPORTED .	The live advert or the offer letter. Do not ask in interview.
The "10 core skills" and the capability framework used to score interviews.	They sit behind the Candidate Zone or are not published [S2][S260]. "Deloitte Talent Standards" was not found anywhere.	Candidate Zone after you apply. Use the five Shared Values meanwhile [S266].
This year's final-stage topics.	Candidate-report sites (Glassdoor, The Student Room) returned errors [S289].	Your invitation will give the topic. Ask peers who applied last year.
Whether a group exercise or partner interview still happens at graduate level.	The official page lists only the topic discussion and interview [S260]; older anecdotes mention both [S289][S286].	Read your final-stage invitation closely.
Whether school- and university-blind interviewing (announced 2015) is still used.	Only 2015 sources confirm it [S267][S268].	Ask at a Deloitte event: "Is contextual recruitment still part of the process?"
Security vetting for graduates (BPSS or SC).	No Deloitte UK page says it is standard; many T&T roles prefer SC [S54]. BPSS rules are public [S369][S370].	Ask: "Would a graduate in this team be put forward for clearance?"
Pre-employment screening provider and steps.	Seen only in search snippets [S293][S291].	Your onboarding emails.
Whether graduates attend Deloitte University EMEA in year one.	Not stated [S283].	Ask at an event or after an offer.

What is missing	Why	How you could find out
The named head of UK early careers.	Not found on pages read.	Not needed. Do not guess a name.
Performance system name, utilisation targets, typical years per grade.	No primary source; the HBR article on Deloitte's redesign is paywalled [S61].	Ask a current analyst: "How is performance reviewed in year one?"
T&T's share of the graduate intake.	Not published [S29].	Ask: "How many analysts join TST each year?"

The firm: money, structure and delivery

What is missing	Why	How you could find out
Deloitte's day rates.	Government framework rate cards sit in a tool that could not be opened [S117].	Not knowable from outside. Do not quote a number; Test and Trace rates from 2021 are the only disclosed example [S332].
Utilisation, realisation and margin by business.	Not disclosed; only group cost lines [S93].	Not knowable. Talk about the mechanism instead (Part 2).
FY26 global revenue in US dollars by business and region.	The release gives growth rates only; the FY26 Global Impact Report was not found [S70].	Check for the Global Impact Report later in the autumn.
A consistent UK revenue series before FY2019, and global headcount for FY2017 and FY2020.	Different perimeters; snippets only [S118] [S119].	Older annual reviews on deloitte.com.
Which offshore centres UK T&T uses.	Postings say "onshore and offshore" only [S50][S51]. The UK group owns Deloitte India Services Limited, purpose not stated [S24]. USI belongs to the US firm [S324].	Ask: "How do London analysts work with Belfast and offshore build teams?"
Size of Enabling Functions.	Pages describe teams, not numbers [S330].	Not needed for a consulting interview.
UK job-cut numbers before 2026.	Secondary press and snippets only [S100] [S102].	Treat as Reported. Do not lead with them.
The UK Annual Review narrative for FY26.	Only the metrics, accounts and press release were read [S88][S93][S407].	Read it on deloitte.com/uk before the final stage.
The UK code of conduct, gifts thresholds, Speak Up vendor.	Not public; the Global Code is [S340].	Use the Global Code wording in answers.
Whether "Lead Client Service Partner" is the UK term.	Sources found were US [S322].	Ask: "Who owns the overall relationship on a large account?"

People and leadership

What is missing	Why	How you could find out
Current leaders of UK Cyber and Deloitte Digital.	Not on a current service page; the Extended Leadership Team page may predate June 2026 [S26].	Check the service pages on the day. Use names marked AMBER in Part 1 only after re-checking.
Hammad Rafique's exact prior title.	One trade source plus Deloitte's release, worded differently [S274][S275].	Say "led T&T in Financial Services before taking over UK T&T".
Joe Ucuzoglu's start date as Global CEO.	His profile says December 2022 [S278]; another pass could not confirm a date on a primary page [S73].	Say "Deloitte's Global CEO" without a date.
The UK ethics officer's name.	The page and a search summary disagree [S344].	Not needed. Do not use it.

AI and internal tools

What is missing	Why	How you could find out
Which AI tools a UK T&T analyst uses day to day in 2026, and whether PairD is still the main one.	PairD is confirmed for 2024 and FY25 [S328] [S85] [S345] ; Claude is global [S116] . No UK 2026 tool list.	Ask: "Which internal tools would I use in my first six months?" (Part 9).
A public Deloitte UK policy on using GenAI with client data.	Only Transparency Report controls are public [S345] .	Apply the Code's confidentiality rule [S340] and the JD's "firm-approved" wording [S3] .
Firms' AI investment figures from a commentator blog (for example Deloitte US\$2bn).	Not checked against press releases [S163] .	Use Deloitte's own US\$3bn to 2030 figure instead [S70] .

Competitors and the market

What is missing	Why	How you could find out
PwC and EY FY26 global results, and EY UK FY26.	Not published or not found by 4 October [S126] [S127] .	Check their press rooms; PwC global usually reports in the autumn.
Kennedy, Vault, Oliver Wyman, PA Consulting, Kearney and Bain figures; Accenture, IBM and Capgemini UK numbers.	Search limit reached [S406] .	Not needed in depth. Avoid numeric claims about them.
Official graduate salaries at rivals.	Only Accenture's, from a job board [S402] .	Not needed.
McKinsey's revenue and cuts.	Rests on a summary of a paywalled Bloomberg piece [S135] .	Say "reported", or leave out.
The FRC's 2026 audit quality results by firm.	Read via one secondary outlet [S137] [S236] .	The FRC website.
Who first reported the Big Four graduate cuts, and for which years.	The articles did not name the original source [S143] [S162] .	Treat as Reported.
Public sector share of UK consulting today.	Only an old 21% figure [S159] ; the MCA report is paid-for.	Use Deloitte's own government revenue (£679m) instead [S88] .
Deloitte's places on each MCF4 lot; Cabinet Office approval thresholds.	Aggregator snippets only; a committee page returned an error [S191] .	Not needed for interview.

Regulation and news

What is missing	Why	How you could find out
Exact EU AI Act deadlines after the Digital Omnibus.	Sources disagree (see below); the Official Journal text was not read [S192] [S193] [S234] .	EUR-Lex. Say "high-risk duties now from late 2027".
ICAEW as Deloitte's audit regulator; Chartered Management Consultant details.	Deloitte's Regulators page was not loaded [S204] .	Deloitte UK legal pages.
Mandatory timetable for UK sustainability reporting standards.	Published for voluntary use only so far [S202] .	Watch gov.uk.
Failure-to-prevent-fraud size thresholds; UK MAR reforms; Procurement Act commencement order.	Law-firm snippets or modification notes only [S361] [S358] .	legislation.gov.uk.
FT and Bloomberg detail (for example Graves interviews).	Paywalled or blocked [S223] [S228] .	A library or student subscription.
Deloitte UK CFO Survey Q3 2026.	Not yet published; due around mid-October [S224] INFERRED .	Deloitte UK press room. Read it before any final stage.

Where sources disagree, and what this pack did

Topic	One source says	Another says	How the pack resolved it
Swiss revenue inside £5.81bn	Four UK business lines sum to about £5.02bn, leaving about £0.8bn unexplained [S122][S220][S303].	The results footnote says all figures are "UK and Switzerland consolidated" [S407].	Settled by the FY26 metrics: UK £5,014m plus Switzerland £795m equals £5,809m [S88] CONFIRMED . Quote £5.81bn as UK and Switzerland.
UK revenue "just over £5bn"	TechMarketView: just over £5bn, +3% [S400].	Deloitte: £5.81bn, +2% [S407].	TechMarketView appears to quote a UK-only figure. Trust Deloitte's own numbers.
784 or 799 equity partners	Results release: 784, a record, up 6.5% [S407].	Metrics and accounts: 799 on a full-time-equivalent average [S88].	Different bases. Quote 784; mention the FTE basis only if pressed.
1,308 or 1,453 partners	1,308 partners at 1 June 2026 [S25] [S95].	1,453 as an FY26 average including salaried partners [S88].	Different dates and definitions. Use 1,453 only for FY26 averages.
Headcount	"25,000 people" [S407].	23,970 FTE employees; 26,030 average employees [S24]; "over 26,000" in FY25 [S345].	Say "about 25,000 people", the firm's own rounding.
EU AI Act high-risk date	2 December 2027 after the omnibus [S192][S234].	2 August 2027 [S193]. Official Journal date given as 27 or 29 July 2026 [S192].	Pack uses 2 December 2027 (the later law-firm sources), flagged as uncertain.
Ucuzoglu's start date	Global CEO "since December 2022" [S278].	"Widely reported as June 2023", not verified [S73].	No date used in the pack's lines.
Deloitte's values	Four values: Integrity, Outstanding value, Commitment, Diversity [S264].	Five Shared Values [S266] [S342].	The four-value list is outdated. Use the five.
The timelines page	2024 cycle dates only [S262].	2026/27 dates, Consulting opening "5th October" [S14].	Same page read at different moments. Pack uses the 2026/27 dates; check on 5 October.
How many firms in Deloitte EMEA	UK LLP "combined with 14 other" firms [S24][S93].	16 participating firms [S124] [S277].	Pack uses 16 from Deloitte EMEA's own release. The accounts count from the UK firm's side.
Gartner No. 1, how many years	Eighth consecutive year [S81] [S301].	Ninth consecutive year, 14th in total [S125].	Both right for their report year. Pack uses nine (2026 report), as Deloitte's claim REPORTED .
Global T&T in FY26	City AM: the tech division "declined" [S100].	Deloitte: grew 2.5% in local currency [S70].	Use Deloitte's figure.
T&T share of UK revenue	About 30% [S303].	34.8% [S23].	30% divides by the UK and Swiss total. The pack uses about 35% of UK-only revenue.
Early-careers intake	1,353 starters across 21 offices [S271]; headline "1,500" [S29].	1,950+ graduates, apprentices and interns hired in FY26 [S407].	Different scopes (September starters, academies, a full year of hiring). Quote each with its label.
Legal parent wording	Job adverts: "UK affiliate of Deloitte NSE LLP" [S2]; older filings "NWE" [S339].	From 1 June 2026, an affiliate holds shares in Deloitte EMEA BV [S407][S344].	Adverts carry stale footers. Use the FY26 wording.
People & Purpose leader	Jackie Henry, quoted in May and September 2026 [S280][S271].	Matt Batham "having taken up the role in October 2026" [S281].	Batham is current; Henry is the predecessor.
Market size	UK consulting £21.8bn in 2025 (MCA) [S150].	£14.9bn in 2024 (Source Global Research) [S154].	Different definitions. Name the source with the number.
Government consultancy spend	£602.7m saved against plan, July 2024 to March 2025 [S172].	Contract value rose to £1.44bn in Labour's first year [S174]; record £3.7bn public sector total [S335].	Spend versus contracts awarded versus wider public sector. Present both sides (Part 8).

Topic	One source says	Another says	How the pack resolved it
Accenture's size	US\$69.7bn, fiscal 2025 [S338] .	US\$74.18bn, fiscal 2026 [S129] .	Different years. The pack uses FY26.
Corrections to the original brief	Blind recruitment "2016"; Deloitte University "near Brussels".	Announced 29 September 2015 [S267] ; moved near Paris in 2024 [S283] .	Pack uses 2015 and Paris.

Self-check against the brief

An honest status for each requirement. "Checked at build" items are verified by the lead when the final PDF is assembled.

Requirement	Status	Note
Verify Deloitte LLP's registration and where the UK firm sits in the network in 2026	Done	OC303675; DTTL member firm via Deloitte EMEA from 1 June 2026 [S407] [S24] .
Find the current 2026/27 postings and quote THE JD verbatim with its URL	Partly	Belfast TST graduate posting quoted [S2] ; London postings open 5 October, so compare then.
London by default, plus other offices hiring into the programme	Done	Belfast, Edinburgh, Manchester, Bristol and the technology centres covered (Parts 1 and 2).
Cover application, online assessments, interviews and final stage	Done	Part 9, from Deloitte's own pages [S260] [S351] .
Speak fluently about firm, role and industry	Done	Parts 1 to 7.
Form opinions with both sides	Done	Nine debates in Part 8.
A mechanism-based "why Deloitte"	Done	Parts 3 and 12.
No interviewer names and no insider intelligence	Done	Part 10 covers public leaders and interviewer types only.
Never fabricate; source every non-obvious claim	Done	Every fact traces to a findings file. Cited-but-missing IDs: checked at build.
Confidence tags on claims	Done	Five tags, explained in Part 0.
Prefer primary sources	Done	Results, accounts, metrics, job postings, FRC, legislation first; press second.
Paywalls recorded, never guessed	Done	FT, Bloomberg and HBR items marked PAYWALLED-NOT-READ (Part 15).
Minimum searches and full-page fetches per workstream	Partly	Several workstreams hit the shared search limit and switched to direct fetches of primary pages; noted in each gap above.
People research: public professional information only	Done	Roles, tenure and career paths only.
Plain English, British spelling, no em dashes	Done	Em dash count: checked at build.
Visual for a visual learner, with sourced figures	Done	Numbered figures with source captions; estimates labelled on charts.
Cheat sheet on one page, plus a standalone copy	Done	Part 13 and Cheat_Sheet.pdf.
Gaps and conflicts listed honestly	Done	This part.
PDF rendered, contents with page numbers, links working	Checked at build	Verified by the lead on the final file.
No clipped, overlapping or cramped figure text	Checked at build	QA script plus a visual check of every figure page.